

# Zcash Protocol Specification

Version 2025.6.3-242-gdb1973 [NU6.1]

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**Abstract.** **Zcash** is an implementation of the *Decentralized Anonymous Payment* scheme **Zerocash**, with security fixes and improvements to performance and functionality. It bridges the existing transparent payment scheme used by **Bitcoin** with a *shielded* payment scheme secured by *zero-knowledge succinct non-interactive arguments of knowledge* (zk-SNARKs). It attempted to address the problem of mining centralization by use of the *Equihash* memory-hard *proof-of-work* algorithm.

This specification defines the **Zcash** consensus protocol at launch, and after each of the upgrades codenamed **Overwinter**, **Sapling**, **Blossom**, **Heartwood**, **Canopy**, **NU5**, **NU6**, and **NU6.1**. It is a work in progress. Protocol differences from **Zerocash** and **Bitcoin** are also explained.

**Keywords:** anonymity, applications, cryptographic protocols, electronic commerce and payment, financial privacy, proof of work, zero knowledge.

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<sup>1</sup> Jubjub bird image credit: Peter Newell 1902; Daira-Emma Hopwood 2018.

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# 1 Introduction

**Zcash** is an implementation of the *Decentralized Anonymous Payment scheme Zerocash* [BCGGMTV2014], with security fixes and improvements to performance and functionality. It bridges the existing transparent payment scheme used by **Bitcoin** [Nakamoto2008] with a *shielded* payment scheme secured by *zero-knowledge succinct non-interactive arguments of knowledge (zk-SNARKs)*.

In this document, technical terms for concepts that play an important rôle in **Zcash** are written in *slanted text*, which links to an index entry. *Italics* are used for emphasis and for references between sections of the document. The symbol § precedes section numbers in cross-references.

The key words **MUST**, **MUST NOT**, **SHOULD**, **SHOULD NOT**, **RECOMMENDED**, **MAY**, and **OPTIONAL** in this document are to be interpreted as described in [RFC-2119] when they appear in **ALL CAPS**. These words may also appear in this document in lower case as plain English words, absent their normative meanings.

The most significant changes from the original **Zerocash** are explained in § 8 *‘Differences from the **Zerocash** paper’* on p. 142.

Changes specific to the **Overwinter** upgrade are highlighted in [bright blue](#).

Changes specific to the **Sapling** upgrade following **Overwinter** are highlighted in [green](#).

Changes specific to the **Blossom** upgrade following **Sapling** are highlighted in [red](#).

Changes specific to the **Heartwood** upgrade following **Blossom** are highlighted in [orange](#).

Changes specific to the **Canopy** upgrade following **Heartwood** are highlighted in [purple](#).

Changes specific to the **NU5** upgrade following **Canopy** are highlighted in [slate blue](#).

Changes specific to the **NU6** upgrade following **NU5** are highlighted in [pink](#).

Changes specific to the **NU6.1** upgrade following **NU6** are highlighted in [burgundy](#).

All of these are also changes from **Zerocash**.

The name **Sprout** is used for the *shielded protocol* defined prior to the **Sapling** upgrade.

This specification is structured as follows:

- Notation – definitions of notation used throughout the document;
- Concepts – the principal abstractions needed to understand the protocol;
- Abstract Protocol – a high-level description of the protocol in terms of ideal cryptographic components;
- Concrete Protocol – how the functions and encodings of the abstract protocol are instantiated;
- Network Upgrades – the strategy for upgrading the **Zcash** protocol.
- Consensus Changes from **Bitcoin** – how **Zcash** differs from **Bitcoin** at the consensus layer, including the Proof of Work;
- Differences from the **Zerocash** protocol – a summary of changes from the protocol in [BCGGMTV2014].
- Appendix: Circuit Design – details of how the **Sapling** circuits are defined as *quadratic constraint programs*.
- Appendix: Batching Optimizations – improvements to the efficiency of validating multiple signatures and verifying multiple proofs.

## 1.1 Caution

**Zcash** security depends on consensus. Should a program interacting with the **Zcash** network diverge from consensus, its security will be weakened or destroyed. The cause of the divergence doesn't matter: it could be a bug in your program, it could be an error in this documentation which you implemented as described, or it could be that you do everything right but other software on the network behaves unexpectedly. The specific cause will not matter to the users of your software whose wealth is lost.

Having said that, a specification of *intended* behaviour is essential for security analysis, understanding of the protocol, and maintenance of **Zcash** and related software. If you find any mistake in this specification, please file an issue at <https://github.com/zcash/zips/issues> or contact <security@z.cash>.

## 1.2 High-level Overview

The following overview is intended to give a concise summary of the ideas behind the protocol, for an audience already familiar with *block chain*-based cryptocurrencies such as **Bitcoin**. It is imprecise in some aspects and is not part of the normative protocol specification. This overview applies to **Sprout**, **Sapling**, and **Orchard**, differences in the cryptographic constructions used notwithstanding.

All value in **Zcash** belongs to some *chain value pool*. There is a single *transparent chain value pool*, a *chain value pool* for each *shielded* protocol (**Sprout** or **Sapling** or **Orchard**), and a *deferred development fund chain value pool*. Transfers of *transparent* value work essentially as in **Bitcoin** and have the same privacy properties. Value in a *shielded chain value pool* is carried by *notes*<sup>2</sup>, which specify an amount and (indirectly) a *shielded payment address*, which is a destination to which *notes* can be sent. As in **Bitcoin**, this is associated with a *private key* that can be used to spend *notes* sent to the address; in **Zcash** this is called a *spending key*.

To each *note* there is cryptographically associated a *note commitment*. Once the *transaction* creating a *note* has been mined, the *note* is associated with a fixed *note position* in a tree of *note commitments*, and with a *nullifier*<sup>2</sup> unique to that *note*. Computing the *nullifier* requires the associated private *spending key* (or the *nullifier deriving key* for **Sapling** or **Orchard** *notes*). It is infeasible to correlate the *note commitment* or *note position* with the corresponding *nullifier* without knowledge of at least this key. An unspent valid *note*, at a given point on the *block chain*, is one for which the *note commitment* has been publically revealed on the *block chain* prior to that point, but the *nullifier* has not.

A *transaction* can contain *transparent* inputs, outputs, and scripts, which all work as in **Bitcoin** [Bitcoin-Protocol]. It also can include *JoinSplit* descriptions, *Spend descriptions*, *Output descriptions* and *Action descriptions*. Together these describe *shielded transfers* which take in *shielded input notes*, and/or produce *shielded output notes*. (For **Sprout**, each *JoinSplit* description handles up to two *shielded inputs* and up to two *shielded outputs*. For **Sapling**, each *shielded input* or *shielded output* has its own description. For **Orchard**, each *Action description* handles up to one *shielded input* and up to one *shielded output*.) It is also possible for value to be transferred between *chain value pools*, either *transparent* or *shielded*; this always reveals the amount transferred.

In each *shielded transfer*, the *nullifiers* of the input *notes* are revealed (preventing them from being spent again) and the commitments of the output *notes* are revealed (allowing them to be spent in future).

A *transaction* also includes computationally sound *zk-SNARK* proofs and signatures, which prove that all of the following hold except with insignificant probability:

For each *shielded input*,

- [Sapling onward] there is a revealed *value commitment* to the same value as the input *note*;<sup>3</sup>
- if the value is nonzero, some revealed *note commitment* exists for this *note*;
- the prover knew the *proof authorizing key* of the *note*;

<sup>2</sup> In **Zerocash** [BCGGMTV2014], *notes* were called “coins”, and *nullifiers* were called “serial numbers”.

<sup>3</sup> For **Orchard**, each *Action* reveals a single *value commitment* to the net value spent by the *Action*, rather than one *value commitment* for the input *note* and one for the output *note*.



- the *nullifier* and *note commitment* are computed correctly.

and for each *shielded output*,

- [Sapling onward] there is a revealed *value commitment* to the same value as the output *note*;<sup>3</sup>
- the *note commitment* is computed correctly;
- it is infeasible to cause the *nullifier* of the output *note* to collide with the *nullifier* of any other *note*.

For **Sprout**, the *JoinSplit statement* also includes an explicit balance check. For **Sapling** and **Orchard**, the *value commitments* corresponding to the inputs and outputs are checked to balance (together with any net *transparent input or output*) outside the *zk-SNARK*.

In addition, various measures (differing between **Sprout** and **Sapling** or **Orchard**) are used to ensure that the *transaction* cannot be modified by a party not authorized to do so.

Outside the *zk-SNARK*, it is checked that the *nullifiers* for the input *notes* had not already been revealed (i.e. they had not already been spent).

A *shielded payment address* includes a *transmission key* for a “key-private” asymmetric encryption scheme. *Key-private* means that ciphertexts do not reveal information about which key they were encrypted to, except to a holder of the corresponding *private key*, which in this context is called the *receiving key*. This facility is used to communicate encrypted output *notes* on the *block chain* to their intended recipient, who can use the *receiving key* to scan the *block chain* for *notes* addressed to them and then decrypt those *notes*.

In **Sapling** and **Orchard**, for each *spending key* there is a *full viewing key* that allows recognizing both incoming and outgoing *notes* without having *spending authority*. This is implemented by an additional ciphertext in each *Output description* or *Action description*.

The basis of the privacy properties of **Zcash** is that when a *note* is spent, the spender only proves that some commitment for it had been revealed, without revealing which one. This implies that a spent *note* cannot be linked to the *transaction* in which it was created. That is, from an adversary’s point of view the set of possibilities for a given *note* input to a *transaction* —its *note traceability set*— includes *all* previous notes that the adversary does not control or know to have been spent.<sup>4</sup> This contrasts with other proposals for private payment systems, such as CoinJoin [Bitcoin-CoinJoin] or **CryptoNote** [vanSaberh2014], that are based on mixing of a limited number of transactions and that therefore have smaller *note traceability sets*.

The *nullifiers* are necessary to prevent *double-spending*: each *note* on the *block chain* only has one valid *nullifier*, and so attempting to spend a *note* twice would reveal the *nullifier* twice, which would cause the second *transaction* to be rejected.

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<sup>4</sup> We make this claim only for *fully shielded transactions*. It does not exclude the possibility that an adversary may use data present in the cleartext of a *transaction* such as the number of inputs and outputs, or metadata-based heuristics such as timing, to make probabilistic inferences about *transaction* linkage. For consequences of this in the case of partially shielded *transactions*, see [Peterson2017], [Quesnelle2017], and [KYMM2018].

## 2 Notation

$\mathbb{B}$  means the type of bit values, i.e.  $\{0, 1\}$ .  $\mathbb{B}^Y$  means the type of byte values, i.e.  $\{0 \dots 255\}$ .

$\mathbb{N}$  means the type of nonnegative integers.  $\mathbb{N}^+$  means the type of positive integers.  $\mathbb{Z}$  means the type of integers.  $\mathbb{Q}$  means the type of rationals.

$x : T$  is used to specify that  $x$  has type  $T$ . A cartesian product type is denoted by  $S \times T$ , and a function type by  $S \rightarrow T$ . An argument to a function can determine other argument or result types.

The type of a randomized algorithm is denoted by  $S \xrightarrow{R} T$ . The domain of a randomized algorithm may be  $()$ , indicating that it requires no arguments. Given  $f : S \xrightarrow{R} T$  and  $s : S$ , sampling a variable  $x : T$  from the output of  $f$  applied to  $s$  is denoted by  $x \xleftarrow{R} f(s)$ .

Initial arguments to a function or randomized algorithm may be written as subscripts, e.g. if  $x : X$ ,  $y : Y$ , and  $f : X \times Y \rightarrow Z$ , then an invocation of  $f(x, y)$  can also be written  $f_x(y)$ .

$\{x : T \mid p_x\}$  means the subset of  $x$  from  $T$  for which  $p_x$  (a boolean expression depending on  $x$ ) holds.

$T \subseteq U$  indicates that  $T$  is an inclusive subset or subtype of  $U$ .

$S \cup T$  means the set union of  $S$  and  $T$ .

$S \cap T$  means the set intersection of  $S$  and  $T$ , i.e.  $\{x : S \mid x \in T\}$ .

$S \setminus T$  means the set difference obtained by removing elements in  $T$  from  $S$ , i.e.  $\{x : S \mid x \notin T\}$ .

$x : T \mapsto e_x : U$  means the function of type  $T \rightarrow U$  mapping formal parameter  $x$  to  $e_x$  (an expression depending on  $x$ ). The types  $T$  and  $U$  are always explicit.

$x : T \mapsto_{\notin V} e_x : U$  means  $x : T \mapsto e_x : U \cup V$  restricted to the domain  $\{x : T \mid e_x \notin V\}$  and range  $U$ .

$\mathcal{P}(T)$  means the powerset of  $T$ .

$\perp$  is a distinguished value used to indicate unavailable information, a failed decryption or validity check, or an exceptional case.

$T^{[\ell]}$ , where  $T$  is a type and  $\ell$  is an integer, means the type of sequences of length  $\ell$  with elements in  $T$ . For example,  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$  means the set of sequences of  $\ell$  bits, and  $\mathbb{B}^{Y[k]}$  means the set of sequences of  $k$  bytes.

$\mathbb{B}^{Y[N]}$  means the type of *byte sequences* of arbitrary length.

$\text{length}(S)$  means the length of (number of elements in)  $S$ .

$\text{truncate}_k(S)$  means the sequence formed from the first  $k$  elements of  $S$ .

$0x$  followed by a string of monospace hexadecimal digits means the corresponding integer converted from hexadecimal.  $[0x00]^\ell$  means the sequence of  $\ell$  zero bytes.

$"\dots"$  means the given string represented as a sequence of bytes in *US-ASCII*. For example,  $"abc"$  represents the *byte sequence*  $[0x61, 0x62, 0x63]$ .

$[0]^\ell$  means the sequence of  $\ell$  zero bits.  $[1]^\ell$  means the sequence of  $\ell$  one bits.

$a..b$ , used as a subscript, means the sequence of values with indices  $a$  through  $b$  inclusive. For example,  $a_{pk,1..N}^{\text{new}}$  means the sequence  $[a_{pk,1}^{\text{new}}, a_{pk,2}^{\text{new}}, \dots, a_{pk,N}^{\text{new}}]$ . (For consistency with the notation in [BCGGMTV2014] and in [BK2016], this specification uses 1-based indexing and inclusive ranges, notwithstanding the compelling arguments to the contrary made in [EWD-831].)

$\{a..b\}$  means the set or type of integers from  $a$  through  $b$  inclusive.

$[f(x) \text{ for } x \text{ from } a \text{ up to } b]$  means the sequence formed by evaluating  $f$  on each integer from  $a$  to  $b$  inclusive, in ascending order. Similarly,  $[f(x) \text{ for } x \text{ from } a \text{ down to } b]$  means the sequence formed by evaluating  $f$  on each integer from  $a$  to  $b$  inclusive, in descending order.

$a || b$  means the concatenation of sequences  $a$  then  $b$ .

$\text{concat}_{\mathbb{B}}(S)$  means the sequence of bits obtained by concatenating the elements of  $S$  as *bit sequences*.

$\text{sorted}(S)$  means the sequence formed by sorting the elements of  $S$ .

$\mathbb{F}_n$  means the finite field with  $n$  elements, and  $\mathbb{F}_n^*$  means its group under multiplication (which excludes 0).

Where there is a need to make the distinction, we denote the unique representative of  $a : \mathbb{F}_n$  in the range  $\{0 \dots n-1\}$  (or the unique representative of  $a : \mathbb{F}_n^*$  in the range  $\{1 \dots n-1\}$ ) as  $a \bmod n$ . Conversely, we denote the element of  $\mathbb{F}_n$  corresponding to an integer  $k : \mathbb{Z}$  as  $k \bmod n$ . We also use the latter notation in the context of an equality  $k = k' \bmod n$  as shorthand for  $k \bmod n = k' \bmod n$ , and similarly  $k \neq k' \bmod n$  as shorthand for  $k \bmod n \neq k' \bmod n$ . (When referring to constants such as 0 and 1 it is usually not necessary to make the distinction between field elements and their representatives, since the meaning is normally clear from context.)

$\mathbb{F}_n[z]$  means the ring of polynomials over  $z$  with coefficients in  $\mathbb{F}_n$ .

$a + b$  means the sum of  $a$  and  $b$ . This may refer to addition of integers, rationals, finite field elements, or group elements (see § 4.1.9 ‘*Represented Group*’ on p. 32) according to context.

$-a$  means the value of the appropriate integer, rational, finite field, or group type such that  $(-a) + a = 0$  (or when  $a$  is an element of a group  $\mathbb{G}$ ,  $(-a) + a = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ ), and  $a - b$  means  $a + (-b)$ .

$a \cdot b$  means the product of multiplying  $a$  and  $b$ . This may refer to multiplication of integers, rationals, or finite field elements according to context (this notation is not used for group elements).

$a/b$ , also written  $\frac{a}{b}$ , means the value of the appropriate integer, rational, or finite field type such that  $(a/b) \cdot b = a$ .

$a \bmod q$ , for  $a : \mathbb{N}$  and  $q : \mathbb{N}^+$ , means the remainder on dividing  $a$  by  $q$ . (This usage does not conflict with the notation above for the unique representative of a field element.)

$a \oplus b$  means the bitwise-exclusive-or of  $a$  and  $b$ , and  $a \& b$  means the bitwise-and of  $a$  and  $b$ . These are defined on integers (which include bits and bytes), or elementwise on equal-length sequences of integers, according to context.

$\sum_{i=1}^N a_i$  means the sum of  $a_{1..N}$ .  $\prod_{i=1}^N a_i$  means the product of  $a_{1..N}$ .  $\bigoplus_{i=1}^N a_i$  means the bitwise-exclusive-or of  $a_{1..N}$ .

When  $N = 0$  these yield the appropriate neutral element, i.e.  $\sum_{i=1}^0 a_i = 0$ ,  $\prod_{i=1}^0 a_i = 1$ , and  $\bigoplus_{i=1}^0 a_i = 0$  or the all-zero *bit sequence* of length given by the type of  $a$ .

$\sqrt[a]{a}$ , where  $a : \mathbb{F}_q$ , means the positive square root of  $a$  in  $\mathbb{F}_q$ , i.e. in the range  $\{0 \dots \frac{q-1}{2}\}$ . It is only used in cases where the square root must exist.

$\sqrt[3]{a}$ , where  $a : \mathbb{F}_q$ , means an arbitrary square root of  $a$  in  $\mathbb{F}_q$ , or  $\perp$  if no such square root exists.

$b ? x : y$  means  $x$  when  $b = 1$ , or  $y$  when  $b = 0$ .

$a^b$ , for  $a$  an integer or finite field element and  $b : \mathbb{Z}$ , means the result of raising  $a$  to the exponent  $b$ , i.e.

$$a^b := \begin{cases} \prod_{i=1}^b a, & \text{if } b \geq 0 \\ \prod_{i=1}^{-b} \frac{1}{a}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The  $[k]$   $P$  notation for scalar multiplication in a group is defined in § 4.1.9 ‘*Represented Group*’ on p. 32.

The convention of affixing  $\star$  to a variable name is used for variables that denote *bit sequence* representations of group elements.

The binary relations  $<$ ,  $\leq$ ,  $=$ ,  $\geq$ , and  $>$  have their conventional meanings on integers and rationals, and are defined lexicographically on sequences of integers.

$\text{floor}(x)$  means the largest integer  $\leq x$ .  $\text{ceiling}(x)$  means the smallest integer  $\geq x$ .

$\text{bitlength}(x)$ , for  $x : \mathbb{N}$ , means the smallest integer  $\ell$  such that  $2^\ell > x$ .

The following integer constants will be instantiated in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74:

MerkleDepth<sup>Sprout</sup>, MerkleDepth<sup>Sapling</sup>, MerkleDepth<sup>Orchard</sup>,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$ ,  $N^{\text{old}}$ ,  $N^{\text{new}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{value}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{hSig}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{PRFexpand}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{PRFnsapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Seed}}$ ,  $\ell_{a_{\text{sk}}}$ ,  $\ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{sk}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{d}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{dk}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{ovk}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{base}}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , MAX\_MONEY, BlossomActivationHeight, CanopyActivationHeight, ZIP212GracePeriod, NUFiveActivationHeight, SlowStartInterval, PreBlossomHalvingInterval, MaxBlockSubsidy, NumFounderAddresses, PoWLimit, PoWAveragingWindow, PoWMedianBlockSpan, PoWDampingFactor, PreBlossomPoWTargetSpacing, and PostBlossomPoWTargetSpacing.

The rational constants FoundersFraction, PoWMaxAdjustDown, and PoWMaxAdjustUp; the *bit-sequence* constants Uncommitted<sup>Sprout</sup> :  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  and Uncommitted<sup>Sapling</sup> :  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]}$ ; and the constant Uncommitted<sup>Orchard</sup> :  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  will also be defined in that section.

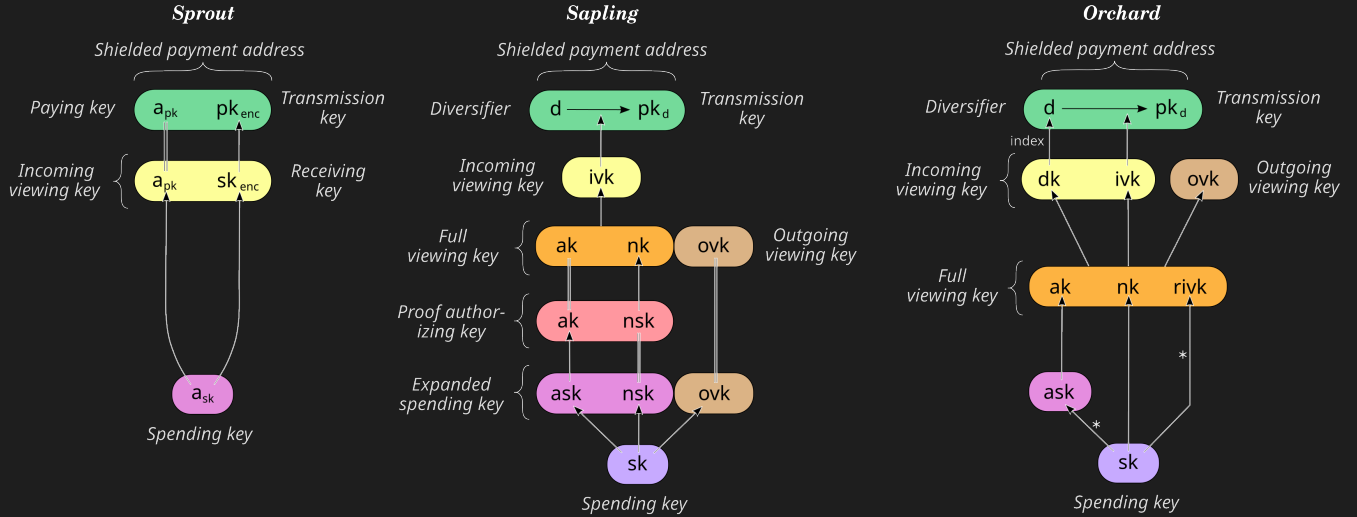
We use the abbreviation “*ctEdwards*” to refer to *complete twisted Edwards elliptic curves* and coordinates (see §5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p.102).

### 3 Concepts

#### 3.1 Payment Addresses and Keys

Users who wish to receive shielded payments in the **Zcash** protocol must have a *shielded payment address*, which is generated from a *spending key*.

The following diagrams depict the relations between key components in **Sprout** and **Sapling** and **Orchard**. Arrows point from a component to any other component(s) that can be derived from it. Double lines indicate that the same component is used in multiple abstractions.



**[Sprout]** A **Sprout** receiving key  $sk_{enc}$ , incoming viewing key  $ivk = (a_{pk}, sk_{enc})$ , and shielded payment address  $addr_{pk} = (a_{pk}, pk_{enc})$  are derived from the spending key  $a_{sk}$ , as described in §4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36.

**[Sapling onward]** A **Sapling** expanded spending key is composed of a *Spend authorizing key*  $ask$ , a *nullifier private key*  $nsk$ , and an *outgoing viewing key*  $ovk$ . From these components we can derive a *proof authorizing key* ( $ak, nsk$ ), a *full viewing key* ( $ak, nk, ovk$ ), an *incoming viewing key*  $ivk$ , and a set of *diversified payment addresses*  $addr_d = (d, pk_d)$ , as described in §4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36.

The consensus protocol does not depend on how an *expanded spending key* is constructed. Two methods of doing so are defined:

1. Generate a *spending key*  $sk$  at random and derive the *expanded spending key* ( $ask, nsk, ovk$ ) from it, as shown in the diagram above and described in §4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36.
2. Obtain an *extended spending key* as specified in [ZIP-32]; this includes a superset of the components of an *expanded spending key*. This method is used in the context of a *Hierarchical Deterministic Wallet*.

**[NU5 onward]** An **Orchard** spending key  $sk$  is used to derive a *Spend authorizing key*  $ask$ , and a *full viewing key* ( $ak, nk, rinvk$ ). From the *full viewing key* we can also derive an *incoming viewing key* (composed of a *diversifier* key  $dk$  and a  $KA^{Orchard}$  private key  $ivk$ ), an *outgoing viewing key*  $ovk$ , and a set of *diversified payment addresses*  $addr_d = (d, pk_d)$ , as described in §4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38.

\* The derivations of  $ask$  and  $rinvk$  shown are not the only possibility. For further detail see §4.2.3 on p. 38.

**Non-normative note:** Most Zcash wallets derive **Sapling** and **Orchard** keys and addresses according to [ZIP-32].

The composition of *shielded payment addresses*, *incoming viewing keys*, *full viewing keys*, and *spending keys* is a cryptographic protocol detail that should not normally be exposed to users. However, user-visible operations should be provided to obtain a *shielded payment address*, *incoming viewing key*, or *full viewing key* from a *spending key* or *extended spending key*.

Users can accept payment from multiple parties with a single *shielded payment address* and the fact that these payments are destined to the same payee is not revealed on the *block chain*, even to the paying parties. *However* if two parties collude to compare a *shielded payment address* they can trivially determine they are the same. In the case that a payee wishes to prevent this they should create a distinct *shielded payment address* for each payer.

[Sapling onward] **Sapling** and **Orchard** provide a mechanism to allow the efficient creation of *diversified payment addresses* with the same *spending authority*. A group of such addresses shares the same *full viewing key* and *incoming viewing key*, and so creating as many unlinkable addresses as needed does not increase the cost of scanning the *block chain* for relevant *transactions*.

**Note:** It is conventional in cryptography to call the key used to encrypt a message in an asymmetric encryption scheme a “*public key*”. However, the *public key* used as the *transmission key* component of an address ( $pk_{enc}$  or  $pk_d$ ) need not be publically distributed; it has the same distribution as the *shielded payment address* itself. As mentioned above, limiting the distribution of the *shielded payment address* is important for some use cases. This also helps to reduce reliance of the overall protocol on the security of the cryptosystem used for *note* encryption (see § 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65 and § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67), since an adversary would have to know  $pk_{enc}$  or some  $pk_d$  in order to exploit a hypothetical weakness in that cryptosystem.

## 3.2 Notes

A *note* (denoted  $n$ ) can be a **Sprout** *note* or a **Sapling** *note* or an **Orchard** *note*. In each case it represents that a value  $v$  is spendable by the recipient who holds the *spending key* corresponding to a given *shielded payment address*.

Let  $MAX\_MONEY$ ,  $\ell_{PRF}^{Sprout}$ ,  $\ell_{PRF}^{Sapling}$ ,  $\ell_d$ , and  $\ell_{value}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $NoteCommit^{Sprout}$  be as defined in § 5.4.8.1 ‘*Sprout Note Commitments*’ on p. 95.

Let  $NoteCommit^{Sapling}$  be as defined in § 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96.

Let  $KA^{Sapling}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.3 ‘*Sapling Key Agreement*’ on p. 89.

Let  $DiversifyHash^{Sapling}$  be as defined in § 5.4.1.6 ‘*DiversifyHash<sup>Sapling</sup> and DiversifyHash<sup>Orchard</sup> Hash Functions*’ on p. 78.

Let  $NoteCommit^{Orchard}$  be as defined in § 5.4.8.4 ‘*Sinsemilla commitments*’ on p. 98.

Let  $KA^{Orchard}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.5 ‘*Orchard Key Agreement*’ on p. 90.

Let  $DiversifyHash^{Orchard}$  be as defined in § 5.4.1.6 ‘*DiversifyHash<sup>Sapling</sup> and DiversifyHash<sup>Orchard</sup> Hash Functions*’ on p. 78.

Let  $PRF^{nfOrchard}$  be as defined in § 5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 86.

Let  $q_p$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105.

A **Sprout** *note* is a tuple  $(a_{pk}, v, \rho, rcm)$ , where:

- $a_{pk} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{PRF}^{Sprout}}$  is the *paying key* of the recipient’s *shielded payment address*;
- $v : \{0 \dots MAX\_MONEY\}$  is an integer representing the value of the *note* in *zatoshi* (1 **ZEC** =  $10^8$  *zatoshi*);
- $\rho : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{PRF}^{Sprout}}$  is used as input to  $PRF_{a_{sk}}^{nfSprout}$  to derive the *nullifier* of the *note*;
- $rcm : NoteCommit^{Sprout}$ . *Trapdoor* is a random *commitment trapdoor* as defined in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be the type of a **Sprout** note, i.e.

$$\text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}} := \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor}.$$

A **Sapling** note is a tuple  $(d, \text{pk}_d, v, \text{rcm})$ , where:

- $d : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}$  is the *diversifier* of the recipient's *shielded payment address*;
- $\text{pk}_d : \text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$  is the *diversified transmission key* of the recipient's *shielded payment address*;
- $v : \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  is an integer representing the value of the *note* in *zatoshi*;
- $\text{rcm} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor}$  is a random *commitment trapdoor* as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{Note}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be the type of a **Sapling** note, i.e.

$$\text{Note}^{\text{Sapling}} := \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]} \times \text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder} \times \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\} \times \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor}.$$

An **Orchard** note is a tuple  $(d, \text{pk}_d, v, \rho, \psi, \text{rcm})$ , where:

- $d : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}$  is the *diversifier* of the recipient's *shielded payment address*;
- $\text{pk}_d : \text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$  is the *diversified transmission key* of the recipient's *shielded payment address*;
- $v : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}$  is an integer representing the value of the *note* in *zatoshi*;
- $\rho : \mathbb{F}_{q_p}$  is used as input to  $\text{PRF}_{\text{nk}}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  as part of deriving the *nullifier* of the *note*;
- $\psi : \mathbb{F}_{q_p}$  is additional randomness used in deriving the *nullifier*;
- $\text{rcm} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor}$  is a random *commitment trapdoor* as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{Note}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be the type of an **Orchard** note, i.e.

$$\text{Note}^{\text{Orchard}} := \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]} \times \text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder} \times \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_p} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_p} \times \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor}.$$

Creation of new *notes* is described in §4.7 ‘*Sending Notes*’ on p. 44.

### 3.2.1 Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields

Transmitted *notes* are stored on the *block chain* in encrypted form, together with a representation of the *note commitment*  $\text{cm}$  described in §3.2.2 ‘*Note Commitments*’ on p. 16.

A *note plaintext* also includes a 512-byte *memo field* associated with this *note*. The usage of the *memo field* is by agreement between the sender and recipient of the *note*. **RECOMMENDED** non-consensus constraints on the *memo field* contents are specified in [ZIP-302].

For **Sprout**, the *note plaintexts* in each *JoinSplit description* are encrypted to the respective *transmission keys*  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}, 1 \dots N}^{\text{new}}$ , as specified in §4.7.1 ‘*Sending Notes (Sprout)*’ on p. 44.

Each **Sprout** *note plaintext* (denoted **np**) consists of

$$(\text{leadByte} : \mathbb{B}^Y, v : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}, \rho : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} , \text{rcm} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor}, \text{memo} : \mathbb{B}^Y^{[512]}).$$

The field  $\text{leadByte}$  is always 0x00 for **Sprout**. The fields  $v$ ,  $\rho$ , and  $\text{rcm}$  are as defined in §3.2 ‘*Notes*’ on p. 14.

**[Sapling onward]** For **Sapling** and **Orchard**, the *note plaintext* in each *Output description* or *Action description* is encrypted to the *diversified payment address*  $(d, \text{pk}_d)$ , as specified in §4.7.2 ‘*Sending Notes (Sapling)*’ on p. 45 or §4.7.3 ‘*Sending Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 46.

Each **Sapling** or **Orchard** *note plaintext* (denoted **np**) consists of

$$(\text{leadByte} : \mathbb{B}^Y, d : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}, v : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}, \text{rseed} : \mathbb{B}^Y^{[32]}, \text{memo} : \mathbb{B}^Y^{[512]})$$

The field **leadByte** indicates the version of the encoding of a **Sapling** or **Orchard** *note plaintext*.

Let the constants **CanopyActivationHeight** and **ZIP212GracePeriod** be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let **protocol** : {**Sapling**, **Orchard**} be the *shielded protocol* of the *note*.

Let **height** be the *block height* of the *block* containing the *transaction* having the encrypted *note plaintext* as an output, and let **txVersion** be the *transaction version number*.

Define  $\text{allowedLeadBytes}^{\text{protocol}}(\text{height}, \text{txVersion}) :=$

$$\begin{cases} \{0x01\}, & \text{if } \text{height} < \text{CanopyActivationHeight} \\ \{0x01, 0x02\}, & \text{if } \text{CanopyActivationHeight} \leq \text{height} < \text{CanopyActivationHeight} + \text{ZIP212GracePeriod} \\ \{0x02\}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The **leadByte** of a **Sapling** or **Orchard** *note* MUST satisfy  $\text{leadByte} \in \text{allowedLeadBytes}^{\text{protocol}}(\text{height}, \text{txVersion})$ . Senders **SHOULD** choose the highest *note plaintext lead byte* allowed under this condition.

#### Non-normative notes:

- [NU5 onward] Since **Orchard** was introduced after the end of the [ZIP-212] grace period, *note plaintexts* for **Orchard** *notes* **MUST** have **leadByte**  $\geq 0x02$ .
- It is intentional that the definition of **allowedLeadBytes** does not currently depend on **protocol** or **txVersion**. It might do so in future.

The fields **d** and **v** are as defined in § 3.2 ‘*Notes*’ on p. 14.

The use of the field **rseed** is described in [ZIP-212].

Encodings are given in § 5.5 ‘*Encodings of Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 112. The result of encryption forms part of a *transmitted note(s) ciphertext*. For further details, see § 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65 and § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67.

### 3.2.2 Note Commitments

When a *note* is created as an output of a *transaction*, only a commitment (see § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31) to the *note* contents is disclosed publicly in the associated *JoinSplit description* or *Output description* or *Action description*. If the *transaction* is entered into the *block chain*, each such *note commitment* is appended to the *note commitment tree* of the associated *treestate*. This allows the value and recipient to be kept private, while the commitment is used by the *zk-SNARK proof* when the *note* is spent, to check that it exists on the *block chain*.

*Treestates* are described in § 3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18, and *note commitment trees* are described in § 3.8 ‘*Note Commitment Trees*’ on p. 21.

A **Sprout** *note commitment* on a *note* **n** = (**a<sub>pk</sub>**, **v**, **ρ**, **rcm**) is computed as

$$\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{n}) = \text{NoteCommit}_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{a}_{\text{pk}}, \mathbf{v}, \rho),$$

where  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is instantiated in § 5.4.8.1 ‘**Sprout Note Commitments**’ on p. 95.



A **Sapling** note commitment on a note  $\mathbf{n} = (d, pk_d, v, rcm)$  is computed as

$$g_d := \text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}}(d)$$

$$\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sapling}}(\mathbf{n}) := \begin{cases} \perp, & \text{if } g_d = \perp \\ \text{NoteCommit}_{rcm}^{\text{Sapling}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(g_d), \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(pk_d), v), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

where  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is instantiated in §5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96.

Notice that the above definition of a **Sapling** note does not have a  $\rho$  component. There is in fact a  $\rho$  value associated with each **Sapling** note, but this can only be computed once its position in the *note commitment tree* (see §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18) is known. We refer to the combination of a note and its note position  $\text{pos}$ , as a *positioned note*.

For a *positioned note*, we can compute the value  $\rho$  as described in §4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58.

A **Sapling** note commitment is represented in an *Output description* by the  $u$ -coordinate of a Jubjub curve point, as specified in §4.5 ‘*Output Descriptions*’ on p. 42.

An **Orchard** note commitment on a note  $\mathbf{n} = (d, pk_d, v, \rho, \psi, rcm)$  is computed as

$$g_d := \text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}(d)$$

$$\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Orchard}}(\mathbf{n}) := \text{NoteCommit}_{rcm}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(g_d), \text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(pk_d), v, \rho, \psi)$$

where  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is instantiated in §5.4.8.4 ‘*Sinsemilla commitments*’ on p. 98.

If  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  returns  $\perp$  (which happens with insignificant probability), the note is invalid and should be recreated with a different rseed.

Unlike in **Sapling**, the definition of an **Orchard** note includes the  $\rho$  component; the note’s position in the *note commitment tree* does not need to be known in order to compute this value.

An **Orchard** note commitment is represented in an *Action description* by the  $x$ -coordinate of a Pallas curve point, as specified in §4.6 ‘*Action Descriptions*’ on p. 43.

### 3.2.3 Nullifiers

The *nullifier* for a note, denoted  $\text{nf}$ , is a value unique to the note that is used to prevent *double-spends*. When a transaction that contains one or more *JoinSplit descriptions* or *Spend descriptions* or *Action descriptions* is entered into the *block chain*, all of the nullifiers for notes spent by that transaction are added to the *nullifier set* of the associated *treestate*. A transaction is not valid if it would have added a nullifier to the *nullifier set* that already exists in the set.

*Treestates* are described in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18, and *nullifier sets* are described in §3.9 ‘*Nullifier Sets*’ on p. 22.

In more detail, when a note is spent, the spender creates a *zero-knowledge proof* that it knows  $(\rho, a_{sk})$  or  $(\rho, ak, nsk)$  or  $(\rho, ak, nk)$ , consistent with the publically disclosed nullifier and some previously committed note commitment.

Because each note can have only a single nullifier, and the same nullifier value cannot appear more than once in a valid block chain, *double-spending* is prevented.

The nullifier for a **Sprout** note is derived from the  $\rho$  value and the recipient’s *spending key*  $a_{sk}$ .

The nullifier for a **Sapling** note is derived from the  $\rho$  value and the recipient’s *nullifier deriving key*  $nk$ .

The nullifier for an **Orchard** note is derived from the  $\rho$  and  $\psi$  values, the recipient’s *nullifier deriving key*  $nk$ , and the note commitment.

The nullifier computation uses a *Pseudo Random Function* (see §4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25), as described in §4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58.

### 3.3 The Block Chain

At a given point in time, each *full validator* is aware of a set of candidate *blocks*. These form a tree rooted at the *genesis block*, where each node in the tree refers to its parent via the `hashPrevBlock` *block header* field (see § 7.6 ‘*Block Header Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 131).

A path from the root toward the leaves of the tree consisting of a sequence of one or more valid *blocks* consistent with consensus rules, is called a *valid block chain*.

Each *block* in a *block chain* has a *block height*. The *block height* of the *genesis block* is 0, and the *block height* of each subsequent *block* in the *block chain* increments by 1. Implementations **MUST** support *block heights* up to and including  $2^{31} - 1$ . As of **NU5**, there is a consensus rule that all *coinbase transactions* (see § 3.11 ‘*Coinbase Transactions*’ on p. 22) **MUST** have the `nExpiryHeight` field set to the *block height*, and this limits the maximum *block height* to  $2^{32} - 1$ , absent future consensus changes.

In order to choose the *best valid block chain* in its view of the overall *block tree*, a node sums the work, as defined in § 7.7.5 ‘*Definition of Work*’ on p. 136, of all *blocks* in each *valid block chain*, and considers the *valid block chain* with greatest total work to be best. To break ties between leaf *blocks*, a node will prefer the *block* that it received first.

The consensus protocol is designed to ensure that for any given *block height*, the vast majority of well-connected nodes should eventually agree on their *best valid block chain* up to that height. A *full validator*<sup>5</sup> **SHOULD** attempt to obtain candidate *blocks* from multiple sources in order to increase the likelihood that it will find a *valid block chain* that reflects a recent consensus state.

A *network upgrade* is *settled* on a given *network* when there is a social consensus that it has activated with a given *activation block* hash. A *full validator* that potentially risks *Mainnet* funds or displays *Mainnet* transaction information to a user **MUST** do so only for a *block chain* that includes the *activation block* of the most recent *settled network upgrade*, with the corresponding *activation block* hash. Currently, there is social consensus that **NU6.1** has activated on the **Zcash** *Mainnet* and *Testnet* with the *activation block* hashes given in § 3.12 ‘*Mainnet and Testnet*’ on p. 23.

A *full validator* **MAY** impose a limit on the number of *blocks* it will “roll back” when switching from one *best valid block chain* to another that is not a descendent. For `zcashd` and `zebra` this limit is 100 *blocks*.

### 3.4 Transactions and Treestates

Each *block* contains one or more *transactions*.

Each *transaction* has a *transaction ID*. *Transaction IDs* are used to refer to *transactions* in `tx_out` fields, in *leaf nodes* of a *block’s transaction tree* rooted at `hashMerkleRoot`, and in other parts of the ecosystem; for example they are shown in *block chain* explorers and can be used in higher-level protocols. *Version 5 transactions* also have a *wtxid*, which is used instead of the *transaction ID* when gossiping *transactions* in the *peer-to-peer protocol* [ZIP-239]. The computation of *transaction IDs* and *wtxids* is described in § 7.1.1 ‘*Transaction Identifiers*’ on p. 124. For more detail on the distinction between these two identifiers and when to use each of them, see [ZIP-239] and [ZIP-244].

*Transparent inputs* to a *transaction* insert value into a *transparent transaction value pool* associated with the *transaction*, and *transparent outputs* remove value from this pool. The effect of **Sprout** *JoinSplit transfers*, **Sapling** *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers*, and **Orchard** *Action transfers* on the *transparent transaction value pool* are specified in § 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60, § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52, and § 4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54 respectively.

As in **Bitcoin**, the remaining value in the *transparent transaction value pool* of a non-coinbase *transaction* is available to miners as a fee. That is, the sum of those values for non-coinbase *transactions* in each *block* is treated as an implicit input to the *transparent transaction value pool* balance of the *block’s coinbase transaction* (in addition to the implicit input created by issuance).

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<sup>5</sup> There is reason to follow the requirements in this section also for non-full validators, but those are outside the scope of this protocol specification.

The remaining value in the *transparent transaction value pool* of coinbase transactions in *blocks* prior to **NU6** is destroyed. From **NU6**, this remaining value is required to be zero; that is, all of the available balance **MUST** be consumed by outputs of the *coinbase transaction*.

**Consensus rule:** The remaining value in the *transparent transaction value pool* **MUST** be nonnegative.

To each *transaction* there are associated initial *treestates* for **Sprout** and for **Sapling** and for **Orchard**. Each *treestate* consists of:

- a *note commitment tree* (§ 3.8 ‘*Note Commitment Trees*’ on p. 21);
- a *nullifier set* (§ 3.9 ‘*Nullifier Sets*’ on p. 22).

Validation state associated with *transparent* inputs and outputs, such as the *UTXO* (*unspent transaction output*) set, is not described in this document; it is used in essentially the same way as in **Bitcoin**.

An *anchor* is a Merkle tree root of a *note commitment tree* (either the **Sprout** tree or the **Sapling** tree or the **Orchard** tree). It uniquely identifies a *note commitment tree* state given the assumed security properties of the Merkle tree’s *hash function*. Since the *nullifier set* is always updated together with the *note commitment tree*, this also identifies a particular state of the associated *nullifier set*.

In a given *block chain*, for each of **Sprout** and **Sapling** and **Orchard**, *treestates* are chained as follows:

- The input *treestate* of the first *block* is the empty *treestate*.
- The input *treestate* of the first *transaction* of a *block* is the final *treestate* of the immediately preceding *block*.
- The input *treestate* of each subsequent *transaction* in a *block* is the output *treestate* of the immediately preceding *transaction*.
- The final *treestate* of a *block* is the output *treestate* of its last *transaction*.

*JoinSplit* descriptions also have interstitial input and output *treestates* for **Sprout**, explained in the following section. There is no equivalent of interstitial *treestates* for **Sapling** or for **Orchard**.

### 3.5 JoinSplit Transfers and Descriptions

A *JoinSplit* description is data included in a *transaction* that describes a *JoinSplit* transfer, i.e. a *shielded* value transfer. In **Sprout**, this kind of value transfer was the primary **Zcash**-specific operation performed by *transactions*.

A *JoinSplit* transfer spends  $N^{\text{old}}$  notes  $\mathbf{n}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}}$  and *transparent* input  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$ , and creates  $N^{\text{new}}$  notes  $\mathbf{n}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}}$  and *transparent* output  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$ . It is associated with a *JoinSplit* statement instance (§ 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60), for which it provides a zk-SNARK proof.

Each *transaction* has a sequence of *JoinSplit* descriptions.

The total  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  value adds to, and the total  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  value subtracts from the *transparent transaction value pool* of the containing *transaction*.

The *anchor* of each *JoinSplit* description in a *transaction* refers to a **Sprout** *treestate*.

For each of the  $N^{\text{old}}$  *shielded* inputs, a *nullifier* is revealed. This allows detection of *double-spends* as described in § 3.9 ‘*Nullifier Sets*’ on p. 22.

For each *JoinSplit* description in a *transaction*, an interstitial output *treestate* is constructed which adds the *note commitments* and *nullifiers* specified in that *JoinSplit* description to the input *treestate* referred to by its *anchor*. This interstitial output *treestate* is available for use as the *anchor* of subsequent *JoinSplit* descriptions in the same *transaction*. In general, therefore, the set of interstitial *treestates* associated with a *transaction* forms a tree in which the parent of each node is determined by its *anchor*.

Interstitial *treestates* are necessary because when a *transaction* is constructed, it is not known where it will eventually appear in a mined *block*. Therefore the *anchors* that it uses must be independent of its eventual position.

The input and output values of each *JoinSplit* transfer **MUST** balance exactly. This is not a consensus rule since it cannot be checked directly; it is enforced by the **Balance** rule of the *JoinSplit* statement.

#### Consensus rules:

- For the first *JoinSplit description* of a *transaction*, the *anchor* **MUST** be the output **Sprout** *treestate* of a previous *block*.
- The *anchor* of each *JoinSplit description* in a *transaction* **MUST** refer to either some earlier *block*'s final **Sprout** *treestate*, or to the interstitial output *treestate* of any prior *JoinSplit description* in the same *transaction*.

### 3.6 Spend Transfers, Output Transfers, and their Descriptions

*JoinSplit transfers* are not used for **Sapling** *notes*. Instead, there is a separate *Spend transfer* for each *shielded input*, and a separate *Output transfer* for each *shielded output*.

*Spend descriptions* and *Output descriptions* are data included in a *transaction* that describe *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers*, respectively.

A *Spend transfer* spends a *note*  $n^{\text{old}}$ . Its *Spend description* includes a *Pedersen value commitment* to the value of the *note*. It is associated with an instance of a *Spend statement* (§4.18.2 '*Spend Statement (Sapling)*' on p. 61) for which it provides a *zk-SNARK proof*.

An *Output transfer* creates a *note*  $n^{\text{new}}$ . Similarly, its *Output description* includes a *Pedersen value commitment* to the *note* value. It is associated with an instance of an *Output statement* (§4.18.3 '*Output Statement (Sapling)*' on p. 62) for which it provides a *zk-SNARK proof*.

Each *transaction* has a sequence of *Spend descriptions* and a sequence of *Output descriptions*.

To ensure balance, we use a homomorphic property of *Pedersen commitments* that allows them to be added and subtracted, as elliptic curve points (§5.4.8.3 '*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*' on p. 97). The result of adding two *Pedersen value commitments*, committing to values  $v_1$  and  $v_2$ , is a new *Pedersen value commitment* that commits to  $v_1 + v_2$ . Subtraction works similarly.

Therefore, balance can be enforced by adding all of the *value commitments* for *shielded inputs*, subtracting all of the *value commitments* for *shielded outputs*, and proving by use of a *Sapling binding signature* (as described in §4.13 '*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*' on p. 52) that the result commits to a value consistent with the net *transparent* value change. This approach allows all of the *zk-SNARK statements* to be independent of each other, potentially increasing opportunities for precomputation.

A *Spend description* specifies an *anchor*, which refers to the output **Sapling** *treestate* of a previous *block*. It also reveals a *nullifier*, which allows detection of *double-spends* as described in §3.2.3 '*Nullifiers*' on p. 17.

**Non-normative note:** Interstitial *treestates* are not necessary for **Sapling**, because a *Spend transfer* in a given *transaction* cannot spend any of the *shielded outputs* of the same *transaction*. This is not an onerous restriction because, unlike **Sprout** where each *JoinSplit transfer* must balance individually, in **Sapling** it is only necessary for the whole *transaction* to balance.

#### Consensus rules:

- The *Spend transfers* and *Action transfers* of a *transaction* **MUST** be consistent with its  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  value as specified in §4.13 '*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*' on p. 52.
- The *anchor* of each *Spend description* **MUST** refer to some earlier *block*'s final **Sapling** *treestate*. The *anchor* is encoded separately in each *Spend description* for v4 *transactions*, or encoded once and shared between all *Spend descriptions* in a v5 *transaction*.

### 3.7 Action Transfers and their Descriptions

**Orchard** introduces *Action transfers*, each of which can optionally perform a spend, and optionally perform an output.

*Action descriptions* are data included in a *transaction* that describe *Action transfers*.

An *Action transfer* spends a *note*  $n^{\text{old}}$ , and creates a *note*  $n^{\text{new}}$ . Its *Action description* includes a *Pedersen value commitment* to the net value, i.e. the value of the spent *note* minus the value of the created *note*. It is associated with an instance of an *Action statement* (§4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p. 63) for which it provides a *zk-SNARK proof*.

Each version 5 *transaction* has a sequence of *Action descriptions*. Version 4 *transactions* cannot contain *Action descriptions*.

As in **Sapling**, we use the homomorphic property of *Pedersen commitments* to enforce balance: we add all of the *value commitments* and prove by use of an *Orchard binding signature* that the result commits to a value consistent with the net *transparent* value change (as described in §4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54). This approach allows all of the *zk-SNARK statements* to be independent of each other, potentially increasing opportunities for precomputation.

The fields of an *Action description* are essentially a merger of the fields of a *Spend description* and an *Output description*, but with only a single *value commitment*. Also, the *zk-SNARK proof* is encoded outside the *Action description*, in order to more easily take advantage of space and performance optimizations in the Halo 2 proof system (§5.4.10.3 ‘Halo 2’ on p. 112) that apply when multiple proofs are aggregated. Each *Action description* does not encode a separate *anchor* field, because that is encoded once in the `anchorOrchard` field of the *transaction*.

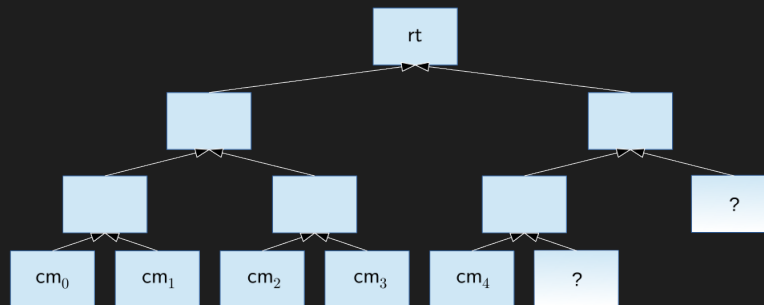
**Non-normative note:** As with **Sapling**, interstitial *treestates* are not necessary for **Orchard**, because an *Action transfer* in a given *transaction* cannot spend any of the *shielded outputs* of the same *transaction*.

**Consensus rules:**

- The *Action transfers* of a *transaction* **MUST** be consistent with its  $v^{\text{balanceOrchard}}$  value as specified in §4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54.
- The `anchorOrchard` field of the *transaction*, whenever it exists (i.e. when there are any *Action descriptions*), **MUST** refer to some earlier *block*’s final **Orchard** *treestate*.

### 3.8 Note Commitment Trees

Let  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , and  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.



A *note commitment tree* is an incremental *Merkle tree* of fixed depth used to store *note commitments* that *JoinSplit transfers* or *Spend transfers* or *Action transfers* produce. Just as the *UTXO* (unspent transaction output) set used in **Bitcoin**, it is used to express the existence of value and the capability to spend it. However, unlike the *UTXO* set, it is *not* the job of this tree to protect against *double-spending*, as it is append-only.

A root of a *note commitment tree* is associated with each *treestate* (§3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18).



Each node in the *incremental Merkle tree* is associated with a *hash value* of size  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}$  or  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}$  or  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  bits. The layer numbered  $h$ , counting from layer 0 at the root, has  $2^h$  nodes with indices 0 to  $2^h - 1$  inclusive. The *hash value* associated with the node at index  $i$  in layer  $h$  is denoted  $M_i^h$ .

The *index* of a note's commitment at the leafmost layer ( $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}$  or  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}$  or  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}}$ ) is called its *note position*.

#### Consensus rules:

- A block **MUST NOT** add **Sprout** note commitments that would result in the **Sprout** note commitment tree exceeding its capacity of  $2^{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}}$  leaf nodes.
- [Sapling onward] A block **MUST NOT** add **Sapling** note commitments that would result in the **Sapling** note commitment tree exceeding its capacity of  $2^{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}}$  leaf nodes.
- [NU5 onward] A block **MUST NOT** add **Orchard** note commitments that would result in the **Orchard** note commitment tree exceeding its capacity of  $2^{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}}}$  leaf nodes.

### 3.9 Nullifier Sets

Each full validator maintains a *nullifier set* logically associated with each *treestate*. As valid transactions containing *JoinSplit transfers* or *Spend transfers* or *Action transfers* are processed, the *nullifiers* revealed in *JoinSplit descriptions* and *Spend descriptions* and *Action descriptions* are inserted into the *nullifier set* associated with the new *treestate*. *Nullifiers* are enforced to be unique within a *valid block chain*, in order to prevent *double-spends*.

**Consensus rule:** A *nullifier* **MUST NOT** repeat either within a *transaction*, or across *transactions* in a *valid block chain*. **Sprout and Sapling and Orchard nullifiers are considered disjoint, even if they have the same bit pattern.**

### 3.10 Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, and Founders' Reward

Like **Bitcoin**, **Zcash** creates currency when *blocks* are mined. The value created on mining a *block* is called the *block subsidy*.

[Pre-Canopy] The *block subsidy* is composed of a *miner subsidy* and a *Founders' Reward*.

[Canopy onward] The *block subsidy* is composed of a *miner subsidy* and a series of *funding streams*.

As in **Bitcoin**, the miner of a *block* also receives *transaction fees*.

The calculations of the *block subsidy*, *miner subsidy*, *Founders' Reward*, and *funding streams* depend on the *block height*, as defined in §3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p.18.

§7.8 ‘*Calculating Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, Lockbox Disbursement, and Founders' Reward*’ on p.136 describes these calculations.

### 3.11 Coinbase Transactions

A *transaction* that has a single *transparent input* with a null *prevout* field, is called a *coinbase transaction*. Every *block* has a single *coinbase transaction* as the first *transaction* in the *block*. The purpose of this *coinbase transaction* is to collect and spend any *miner subsidy*, and *transaction fees* paid by other *transactions* included in the *block*.

[Pre-Canopy] §7.9 ‘*Payment of Founders' Reward*’ on p.137 specifies that the *coinbase transaction* **MUST** also pay the *Founders' Reward*.

[Canopy onward] §7.10 ‘*Payment of Funding Streams, Deferred Lockbox, and Lockbox Disbursement*’ on p.139 specifies that the *coinbase transaction* **MUST** also pay the *funding streams*.

### 3.12 Mainnet and Testnet

The production **Zcash** network, which supports the **ZEC** token, is called *Mainnet*. Governance of its protocol is by social consensus on which *full validator* implementations are considered to be faithful implementations of the intended *Mainnet* consensus rules (currently, zebra maintained by the Zcash Foundation, and zcashd maintained by the Electric Coin Company), and on how those implementations should be modified. Subject to errors and omissions, each version of this document intends to describe some version (or planned version) of the **Zcash** protocol.

All *block hashes* given in this section are in *RPC byte order* (that is, byte-reversed relative to the normal order for a SHA-256 hash).

*Mainnet genesis block*: 00040fe8ec8471911baa1db1266ea15dd06b4a8a5c453883c000b031973dce08

*Mainnet NU6.1 activation block*: 0000000000b98a7d8f390793fa113bf6755935f0c14ea817af07d2c16f2c3ef4

There is also a public test network called *Testnet*. It supports a **TAZ** token which is intended to have no monetary value. By convention, *Testnet* activates *network upgrades* (as described in § 6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120) before *Mainnet*, in order to allow for errors or ambiguities in their specification and implementation to be discovered. The *Testnet block chain* is subject to being rolled back to a prior *block* at any time.

*Testnet genesis block*: 05a60a92d99d85997cce3b87616c089f6124d7342af37106edc76126334a2c38

*Testnet NU6.1 activation block*: 01b947c7556b23040dc6840e9d3e4c6d9478c67a87b9737a83be848729d6e0af

We call the smallest units of currency (on either network) *zatoshi*.<sup>6</sup>

On *Mainnet*, 1 **ZEC** =  $10^8$  *zatoshi*. On *Testnet*, 1 **TAZ** =  $10^8$  *zatoshi*.

Other networks using variants of the **Zcash** protocol may exist, but are not described by this specification.

## 4 Abstract Protocol

*‘We all know that the only mental tool by means of which a very finite piece of reasoning can cover a myriad cases is called “abstraction”; as a result the effective exploitation of [their] powers of abstraction must be regarded as one of the most vital activities of a competent programmer. In this connection it might be worth-while to point out that the purpose of abstracting is **not** to be vague, but to create a new semantic level in which one can be absolutely precise.’*

— Edsger Dijkstra, “The Humble Programmer” [EWD-340]

Abstraction is an incredibly important idea in the design of any complex system. Without abstraction, we would not be able to design anything as ambitious as a computer, or a cryptographic protocol. Were we to attempt it, the computer would be hopelessly unreliable or the protocol would be insecure, if they could be completed at all.

The aim of abstraction is primarily to limit how much a human working on a piece of a system has to keep in mind at one time, in order to apprehend the connections of that piece to the remainder. The work could be to extend or maintain the system, to understand its security or other properties, or to explain it to others.

In this specification, we make use wherever possible of abstractions that have been developed by the cryptography community to model cryptographic primitives: *Pseudo Random Functions*, *commitment schemes*, *signature schemes*, etc. Each abstract primitive has associated syntax (its interface as used by the rest of the system) and security properties, as documented in this part. Their instantiations are documented in part § 5 ‘*Concrete Protocol*’ on p. 73.

In some cases this syntax or these security requirements have been extended to meet the needs of the **Zcash** protocol. For example, some of the PRFs used in **Zcash** need to be *collision-resistant*, which is not part of the usual

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<sup>6</sup> “*zatoshi*” may be used for the smallest units of currency on Testnet, but it is usually more convenient to use a *network-independent* term.

security requirement for a PRF; some *signature schemes* need to support additional functionality and security properties; and so on. Also, security requirements are sometimes intentionally stronger than what is known to be needed, because the stronger property is simpler or less error-prone to work with, and/or because it has been studied in the cryptographic literature in more depth.

We explicitly *do not claim*, however, that all of these instantiations satisfying their documented syntax and security requirements would be sufficient for security or correctness of the overall **Zcash** protocol, or that it is always necessary. The claim is only that it helps to understand the protocol; that is, that analysis or extension is simplified by making use of the abstraction. In other words, *a good way to understand* the use of that primitive in the protocol is to model it as an instance of the given abstraction. And furthermore, if the instantiated primitive does not in fact satisfy the requirements of the abstraction, then this is an error that should be corrected –whether or not it leads to a vulnerability– since that would compromise the facility to understand its use in terms of the abstraction.

In this respect the abstractions play a similar rôle to that of a type system (which we also use): they add a form of redundancy to the specification that helps to express the intent.

Each property is a claim that may be incorrect (or that may be insufficiently precisely stated to determine whether it is correct). An example of an incorrect security claim occurs in the **Zerocash** protocol [BCGGMTV2014]: the instantiation of the *note commitment* scheme used in **Zerocash** failed to be *binding* at the intended security level (see § 8.5 ‘*Internal hash collision attack and fix*’ on p. 145).

Another hazard that we should be aware of is that abstractions can be “leaky”: an instantiation may impose conditions on its correct or secure use that are not captured by the abstraction’s interface and semantics. Ideally, the abstraction would be changed to explicitly document these conditions, or the protocol changed to rely only on the original abstraction.

An abstraction can also be incomplete (not quite the same thing as being leaky): it intentionally –usually for simplicity– does not model an aspect of behaviour that is important to security or correctness. An example would be resistance to *side-channel* attacks; this specification says little about *side-channel* defence, among many other implementation concerns.

## 4.1 Abstract Cryptographic Schemes

### 4.1.1 Hash Functions

Let  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}, \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}, \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}, \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}}, \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}, \ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}}, \ell_{\text{d}}, \ell_{\text{Seed}}, \ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{hSig}}$ , and  $N^{\text{old}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathbb{J}, \mathbb{J}^{(n)}, \mathbb{J}^{(n)*}, r_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $\ell_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.

Let  $\mathbb{P}^*$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105.

The following *hash functions* are used in § 4.9 ‘*Merkle Path Validity*’ on p. 49:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sprout}} &: \{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \\ \text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}} &: \{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} \\ \text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}} &: \{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}} - 1\} \times \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} \times \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} \rightarrow \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}. \end{aligned}$$

$\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is *collision-resistant* except on its first argument.  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  are *collision-resistant on all their arguments*.

These functions are instantiated in § 5.4.1.3 ‘*Merkle Tree Hash Function*’ on p. 76.

$\text{hSigCRH} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Seed}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} [N^{\text{old}}] \times \text{JoinSplitSig.Public} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{hSig}}]}$  is a *collision-resistant hash function* used in § 4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40. It is instantiated in § 5.4.1.4 ‘*h<sub>sig</sub> Hash Function*’ on p. 77.

$\text{EquiHashGen} : (n : \mathbb{N}^+) \times \mathbb{N}^+ \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{N}} \times \mathbb{N}^+ \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[n]}$  is another *hash function*, used in § 7.7.1 ‘*EquiHash*’ on p. 133 to generate input to the *EquiHash* solver. The first two arguments, representing the *EquiHash* parameters  $n$  and  $k$ , are written subscripted. It is instantiated in § 5.4.1.11 ‘*EquiHash Generator*’ on p. 85.



$\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_1]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_2]} \rightarrow \{1 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$  is a *collision-resistant hash function* used in § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36 to derive an *incoming viewing key* for a **Sapling shielded payment address**. It is also used in the *Spend statement* (§ 4.18.2 ‘**Spend Statement (Sapling)**’ on p. 61) to confirm use of the correct keys for the *note* being spent. It is instantiated in § 5.4.1.5 ‘**CRH<sup>ivk</sup> Hash Function**’ on p. 77.

$\text{MixingPedersenHash} : \mathbb{J} \times \{0 \dots r_{\mathbb{J}} - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{J}$  is a *hash function* used in § 4.16 ‘**Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers**’ on p. 58 to derive the unique  $\rho$  value for a **Sapling note**. It is also used in the *Spend statement* to confirm use of the correct  $\rho$  value as an input to *nullifier* derivation. It is instantiated in § 5.4.1.8 ‘**Mixing Pedersen Hash Function**’ on p. 81.

$\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]} \rightarrow \mathbb{J}^{(r)*} \cup \{\perp\}$  and  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^*$  are *hash functions* instantiated in § 5.4.1.6 ‘**DiversifyHash<sup>Sapling</sup> and DiversifyHash<sup>Orchard</sup> Hash Functions**’ on p. 78, satisfying the Unlinkability security property described in that section. They are used to derive a *diversified base* from a *diversifier*, which is specified in § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36 and in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38.

## 4.1.2 Pseudo Random Functions

$\text{PRF}_x$  denotes a *Pseudo Random Function* keyed by  $x$ .

Let  $\ell_{\text{ask}}, \ell_{\text{hSig}}, \ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{sk}}, \ell_{\text{ovk}}, \ell_{\text{PRFExpand}}, \ell_{\text{PRFntSapling}}, \text{N}^{\text{old}}$ , and  $\text{N}^{\text{new}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘**Constants**’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{Sym}$  be as defined in § 5.4.3 ‘**Symmetric Encryption**’ on p. 88.

Let  $\ell_{\mathbb{J}}$  and  $\mathbb{J}_{\star}^{(r)}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘**Jubjub**’ on p. 102.

Let  $\ell_{\mathbb{P}}$  and  $q_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘**Pallas and Vesta**’ on p. 105.

For **Sprout**, four *independent*  $\text{PRF}_x$  are needed:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PRF}^{\text{addr}} &: \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{ask}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \\ \text{PRF}^{\text{pk}} &: \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{ask}}]} \times \{1 \dots \text{N}^{\text{old}}\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{hSig}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \\ \text{PRF}^{\rho} &: \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \{1 \dots \text{N}^{\text{new}}\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{hSig}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \\ \text{PRF}^{\text{ntSprout}} &: \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{ask}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \end{aligned}$$

These are used in § 4.18.1 ‘**JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)**’ on p. 60;  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  is also used to derive a *shielded payment address* from a *spending key* in § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36.

For **Sapling**, three additional  $\text{PRF}_x$  are needed:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PRF}^{\text{expand}} &: \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{sk}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\text{N}]}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\text{PRFExpand}}/8]}} \\ \text{PRF}^{\text{ockSapling}} &: \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\text{ovk}}/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_1/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_2/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_3/8]}} \rightarrow \text{Sym.K} \\ \text{PRF}^{\text{ntSapling}} &: \mathbb{J}_{\star}^{(r)} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_1]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\text{PRFntSapling}}/8]}} \end{aligned}$$

For **Orchard**, we need  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$ , and also:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PRF}^{\text{ockOrchard}} &: \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\text{ovk}}/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{P}}/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{P}}/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{P}}/8]}} \rightarrow \text{Sym.K} \\ \text{PRF}^{\text{ntOrchard}} &: \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \end{aligned}$$

$\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  is used in the following places:

- § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36, with inputs  $[0x00]$ ,  $[0x01]$ ,  $[0x02]$ , and  $[0x03, i : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}}]$ ;
- $[\text{NU5 onward}]$  in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38, with inputs  $[0x06]$ ,  $[0x07]$ ,  $[0x08]$ , and with first byte  $0x82$ ;
- in the processes of sending (§ 4.7.2 ‘**Sending Notes (Sapling)**’ on p. 45 and § 4.7.3 ‘**Sending Notes (Orchard)**’ on p. 46) and of receiving (§ 4.20 ‘**In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 67) *notes*, for **Sapling** with inputs  $[0x04]$  and  $[0x05]$ , and for **Orchard**  $[t] \parallel p$  with  $t \in \{0x05, 0x04, 0x09\}$ ;

- in [ZIP-32], with inputs [0x00], [0x01], [0x02] (intentionally matching § 4.2.2 on p. 36), [0x10], [0x13], [0x14], and with first byte in {0x11, 0x12, 0x15, 0x16, 0x17, 0x18, 0x80, 0x81, 0x83};
- in [ZIP-316], with first byte 0xD0.

$\text{PRF}^{\text{ockSapling}}$  and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{ockOrchard}}$  are used in § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67.

$\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}$  is used in § 4.18.2 ‘*Spend Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 61.

$\text{PRF}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  is used in § 4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p. 63.

All of these *Pseudo Random Functions* are instantiated in § 5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 86.

#### Security requirements:

- Security definitions for *Pseudo Random Functions* are given in [BDJR2000, section 4].
- In addition to being *Pseudo Random Functions*, it is required that  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{addr}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}_x^{\rho}$ ,  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfSprout}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfSapling}}$  and  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  be *collision-resistant* across all  $x$  – i.e. finding  $(x, y) \neq (x', y')$  such that  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{addr}}(y) = \text{PRF}_{x'}^{\text{addr}}(y')$  should not be feasible, and similarly for  $\text{PRF}_x^{\rho}$ ,  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfSprout}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfSapling}}$ , and  $\text{PRF}_x^{\text{nfOrchard}}$ .
- See the note in § 4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p. 38 for a security caveat about the use of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$ .

**Non-normative note:**  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$  was called  $\text{PRF}^{\text{sn}}$  in Zerocash [BCGGMTV2014], and just  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nf}}$  in some previous versions of this specification.

### 4.1.3 Pseudo Random Permutations

$\text{PRP}_x$  denotes a *Pseudo Random Permutation* keyed by  $x$ .

Let  $\ell_{\text{dk}}$  and  $\ell_{\text{d}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

One *Pseudo Random Permutation* is used for **Orchard**, to generate *diversifiers* from a *diversifier* key and index (an identical construction is also used for **Sapling** in [ZIP-32]):

$$\text{PRP}^{\text{d}} : \mathbb{B}^{Y[\ell_{\text{dk}}/8]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{d}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{d}}]}.$$

It is instantiated in § 5.4.4 ‘*Pseudo Random Permutations*’ on p. 88.

**Security requirement:**  $\text{PRP}^{\text{d}}$  is a keyed *Pseudo Random Permutation* as defined in [BKR2001].

### 4.1.4 Symmetric Encryption

Let  $\text{Sym}$  be an *authenticated one-time symmetric encryption scheme* with keyspace  $\text{Sym.K}$ , encrypting plaintexts in  $\text{Sym.P}$  to produce ciphertexts in  $\text{Sym.C}$ .

$\text{Sym.Encrypt} : \text{Sym.K} \times \text{Sym.P} \rightarrow \text{Sym.C}$  is the encryption algorithm.

$\text{Sym.Decrypt} : \text{Sym.K} \times \text{Sym.C} \rightarrow \text{Sym.P} \cup \{\perp\}$  is the decryption algorithm, such that for any  $K \in \text{Sym.K}$  and  $P \in \text{Sym.P}$ ,  $\text{Sym.Decrypt}_K(\text{Sym.Encrypt}_K(P)) = P$ .  $\perp$  is used to represent the decryption of an invalid ciphertext.

**Security requirement:**  $\text{Sym}$  must be *one-time* ( $\text{INT-CTXT} \wedge \text{IND-CPA}$ )-secure [BN2007]. “*One-time*” here means that an honest protocol participant will almost surely encrypt only one message with a given key; however, the adversary may make many adaptive chosen ciphertext queries for a given key.

### 4.1.5 Key Agreement

A *key agreement scheme* is a cryptographic protocol in which two parties agree a shared secret, each using their *private key* and the other party's *public key*.

A *key agreement scheme* KA defines a type of *public keys* KA.Public, a type of *private keys* KA.Private, and a type of shared secrets KA.SharedSecret. **Optionally, it also defines a type KA.PublicPrimeOrder  $\subseteq$  KA.Public.**

**Optional:** Let KA.FormatPrivate :  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \text{KA.Private}$  be a function to convert a bit string of length  $\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}$  to a KA *private key*.

Let KA.DerivePublic : KA.Private  $\times$  KA.Public  $\rightarrow$  KA.Public be a function that derives the KA *public key* corresponding to a given KA *private key* and base point.

Let KA.Agree : KA.Private  $\times$  KA.Public  $\rightarrow$  KA.SharedSecret be the agreement function.

**Optional:** Let KA.Base : KA.Public be a public base point.

**Note:** The range of KA.DerivePublic may be a strict subset of KA.Public.

#### Security requirements:

- KA.FormatPrivate must preserve sufficient entropy from its input to be used as a secure KA *private key*.
- The key agreement and the KDF defined in the next section must together satisfy a suitable adaptive security assumption along the lines of [Bernstein2006, section 3] or [ABR1999, Definition 3].

More precise formalization of these requirements is beyond the scope of this specification.

### 4.1.6 Key Derivation

A *Key Derivation Function* is defined for a particular *key agreement scheme* and *authenticated one-time symmetric encryption scheme*; it takes the shared secret produced by the key agreement and additional arguments, and derives a key suitable for the encryption scheme.

**The inputs to the *Key Derivation Function* differ between the **Sprout** and **Sapling** and **Orchard** KDFs:**

KDF<sup>Sprout</sup> takes as input an output index in  $\{1..N^{\text{new}}\}$ , the value  $h_{\text{Sig}}$ , the shared Diffie–Hellman secret sharedSecret, the *ephemeral public key* epk, and the recipient's public *transmission key* pk<sub>enc</sub>. It is suitable for use with KA<sup>Sprout</sup> and derives keys for Sym.Encrypt.

$$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}} : \{1..N^{\text{new}}\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{h_{\text{Sig}}}] \times \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{SharedSecret} \times \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public} \times \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public} \rightarrow \text{Sym.K}$$

KDF<sup>Sapling</sup> takes as input the shared Diffie–Hellman secret sharedSecret and the *ephemeral public key* epk. (It does not have inputs taking the place of the output index,  $h_{\text{Sig}}$ , or pk<sub>enc</sub>.) It is suitable for use with KA<sup>Sapling</sup> and derives keys for Sym.Encrypt.

$$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sapling}} : \text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{SharedSecret} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Sig}}/8]} \rightarrow \text{Sym.K}$$

As in **Sapling**, KDF<sup>Orchard</sup> takes as input the shared Diffie–Hellman secret sharedSecret and the *ephemeral public key* epk. It is suitable for use with KA<sup>Orchard</sup> and derives keys for Sym.Encrypt.

$$\text{KDF}^{\text{Orchard}} : \text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{SharedSecret} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Sig}}/8]} \rightarrow \text{Sym.K}$$

## Security requirements:

- The asymmetric encryption scheme in § 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65, constructed from  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $KDF^{\text{Sprout}}$  and  $\text{Sym}$ , is required to be IND-CCA2-secure and key-private.
- The asymmetric encryption scheme in § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67, constructed from  $KA^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $KDF^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{Sym}$  or from  $KA^{\text{Orchard}}$ ,  $KDF^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{Sym}$ , is required to be IND-CCA2-secure and key-private.

Key privacy is defined in [BBDP2001].

## 4.1.7 Signature

A signature scheme  $\text{Sig}$  defines:

- a type of *signing keys*  $\text{Sig.Private}$ ;
- a type of *validating keys*  $\text{Sig.Public}$ ;
- a type of messages  $\text{Sig.Message}$ ;
- a type of signatures  $\text{Sig.Signature}$ ;
- a randomized *signing key generation* algorithm  $\text{Sig.GenPrivate} : () \xrightarrow{R} \text{Sig.Private}$ ;
- an injective *validating key derivation* algorithm  $\text{Sig.DerivePublic} : \text{Sig.Private} \rightarrow \text{Sig.Public}$ ;
- a randomized *signing* algorithm  $\text{Sig.Sign} : \text{Sig.Private} \times \text{Sig.Message} \xrightarrow{R} \text{Sig.Signature}$ ;
- a *validating* algorithm  $\text{Sig.Validate} : \text{Sig.Public} \times \text{Sig.Message} \times \text{Sig.Signature} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}$ ;

such that for any *signing key*  $sk \xleftarrow{R} \text{Sig.GenPrivate}()$  and corresponding *validating key*  $vk = \text{Sig.DerivePublic}(sk)$ , and any  $m : \text{Sig.Message}$  and  $s : \text{Sig.Signature} \xleftarrow{R} \text{Sig.Sign}_{sk}(m)$ ,  $\text{Sig.Validate}_{vk}(m, s) = 1$ .

Zcash uses **four** signature schemes:

- one used for signatures that can be validated by script operations such as `OP_CHECKSIG` and `OP_CHECKMULTISIG` as in **Bitcoin**;
- one called `JoinSplitSig` which is used to sign *transactions* that contain at least one *JoinSplit description* (instantiated in § 5.4.6 ‘*Ed25519*’ on p. 90);
- [Sapling onward] one called `SpendAuthSig` which is used to sign *authorizations of Spend transfers* (instantiated in § 5.4.7.1 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95);
- [Sapling onward] one called `BindingSig`. A *Sapling binding signature* is used to enforce balance of *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers*, and to prevent their replay across *transactions*. Similarly, an *Orchard binding signature* is used to enforce balance of *Action transfers* and to prevent their replay. `BindingSig` is instantiated for both **Sapling** and **Orchard** in § 5.4.7.2 ‘*Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.

The signature scheme used in script operations is instantiated by ECDSA on the `secp256k1` curve. `JoinSplitSig` is instantiated by `Ed25519`. `SpendAuthSig` and `BindingSig` are instantiated by `RedDSA`; on the *Jubjub* curve in **Sapling**, and on the *Pallas* curve in **Orchard**.

The following security property is needed for `JoinSplitSig` and `BindingSig`. Security requirements for `SpendAuthSig` are defined in the next section, § 4.1.7.1 ‘*Signature with Re-Randomizable Keys*’ on p. 29. An additional requirement for `BindingSig` is defined in § 4.1.7.2 ‘*Signature with Signing Key to Validating Key Monomorphism*’ on p. 30.

**Security requirement:** `JoinSplitSig` and each instantiation of `BindingSig` must be Strongly Unforgeable under (non-adaptive) Chosen Message Attack (SU-CMA), as defined for example in [BDEHR2011, Definition 6].<sup>7</sup> This allows an adversary to obtain signatures on chosen messages, and then requires it to be infeasible for the adversary to forge a previously unseen valid (message, signature) pair without access to the *signing key*.

<sup>7</sup> The scheme defined in that paper was attacked in [LM2017], but this has no impact on the applicability of the definition.

#### Non-normative notes:

- We need separate *signing key* generation and *validating key* derivation algorithms, rather than the more conventional combined key pair generation algorithm  $\text{Sig.Gen} : () \xrightarrow{R} \text{Sig.Private} \times \text{Sig.Public}$ , to support the key derivation in § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36 and in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38. The definitions of schemes with additional features in § 4.1.7.1 ‘*Signature with Re-Randomizable Keys*’ on p. 29 and in § 4.1.7.2 ‘*Signature with Signing Key to Validating Key Monomorphism*’ on p. 30 also become simpler.
- A fresh signature key pair is generated for each *transaction* containing a *JoinSplit description*. Since each key pair is only used for one signature (see § 4.11 ‘*Non-malleability (Sprout)*’ on p. 51), a *one-time signature scheme* would suffice for JoinSplitSig. This is also the reason why only security against *non-adaptive* chosen message attack is needed. In fact the instantiation of JoinSplitSig uses a scheme designed for security under adaptive attack even when multiple signatures are signed under the same key.
- [Sapling onward] The same remarks as above apply to BindingSig, except that the key is derived from the randomness of *value commitments*. This results in the same distribution as of freshly generated key pairs, for each *transaction* containing *Spend descriptions* or *Output descriptions* or *Action descriptions*.
- SU-CMA security requires it to be infeasible for the adversary, not knowing the *private key*, to forge a distinct signature on a previously seen message. That is, *JoinSplit signatures* and *Sapling binding signatures* and *Orchard binding signatures* are intended to be *nonmalleable* in the sense of [BIP-62].
- The terminology used in this specification is that we “validate” signatures, and “verify” zk-SNARK proofs.

#### 4.1.7.1 Signature with Re-Randomizable Keys

A signature scheme with re-randomizable keys Sig is a signature scheme that additionally defines:

- a type of *randomizers*  $\text{Sig.Random}$ ;
- a *randomizer generator*  $\text{Sig.GenRandom} : () \xrightarrow{R} \text{Sig.Random}$ ;
- a *signing key randomization algorithm*  $\text{Sig.RandomizePrivate} : \text{Sig.Random} \times \text{Sig.Private} \rightarrow \text{Sig.Private}$ ;
- a *validating key randomization algorithm*  $\text{Sig.RandomizePublic} : \text{Sig.Random} \times \text{Sig.Public} \rightarrow \text{Sig.Public}$ ;
- a distinguished “identity” *randomizer*  $\mathcal{O}_{\text{Sig.Random}} : \text{Sig.Random}$

such that:

- for any  $\alpha : \text{Sig.Random}$ ,  $\text{Sig.RandomizePrivate}_\alpha : \text{Sig.Private} \rightarrow \text{Sig.Private}$  is injective and easily invertible;
- $\text{Sig.RandomizePrivate}_{\mathcal{O}_{\text{Sig.Random}}}$  is the identity function on  $\text{Sig.Private}$ .
- for any  $\text{sk} : \text{Sig.Private}$ ,  
 $\text{Sig.RandomizePrivate}(\alpha, \text{sk}) : \alpha \xleftarrow{R} \text{Sig.GenRandom}()$   
is identically distributed to  $\text{Sig.GenPrivate}()$ .
- for any  $\text{sk} : \text{Sig.Private}$  and  $\alpha : \text{Sig.Random}$ ,  
 $\text{Sig.RandomizePublic}(\alpha, \text{Sig.DerivePublic}(\text{sk})) = \text{Sig.DerivePublic}(\text{Sig.RandomizePrivate}(\alpha, \text{sk}))$ .

The following security requirement for such *signature schemes* is based on that given in [FKMSSS2016, section 3]. Note that we require Strong Unforgeability with Re-randomized Keys, not Existential Unforgeability with Re-randomized Keys (the latter is called “Unforgeability under Re-randomized Keys” in [FKMSSS2016, Definition 8]). Unlike the case for JoinSplitSig, we require security under adaptive chosen message attack with multiple messages signed using a given key. (Although each *note* uses a different *re-randomized* key pair, the same original key pair can be *re-randomized* for multiple *notes*, and also it can happen that multiple *transactions* spending the same *note* are revealed to an adversary.)





**Security requirement:** For any  $sk_1 : \text{Sig.Private}$ , and an unknown  $sk_2 \xleftarrow{R} \text{Sig.GenPrivate}()$  chosen independently of  $sk_1$ , the distribution of  $sk_1 \boxplus sk_2$  is computationally indistinguishable from that of  $\text{Sig.GenPrivate}()$ . (Since  $\boxplus$  is an abelian group operation, this implies that for  $n : \mathbb{N}^+$ ,  $\boxplus_{i=1}^n sk_i$  is computationally indistinguishable from  $\text{Sig.GenPrivate}()$  when at least one of  $sk_{1..n}$  is unknown.)

#### 4.1.8 Commitment

A *commitment scheme* is a function that, given a *commitment trapdoor* generated at random and an input, can be used to commit to the input in such a way that:

- no information is revealed about it without the *trapdoor* (“*hiding*”); and
- given the *trapdoor* and input, the commitment can be verified to “*open*” to that input and no other (“*binding*”).

A *commitment scheme*  $\text{COMM}$  defines a type of inputs  $\text{COMM.Input}$ , a type of commitments  $\text{COMM.Output}$ , a type of *commitment trapdoors*  $\text{COMM.Trapdoor}$ , and a *trapdoor* generator  $\text{COMM.GenTrapdoor} : () \xrightarrow{R} \text{COMM.Trapdoor}$ .

Let  $\text{COMM} : \text{COMM.Trapdoor} \times \text{COMM.Input} \rightarrow \text{COMM.Output}$  be a function satisfying the following security requirements.

**Security requirements:**

- **Computational *hiding*:** For all  $x, x' : \text{COMM.Input}$ , the distributions  $\{\text{COMM}_r(x) \mid r \xleftarrow{R} \text{COMM.GenTrapdoor}()\}$  and  $\{\text{COMM}_r(x') \mid r \xleftarrow{R} \text{COMM.GenTrapdoor}()\}$  are computationally indistinguishable.
- **Computational *binding*:** It is infeasible to find  $x, x' : \text{COMM.Input}$  and  $r, r' : \text{COMM.Trapdoor}$  such that  $x \neq x'$  and  $\text{COMM}_r(x) = \text{COMM}_{r'}(x')$ .

**Notes:**

- $\text{COMM.GenTrapdoor}$  need not produce the uniform distribution on  $\text{COMM.Trapdoor}$ . In that case, it is incorrect to choose a *trapdoor* from the latter distribution.
- If it were only feasible to find  $x : \text{COMM.Input}$  and  $r, r' : \text{COMM.Trapdoor}$  such that  $r \neq r'$  and  $\text{COMM}_r(x) = \text{COMM}_{r'}(x)$ , this would not contradict the computational *binding* security requirement. (In fact, this is feasible for  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  because *trapdoors* are equivalent modulo  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and the range of a *trapdoor* for those algorithms is  $\{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$  where  $2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} > r_{\mathbb{J}}$ .)

Let  $\ell_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ , and  $\ell_{\text{value}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Define  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor} := \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  and  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Output} := \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$ .

**Sprout** uses a *note commitment scheme*

$$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Output},$$

instantiated in § 5.4.8.1 ‘*Sprout Note Commitments*’ on p. 95.

Let  $\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ ,  $\ell_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.

Define:

$$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor} := \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\} \text{ and } \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output} := \mathbb{J};$$

$$\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor} := \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\} \text{ and } \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output} := \mathbb{J}.$$



**Sapling** uses two additional *commitment schemes*:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}} &: \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{J}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{J}}]} \times \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\} \rightarrow \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output} \\ \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}} &: \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \left\{-\frac{r_{\mathbb{P}}-1}{2} \dots \frac{r_{\mathbb{P}}-1}{2}\right\} \rightarrow \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output} \end{aligned}$$

$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is instantiated in § 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96, and  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is instantiated in § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97.

**Non-normative note:**  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  always return points in the subgroup  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ . However, we declare the type of these commitment outputs to be  $\mathbb{J}$  because they are not directly checked to be in the subgroup when  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  outputs appear in *Spend descriptions* and *Output descriptions*, or when the  $\text{cmu}$  field derived from a  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  appears in an *Output description*.

Let  $\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathbb{P}$ ,  $\ell_{\mathbb{P}}$ ,  $q_{\mathbb{P}}$ , and  $r_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105.

Define:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor} &:= \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}}}-1\} \text{ and } \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Output} := \mathbb{P} \cup \{\perp\}; \\ \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor} &:= \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}}}-1\} \text{ and } \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Output} := \mathbb{P}. \\ \text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}.\text{Trapdoor} &:= \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}}}-1\} \text{ and } \text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}.\text{Output} := \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}}-1\} \cup \{\perp\}. \end{aligned}$$

**Orchard** uses three additional *commitment schemes*:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}} &: \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{P}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{P}}]} \times \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\} \\ &\quad \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \rightarrow \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Output} \\ \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}} &: \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \left\{-\frac{r_{\mathbb{P}}-1}{2} \dots \frac{r_{\mathbb{P}}-1}{2}\right\} \rightarrow \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Output} \\ \text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}} &: \text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}.\text{Trapdoor} \times \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}}-1\} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \rightarrow \text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}.\text{Output} \end{aligned}$$

**Notes:**

- $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  can return  $\perp$  (with insignificant probability).
- $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  can return 0 (with insignificant probability) even though that is not a valid  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  private key. The use of  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  to obtain an **Orchard** incoming viewing key in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard** Key Components’ on p. 38 explicitly accounts for the 0 and  $\perp$  cases. Use of  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  in the *Action circuit* does not require special handling of the 0 case.

$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  are instantiated in § 5.4.8.4 ‘*Sinsemilla commitments*’ on p. 98.  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is instantiated in § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97.

## 4.1.9 Represented Group

A *represented group*  $\mathbb{G}$  consists of:

- a subgroup order parameter  $r_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{N}^+$ , which must be prime;
- a cofactor parameter  $h_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{N}^+$ ;
- a group  $\mathbb{G}$  of order  $h_{\mathbb{G}} \cdot r_{\mathbb{G}}$ , written additively with operation  $+$  :  $\mathbb{G} \times \mathbb{G} \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$ , and additive identity  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ ;
- a bit-length parameter  $\ell_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{N}$ ;
- a representation function  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{G} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{G}}]}$  and an abstraction function  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{G}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{G} \cup \{\perp\}$ , such that  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}$  is a left inverse of  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , i.e. for all  $P \in \mathbb{G}$ ,  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}(P)) = P$ .

**Note:** Ideally, we would also have that for all  $S$  not in the image of  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ ,  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}(S) = \perp$ . This may not be true in all cases, i.e. there can be *non-canonical* encodings  $P\star$  such that  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}(\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}(P\star)) \neq P\star$ .

Define  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$  as the order- $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  subgroup of  $\mathbb{G}$ , which is called a *represented subgroup*. Note that this includes  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ . For the set of points of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  (which excludes  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ ), we write  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)*}$ .

Define  $\mathbb{G}_{\star}^{(r)} := \{\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}(P) : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{G}}]} \mid P \in \mathbb{G}^{(r)}\}$ . (This intentionally excludes *non-canonical* encodings if there are any.)

For  $G : \mathbb{G}$  we write  $-G$  for the negation of  $G$ , such that  $(-G) + G = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ . We write  $G - H$  for  $G + (-H)$ .

We also extend the  $\sum$  notation to addition on group elements.

For  $G : \mathbb{G}$  and  $k : \mathbb{Z}$  we write  $[k] G$  for scalar multiplication on the group, i.e.

$$[k] G := \begin{cases} \sum_{i=1}^k G, & \text{if } k \geq 0 \\ \sum_{i=1}^{-k} (-G), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

For  $G : \mathbb{G}$  and  $a : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{G}}}$ , we may also write  $[a] G$  meaning  $[a \bmod r_{\mathbb{G}}] G$  as defined above. (This variant is not defined for fields other than  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{G}}}$ .)

#### 4.1.10 Coordinate Extractor

A *coordinate extractor* for a *represented group*  $\mathbb{G}$  is a function  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}} : \mathbb{G}^{(r)} \rightarrow T$  for some type  $T$ .

**Note:** Unlike the representation function  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ ,  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}$  need not have an efficiently computable left inverse.

#### 4.1.11 Group Hash

Given a *represented subgroup*  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$ , a *family of group hashes into the subgroup*, denoted  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}$ , consists of:

- a type  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{URSType}$  of *Uniform Random Strings*;
- a type  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{Input}$  of inputs;
- a function  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}} : \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{URSType} \times \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{Input} \rightarrow \mathbb{G}^{(r)}$ .

In § 5.4.9.5 ‘*Group Hash into Jubjub*’ on p. 104, we instantiate a family of *group hashes* into the Jubjub curve defined by § 5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.

**Security requirement:** For a randomly selected  $\text{URS} : \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{URSType}$ , it must be reasonable to model  $\text{GroupHash}_{\text{URS}}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}$  (restricted to inputs for which it does not return  $\perp$ ) as a *random oracle*.

In § 5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 107, we instantiate *group hashes* into the Pallas and Vesta curves. These are not strictly speaking *families of group hashes*, because they have a trivial URS, and so the above security definition does not apply. Nevertheless, they can be heuristically modelled as *random oracles*.

### Non-normative notes:

- $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  is used to obtain generators of the Jubjub curve for various purposes: the bases  $\mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\mathcal{H}^{\text{Sapling}}$  used in **Sapling** key generation, the *Pedersen hash* defined in § 5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79, and the *commitment schemes* defined in § 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96 and in § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97.  
The security property needed for these uses can alternatively be defined in the standard model as follows:  
**Discrete Logarithm Independence:** For a randomly selected member  $\text{GroupHash}_{\text{URS}}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}$  of the family, it is infeasible to find a sequence of *distinct* inputs  $m_{1..n} : \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}.\text{Input}^{[n]}$  and a sequence of nonzero  $x_{1..n} : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{G}}}^*^{[n]}$  such that  $\sum_{i=1}^n \left( [x_i] \text{GroupHash}_{\text{URS}}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}(m_i) \right) = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ .
- Assuming hardness of the *Discrete Logarithm Problem* on  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$ , a *random oracle* almost surely satisfies *Discrete Logarithm Independence*. *Discrete Logarithm Independence* implies *collision resistance*, since a collision  $(m_1, m_2)$  for  $\text{GroupHash}_{\text{URS}}^{\mathbb{G}^{(r)}}$  trivially gives a *discrete logarithm* relation with  $x_1 = 1$  and  $x_2 = -1$ .
- $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  is used in § 5.4.1.6 ‘*DiversifyHash<sup>Sapling</sup> and DiversifyHash<sup>Orchard</sup> Hash Functions*’ on p. 78 to instantiate  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}}$ . We do not know how to prove the *Unlinkability* property defined in that section in the standard model, but in a model where  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  (restricted to inputs for which it does not return  $\perp$ ) is taken as a *random oracle*, it is implied by the *Decisional Diffie–Hellman assumption* on  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ , and similarly for  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$ .
- **URS** is a *Uniform Random String*; we chose it verifiably at random (see § 5.9 ‘*Randomness Beacon*’ on p. 120), after fixing the concrete group hash algorithm to be used. This mitigates the possibility that the group hash algorithm could have been backdoored. For **Orchard**, we considered a URS to be unnecessary, because we follow [ID-hashtocurve] which does not use one.

### 4.1.12 Represented Pairing

A *represented pairing*  $\mathbb{PAIR}$  consists of:

- a group order parameter  $r_{\mathbb{PAIR}} : \mathbb{N}^+$  which must be prime;
- two *represented subgroups*  $\mathbb{PAIR}_{1,2}^{(r)}$ , both of order  $r_{\mathbb{PAIR}}$ ;
- a group  $\mathbb{PAIR}_T^{(r)}$  of order  $r_{\mathbb{PAIR}}$ , written multiplicatively with operation  $\cdot : \mathbb{PAIR}_T^{(r)} \times \mathbb{PAIR}_T^{(r)} \rightarrow \mathbb{PAIR}_T^{(r)}$  and group identity  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{PAIR}}$ ;
- three generators  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{PAIR}_{1,2,T}}$  of  $\mathbb{PAIR}_{1,2,T}^{(r)}$  respectively;
- a pairing function  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{PAIR}} : \mathbb{PAIR}_1^{(r)} \times \mathbb{PAIR}_2^{(r)} \rightarrow \mathbb{PAIR}_T^{(r)}$  satisfying:
  - (Bilinearity) for all  $a, b : \mathbb{F}_r^*$ ,  $P : \mathbb{PAIR}_1^{(r)}$ , and  $Q : \mathbb{PAIR}_2^{(r)}$ ,  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{PAIR}}([a] P, [b] Q) = \hat{e}_{\mathbb{PAIR}}(P, Q)^{a \cdot b}$ ; and
  - (Nondegeneracy) there does not exist  $P : \mathbb{PAIR}_1^{(r)*}$  such that for all  $Q : \mathbb{PAIR}_2^{(r)}$ ,  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{PAIR}}(P, Q) = \mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{PAIR}}$ .

### 4.1.13 Zero-Knowledge Proving System

A *zero-knowledge proving system* is a cryptographic protocol that allows proving a particular *statement*, dependent on *primary* and *auxiliary inputs*, in zero knowledge – that is, without revealing information about the *auxiliary inputs* other than that implied by the *statement*. The type of *zero-knowledge proving system* needed by **Zcash** is a *preprocessing zk-SNARK* [BCCGLRT2014].

A preprocessing zk-SNARK instance  $ZK$  defines:

- a type of zero-knowledge proving keys,  $ZK.ProvingKey$ ;
- a type of zero-knowledge verifying keys,  $ZK.VerifyingKey$ ;
- a type of primary inputs  $ZK.PrimaryInput$ ;
- a type of auxiliary inputs  $ZK.AuxiliaryInput$ ;
- a type of zk-SNARK proofs  $ZK.Proof$ ;
- a type  $ZK.SatisfyingInputs \subseteq ZK.PrimaryInput \times ZK.AuxiliaryInput$  of inputs satisfying the *statement*;
- a randomized key pair generation algorithm  $ZK.Gen : () \xrightarrow{R} ZK.ProvingKey \times ZK.VerifyingKey$ ;
- a proving algorithm  $ZK.Prove : ZK.ProvingKey \times ZK.SatisfyingInputs \rightarrow ZK.Proof$ ;
- a verifying algorithm  $ZK.Verify : ZK.VerifyingKey \times ZK.PrimaryInput \times ZK.Proof \rightarrow \mathbb{B}$ ;

The security requirements below are supposed to hold with overwhelming probability for  $(pk, vk) \xleftarrow{R} ZK.Gen()$ .

#### Security requirements:

- **Completeness:** An honestly generated proof will convince a verifier: for any  $(x, w) \in ZK.SatisfyingInputs$ , if  $ZK.Prove_{pk}(x, w)$  outputs  $\pi$ , then  $ZK.Verify_{vk}(x, \pi) = 1$ .
- **Knowledge Soundness:** For any adversary  $\mathcal{A}$  able to find an  $x : ZK.PrimaryInput$  and proof  $\pi : ZK.Proof$  such that  $ZK.Verify_{vk}(x, \pi) = 1$ , there is an efficient extractor  $\mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{A}}$  such that if  $\mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{A}}(vk, pk)$  returns  $w$ , then the probability that  $(x, w) \notin ZK.SatisfyingInputs$  is insignificant.
- **Statistical Zero Knowledge:** An honestly generated proof is statistical zero knowledge. That is, there is a feasible stateful simulator  $\mathcal{S}$  such that, for all stateful distinguishers  $\mathcal{D}$ , the following two probabilities are not significantly different:

$$\Pr \left[ \begin{array}{c} (x, w) \in ZK.SatisfyingInputs \\ \mathcal{D}(\pi) = 1 \end{array} \middle| \begin{array}{c} (pk, vk) \xleftarrow{R} ZK.Gen() \\ (x, w) \xleftarrow{R} \mathcal{D}(pk, vk) \\ \pi \xleftarrow{R} ZK.Prove_{pk}(x, w) \end{array} \right] \text{ and } \Pr \left[ \begin{array}{c} (x, w) \in ZK.SatisfyingInputs \\ \mathcal{D}(\pi) = 1 \end{array} \middle| \begin{array}{c} (pk, vk) \xleftarrow{R} \mathcal{S}() \\ (x, w) \xleftarrow{R} \mathcal{D}(pk, vk) \\ \pi \xleftarrow{R} \mathcal{S}(x) \end{array} \right]$$

These definitions are derived from those in [BCTV2014b, Appendix C], adapted to state concrete security for a fixed circuit, rather than asymptotic security for arbitrary circuits. ( $ZK.Prove$  corresponds to  $P$ ,  $ZK.Verify$  corresponds to  $V$ , and  $ZK.SatisfyingInputs$  corresponds to  $\mathcal{R}_C$  in the notation of that appendix.)

The Knowledge Soundness definition is a way to formalize the property that it is infeasible to find a new proof  $\pi$  where  $ZK.Verify_{vk}(x, \pi) = 1$  without *knowing* an *auxiliary input*  $w$  such that  $(x, w) \in ZK.SatisfyingInputs$ . Note that Knowledge Soundness implies Soundness — i.e. the property that it is infeasible to find a new proof  $\pi$  where  $ZK.Verify_{vk}(x, \pi) = 1$  without *there existing* an *auxiliary input*  $w$  such that  $(x, w) \in ZK.SatisfyingInputs$ .

#### Non-normative notes:

- The above properties do not include *nonmalleability* [DSDCOPS2001], and the design of the protocol using the zero-knowledge proving system must take this into account.
- The terminology used in this specification is that we “validate” signatures, and “verify” zk-SNARK proofs.

#### Zcash uses three proving systems:

- BCTV14 (§5.4.10.1 ‘BCTV14’ on p. 110) is used with the BN-254 pairing (§5.4.9.1 ‘BN-254’ on p. 99), to prove and verify the **Sprout JoinSplit statement** (§4.18.1 ‘JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)’ on p. 60) before **Sapling** activation.
- Groth16 (§5.4.10.2 ‘Groth16’ on p. 111) is used with the BLS12-381 pairing (§5.4.9.2 ‘BLS12-381’ on p. 101), to prove and verify the **Sapling Spend statement** (§4.18.2 ‘Spend Statement (Sapling)’ on p. 61) and **Output statement** (§4.18.3 ‘Output Statement (Sapling)’ on p. 62). It is also used to prove and verify the **JoinSplit statement** after **Sapling** activation.

- [NU5 onward] Halo 2 (§ 5.4.10.3 ‘Halo 2’ on p. 112) is used with the Vesta curve (§ 5.4.9.6 ‘Pallas *and* Vesta’ on p. 105) to prove and verify the **Orchard** Action statement (§ 4.18.4 ‘Action Statement (**Orchard**)’ on p. 63).

These specializations are:

- ZKJoinSplit for the **Sprout** JoinSplit statement (with BCTV14 and BN-254, or Groth16 and BLS12-381);
- ZKSpend for the **Sapling** Spend statement and ZKOutput for the **Sapling** Output statement;
- [NU5 onward] ZKAction for the **Orchard** Action statement.

We omit key subscripts on ZKJoinSplit.Prove and ZKJoinSplit.Verify, taking them to be either the BCTV14 *proving* key and *verifying* key defined in § 5.7 ‘BCTV14 *zk*-SNARK Parameters’ on p. 119, or the sprout-groth16.params Groth16 *proving* key and *verifying* key defined in § 5.8 ‘Groth16 *zk*-SNARK Parameters’ on p. 119, according to whether the proof appears in a *block* before or after **Sapling** activation.

We omit subscripts on ZKSpend.Prove, ZKSpend.Verify, ZKOutput.Prove, and ZKOutput.Verify, taking them to be the relevant Groth16 *proving* keys and *verifying* keys defined in § 5.8 ‘Groth16 *zk*-SNARK Parameters’ on p. 119.

We also omit subscripts on ZKAction.Prove and ZKAction.Verify. For Halo 2, parameters for a given circuit implementation are generated on the fly by the halo2 library, and do not require parameter files.

## 4.2 Key Components

### 4.2.1 Sprout Key Components

Let  $\ell_{\text{ask}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  be a *Pseudo Random Function*, instantiated in § 5.4.2 ‘Pseudo Random Functions’ on p. 86.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be a key agreement scheme, instantiated in § 5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout** Key Agreement’ on p. 88.

A new **Sprout** spending key  $\text{a}_{\text{sk}}$  is generated by choosing a *bit* sequence uniformly at random from  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{ask}}]}$ .

$\text{a}_{\text{pk}}$ ,  $\text{sk}_{\text{enc}}$  and  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}}$  are derived from  $\text{a}_{\text{sk}}$  as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{a}_{\text{pk}} &:= \text{PRF}_{\text{ask}}^{\text{addr}}(0) \\ \text{sk}_{\text{enc}} &:= \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{FormatPrivate}(\text{PRF}_{\text{ask}}^{\text{addr}}(1)) \\ \text{pk}_{\text{enc}} &:= \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{DerivePublic}(\text{sk}_{\text{enc}}, \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Base}). \end{aligned}$$

### 4.2.2 Sapling Key Components

Let  $\ell_{\text{PRFexpand}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{sk}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{ovk}}$ , and  $\ell_{\text{d}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ ,  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ ,  $\mathbb{J}_{\star}^{(r)}$ ,  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102, and let  $\text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.5 ‘Group Hash into Jubjub’ on p. 104.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{ockSapling}}$ , instantiated in § 5.4.2 ‘Pseudo Random Functions’ on p. 86, be *Pseudo Random Functions*.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , instantiated in § 5.4.5.3 ‘**Sapling** Key Agreement’ on p. 89, be a *key agreement scheme*.

Let  $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$ , instantiated in § 5.4.1.5 ‘ $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$  Hash Function’ on p. 77, be a *hash function*.

Let  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , instantiated in § 5.4.1.6 ‘ $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}$  Hash Functions’ on p. 78, be a *hash function*.

Let  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , instantiated in § 5.4.7.1 ‘Spend Authorization Signature (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’ on p. 95, be a *signature scheme with re-randomizable keys*.

Let  $\text{LEBS2OSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \text{ceiling}(\ell/8) \rceil}$  and  $\text{LEOS2IP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N} \mid \ell \bmod 8 = 0) \times \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil} \rightarrow \{0..2^{\ell}-1\}$  be as defined in § 5.1 ‘Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness’ on p. 73.

Define  $\mathcal{H}^{\text{Sapling}} := \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}(\text{"Zcash\_H\_"}, \text{""})$

Define  $\text{ToScalar}^{\text{Sapling}}(x : \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell_{\text{PRFexpand}}/8 \rceil}) := \text{LEOS2IP}_{\ell_{\text{PRFexpand}}}(x) \pmod{r_{\mathbb{J}}}.$











#### Non-normative notes:

- The uses of  $\text{ToScalar}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{ToBase}^{\text{Orchard}}$  produce output that is uniform on  $\mathbb{F}_{r_p}$  and  $\mathbb{F}_{d_p}$  respectively when applied to random input, by a similar argument to that used in § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36.
- The output of  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  is the *affine-short-Weierstrass*  $x$ -coordinate of a Pallas curve point, which we then use as a  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  private key  $\text{ivk}$  for note encryption. The fact that  $\text{ivk}$  is non-uniform on  $\mathbb{F}_{r_p}$  (since it can only take on roughly half of the possible values) is not expected to cause any security issue.

### 4.3 JoinSplit Descriptions

A *JoinSplit transfer*, as specified in § 3.5 ‘*JoinSplit Transfers and Descriptions*’ on p. 19, is encoded in *transactions* as a *JoinSplit description*.

Each *transaction* includes a sequence of zero or more *JoinSplit descriptions*. When this sequence is non-empty, the *transaction* also includes encodings of a *JoinSplitSig* public *validating key* and signature.

Let  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}$ ,  $\ell_{\text{Seed}}$ ,  $N^{\text{old}}$ ,  $N^{\text{new}}$ , and  $\text{MAX\_MONEY}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{hSigCRH}$  be as defined in § 4.1.1 ‘*Hash Functions*’ on p. 24.

Let  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in § 4.1.5 ‘*Key Agreement*’ on p. 27.

Let  $\text{Sym}$  be as defined in § 4.1.4 ‘*Symmetric Encryption*’ on p. 26.

Let  $\text{ZKJoinSplit}$  be as defined in § 4.1.13 ‘*Zero-Knowledge Proving System*’ on p. 34.

A *JoinSplit description* comprises  $(v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}, \text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}}, \text{nf}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}}, \text{cm}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}}, \text{epk}, \text{randomSeed}, h_{1..N^{\text{old}}}, \pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}, C_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{enc}})$  where

- $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  is the value that the *JoinSplit transfer* removes from the *transparent transaction value pool*;
- $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}} : \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  is the value that the *JoinSplit transfer* inserts into the *transparent transaction value pool*;
- $\text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  is an *anchor*, as defined in § 3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18, for the output *treestate* of either a previous *block*, or a previous *JoinSplit transfer* in this *transaction*.
- $\text{nf}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}][N^{\text{old}}]}$  is the sequence of *nullifiers* for the input *notes*;
- $\text{cm}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Output}^{[N^{\text{new}}]}$  is the sequence of *note commitments* for the output *notes*;
- $\text{epk} : \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public}$  is a key agreement *public key*, used to derive the key for encryption of the *transmitted notes ciphertext* (§ 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65);
- $\text{randomSeed} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Seed}}]}$  is a seed that must be chosen independently at random for each *JoinSplit description*;
- $h_{1..N^{\text{old}}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}][N^{\text{old}}]}$  is a sequence of tags that bind  $\text{hSig}$  to each  $a_{\text{sk}}$  of the input *notes*;
- $\pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}} : \text{ZKJoinSplit}.\text{Proof}$  is a *zk proof* with *primary input*  $(\text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}}, \text{nf}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}}, \text{cm}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}, \text{hSig}, h_{1..N^{\text{old}}})$  for the *JoinSplit statement* defined in § 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60 (this is a **BCTV14 proof before Sapling activation, and a Groth16 proof after Sapling activation**);
- $C_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{enc}} : \text{Sym}.\text{C}^{[N^{\text{new}}]}$  is a sequence of ciphertext components for the encrypted output *notes*.

The *ephemeralKey* and *encCiphertexts* fields together form the *transmitted notes ciphertext*.

The value  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  is also computed from  $\text{randomSeed}$ ,  $\text{nf}_{1..N}^{\text{old}}$ , and the  $\text{joinSplitPubKey}$  of the containing *transaction*:

$$h_{\text{Sig}} := \text{hSigCRH}(\text{randomSeed}, \text{nf}_{1..N}^{\text{old}}, \text{joinSplitPubKey}).$$

#### Consensus rules:

- Elements of a *JoinSplit description* **MUST** have the types given above (for example:  $0 \leq v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}} \leq \text{MAX\_MONEY}$  and  $0 \leq v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}} \leq \text{MAX\_MONEY}$ ).
- The proof  $\pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}$  **MUST** be valid given a *primary input* formed from the relevant other fields and  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  — i.e.  $\text{ZKJoinSplit.Verify}((\text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}}, \text{nf}_{1..N}^{\text{old}}, \text{cm}_{1..N}^{\text{new}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}, h_{\text{Sig}}, h_{1..N}^{\text{old}}), \pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}) = 1$ .
- Either  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  or  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  **MUST** be zero.
- [Canopy onward]  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  **MUST** be zero.

## 4.4 Spend Descriptions

A *Spend transfer*, as specified in § 3.6 ‘*Spend Transfers, Output Transfers, and their Descriptions*’ on p. 20, is encoded in *transactions* as a *Spend description*.

Each *transaction* includes a sequence of zero or more *Spend descriptions*.

Each *Spend description* is authorized by a signature, called the *spend authorization signature*.

Let  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\ell_{\text{PRFnsapling}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ ,  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}$ ,  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $h_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.

Let  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}$  be as defined in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in § 4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 57.

Let  $\text{ZKSpend}$  be as defined in § 4.1.13 ‘*Zero-Knowledge Proving System*’ on p. 34.

A *Spend description* comprises  $(\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}, \pi_{\text{ZKSpend}}, \text{spendAuthSig})$  where

- $\text{cv} : \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}$  is the *value commitment* to the value of the input *note*;
- $\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$  is an *anchor*, as defined in § 3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18, for the output *treestate* of a previous *block*;
- $\text{nf} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{PRFnsapling}}/8}$  is the *nullifier* for the input *note*;
- $\text{rk} : \text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Public}$  is a randomized *validating key* that should be used to validate  $\text{spendAuthSig}$ ;
- $\pi_{\text{ZKSpend}} : \text{ZKSpend}.\text{Proof}$  is a *zk-SNARK proof* with *primary input*  $(\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk})$  for the *Spend statement* defined in § 4.18.2 ‘*Spend Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 61;
- $\text{spendAuthSig} : \text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Signature}$  is a *spend authorization signature*, validated as specified in § 4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 57.

#### Consensus rules:

- Elements of a *Spend description* **MUST** be valid encodings of the types given above.
- $\text{cv}$  and  $\text{rk}$  **MUST NOT** be of *small order*, i.e.  $[h_{\mathbb{J}}] \text{cv}$  **MUST NOT** be  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$  and  $[h_{\mathbb{J}}] \text{rk}$  **MUST NOT** be  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ .
- The proof  $\pi_{\text{ZKSpend}}$  **MUST** be valid given a *primary input* formed from the other fields except  $\text{spendAuthSig}$  — i.e.  $\text{ZKSpend.Verify}((\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}), \pi_{\text{ZKSpend}}) = 1$ .



### Non-normative notes:

- As stated in §5.4.8.3 on p.97, an implementation of `HomomorphicPedersenCommitSapling` **MAY** resample the *commitment trapdoor* until the resulting commitment is not  $\mathcal{O}_j$ .
- The rule that `cv` and `epk` **MUST** not be *small-order* has the effect of also preventing *non-canonical* encodings of these fields, as required by [ZIP-216]. That is, it is necessarily the case that  $\text{repr}_j(\text{abst}_j(\text{cv})) = \text{cv}$  and  $\text{repr}_j(\text{abst}_j(\text{epk})) = \text{rk}$ .

## 4.6 Action Descriptions

An *Action transfer*, as specified in §3.7 ‘*Action Transfers and their Descriptions*’ on p.20, is encoded in *transactions* as an *Action description*. Each version 5 *transaction* includes a sequence of zero or more *Action descriptions*. (Version 4 *transactions* cannot contain *Action descriptions*.)

Each *Action description* is authorized by a signature, called the *spend authorization signature*.

Let  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p.74.

Let  $q_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p.105.

Let `ExtractP` be as defined in §5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p.106.

Let `ValueCommitOrchard.Output` be as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p.31.

Let `SpendAuthSigOrchard` be as defined in §4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p.57.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in §4.1.5 ‘*Key Agreement*’ on p.27.

Let `Sym` be as defined in §4.1.4 ‘*Symmetric Encryption*’ on p.26.

Let `ZKAction` be as defined in §4.1.13 ‘*Zero-Knowledge Proving System*’ on p.34.

An *Action description* comprises  $(\text{cv}^{\text{net}}, \text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}, \text{spendAuthSig}, \text{cm}_x, \text{epk}, \text{C}^{\text{enc}}, \text{C}^{\text{out}}, \text{enableSpends}, \text{enableOutputs}, \pi)$ :

- $\text{cv}^{\text{net}}$  : `ValueCommitOrchard.Output` is the *value commitment* to the value of the input *note* minus the value of the output *note*;
- $\text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}$  :  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  is an *anchor*, as defined in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p.18, for the output *treestate* of a previous *block*;
- $\text{nf}$  :  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  is the *nullifier* for the input *note*;
- $\text{rk}$  : `SpendAuthSigOrchard.Public` is a randomized *validating key* that should be used to validate `spendAuthSig`;
- `spendAuthSig` : `SpendAuthSigOrchard.Signature` is a *spend authorization signature*, validated as specified in §4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p.57;
- $\text{cm}_x$  :  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  is the result of applying `ExtractP` to the *note commitment* for the output *note*;
- $\text{epk}$  :  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Public}$  is a *key agreement public key*, used to derive the key for encryption of the *transmitted note ciphertext* (§4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p.67);
- $\text{C}^{\text{enc}}$  : `Sym.C` is a ciphertext component for the encrypted output *note*;
- $\text{C}^{\text{out}}$  : `Sym.C` is a ciphertext component that allows the holder of the *outgoing cipher key* (which can be derived from a *full viewing key*) to recover the recipient *diversified transmission key*  $\text{pk}_d$  and the *ephemeral private key*  $\text{esk}$ , hence the entire *note plaintext*;
- `enableSpends` :  $\mathbb{B}$  is a flag that is set in order to enable non-zero-valued spends in this *Action*;
- `enableOutputs` :  $\mathbb{B}$  is a flag that is set in order to enable non-zero-valued outputs in this *Action*;
- $\pi$  : `ZKAction.Proof` is a *zk-SNARK proof* with *primary input*  $(\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}, \text{cm}_x, \text{enableSpends}, \text{enableOutputs})$  for the *Action statement* defined in §4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p.63.

**Note:** The  $\text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , `enableSpends`, and `enableOutputs` components are the same for all *Action transfers* in a *transaction*, and are encoded once in the *transaction body* (§7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p.122), not the `ActionDescription` structure.  $\pi$  is aggregated with other *Action proofs* and encoded in the `proofsOrchard` field.

#### Consensus rules:

- Elements of an *Action description* **MUST** be canonical encodings of the types given above.
- Let  $\text{SigHash}$  be the *SIGHASH transaction hash* of this *transaction*, not associated with an input, as defined in §4.10 ‘*SIGHASH Transaction Hashing*’ on p. 50 using  $\text{SIGHASH\_ALL}$ .  
The *spend authorization signature* **MUST** be a valid  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Orchard}}$  signature over  $\text{SigHash}$  using  $\text{rk}$  as the *validating key*— i.e.  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Validate}_{\text{rk}}(\text{SigHash}, \text{spendAuthSig}) = 1$ . As specified in §5.4.7 ‘*RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas*’ on p. 92, validation of the  $\underline{R}$  component of the signature prohibits *non-canonical* encodings.
- The proof  $\pi$  **MUST** be valid given a *primary input*  $(\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}, \text{cm}_x, \text{enableSpends}, \text{enableOutputs})$  — i.e.  $\text{ZKAction}.\text{Verify}((\text{cv}, \text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}, \text{nf}, \text{rk}, \text{cm}_x, \text{enableSpends}, \text{enableOutputs}), \pi) = 1$ .

#### Non-normative notes:

- $\text{cv}$  and  $\text{rk}$  can be the zero point  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ .  $\text{epk}$  cannot be  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ .
- $\text{nf}$  and  $\text{cm}_x$  are *not* checked to be valid *affine-short-Weierstrass*  $x$ -coordinates on the Pallas curve; they are only checked to encode integers in  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$ .

## 4.7 Sending Notes

### 4.7.1 Sending Notes (Sprout)

In order to send **Sprout** *shielded* value, the sender constructs a *transaction* containing one or more *JoinSplit descriptions*.

Let  $\text{JoinSplitSig}$  be as specified in §4.1.7 ‘*Signature*’ on p. 28.

Let  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as specified in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\ell_{\text{Seed}}$  and  $\ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as specified in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Sending a *transaction* containing *JoinSplit descriptions* involves first generating a new  $\text{JoinSplitSig}$  key pair:

```
joinSplitPrivKey  $\xleftarrow{R}$  JoinSplitSig.GenPrivate()  
joinSplitPubKey := JoinSplitSig.DerivePublic(joinSplitPrivKey).
```

For each *JoinSplit description*, the sender chooses  $\text{randomSeed}$  uniformly at random on  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Seed}}]}$ , and selects the input *notes*. At this point there is sufficient information to compute  $\text{h}_{\text{Sig}}$ , as described in the previous section. The sender also chooses  $\varphi$  uniformly at random on  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$ . Then it creates each output *note* with index  $i : \{1 \dots N^{\text{new}}\}$ :

- Choose uniformly random  $\text{rcm}_i \xleftarrow{R} \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{GenTrapdoor}()$ .
- Compute  $\rho_i = \text{PRF}_{\varphi}^{\rho}(i, \text{h}_{\text{Sig}})$ .
- Compute  $\text{cm}_i = \text{NoteCommit}_{\text{rcm}_i}^{\text{Sprout}}(\text{apk}_i, v_i, \rho_i)$ .
- Let  $\text{np}_i = (0x00, v_i, \rho_i, \text{rcm}_i, \text{memo}_i)$ .

$\text{np}_{1 \dots N^{\text{new}}}$  are then encrypted to the recipient *transmission keys*  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}, 1 \dots N^{\text{new}}}$ , giving the *transmitted notes ciphertext*  $(\text{epk}, \text{C}_{1 \dots N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{enc}})$ , as described in §4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65.

In order to minimize information leakage, the sender **SHOULD** randomize the order of the input *notes* and of the output *notes*. Other considerations relating to information leakage from the structure of *transactions* are beyond the scope of this specification.

After generating all of the *JoinSplit descriptions*, the sender obtains  $\text{dataToBeSigned} : \mathbb{B}^{\text{Y}^{[N]}}$  as described in §4.11 ‘*Non-malleability (Sprout)*’ on p. 51, and signs it with the private *JoinSplit signing key*:

```
joinSplitSig  $\xleftarrow{R}$  JoinSplitSig.Sign_{joinSplitPrivKey}(\text{dataToBeSigned})
```

Then the encoded *transaction* including  $\text{joinSplitSig}$  is submitted to the *peer-to-peer network*.

[Canopy onward] **Note:** [ZIP-211] specifies that nodes and wallets **MUST** disable any facilities to send to **Sprout** addresses. This **SHOULD** be made clear in user interfaces and API documentation.

The facility to send to **Sprout** addresses is in any case **OPTIONAL** for a particular node or wallet implementation.







### 4.7.3 Sending Notes (Orchard)

In order to send **Orchard** *shielded* value, the sender constructs a *transaction* with one or more *Action descriptions*. This section describes how to produce the output-related fields of an *Action description*.

Let  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as specified in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  be as specified in § 4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as specified in § 4.1.5 ‘*Key Agreement*’ on p. 27.

Let  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as specified in § 4.1.1 ‘*Hash Functions*’ on p. 24.

Let  $\text{ToScalar}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{ToBase}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as specified in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard** *Key Components*’ on p. 38.

Let  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}$ ,  $r_{\mathbb{P}}$ , and the Pallas curve be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105.

Let  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106.

Let  $\text{I2LEOSP}$  be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

Let  $\text{ovk}$  be an **Orchard** *outgoing viewing key* that is intended to be able to decrypt this payment. The considerations for choosing *outgoing viewing keys* are as described for **Sapling** in § 4.7.2 ‘**Sending Notes (Sapling)**’ on p. 45.

Let  $\text{leadByte}$  be the *note plaintext lead byte*, chosen according to § 3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15 with  $\text{protocol} = \text{Orchard}$ .

For each *Action description*, the sender selects a value  $v : \{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  and a destination **Orchard** *shielded payment address*  $(d, \text{pk}_d)$ , and performs the following steps:

Check that  $\text{pk}_d$  is of type  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ .

Calculate  $g_d = \text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}(d)$ .

Choose a uniformly random *commitment trapdoor*  $\text{rcv} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{GenTrapdoor}()$ .

Choose uniformly random  $\text{rseed} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{BY}^{[32]}$ .

Let  $\rho = \text{nf}^{\text{old}}$  from the same *Action description*, and let  $\underline{\rho} = \text{I2LEOSP}_{256}(\rho)$ .

Derive  $\text{esk} = \text{ToScalar}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([4] \parallel \underline{\rho}))$ .

If  $\text{esk} = 0 \pmod{r_{\mathbb{P}}}$ , repeat the above steps using a different  $\text{rseed}$ .

Derive  $\text{rcm} = \text{ToScalar}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([5] \parallel \underline{\rho}))$ .

Derive  $\psi = \text{ToBase}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([9] \parallel \underline{\rho}))$ .

Let  $\text{cv}^{\text{net}}$  be the *value commitment* to the value of the input *note* minus the value  $v$  of the output *note* for this *Action transfer*, using  $\text{rcv}$ , as described in § 4.14 ‘**Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)**’ on p. 54.

Let  $\text{cm}_x = \text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}(\text{NoteCommit}_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(g_d), \text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(\text{pk}_d), v, \rho, \psi))$ .

If  $\text{cm}_x = \perp$ , repeat the above steps using a different  $\text{rseed}$ .

Let  $\text{np} = (\text{leadByte}, d, v, \text{rseed}, \text{memo})$ .

Encrypt  $\text{np}$  to the recipient *diversified transmission key*  $\text{pk}_d$  with *diversified base*  $g_d$ , and to the *outgoing viewing key*  $\text{ovk}$ , giving the *transmitted note ciphertext*  $(\text{epk}, \text{C}^{\text{enc}}, \text{C}^{\text{out}})$ . This procedure is described in § 4.20.1 ‘**Encryption (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 67; it uses  $\text{cv}^{\text{net}}$  and  $\text{cm}_x$  to derive  $\text{ock}$ , and takes  $\text{esk}$  as input.

Fill in the spending side of the *Action transfer* (§ 4.15 ‘**Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 57), and generate a proof  $\pi$  for the *Action statement* in § 4.18.4 ‘**Action Statement (Orchard)**’ on p. 63.

Return  $(\text{cv}, \text{cm}_x, \text{epk}, \text{C}^{\text{enc}}, \text{C}^{\text{out}}, \pi)$ .

If no real **Orchard** note is being spent in the same *Action transfer*, the sender **SHOULD** create a *dummy note* to spend as described in §4.8.3 ‘*Dummy Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 48, and use that *dummy note*’s nullifier as the  $p$  value.

In order to minimize information leakage, the sender **SHOULD** randomize the order of *Action descriptions* in a *transaction*. Other considerations relating to information leakage from the structure of *transactions* are beyond the scope of this specification. The encoded *transaction* is submitted to the *peer-to-peer network*.

**Note:** The domain separators [4] and [5] used in the input to  $\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}$  are swapped for **Orchard** relative to **Sapling**. This was due to an oversight and there is no good reason for it.

## 4.8 Dummy Notes

### 4.8.1 Dummy Notes (Sprout)

The fields in a *JoinSplit description* allow for  $N^{\text{old}}$  input notes, and  $N^{\text{new}}$  output notes. In practice, we may wish to encode a *JoinSplit transfer* with fewer input or output notes. This is achieved using *dummy notes*.

Let  $\ell_{\text{sk}}$  and  $\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$  be as defined in §4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.

Let  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

A *dummy Sprout* input note, with index  $i$  in the *JoinSplit description*, is constructed as follows:

- Generate a new uniformly random *spending key*  $a_{\text{sk},i}^{\text{old}} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{sk}}]}$  and derive its *paying key*  $a_{\text{pk},i}^{\text{old}}$ .
- Set  $v_i^{\text{old}} = 0$ .
- Choose uniformly random  $\rho_i^{\text{old}} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  and  $\text{rcm}_i^{\text{old}} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{GenTrapdoor}()$ .
- Compute  $\text{nf}_i^{\text{old}} = \text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk},i}^{\text{old}}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho_i^{\text{old}})$ .
- Let  $\text{path}_i$  be a *dummy Merkle path* for the *auxiliary input* to the *JoinSplit statement* (this will not be checked).
- When generating the *JoinSplit proof*, set  $\text{enforceMerklePath}_i$  to 0.

A *dummy Sprout* output note is constructed as normal but with zero value, and sent to a random *shielded payment address*.

### 4.8.2 Dummy Notes (Sapling)

In **Sapling** there is no need to use *dummy notes* simply in order to fill otherwise unused inputs as in the case of a *JoinSplit description*; nevertheless it may be useful for privacy to obscure the number of real *shielded inputs* from **Sapling** notes.

Let  $\ell_{\text{sk}}$  be as defined in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.

Let  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as specified in §4.1.1 ‘*Hash Functions*’ on p. 24.

Let  $\text{ToScalar}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as specified in §4.2.2 ‘*Sapling Key Components*’ on p. 36.

Let  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}$  and  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}$  be as defined in §4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.

Let  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in §4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31.



- Derive  $\text{rcm} = \text{ToScalar}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([5] \parallel \underline{\rho}))$ .
- Derive  $\psi = \text{ToBase}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([9] \parallel \underline{\rho}))$ .
- Let  $\text{cm} = \text{NoteCommit}_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(\mathbf{g}_d), \text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(\mathbf{pk}_d), v, \rho, \psi)$ .
- If  $\text{cm} = \perp$ , repeat the above steps using a different  $\text{rseed}$ .
- Let  $\text{nf} = \text{DeriveNullifier}_{\text{nk}}(\rho, \psi, \text{cm})$ .
- Construct a *dummy Merkle path*  $\text{path}$  for use in the *auxiliary input* to the *Action statement* (this will not be checked, because  $v = 0$ ).

As in **Sprout** and **Sapling**, a *dummy Orchard* output *note* is constructed as normal but with zero value, and sent to a random *shielded payment address*.

**Note:** The domain separators [4] and [5] used in the input to  $\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}$  are swapped for **Orchard** relative to **Sapling**. This was due to an oversight and there is no good reason for it.

## 4.9 Merkle Path Validity

Let  $\text{MerkleDepth}$  be  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}$  for the **Sprout** note commitment tree, or  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}$  for the **Sapling** note commitment tree, or  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}}$  for the **Orchard** note commitment tree. These constants are defined in § 5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

Similarly, let  $\text{MerkleCRH}$  be  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sprout}}$  for **Sprout**, or  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$  for **Sapling**, or  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  for **Orchard**.

The following discussion applies independently to the **Sprout** and **Sapling** and **Orchard** note commitment trees.

Each *node* in the *incremental Merkle tree* is associated with a *hash value*, which is a *bit sequence*.

The *layer* numbered  $h$ , counting from *layer* 0 at the *root*, has  $2^h$  *nodes* with *indices* 0 to  $2^h - 1$  inclusive.

Let  $M_i^h$  be the *hash value* associated with the *node* at *index*  $i$  in *layer*  $h$ .

The *nodes* at *layer*  $\text{MerkleDepth}$  are called *leaf nodes*. When a *note commitment* is added to the tree, it occupies the *leaf node hash value*  $M_i^{\text{MerkleDepth}}$  for the next available  $i$ .

As-yet unused *leaf nodes* are associated with a distinguished *hash value*  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sprout}}$  or  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}}$  or  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Orchard}}$ . It is assumed to be infeasible to find a preimage *note*  $\mathbf{n}$  such that  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{n}) = \text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sprout}}$ . (No similar assumption is needed for **Sapling** or **Orchard** because we use a representation for  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}}$  that cannot occur as an output of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , and similarly for **Orchard**.)

The *nodes* at *layers* 0 to  $\text{MerkleDepth} - 1$  inclusive are called *internal nodes*, and are associated with  $\text{MerkleCRH}$  outputs. *Internal nodes* are computed from their children in the next *layer* as follows: for  $0 \leq h < \text{MerkleDepth}$  and  $0 \leq i < 2^h$ ,

$$M_i^h := \text{MerkleCRH}(h, M_{2i}^{h+1}, M_{2i+1}^{h+1}).$$

A *Merkle path* from *leaf node*  $M_i^{\text{MerkleDepth}}$  in the *incremental Merkle tree* is the sequence

$$[M_{\text{sibling}(h,i)}^h \text{ for } h \text{ from } \text{MerkleDepth} \text{ down to } 1],$$

where

$$\text{sibling}(h, i) := \text{floor}\left(\frac{i}{2^{\text{MerkleDepth}-h}}\right) \oplus 1$$

Given such a *Merkle path*, it is possible to verify that *leaf node*  $M_i^{\text{MerkleDepth}}$  is in a tree with a given *root*  $\text{rt} = M_0^0$ .

## Notes:

- For **Sapling**, Merkle *hash values* are specified to be encoded as *bit sequences*, but the root  $rt^{\text{Sapling}}$  is encoded for the *primary input* of a *Spend proof* as an element of  $\mathbb{F}_{q_1}$ , as specified in § A.4 ‘*The Sapling Spend circuit*’ on p. 217. The *Spend circuit* allows inputs to  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$  at each *node* to be *non-canonically* encoded, as specified in § A.3.4 ‘*Merkle path check*’ on p. 213.
- For **Orchard**, Merkle *hash values* have type  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  as defined in § 5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106. Similarly to **Sapling**, the *Action circuit* allows inputs to  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  at each *node* to be *non-canonically* encoded.
- The *Action circuit* is permitted to be implemented in such a way that the *Merkle path* validity check can pass if any *hash value* on the path, including the *root*, is 0. This can only happen if  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  returned  $\perp$  for that hash, because 0 is not the *affine-short-Weierstrass*  $x$ -coordinate of any point on the Pallas curve (as shown in a note at § 5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106), and  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}$  cannot return  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ . Allowing the validity check to pass in that case models the fact that incomplete addition is used to implement  $\text{Sinsemilla}$  in the circuit. As proven in Theorem 5.4.4 on p. 84, a  $\perp$  output from  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  yields a nontrivial *discrete logarithm* relation. Since we assume finding such a relation to be infeasible, we can argue that it is safe to allow an adversary to create a proof that passes the Merkle validity check in such a case.

## 4.10 SIGHASH Transaction Hashing

**Bitcoin** and **Zcash** use signatures and/or non-interactive proofs associated with *transaction* inputs to authorize spending. Because these signatures or proofs could otherwise be replayed in a different *transaction*, it is necessary to “bind” them to the *transaction* for which they are intended. This is done by hashing information about the *transaction* and (where applicable) the specific input, to give a *SIGHASH transaction hash* which is then used for the Spend authorization. The means of authorization differs between *transparent inputs*, inputs to **Sprout** *JoinSplit* transfers, and **Sapling Spend** transfers or **Orchard Action** transfers, but for a given *transaction version* the same *SIGHASH transaction hash* algorithm is used.

In the case of **Zcash**, the BCTV14 and Groth16 and Halo 2 proving systems used are *malleable*, meaning that there is the potential for an adversary who does not know all of the *auxiliary inputs* to a proof, to malleate it in order to create a new proof involving related *auxiliary inputs* [DSDCOPS2001]. This can be understood as similar to a malleability attack on an encryption scheme, in which an adversary can malleate a ciphertext in order to create an encryption of a related plaintext, without knowing the original plaintext. **Zcash** has been designed to mitigate malleability attacks, as described in § 4.11 ‘*Non-malleability (Sprout)*’ on p. 51, § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52, and § 4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 57.

To provide additional flexibility when combining spend authorizations from different sources, **Bitcoin** defines several *SIGHASH* types that cover various parts of a transaction [Bitcoin-SigHash]. One of these types is *SIGHASH\_ALL*, which is used for **Zcash**-specific signatures, i.e. *JoinSplit* signatures, *spend authorization signatures*, *Sapling binding signatures*, and *Orchard binding signatures*. In these cases the *SIGHASH transaction hash* is not associated with a *transparent input*, and so the input to hashing excludes *all* of the *scriptSig* fields in the non-**Zcash**-specific parts of the *transaction*.

In **Zcash**, all *SIGHASH* types are extended to cover the **Zcash**-specific fields *nJoinSplit*, *vJoinSplit*, and if present *joinSplitPubKey*. These fields are described in § 7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 122. The hash *does not* cover the field *joinSplitSig*. After **Overwinter** activation, all *SIGHASH* types are also extended to cover *transaction* fields introduced in that upgrade, and similarly after **Sapling** activation and after **NU5** activation.

The original *SIGHASH* algorithm defined by **Bitcoin** suffered from some deficiencies as described in [ZIP-143]; in **Zcash** these were addressed by changing this algorithm as part of the **Overwinter** upgrade.

**Orchard** and the **NU5** network upgrade introduce *transaction* version 5, which **MUST** be used if any *Action transfers* are present. This version also provides nonmalleable *transaction* identifiers, and **MAY** be used for that reason whether or not *Action transfers* are present.



#### Consensus rules:

- [NU5 onward] Any *SIGHASH* type encoding used in a version 5 *transaction* **MUST** be the canonical encoding of one of the defined *SIGHASH* types, i.e. one of 0x01, 0x02, 0x03, 0x81, 0x82, or 0x83. (Previously, undefined bits of a *SIGHASH* type encoding were ignored.)
- [Pre-Overwinter] The *SIGHASH* algorithm used prior to **Overwinter** activation, i.e. for version 1 and 2 *transactions*, will be defined in [ZIP-76] (to be written).
- [Overwinter only, pre-Sapling] The *SIGHASH* algorithm used after **Overwinter** activation and before **Sapling** activation, i.e. for version 3 *transactions*, is defined in [ZIP-143].
- [Overwinter only, pre-Sapling] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **Overwinter** consensus branch ID 0x5BA81B19 as defined in [ZIP-201].
- [Sapling onward] The *SIGHASH* algorithm used after **Sapling** activation, i.e. for version 4 *transactions*, is defined in [ZIP-243].
- [Sapling only, pre-Blossom] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **Sapling** consensus branch ID 0x76B809BB as defined in [ZIP-205].
- [Blossom only, pre-Heartwood] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **Blossom** consensus branch ID 0x2BB40E60 as defined in [ZIP-206].
- [Heartwood only, pre-Canopy] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **Heartwood** consensus branch ID 0xF5B9230B as defined in [ZIP-250].
- [Canopy only, pre-NU5] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **Canopy** consensus branch ID 0xE9FF75A6 as defined in [ZIP-251].
- [NU5 onward] The *SIGHASH* algorithm used for version 5 *transactions* introduced by the **NU5** network upgrade is defined in [ZIP-244]. Version 4 *transactions* continue to use the *SIGHASH* algorithm defined in [ZIP-243].
- [NU5 only, pre-NU6] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **NU5** consensus branch ID 0xF919A198 as defined in [ZIP-252].
- [NU6 only, pre-NU6.1] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **NU6** consensus branch ID 0xC8E71055 as defined in [ZIP-253].
- [NU6.1 only] All *transactions* **MUST** use the **NU6.1** consensus branch ID 0x4DEC4DF0 as defined in [ZIP-255].

## 4.11 Non-malleability (Sprout)

Let  $\text{dataToBeSigned}$  be the hash of the *transaction*, not associated with an input, using the `SIGHASH_ALL` *SIGHASH* type.

In order to ensure that a *JoinSplit* description is cryptographically bound to the *transparent* inputs and outputs corresponding to  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  and  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$ , and to the other *JoinSplit* descriptions in the same *transaction*, an ephemeral *JoinSplitSig* key pair is generated for each *transaction*, and the  $\text{dataToBeSigned}$  is signed with the private *signing* key of this key pair. The corresponding public *validating* key is included in the *transaction* encoding as *joinSplitPubKey*.

*JoinSplitSig* is instantiated in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90.

If  $n_{\text{JoinSplit}}$  is zero, the *joinSplitPubKey* and *joinSplitSig* fields are omitted. Otherwise, a *transaction* has a correct *JoinSplit* signature if and only if  $\text{JoinSplitSig.Validate}_{\text{joinSplitPubKey}}(\text{dataToBeSigned}, \text{joinSplitSig}) = 1$ .

Let  $h_{\text{sig}}$  be computed as specified in § 4.3 ‘*JoinSplit* Descriptions’ on p. 40.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$  be as defined in § 4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.

For each  $i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}$ , the creator of a *JoinSplit* description calculates  $h_i = \text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}, i}}^{\text{pk}}(i, h_{\text{sig}})$ .

The correctness of  $h_{1..N^{\text{old}}}$  is enforced by the *JoinSplit* statement given in § 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit* Statement (**Sprout**)’ on p. 60. This ensures that a holder of all of the  $a_{\text{sk}, 1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}}$  for every *JoinSplit* description in the *transaction* has authorized the use of the private *signing* key corresponding to *joinSplitPubKey* to sign this *transaction*.

## 4.12 Balance (Sprout)

In **Bitcoin**, all inputs to and outputs from a *transaction* are transparent. The total value of *transparent outputs* must not exceed the total value of *transparent inputs*. The net value of *transparent inputs* minus *transparent outputs* is transferred to the miner of the *block* containing the *transaction*; it is added to the *miner subsidy* in the *coinbase transaction* of the *block*.

**Zcash Sprout** extends this by adding *JoinSplit transfers*. Each *JoinSplit transfer* can be seen, from the perspective of the *transparent transaction value pool*, as an input and an output simultaneously.

$v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  takes value from the *transparent transaction value pool* and  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  adds value to the *transparent transaction value pool*. As a result,  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  is treated like an *output* value, whereas  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  is treated like an *input* value.

Unlike original **Zerocash** [BCGGMV2014], **Zcash** does not have a distinction between Mint and Pour operations. The addition of  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  to a *JoinSplit description* subsumes the functionality of both Mint and Pour.

Also, a difference in the number of real input *notes* does not by itself cause two *JoinSplit descriptions* to be distinguishable.

As stated in §4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40, either  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  or  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  **MUST** be zero. No generality is lost because, if a *transaction* in which both  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  and  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  were nonzero were allowed, it could be replaced by an equivalent one in which  $\min(v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}, v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}})$  is subtracted from both of these values. This restriction helps to avoid unnecessary distinctions between *transactions* according to client implementation.

## 4.13 Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)

**Sapling** adds *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers* to the transparent and *JoinSplit transfers* present in **Sprout**. The net value of *Spend transfers* minus *Output transfers* in a *transaction* is called the *Sapling balancing value*, measured in *zatoshi* as a signed integer  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$ .

$v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  is encoded in a *transaction* as the field `valueBalanceSapling`. For a v4 *transaction*,  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  is always explicitly encoded. For a v5 *transaction*,  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  is implicitly zero if the *transaction* has no *Spend descriptions* or *Output descriptions*. Transaction fields are described in §7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 122.

A positive *Sapling balancing value* takes value from the **Sapling transaction value pool** and adds it to the *transparent transaction value pool*. A negative *Sapling balancing value* does the reverse. As a result, positive  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  is treated like an *input* to the *transparent transaction value pool*, whereas negative  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  is treated like an *output* from that pool.

Consistency of  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  with the *value commitments* in *Spend descriptions* and *Output descriptions* is enforced by the *Sapling binding signature*. This signature has a dual rôle in the **Sapling** protocol:

- To prove that the total value spent by *Spend transfers*, minus that produced by *Output transfers*, is consistent with the  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$  field of the *transaction*;
- To prove that the signer knew the randomness used for the *Spend* and *Output value commitments*, in order to prevent *Output descriptions* from being replayed by an adversary in a different *transaction*. (A *Spend description* already cannot be replayed due to its *spend authorization signature*.)

Instead of generating a key pair at random, we generate it as a function of the *value commitments* in the *Spend descriptions* and *Output descriptions* of the *transaction*, and the *Sapling balancing value*.

Let  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ ,  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , and  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102.













## 4.16 Computing $\rho$ values and Nullifiers

In **Sprout** and **Orchard**, each *note* has a  $\rho$  component, defined as part of the *note*.

In **Sapling**, each *positioned note* (as defined in §3.2.2 ‘*Note Commitments*’ on p.16) has an associated  $\rho$  value, which is computed from its *note commitment*  $cm$  and *note position*  $pos$  as follows:

$$\rho := \text{MixingPedersenHash}(cm, pos).$$

MixingPedersenHash is defined in §5.4.1.8 ‘*Mixing Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p.81.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$  and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}$  and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  be as instantiated in §5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p.86.

For a **Sprout** *note*, the *nullifier* (see §3.2.3 ‘*Nullifiers*’ on p.17) is derived as  $\text{PRF}_{a_{sk}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho)$ , where  $a_{sk}$  is the *spending key* associated with the *note*.

For a **Sapling** *note*, the *nullifier* is derived as  $\text{PRF}_{nk\star}^{\text{nfSapling}}(\rho\star)$ , where  $nk\star$  is a representation of the *nullifier deriving key* associated with the *note* and  $\rho\star = \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\rho)$ .

The derivation of *nullifiers* for **Orchard** *notes* is a little more complicated.

Let  $\mathbb{P}$  and  $q_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p.105.

Let  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p.106.

Let  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p.107.

Define  $\mathcal{K}^{\text{Orchard}} := \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}(\text{"z.cash:Orchard"}, \text{"K"})$ .

To avoid repetition, we define a function  $\text{DeriveNullifier} : \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \times \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}} \times \mathbb{P} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$  as follows:

$$\text{DeriveNullifier}_{nk}(\rho, \psi, cm) = \text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}\left(\left[(\text{PRF}_{nk}^{\text{nfOrchard}}(\rho) + \psi) \bmod q_{\mathbb{P}}\right] \mathcal{K}^{\text{Orchard}} + cm\right).$$

where  $nk$  is the *nullifier deriving key* associated with the *note*;  $\rho$  and  $\psi$  are part of the *note*; and  $cm$  is the *note commitment*.

**Notes:**

- The addition of  $\text{PRF}_{nk}^{\text{nfOrchard}}(\rho)$  and  $\psi$  is intentionally done modulo  $q_{\mathbb{P}}$ , even though the scalar multiplication is on the Pallas curve which has scalar field  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{P}}}$ .
- For correctness, the  $\rho$  and  $\psi$  inputs must always be consistent with the *note* committed to by  $cm$ .

**Security requirement:** For each *shielded protocol*, the requirements on *nullifier* derivation are as follows:

- The derived *nullifier* must be determined completely by the fields of the *note*, and possibly its position, in a way that can be checked in the corresponding statement that controls spends (i.e. the *JoinSplit statement*, *Spend statement*, or *Action statement*).
- Under the assumption that  $\rho$  values are unique, it must not be possible to generate two *notes* with distinct *note commitments* but the same *nullifier*. (See §8.4 ‘*Faerie Gold attack and fix*’ on p.143 for further discussion.)
- Given a set of *nullifiers* of *a priori* unknown *notes*, they must not be linkable to those *notes* with probability greater than expected by chance, even to an adversary with the corresponding *incoming viewing keys* (but not *full viewing keys*), and even if the adversary may have created the *notes*.



## 4.17 Chain Value Pool Balances

The *transparent chain value pool balance* for a given *block chain* is the sum of the values of all *UTXOs* in the *UTXO* (*unspent transaction output*) set for that chain. It is denoted by  $\text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Transparent}}(\text{height})$ .

As defined in [ZIP-209], the **Sprout** *chain value pool balance* for a given *block chain* is the sum of all  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  field values for *transactions* in the *block chain*, minus the sum of all  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$  field values for *transactions* in the *block chain*. It is denoted by  $\text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Sprout}}(\text{height})$ .

**Consensus rule:** If the **Sprout** *chain value pool balance* would become negative in the *block chain* created as a result of accepting a *block*, then all nodes **MUST** reject the block as invalid.

As defined in [ZIP-209], the **Sapling** *chain value pool balance* for a given *block chain* is the negation of the sum of all  $\text{valueBalanceSapling}$  values for *transactions* in the *block chain*. It is denoted by  $\text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Sapling}}(\text{height})$ .

**Consensus rule:** If the **Sapling** *chain value pool balance* would become negative in the *block chain* created as a result of accepting a *block*, then all nodes **MUST** reject the block as invalid.

Similarly to the **Sapling** *chain value pool balance* defined in [ZIP-209], the **Orchard** *chain value pool balance* for a given *block chain* is the negation of the sum of all  $\text{valueBalanceOrchard}$  field values for *transactions* in the *block chain*. It is denoted by  $\text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{height})$ .

**Consensus rule:** If the **Orchard** *chain value pool balance* would become negative in the *block chain* created as a result of accepting a *block*, then all nodes **MUST** reject the block as invalid.

Define  $\text{totalDeferredOutput}$  and  $\text{totalDeferredInput}$  as in § 7.8 on p. 136.

Then, consistent with [ZIP-207], the *deferred development fund chain value pool balance* for a *block chain* up to and including height  $h$  is given by:

$$\text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Deferred}}(\text{height}) := \sum_{h=0}^{\text{height}} \text{totalDeferredOutput}(h) - \text{totalDeferredInput}(h)$$

**Consensus rule:** If the *deferred development fund chain value pool balance* would become negative in the *block chain* created as a result of accepting a *block*, then all nodes **MUST** reject the block as invalid.

### Non-normative notes:

- $\text{totalDeferredOutput}(h)$  is necessarily zero for heights  $h$  prior to **NU6** activation.
- $\text{totalDeferredInput}(h)$  is necessarily zero for heights  $h$  prior to **NU6.1** activation.

The *total issued supply* of a *block chain* at *block height*  $h$  is given by the function:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{IssuedSupply}(\text{height}) := & \text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Transparent}}(\text{height}) \\ & + \text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Sprout}}(\text{height}) \\ & + \text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Sapling}}(\text{height}) \\ & + \text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{height}) \\ & + \text{ChainValuePoolBalance}^{\text{Deferred}}(\text{height}) \end{aligned}$$



## 4.18 Zk-SNARK Statements

### 4.18.1 JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)

Let  $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}, \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{value}}, \ell_{\text{a}_{\text{sk}}}, \ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}, \ell_{\text{hSig}}, N^{\text{old}}, N^{\text{new}}$  be as defined in §5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}, \text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}, \text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$ , and  $\text{PRF}^{\varphi}$  be as defined in §4.1.2 ‘Pseudo Random Functions’ on p. 25.

Let  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in §4.1.8 ‘Commitment’ on p. 31, and let  $\text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}}$  and  $\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in §3.2 ‘Notes’ on p. 14.

A valid instance of a *JoinSplit statement*,  $\pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}$ , assures that given a *primary input*:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}}, \\ &\text{nf}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}}[N^{\text{old}}], \\ &\text{cm}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Output}^{[N^{\text{new}}]}, \\ &\mathbf{v}_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}, \\ &\mathbf{v}_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}, \\ &\text{hSig} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{hSig}}}, \\ &\mathbf{h}_{1..N^{\text{old}}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}}[N^{\text{old}}]), \end{aligned}$$

the prover knows an *auxiliary input*:

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{path}_{1..N^{\text{old}}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}[\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}][N^{\text{old}}]}, \\ &\text{pos}_{1..N^{\text{old}}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}}-1\}^{[N^{\text{old}}]}, \\ &\mathbf{n}_{1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}} : \text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}}[N^{\text{old}}], \\ &\mathbf{a}_{\text{sk},1..N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{a}_{\text{sk}}}}[N^{\text{old}}], \\ &\mathbf{n}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{new}} : \text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}}[N^{\text{new}}], \\ &\varphi : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}}}, \\ &\text{enforceMerklePath}_{1..N^{\text{old}}} : \mathbb{B}^{[N^{\text{old}}]}), \end{aligned}$$

where:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}: \mathbf{n}_i^{\text{old}} = (\mathbf{a}_{\text{pk},i}^{\text{old}}, \mathbf{v}_i^{\text{old}}, \rho_i^{\text{old}}, \text{rcm}_i^{\text{old}}); \\ &\text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{new}}\}: \mathbf{n}_i^{\text{new}} = (\mathbf{a}_{\text{pk},i}^{\text{new}}, \mathbf{v}_i^{\text{new}}, \rho_i^{\text{new}}, \text{rcm}_i^{\text{new}}) \end{aligned}$$

such that the following conditions hold:

**Merkle path validity** for each  $i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}$  |  $\text{enforceMerklePath}_i = 1$ :  $(\text{path}_i, \text{pos}_i)$  is a valid *Merkle path* (see §4.9 ‘Merkle Path Validity’ on p. 49) of depth  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}}$  from  $\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{n}_i^{\text{old}})$  to the anchor  $\text{rt}^{\text{Sprout}}$ .

**Note:** Merkle path validity covers conditions 1.(a) and 1.(d) of the NP *statement* in [BCGGMTV2014, section 4.2].

**Merkle path enforcement** for each  $i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}$ , if  $\mathbf{v}_i^{\text{old}} \neq 0$  then  $\text{enforceMerklePath}_i = 1$ .

$$\text{Balance} \quad \mathbf{v}_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}} + \sum_{i=1}^{N^{\text{old}}} \mathbf{v}_i^{\text{old}} = \mathbf{v}_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}} + \sum_{i=1}^{N^{\text{new}}} \mathbf{v}_i^{\text{new}} \in \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}.$$

$$\text{Nullifier integrity} \quad \text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}: \text{nf}_i^{\text{old}} = \text{PRF}_{\text{a}_{\text{sk},i}^{\text{old}}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho_i^{\text{old}}).$$

$$\text{Spend authority} \quad \text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}: \mathbf{a}_{\text{pk},i}^{\text{old}} = \text{PRF}_{\text{a}_{\text{sk},i}^{\text{old}}}^{\text{addr}}(0).$$

$$\text{Non-malleability} \quad \text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{old}}\}: \mathbf{h}_i = \text{PRF}_{\text{a}_{\text{sk},i}^{\text{old}}}^{\text{pk}}(i, \text{hSig}).$$

$$\text{Uniqueness of } \rho_i^{\text{new}} \quad \text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{new}}\}: \rho_i^{\text{new}} = \text{PRF}_{\varphi}^{\varphi}(i, \text{hSig}).$$

$$\text{Note commitment integrity} \quad \text{for each } i \in \{1..N^{\text{new}}\}: \text{cm}_i^{\text{new}} = \text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{n}_i^{\text{new}}).$$

For details of the form and encoding of proofs, see §5.4.10.1 ‘BCTV14’ on p. 110.









$\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{RandomizePublic}$ . In particular, the representation of  $(\text{PRF}_{\text{nk}}^{\text{nfOrchard}}(\rho) + \psi) \bmod q_{\mathbb{P}}$  that is used for the scalar multiplication in  $\text{DeriveNullifier}$  **MUST** be checked to be canonical in order to avoid a potential *double-spend* vulnerability, and similarly for the representation of  $\text{ivk}$  in  $[\text{ivk}] g_d^{\text{old}}$ .

#### Non-normative notes:

- The procedure in §4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38 will always produce a *spend authorization address key* that effectively has the compressed  $y$ -coordinate,  $\tilde{y}$ , set to 0. The *Action statement*, on the other hand, allows the prover to witness  $\text{ak}^{\mathbb{P}}$  with  $\tilde{y}$  set to 0 or 1. This is harmless because if the prover and signer(s) of the *spend authorization signature* collectively know  $\text{rsk}$  and  $\alpha$ , we can conclude that they collectively know  $\text{ask}$  up to sign, which is sufficient for spend authorization.
- There is intentionally no equivalent to the **Ephemeral public key integrity** check from the **Sapling Output statement**. It is unnecessary for the sender of an **Orchard note** to prove knowledge of  $\text{esk}$ , because the potential attack this originally addressed for **Sapling** is prevented by checks added at **Canopy** activation in [ZIP-212]. These checks are required after the end of the ZIP 212 grace period, which precedes **NU5** activation.
- If  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  returns  $\perp$  for the old or new *note*, then the corresponding **note commitment integrity** check is satisfied. Similarly, if  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  returns  $\perp$ , then the **diversified address integrity** check is satisfied. This models the fact that the implemented circuit uses incomplete point addition to compute  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}$ . If an exceptional case were to occur, the prover could arbitrarily choose the intermediate  $\lambda$  value in an addition, which must be assumed to allow them to control the output. (The formal output of  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}$  is  $\perp$  in such a case, while the output computed by the circuit would be nondeterministic.) But as proven in Theorem 5.4.4 on p. 84, these exceptional cases allow immediately finding a nontrivial *discrete logarithm* relation. If the *Discrete Logarithm Problem* is hard on the Pallas curve, then finding such a case is infeasible.

## 4.19 In-band secret distribution (Sprout)

In **Sprout**, the secrets that need to be transmitted to a recipient of funds in order for them to later spend, are  $v$ ,  $\rho$ , and  $\text{rcm}$ . A *memo field* (§3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15) is also transmitted.

To transmit these secrets securely to a recipient *without* requiring an *out-of-band* communication channel, the *transmission key*  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}}$  is used to encrypt them. The recipient’s possession of the associated *incoming viewing key*  $\text{ivk}$  is used to reconstruct the original *note* and *memo field*.

A single *ephemeral public key* is shared between encryptions of the  $N^{\text{new}}$  *shielded outputs* in a *JoinSplit description*. All of the resulting ciphertexts are combined to form a *transmitted notes ciphertext*.

For both encryption and decryption,

- let  $\text{Sym}$  be the scheme instantiated in §5.4.3 ‘*Symmetric Encryption*’ on p. 88;
- let  $\text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be the *Key Derivation Function* instantiated in §5.4.5.2 ‘**Sprout Key Derivation**’ on p. 89;
- let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be the *key agreement scheme* instantiated in §5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout Key Agreement**’ on p. 88;
- let  $h_{\text{sig}}$  be the value computed for this *JoinSplit description* in §4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40.

### 4.19.1 Encryption (Sprout)

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  be the *key agreement scheme* instantiated in §5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout Key Agreement**’ on p. 88.

Let  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}, 1..N^{\text{new}}}$  be the *transmission keys* for the intended recipient addresses of each new *note*.

Let  $\text{np}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}$  be **Sprout note plaintexts** defined in §3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15.



Then to encrypt:

- Generate a new  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  (public, private) key pair (epk, esk).
- For  $i \in \{1..N^{\text{new}}\}$ ,
  - Let  $P_i^{\text{enc}} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[585]}$  be the *raw encoding* of  $\mathbf{np}_i$ .
  - Let  $\text{sharedSecret}_i = \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Agree}(\text{esk}, \text{pk}_{\text{enc},i})$ .
  - Let  $K_i^{\text{enc}} = \text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}}(i, h_{\text{sig}}, \text{sharedSecret}_i, \text{epk}, \text{pk}_{\text{enc},i})$ .
  - Let  $C_i^{\text{enc}} = \text{Sym.Encrypt}_{K_i^{\text{enc}}}(P_i^{\text{enc}})$ .

The resulting *transmitted notes ciphertext* is  $(\text{epk}, C_{1..N^{\text{new}}}^{\text{enc}})$ .

**Note:** It is technically possible to replace  $C_i^{\text{enc}}$  for a given *note* with a random (and undecryptable) dummy ciphertext, relying instead on *out-of-band* transmission of the *note* to the recipient. In this case the ephemeral key **MUST** still be generated as a random *public key* (rather than a random *bit sequence*) to ensure indistinguishability from other *JoinSplit descriptions*. This mode of operation raises further security considerations, for example of how to validate a *Sprout note* received *out-of-band*, which are not addressed in this document.

#### 4.19.2 Decryption (Sprout)

Let  $\text{ivk} = (\text{a}_{\text{pk}}, \text{sk}_{\text{enc}})$  be the recipient's *incoming viewing key*, and let  $\text{pk}_{\text{enc}}$  be the corresponding *transmission key* derived from  $\text{sk}_{\text{enc}}$  as specified in § 4.2.1 '*Sprout Key Components*' on p. 36.

Let  $\text{cm}_{1..N^{\text{new}}}$  be the *note commitments* of each output coin.

Then for each  $i \in \{1..N^{\text{new}}\}$ , the recipient will attempt to decrypt that ciphertext component  $(\text{epk}, C_i^{\text{enc}})$  as follows:

```

let  $\text{sharedSecret}_i = \text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Agree}(\text{sk}_{\text{enc}}, \text{epk})$ 
let  $K_i^{\text{enc}} = \text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}}(i, h_{\text{sig}}, \text{sharedSecret}_i, \text{epk}, \text{pk}_{\text{enc}})$ 
let  $P_i^{\text{enc}} = \text{Sym.Decrypt}_{K_i^{\text{enc}}}(C_i^{\text{enc}})$ 
if  $P_i^{\text{enc}} = \perp$ , return  $\perp$ 
return  $\text{ExtractNote}^{\text{Sprout}}(P_i^{\text{enc}}, \text{cm}_i, \text{a}_{\text{pk}})$ 

```

$\text{ExtractNote}^{\text{Sprout}}(P_i^{\text{enc}} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[585]}, \text{cm}_i : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[32]}, \text{a}_{\text{pk}} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]})$  is defined as follows:

```

extract  $\mathbf{np}_i = (\text{leadByte}_i : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}}, v_i : \{0..2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}, \rho_i : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}, \text{rcm}_i : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor}, \text{memo}_i : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[512]})$ 
from  $P_i^{\text{enc}}$ 
let  $\mathbf{n}_i = (\text{a}_{\text{pk}}, v_i, \rho_i, \text{rcm}_i)$ 
if  $\text{leadByte}_i \neq 0x00$  or  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}(\mathbf{n}_i) \neq \text{cm}_i$ , return  $\perp$ 
return  $(\mathbf{n}_i, \text{memo}_i)$ 

```

#### Notes:

- The decryption algorithm corresponds to step 3 (b) i. and ii. (first bullet point) of the Receive algorithm shown in [BCGGMTV2014, Figure 2].
- To test whether a *note* is unspent in a particular *block chain* also requires the *spending key*  $\text{a}_{\text{sk}}$ ; the coin is unspent if and only if  $\text{nf} = \text{PRF}_{\text{a}_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho)$  is not in the *nullifier set* for that *block chain*.
- A *note* can change from being unspent to spent as a node's view of the *best valid block chain* is extended by new *transactions*. Also, *block chain reorganizations* can cause a node to switch to a different *best valid block chain* that does not contain the *transaction* in which a *note* was output.

See § 8.7 '*In-band secret distribution*' on p. 147 for further discussion of the security and engineering rationale behind this encryption scheme.









#### Notes:

- $g_d$  has already been computed when applying NoteCommitment, and need not be computed again.
- A previous version of this specification did not have the requirement for the decoded point  $pk_d$  of a **Sapling** note to be in the set of *prime-order* points  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$  (i.e. "if ...  $pk_d \notin \mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , return  $\perp$ "). That did not match the implementation in zcashd. In fact the history is a little more complicated. The current specification matches the implementation in librustzcash as of [librustzcash-109], which has been used in zcashd since zcashd v2.1.2. However, there was another implementation of **Sapling** note decryption used in zcashd for consensus checks, specifically the check that a *shielded* coinbase output decrypts successfully with the zero ovk. This was corrected to enforce the same restriction on the decrypted  $pk_d$  in zcashd v5.5.0, originally set to activate in a soft fork at *block height* 2121200 on both *Mainnet* and *Testnet* [zcashd-6459]. (On *Testnet* this height was in the past as of the zcashd v5.5.0 release, and so the change would have been immediately enforced on upgrade.) Since the soft fork was observed to be retrospectively valid after that height, the implementation was simplified in [zcashd-6725] to use the librustzcash implementation in all cases, which reflects the specification above. zebra always used the librustzcash implementation.
- As explained in the note in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102,  $abst_j$  accepts *non-canonical* compressed encodings of Jubjub curve points. Therefore, an implementation **MUST** use the original ephemeralKey field as encoded in the *transaction* as input to  $PRF^{ock}$  and  $KDF^{Sapling}$ , and in the comparison against  $repr_G(KA^{Sapling}.DerivePublic(esk, g_d))$ . For consistency this is also what is specified for **Orchard**.
- For **Sapling** outgoing ciphertexts,  $pk_{*d}$  could also be *non-canonical*. The above algorithm explicitly returns  $\perp$  if  $repr_P(pk_d) \neq pk_{*d}$ . However, this is technically redundant with the later check that returns  $\perp$  if  $pk_d \notin \mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , because only *small-order* Jubjub curve points have *non-canonical* encodings. This check is enforced retrospectively for consensus by current zcashd and zebra versions, and for wallet rescanning by current zcashd. Versions of zcashd prior to [zcashd-6725] could however have accepted notes for which the *outgoing ciphertext* contains either a canonical or a *non-canonical* encoding of  $\mathcal{O}_J$  for  $pk_d$ .
- [NU5 onward] For **Orchard** outgoing ciphertexts, it is not possible for  $pk_{*d}$  to be *non-canonical*.
- [NU5 onward] The domain separators [4] and [5] used in the input to  $PRF_{rseed}^{expand}$  are swapped for **Orchard** relative to **Sapling**. This was due to an oversight and there is no good reason for it.
- The comments in § 4.20.2 ‘Decryption using an Incoming Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’ on p. 68 concerning calculation of  $\rho$ , detection of spent notes, and decryption of *transmitted note ciphertexts* for *transactions* in the *mempool* also apply to notes decrypted by this procedure.

**Non-normative note:** Implementors should pay close attention to similarities and differences between this procedure and § 4.20.2 ‘Decryption using an Incoming Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’ on p. 68, especially that:

- in this procedure, the ephemeral *private key*  $esk'$  derived from  $rseed$  is checked to be identical to that obtained from **op** (when  $leadByte \neq 0x01$ );
- in this procedure,  $pk_d$  is obtained from **op** rather than being derived as  $KA^{Sapling}.DerivePublic(ivk, g_d)$ ;
- in this procedure, the check that  $KA^{Sapling}.DerivePublic(esk, g_d) = epk$  is unconditional rather than being dependent on  $leadByte \neq 0x01$ , and it uses the  $esk$  obtained from **op**;
- [NU5 onward] for the same reason as in § 4.20.2 on p. 68,  $epk$  cannot be  $\mathcal{O}_P$ .

## 4.21 Block Chain Scanning (Sprout)

Let  $\ell_{PRF}^{Sprout}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

Let  $Note^{Sprout}$  be as defined in § 3.2 ‘Notes’ on p. 14.

Let  $KA^{Sprout}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout** Key Agreement’ on p. 88.

Let  $ivk = (a_{pk} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{PRF}^{Sprout}]}, sk_{enc} : KA^{Sprout}.Private)$  be the *incoming viewing key* corresponding to  $a_{sk}$ , and let  $pk_{enc}$  be the associated *transmission key*, as specified in § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout** Key Components’ on p. 36.

The following algorithm can be used, given the *block chain* and a **Sprout** *spending key*  $a_{sk}$ , to obtain each *note* sent to the corresponding *shielded payment address*, its *memo field*, and its final status (spent or unspent).

```

let mutable ReceivedSet :  $\mathcal{P}(\text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}} \times \mathbb{BY}^{[512]}) \leftarrow \{\}$ 
let mutable SpentSet :  $\mathcal{P}(\text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}}) \leftarrow \{\}$ 
let mutable NullifierMap :  $\mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \text{Note}^{\text{Sprout}} \leftarrow$  the empty mapping
for each transaction tx:
  for each JoinSplit description in tx:
    let  $(\text{epk}, C_{1..N}^{\text{enc}})$  be the transmitted notes ciphertext of the JoinSplit description
    for  $i$  in  $1..N^{\text{new}}$ :
      Attempt to decrypt the transmitted notes ciphertext component  $(\text{epk}, C_i^{\text{enc}})$  using  $\text{ivk}$  with the
      algorithm in § 4.19.2 ‘Decryption (Sprout)’ on p. 66. If this succeeds with  $(\mathbf{n}, \text{memo})$ :
        Add  $(\mathbf{n}, \text{memo})$  to ReceivedSet.
        Calculate the nullifier  $\text{nf}$  of  $\mathbf{n}$  using  $a_{sk}$  as in § 4.16 ‘Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers’ on p. 58.
        Add the mapping  $\text{nf} \rightarrow \mathbf{n}$  to NullifierMap.
    let  $\text{nf}_{1..N}^{\text{old}}$  be the nullifiers of the JoinSplit description
    for  $i$  in  $1..N^{\text{old}}$ : if  $\text{nf}_i$  is present in NullifierMap, add NullifierMap( $\text{nf}_i$ ) to SpentSet
return (ReceivedSet, SpentSet).

```

## 4.22 Block Chain Scanning (Sapling and Orchard)

In **Sapling** and **Orchard**, *block chain* scanning requires only the  $\text{nk}$  and  $\text{ivk}$  key components, rather than a *spending key* as in **Sprout**. Typically, these components are derived from a *full viewing key* (§ 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36 or § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38).

Let  $\ell_{\text{PRF}\text{nfSapling}}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘**Constants**’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{Note}$  be  $\text{Note}^{\text{Sapling}}$  or  $\text{Note}^{\text{Orchard}}$  as defined in § 3.2 ‘**Notes**’ on p. 14.

Let  $\text{KA}$  be either  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$  as defined in § 5.4.5.3 on p. 89, or  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  as defined in § 5.4.5.5 on p. 90.

Let  $\text{NullifierType}$  be  $\mathbb{BY}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}\text{nfSapling}}/8]}$  for **Sapling**, or  $\mathbb{F}_{q_F}$  for **Orchard**.

The following algorithm can be used, given the *block chain* and  $(\text{nk}, \text{ivk})$ , to obtain each *note* sent to the corresponding *shielded payment address*, its *memo field*, and its final status (spent or unspent).

```

let mutable ReceivedSet :  $\mathcal{P}(\text{Note} \times \mathbb{BY}^{[512]}) \leftarrow \{\}$ 
let mutable SpentSet :  $\mathcal{P}(\text{Note}) \leftarrow \{\}$ 
let mutable NullifierMap :  $(\text{NullifierType} \rightarrow \text{Note}) \leftarrow$  the empty mapping
for each transaction tx:
  for each Output description or Action description in tx:
    Attempt to decrypt the transmitted note ciphertext components  $\text{epk}$  and  $C^{\text{enc}}$  using  $\text{ivk}$  with the algorithm
    § 4.20.2 ‘Decryption using an Incoming Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)’ on p. 68.
    If this succeeds with  $(\mathbf{n}, \text{memo})$ :
      Add  $(\mathbf{n}, \text{memo})$  to ReceivedSet.
      Calculate the nullifier  $\text{nf}$  of  $\mathbf{n}$  using  $\text{nk}$  as in § 4.16 ‘Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers’ on p. 58.
      (This also requires  $\text{pos}$  from the Output description for Sapling notes.)
      Add the mapping  $\text{nf} \rightarrow \mathbf{n}$  to NullifierMap.
  for each nullifier  $\text{nf}$  of a Spend description or Action description in tx:
    if  $\text{nf}$  is present in NullifierMap, add NullifierMap( $\text{nf}$ ) to SpentSet
return (ReceivedSet, SpentSet).

```



### Non-normative notes:

- The above algorithm does not use the *ovk* key component, or the  $C^{\text{out}}$  *transmitted note ciphertext* component. When scanning the whole *block chain*, these are indeed not necessary. The advantage of supporting decryption using *ovk* as described in §4.20.3 ‘*Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 70, is that it allows recovering information about the *note plaintexts* sent in a *transaction* from that *transaction* alone.
- When scanning only part of a *block chain*, it may be useful to augment the above algorithm with decryption of  $C^{\text{out}}$  components for each *transaction*, in order to obtain information about *notes* that were spent in the scanned period but received outside it.
- The above algorithm does not detect *notes* that were sent “out-of-band” or with incorrect *transmitted note ciphertexts*. It is possible to detect whether such *notes* were spent only if their *nullifiers* are known.

## 5 Concrete Protocol

### 5.1 Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness

All integers in **Zcash**-specific encodings are unsigned, have a fixed bit length, and are encoded in little-endian byte order *unless otherwise specified*.

The following functions convert between sequences of bits, sequences of bytes, and integers:

- $\text{I2LEBSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$ , such that  $\text{I2LEBSP}_\ell(x)$  is the sequence of  $\ell$  bits representing  $x$  in little-endian order;
- $\text{I2LEOSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil}$ , such that  $\text{I2LEOSP}_\ell(x)$  is the sequence of  $\lceil \ell/8 \rceil$  bytes representing  $x$  in little-endian order;
- $\text{I2BEBSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$  such that  $\text{I2BEBSP}_\ell(x)$  is the sequence of  $\ell$  bits representing  $x$  in big-endian order.
- $\text{LEBS2IP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]} \rightarrow \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\}$  such that  $\text{LEBS2IP}_\ell(S)$  is the integer represented in little-endian order by the *bit sequence*  $S$  of length  $\ell$ .
- $\text{LEOS2IP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N} \mid \ell \bmod 8 = 0) \times \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil} \rightarrow \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\}$  such that  $\text{LEOS2IP}_\ell(S)$  is the integer represented in little-endian order by the *byte sequence*  $S$  of length  $\ell/8$ .
- $\text{BEOS2IP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N} \mid \ell \bmod 8 = 0) \times \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil} \rightarrow \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\}$  such that  $\text{BEOS2IP}_\ell(S)$  is the integer represented in big-endian order by the *byte sequence*  $S$  of length  $\ell/8$ .
- $\text{LEBS2OSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil}$  defined as follows: pad the input on the right with  $8 \cdot \lceil \ell/8 \rceil - \ell$  zero bits so that its length is a multiple of 8 bits. Then convert each group of 8 bits to a byte value with the *least* significant bit first, and concatenate the resulting bytes in the same order as the groups.
- $\text{LEOS2BSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N} \mid \ell \bmod 8 = 0) \times \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell/8 \rceil} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$  defined as follows: convert each byte to a group of 8 bits with the *least* significant bit first, and concatenate the resulting groups in the same order as the bytes.

### 5.2 Bit layout diagrams

We sometimes use bit layout diagrams, in which each box of the diagram represents a sequence of bits. Diagrams are read from left to right, with lines read from top to bottom; the breaking of boxes across lines has no significance. The bit length  $\ell$  is given explicitly in each box, except when it is obvious (e.g. for a single bit, or for the notation  $[0]^\ell$  representing the sequence of  $\ell$  zero bits, or for the output of  $\text{LEBS2OSP}_\ell$ ).

The entire diagram represents the sequence of *bytes* formed by first concatenating these *bit sequences*, and then treating each subsequence of 8 bits as a byte with the bits ordered from *most significant* to *least significant*. Thus the *most significant* bit in each byte is toward the left of a diagram. (This convention is used only in descriptions of the **Sprout** design; in the **Sapling** and **Orchard** additions, *bit sequence/byte sequence conversions are always specified explicitly*.) Where bit fields are used, the text will clarify their position in each case.

## 5.3 Constants

Define:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 29 \\
 \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 32 \\
 \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 32 \\
 \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 255 \\
 \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 255 \\
 N^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 2 \\
 N^{\text{new}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 2 \\
 \ell_{\text{value}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 64 \\
 \ell_{\text{hSig}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{PRFexpand}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 512 \\
 \ell_{\text{PRFfnSapling}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{Seed}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{a}_{\text{sk}}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 252 \\
 \ell_{\varphi}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 252 \\
 \ell_{\text{sk}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{d}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 88 \\
 \ell_{\text{dk}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 251 \\
 \ell_{\text{ovk}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 256 \\
 \ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 252 \\
 \ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Orchard}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 255 \\
 \ell_{\text{base}}^{\text{Orchard}} : \mathbb{N} &:= 255 \\
 \text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sprout}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} &:= [0]^{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}} \\
 \text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} &:= \text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}(1) \\
 \text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Orchard}} : \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} &:= 2 \\
 \text{MAX\_MONEY} : \mathbb{N} &:= 2.1 \cdot 10^{15} \text{ (zatoshi)} \\
 \text{BlossomActivationHeight} : \mathbb{N} &:= \begin{cases} 653600, & \text{for Mainnet} \\ 584000, & \text{for Testnet} \end{cases} \\
 \text{CanopyActivationHeight} : \mathbb{N} &:= \begin{cases} 1046400, & \text{for Mainnet} \\ 1028500, & \text{for Testnet} \end{cases} \\
 \text{ZIP212GracePeriod} : \mathbb{N} &:= 32256 \\
 \text{NUFiveActivationHeight} : \mathbb{N} &:= \begin{cases} 1687104, & \text{for Mainnet} \\ 1842420, & \text{for Testnet} \end{cases}
 \end{aligned}$$

$\text{SlowStartInterval} : \mathbb{N} := 20000$   
 $\text{PreBlossomHalvingInterval} : \mathbb{N} := 840000$   
 $\text{MaxBlockSubsidy} : \mathbb{N} := 1.25 \cdot 10^9$  (*zatoshi*)  
 $\text{NumFounderAddresses} : \mathbb{N} := 48$   
 $\text{FoundersFraction} : \mathbb{Q} := \frac{1}{5}$   
 $\text{PoWLimit} : \mathbb{N} := \begin{cases} 2^{243} - 1, & \text{for Mainnet} \\ 2^{251} - 1, & \text{for Testnet} \end{cases}$   
 $\text{PoWAveragingWindow} : \mathbb{N} := 17$   
 $\text{PoWMedianBlockSpan} : \mathbb{N} := 11$   
 $\text{PoWMaxAdjustDown} : \mathbb{Q} := \frac{32}{100}$   
 $\text{PoWMaxAdjustUp} : \mathbb{Q} := \frac{16}{100}$   
 $\text{PoWDampingFactor} : \mathbb{N} := 4$   
 $\text{PreBlossomPoWTargetSpacing} : \mathbb{N} := 150$  (seconds).  
 $\text{PostBlossomPoWTargetSpacing} : \mathbb{N} := 75$  (seconds).

## 5.4 Concrete Cryptographic Schemes

### 5.4.1 Hash Functions

#### 5.4.1.1 SHA-256, SHA-256d, SHA256Compress, and SHA-512 Hash Functions

SHA-256 and SHA-512 are defined by [NIST2015].

**Zcash** uses the full SHA-256 *hash function* to instantiate  $\text{NoteCommitment}^{\text{Sprout}}$ .

$$\text{SHA-256} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[32]}$$

[NIST2015] strictly speaking only specifies the application of SHA-256 to messages that are *bit sequences*, producing outputs (“message digests”) that are also *bit sequences*. In practice, SHA-256 is universally implemented with a byte-sequence interface for messages and outputs, such that the *most significant* bit of each byte corresponds to the first bit of the associated *bit sequence*. (In the NIST specification “first” is conflated with “leftmost”)

SHA-256d, defined as a double application of SHA-256, is used to hash *block headers*:

$$\text{SHA-256d} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[32]}$$

**Zcash** also uses the SHA-256 compression function,  $\text{SHA256Compress}$ . This operates on a single 512-bit block and *excludes* the padding step specified in [NIST2015, section 5.1].

That is, the input to  $\text{SHA256Compress}$  is what [NIST2015, section 5.2] refers to as “the message and its padding”. The Initial Hash Value is the same as for full SHA-256.

$\text{SHA256Compress}$  is used to instantiate several *Pseudo Random Functions* and  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sprout}}$ .

$$\text{SHA256Compress} : \mathbb{B}^{[512]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[256]}$$

The ordering of bits within words in the interface to  $\text{SHA256Compress}$  is consistent with [NIST2015, section 3.1], i.e. big-endian.

Ed25519 uses SHA-512:

$$\text{SHA-512} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[64]}$$

The comment above concerning bit vs byte-sequence interfaces also applies to SHA-512.

### 5.4.1.2 BLAKE2 Hash Functions

BLAKE2 is defined by [ANWW2013]. **Zcash** uses both the BLAKE2b and BLAKE2s variants.

BLAKE2b- $\ell(p, x)$  refers to unkeyed BLAKE2b- $\ell$  in sequential mode, with an output digest length of  $\ell/8$  bytes, 16-byte personalization string  $p$ , and input  $x$ .

BLAKE2b is used to instantiate hSigCRH, EquihashGen, and KDF<sup>Sprout</sup>. From **Overwinter** onward, it is used to compute *SIGHASH transaction hashes* as specified in [ZIP-143], or as in [ZIP-243] after **Sapling** activation, or as in [ZIP-244] for version 5 transactions. For **Sapling**, it is also used to instantiate PRF<sup>expand</sup>, PRF<sup>ockSapling</sup>, KDF<sup>Sapling</sup>, and in the *RedJubjub signature scheme* which instantiates SpendAuthSig<sup>Sapling</sup> and BindingSig<sup>Sapling</sup>.

$$\text{BLAKE2b-}\ell : \mathbb{B}^{[16]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[N]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell/8]}$$

**Note:** BLAKE2b- $\ell$  is not the same as BLAKE2b-512 truncated to  $\ell$  bits, because the digest length is encoded in the parameter block.

BLAKE2s- $\ell(p, x)$  refers to unkeyed BLAKE2s- $\ell$  in sequential mode, with an output digest length of  $\ell/8$  bytes, 8-byte personalization string  $p$ , and input  $x$ .

BLAKE2s is used to instantiate PRF<sup>nfSapling</sup>, CRH<sup>ivk</sup>, and GroupHash <sup>$\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$</sup> .

$$\text{BLAKE2s-}\ell : \mathbb{B}^{[8]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[N]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell/8]}$$

### 5.4.1.3 Merkle Tree Hash Function

MerkleCRH<sup>Sprout</sup> and MerkleCRH<sup>Sapling</sup> and MerkleCRH<sup>Orchard</sup> are used to hash *incremental Merkle tree hash values* for **Sprout** and **Sapling** and **Orchard** respectively.

MerkleCRH<sup>Sprout</sup> Hash Function

MerkleCRH<sup>Sprout</sup> :  $\{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sprout}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  is defined as follows:

$$\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sprout}}(\text{layer}, \text{left}\star, \text{right}\star) := \text{SHA256Compress} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit left}\star & 256\text{-bit right}\star \\ \hline \end{array} \right).$$

SHA256Compress is defined in § 5.4.1.1 ‘SHA-256, SHA-256d, SHA256Compress, and SHA-512 Hash Functions’ on p. 75.

**Security requirement:** SHA256Compress must be *collision-resistant*, and it must be infeasible to find a preimage  $x$  such that  $\text{SHA256Compress}(x) = [0]^{256}$ .

**Notes:**

- The layer argument does not affect the output.
- SHA256Compress is not the same as the SHA-256 function, which hashes arbitrary-length *byte sequences*.

MerkleCRH<sup>Sapling</sup> Hash Function

Let PedersenHash be as specified in § 5.4.1.7 ‘Pedersen Hash Function’ on p. 79.

MerkleCRH<sup>Sapling</sup> :  $\{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}]}$  is defined as follows:

$$\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}(\text{layer}, \text{left}\star, \text{right}\star) := \text{PedersenHash}(\text{"Zcash\_PH"}, l\star || \text{left}\star || \text{right}\star)$$

$$\text{where } l\star = \text{I2LEBSP}_6(\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} - 1 - \text{layer}).$$

**Security requirement:** PedersenHash must be *collision-resistant*.

**Note:** The prefix  $l\star$  provides domain separation between inputs at different layers of the *note commitment tree*.  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , like  $\text{PedersenHash}$ , is defined in terms of  $\text{PedersenHashToPoint}$ , but using a prefix that cannot collide with a layer prefix, as noted in § 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96.

### MerkleCRH<sup>Orchard</sup> Hash Function

Let  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  be as specified in § 5.4.1.9 ‘*Sinsemilla Hash Function*’ on p. 81.

$\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}} : \{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}} - 1\} \times \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} \times \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} \rightarrow \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  is defined as follows:

$$\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{layer}, \text{left}, \text{right}) := \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if hash} = \perp \\ \text{hash}, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

where  $\text{hash} = \text{SinsemillaHash}(\text{"z.cash:Orchard-MerkleCRH"}, l\star \parallel \text{left}\star \parallel \text{right}\star)$

$$l\star = \text{I2LEBSP}_{10}(\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Orchard}} - 1 - \text{layer})$$

$$\text{left}\star = \text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}}(\text{left})$$

$$\text{right}\star = \text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}}(\text{right}).$$

#### Security requirements:

- $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  must be *collision-resistant*.
- It must be infeasible to find a input of length  $10 + 2 \cdot \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  bits to  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  that yields output  $\perp$ .

**Note:** The prefix  $l\star$  provides domain separation between inputs at different layers of the *note commitment tree*.

### 5.4.1.4 $h_{\text{Sig}}$ Hash Function

$h_{\text{Sig}}\text{CRH}$  is used to compute the value  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  in § 4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40.

$$h_{\text{Sig}}\text{CRH}(\text{randomSeed}, \text{nf}_{1 \dots N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}}, \text{joinSplitPubKey}) := \text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{"ZcashComputehSig"}, h_{\text{Sig}}\text{Input})$$

where

$$h_{\text{Sig}}\text{Input} := \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit randomSeed} & 256\text{-bit nf}_1^{\text{old}} & \dots & 256\text{-bit nf}_{N^{\text{old}}}^{\text{old}} & 256\text{-bit joinSplitPubKey} \\ \hline \end{array}.$$

$\text{BLAKE2b-256}(p, x)$  is defined in § 5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

**Security requirement:**  $\text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{"ZcashComputehSig"}, x)$  must be *collision-resistant* on  $x$ .

### 5.4.1.5 $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$ Hash Function

$\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$  is used to derive the *incoming viewing key*  $\text{ivk}$  for a **Sapling** shielded payment address. For its use when generating an address see § 4.2.2 ‘*Sapling Key Components*’ on p. 36, and for its use in the *Spend statement* see § 4.18.2 ‘*Spend Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 61.

It is defined as follows:

$$\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}(\text{ak}\star, \text{nk}\star) := \text{LEOS2IP}_{256}(\text{BLAKE2s-256}(\text{"Zcashivk"}, \text{crhInput})) \bmod 2^{\ell_{\text{ivk}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$$

where

$$\text{crhInput} := \begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{ak}\star) & \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{nk}\star) \\ \hline \end{array}$$

$\text{BLAKE2s-256}(p, x)$  is defined in § 5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

















#### Non-normative notes:

- The choice of MDS matrix and the number of rounds take into account cryptanalytic results in [KR2020] and [BCD+2020]. A detailed analysis of related matrix properties is given in [GRS2020].
- [BCD+2020] says that “... finite fields  $\mathbb{F}_q$  with a limited number of multiplicative subgroups might be preferable, i.e. one might want to avoid  $q-1$  being smooth. This implies that the fields which are suitable for implementing FFT may be more vulnerable to integral attacks.”  $\mathbb{F}_{q_p}$  is such a field; the factorization of  $q_p - 1$  is  $2^{32} \cdot 3 \cdot 463 \cdot 539204044132271846773 \cdot 8999194758858563409123804352480028797519453$ .

Furthermore, previous cryptanalysis of Poseidon has focussed mainly on the case of S-box  $x \mapsto x^3$ . That variant cannot be used in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_p}$  because  $x \mapsto x^3$  would not be a permutation.  $\alpha = 5$  is the smallest integer for which  $x \mapsto x^\alpha$  is a permutation in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_p}$ .

On the other hand, the number of rounds chosen includes a significant security margin, even taking into account these considerations. For small  $t$ , such as  $t = 3$  as used here, the results of [KR2020] are positive for security since they indicate that the number of active S-boxes through the middle rounds is larger than originally estimated by the Poseidon designers (and the number of rounds is based on this original conservative estimate).

Also note that the use of Poseidon in **Orchard** is very conservative. First, the sponge mode limits an adversary to only being able to influence part of the Poseidon permutation input, and we use it only to construct a PRF (PRF<sup>nfOrchard</sup> as described in § 5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 86). Half of the sponge input is a random key  $nk$ , known only to holders of a *full viewing key*, and the remaining half  $\rho$  comes from a previous *nullifier* which is effectively a random *affine-short-Weierstrass*  $x$ -coordinate on the Pallas curve. Then the PRF is used to enhance the security of a discrete-logarithm-based nullifier construction (described in [Zcash-Orchard, Section 3.5 Nullifiers]) against a potential discrete-log-breaking adversary. Given the weak assumption that the PoseidonHash sponge produces output that preserves sufficient entropy from the inputs  $nk$  and  $\rho$ , this nullifier construction would still be secure under a *Decisional Diffie-Hellman assumption* on the Pallas curve, even if the Poseidon-based PRF were distinguishable from an ideal PRF.

- The constant  $2^{65}$  comes from [GKRRS2019, section 4.2]: “Constant-Input-Length Hashing. The capacity value is  $length \cdot (2^{64}) + (o - 1)$  where  $o$  is the output length.” In this case the input length (*length*) is 2 field elements, and the output length is 1 field element.

#### 5.4.1.11 Equihash Generator

EquihashGen <sub>$n,k$</sub>  is a specialized *hash function* that maps an input and an index to an output of length  $n$  bits. It is used in § 7.7.1 ‘*Equihash*’ on p. 133.

Let  $\text{powtag} := \begin{array}{|c|c|c|} \hline 64\text{-bit “ZcashPoW”} & 32\text{-bit } n & 32\text{-bit } k \\ \hline \end{array}$ .

Let  $\text{powcount}(g) := \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 32\text{-bit } g \\ \hline \end{array}$ .

Let EquihashGen <sub>$n,k$</sub> ( $S, i$ ) :=  $T_{h+1 \dots h+n}$ , where

$$m = \text{floor}\left(\frac{512}{n}\right);$$

$$h = (i - 1 \bmod m) \cdot n;$$

$$T = \text{BLAKE2b-}(n \cdot m)(\text{powtag}, S \parallel \text{powcount}(\text{floor}\left(\frac{i-1}{m}\right))).$$

Indices of bits in  $T$  are 1-based.

BLAKE2b- $\ell(p, x)$  is defined in § 5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

**Security requirement:**  $\text{BLAKE2b-}\ell(\text{powtag}, x)$  must generate output that is sufficiently unpredictable to avoid short-cuts to the *Equihash* solution process. It would suffice to model it as a *random oracle*.

**Note:** When *EquihashGen* is evaluated for sequential indices, as in the *Equihash* solving process (§7.7.1 ‘*Equihash*’ on p. 133), the number of calls to *BLAKE2b* can be reduced by a factor of  $\text{floor}(\frac{512}{n})$  in the best case (which is a factor of 2 for  $n = 200$ ).

## 5.4.2 Pseudo Random Functions

Let *SHA256Compress* be as given in §5.4.1.1 ‘*SHA-256, SHA-256d, SHA256Compress, and SHA-512 Hash Functions*’ on p. 75.

The *Pseudo Random Functions*  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$ , and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{p}}$  from §4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25, are all instantiated using *SHA256Compress*:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PRF}_x^{\text{addr}}(t) &:= \text{SHA256Compress} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 252\text{-bit } x \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 8\text{-bit } t \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline [0]^{248} \\ \hline \end{array} \right) \\ \text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho) &:= \text{SHA256Compress} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 252\text{-bit } a_{\text{sk}} \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit } \rho \\ \hline \end{array} \right) \\ \text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{pk}}(i, h_{\text{sig}}) &:= \text{SHA256Compress} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 0 & i-1 & 0 & 0 \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 252\text{-bit } a_{\text{sk}} \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit } h_{\text{sig}} \\ \hline \end{array} \right) \\ \text{PRF}_{\varphi}^{\text{p}}(i, h_{\text{sig}}) &:= \text{SHA256Compress} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 0 & i-1 & 1 & 0 \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 252\text{-bit } \varphi \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit } h_{\text{sig}} \\ \hline \end{array} \right) \end{aligned}$$

**Security requirements:**

- *SHA256Compress* must be *collision-resistant*.
- *SHA256Compress* must be a *PRF* when keyed by the bits corresponding to  $x$ ,  $a_{\text{sk}}$  or  $\varphi$  in the above diagrams, with input in the remaining bits.

**Note:** The first four bits –i.e. the most significant four bits of the first byte– are used to separate distinct uses of *SHA256Compress*, ensuring that the functions are independent. As well as the inputs shown here, bits 1011 in this position are used to distinguish uses of the full *SHA-256* hash function; see §5.4.8.1 ‘*Sprout Note Commitments*’ on p. 95.

(The specific bit patterns chosen here were motivated by the possibility of future extensions that might have increased  $N^{\text{old}}$  and/or  $N^{\text{new}}$  to 3, or added an additional bit to  $a_{\text{sk}}$  to encode a new key type, or that would have required an additional *PRF*. In fact since **Sapling switches to non-SHA256Compress-based cryptographic primitives, these extensions are unlikely to be necessary.**)

$\text{PRF}_{\text{sk}}^{\text{expand}}$  is used in §4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p. 36 to derive the *Spend authorizing key*  $a_{\text{sk}}$  and the *proof authorizing key*  $n_{\text{sk}}$ .

It is instantiated using the *BLAKE2b hash function* defined in §5.4.1.2 ‘**BLAKE2 Hash Functions**’ on p. 76:

$$\text{PRF}_{\text{sk}}^{\text{expand}}(t) := \text{BLAKE2b-512}(\text{"Zcash\_ExpandSeed"}, \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{sk}) \parallel t)$$

**Security requirement:**  $\text{BLAKE2b-512}(\text{"Zcash\_ExpandSeed"}, \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{sk}) \parallel t)$  must be a *PRF* for output range  $\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}}/8]}$  when keyed by the bits corresponding to  $\text{sk}$ , with input in the bits corresponding to  $t$ .

$\text{PRF}_{\text{ovk}}^{\text{ockSapling}}$  is used in §4.20.1 ‘**Encryption (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 67 to derive the *outgoing cipher key*  $\text{ock}$  used to encrypt an *outgoing ciphertext*.

It is instantiated using the *BLAKE2b hash function* defined in §5.4.1.2 ‘**BLAKE2 Hash Functions**’ on p. 76:

$$\text{PRF}_{\text{ovk}}^{\text{ockSapling}}(\text{cv}, \text{cmu}, \text{ephemeralKey}) := \text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{"Zcash\_Derive\_ock"}, \text{ockInput})$$

$$\text{where } \text{ockInput} = \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{ovk}) & 32\text{-byte } \text{cv} & 32\text{-byte } \text{cmu} & 32\text{-byte } \text{ephemeralKey} \\ \hline \end{array}.$$





### 5.4.3 Symmetric Encryption

Let  $\text{Sym.K} := \mathbb{B}^{[256]}$ ,  $\text{Sym.P} := \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[N]}}$ , and  $\text{Sym.C} := \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[N]}}$ .

Let the *authenticated one-time symmetric encryption scheme*  $\text{Sym.Encrypt}_K(P)$  be authenticated encryption using AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305 [RFC-7539] encryption of plaintext  $P \in \text{Sym.P}$ , with empty “associated data”, all-zero nonce  $[0]^{96}$ , and 256-bit key  $K \in \text{Sym.K}$ .

Similarly, let  $\text{Sym.Decrypt}_K(C)$  be AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305 decryption of ciphertext  $C \in \text{Sym.C}$ , with empty “associated data”, all-zero nonce  $[0]^{96}$ , and 256-bit key  $K \in \text{Sym.K}$ . The result is either the plaintext *byte sequence*, or  $\perp$  indicating failure to decrypt.

**Note:** The “IETF” definition of AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305 from [RFC-7539] is used; this has a 32-bit block count and a 96-bit nonce, rather than a 64-bit block count and 64-bit nonce as in the original definition of ChaCha20.

### 5.4.4 Pseudo Random Permutations

Let  $\ell_{dk}$  and  $\ell_d$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘Constants’ on p. 74.

$\text{PRP}^d : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[\ell_{dk}/8]}} \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}$  is a *Pseudo Random Permutation* specified in § 4.1.3 ‘Pseudo Random Permutations’ on p. 26. In this specification, it is used to generate *diversifiers* for **Orchard** *shielded payment addresses* in § 4.2.3 ‘Orchard Key Components’ on p. 38. ([ZIP-32] uses an identical construction to generate *diversifiers* for **Sapling** *shielded payment addresses*.)

Let  $\text{FF1-AES256}_K(\text{tweak}, x)$  be the FF1 format-preserving encryption algorithm [NIST2016] using AES with a 256-bit key  $K$ , and parameters  $\text{radix} = 2$ ,  $\text{minlen} = 88$ ,  $\text{maxlen} = 88$ . It will be used only with the empty string “” as the *tweak*.  $x$  is a sequence of 88 bits, as is the output.

Define  $\text{PRP}_K^d(d) := \text{FF1-AES256}_K(\text{“”}, d)$ .

**Security requirement:** FF1-AES256 with tweak fixed to “” must be a secure *Pseudo Random Permutation*.

**Non-normative note:** [DKLS2020] describes attacks against FF1 that are practical for some parameterizations. However, for an 88-bit domain, and 10 rounds as specified in [NIST2016], even the distinguishing attack is no better than a brute force search for the 256-bit key. Specifically we have  $r = 5$  (half the number of rounds) and  $n = 44$  (half the domain size in bits), so according to [DKLS2020, section 4.2] the data complexity is  $2^{2n((r-1)-\frac{1}{2})-n} = 2^{264}$ , and the time complexity is  $2^{2n((r-1)-\frac{1}{2})} = 2^{308}$ .

### 5.4.5 Key Agreement And Derivation

#### 5.4.5.1 Sprout Key Agreement

$\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is a *key agreement scheme* as specified in § 4.1.5 ‘Key Agreement’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated as Curve25519 key agreement, described in [Bernstein2006], as follows.

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public}$  and  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{SharedSecret}$  be the type of Curve25519 *public keys* (i.e.  $\mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[32]}}$ ), and let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Private}$  be the type of Curve25519 *secret keys*.

Let  $\text{Curve25519}(\underline{n}, \underline{q})$  be the result of point multiplication of the Curve25519 *public key* represented by the byte sequence  $\underline{q}$  by the Curve25519 *secret key* represented by the *byte sequence*  $\underline{n}$ , as defined in [Bernstein2006, section 2].

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Base} := \underline{9}$  be the public *byte sequence* representing the Curve25519 base point.

Let  $\text{clamp}_{\text{Curve25519}}(x)$  take a 32-byte sequence  $x$  as input and return a *byte sequence* representing a Curve25519 *private key*, with bits “clamped” as described in [Bernstein2006, section 3]: “clear bits 0, 1, 2 of the first byte, clear bit 7 of the last byte, and set bit 6 of the last byte.” Here the bits of a byte are numbered such that bit  $b$  has numeric weight  $2^b$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{FormatPrivate}(x) := \text{clamp}_{\text{Curve25519}}(x)$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{DerivePublic}(n, q) := \text{Curve25519}(n, q)$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Agree}(n, q) := \text{Curve25519}(n, q)$ .

### 5.4.5.2 Sprout Key Derivation

$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is a *Key Derivation Function* as specified in §4.1.6 ‘*Key Derivation*’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated using BLAKE2b-256 as follows:

$$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sprout}}(i, h_{\text{Sig}}, \text{sharedSecret}_i, \text{epk}, \text{pk}_{\text{enc}, i}^{\text{new}}) := \text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{kdf\_tag}, \text{kdf\_input})$$

where:

$$\text{kdf\_tag} := \begin{array}{|c|c|c|} \hline 64\text{-bit “ZcashKDF”} & 8\text{-bit } i-1 & [0]^{56} \\ \hline \end{array}$$

$$\text{kdf\_input} := \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|} \hline 256\text{-bit } h_{\text{Sig}} & 256\text{-bit } \text{sharedSecret}_i & 256\text{-bit } \text{epk} & 256\text{-bit } \text{pk}_{\text{enc}, i}^{\text{new}} \\ \hline \end{array}.$$

$\text{BLAKE2b-256}(p, x)$  is defined in §5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

### 5.4.5.3 Sapling Key Agreement

$\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is a *key agreement scheme* as specified in §4.1.5 ‘*Key Agreement*’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated as Diffie–Hellman with cofactor multiplication on Jubjub as follows:

Let  $\mathbb{J}$ ,  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ ,  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , and the cofactor  $h_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in §5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102.

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Public} := \mathbb{J}$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder} := \mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{SharedSecret} := \mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Private} := \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{J}}}$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{DerivePublic}(\text{sk}, B) := [\text{sk}] B$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Agree}(\text{sk}, P) := [h_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot \text{sk}] P$ .

### 5.4.5.4 Sapling Key Derivation

$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is a *Key Derivation Function* as specified in §4.1.6 ‘*Key Derivation*’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated using BLAKE2b-256 as follows:

$$\text{KDF}^{\text{Sapling}}(\text{sharedSecret}, \text{ephemeralKey}) := \text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{“Zcash\_SaplingKDF”}, \text{kdf\_input}).$$

where:

$$\text{kdf\_input} := \begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{sharedSecret})) & \text{ephemeralKey} \\ \hline \end{array}.$$

$\text{BLAKE2b-256}(p, x)$  is defined in §5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

### 5.4.5.5 Orchard Key Agreement

$\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is a *key agreement scheme* as specified in § 4.1.5 ‘*Key Agreement*’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated as Diffie–Hellman on Pallas as follows:

Let  $\mathbb{P}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105.

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Public} := \mathbb{P}^*$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder} := \mathbb{P}^*$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{SharedSecret} := \mathbb{P}^*$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Private} := \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{P}}}^*$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{DerivePublic}(\text{sk}, B) := [\text{sk}] B$ .

Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Agree}(\text{sk}, P) := [\text{sk}] P$ .

### 5.4.5.6 Orchard Key Derivation

$\text{KDF}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is a *Key Derivation Function* as specified in § 4.1.6 ‘*Key Derivation*’ on p. 27.

It is instantiated using BLAKE2b-256 as follows:

$\text{KDF}^{\text{Orchard}}(\text{sharedSecret}, \text{ephemeralKey}) := \text{BLAKE2b-256}(\text{“Zcash\_OrchardKDF”}, \text{kdfinput})$ .

where:

$\text{kdfinput} := \left[ \text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(\text{sharedSecret})) \quad \text{ephemeralKey} \right]$ .

$\text{BLAKE2b-256}(p, x)$  is defined in § 5.4.1.2 ‘*BLAKE2 Hash Functions*’ on p. 76.

## 5.4.6 Ed25519

Ed25519 is a *signature scheme* as specified in § 4.1.7 ‘*Signature*’ on p. 28. It is used to instantiate JoinSplitSig as described in § 4.11 ‘*Non-malleability (Sprout)*’ on p. 51.

Let  $\text{PreCanopyExcludedPointEncodings} : \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{BY}^{[32]}) = \{$

[0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00],  
 [0x01, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00, 0x00],  
 [0x26, 0xe8, 0x95, 0x8f, 0xc2, 0xb2, 0x27, 0xb0, 0x45, 0xc3, 0xf4, 0x89, 0xf2, 0xef, 0x98, 0xf0, 0xd5, 0xdf, 0xac, 0x05, 0xd3, 0xc6, 0x33, 0x39, 0xb1, 0x38, 0x02, 0x88, 0x6d, 0x53, 0xfc, 0x05],  
 [0xc7, 0x17, 0x6a, 0x70, 0x3d, 0x4d, 0xd8, 0x4f, 0xba, 0x3c, 0x0b, 0x76, 0x0d, 0x10, 0x67, 0x0f, 0x2a, 0x20, 0x53, 0xfa, 0x2c, 0x39, 0xcc, 0xc6, 0x4e, 0xc7, 0xfd, 0x77, 0x92, 0xac, 0x03, 0x7a],  
 [0x13, 0xe8, 0x95, 0x8f, 0xc2, 0xb2, 0x27, 0xb0, 0x45, 0xc3, 0xf4, 0x89, 0xf2, 0xef, 0x98, 0xf0, 0xd5, 0xdf, 0xac, 0x05, 0xd3, 0xc6, 0x33, 0x39, 0xb1, 0x38, 0x02, 0x88, 0x6d, 0x53, 0xfc, 0x85],  
 [0xb4, 0x17, 0x6a, 0x70, 0x3d, 0x4d, 0xd8, 0x4f, 0xba, 0x3c, 0x0b, 0x76, 0x0d, 0x10, 0x67, 0x0f, 0x2a, 0x20, 0x53, 0xfa, 0x2c, 0x39, 0xcc, 0xc6, 0x4e, 0xc7, 0xfd, 0x77, 0x92, 0xac, 0x03, 0xfa],  
 [0xec, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff],  
 [0xed, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff],  
 [0xee, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff],  
 [0xd9, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff],  
 [0xda, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff, 0xff]

$\}$ .

Let  $p = 2^{255} - 19$ .

Let  $a = -1$ .

Let  $d = -121665/121666 \pmod{p}$ .

Let  $\ell = 2^{252} + 27742317777372353535851937790883648493$  (the order of the Ed25519 curve’s *prime-order subgroup*).



#### Notes:

- It is *not* required that the integer encoding of the  $y$ -coordinate<sup>10</sup> of the points represented by  $\underline{R}$  or  $\underline{A}$  are less than  $2^{255} - 19$ .
- It is *not* required that  $\underline{A} \notin \text{PreCanopyExcludedPointEncodings}$ .
- [Canopy onward] Appendix § B.3 ‘Ed25519 *batch validation*’ on p. 223 describes an optimization that **MAY** be used to speed up validation of batches of Ed25519 signatures.

**Non-normative note:** The exclusion, before **Canopy** activation, of `PreCanopyExcludedPointEncodings` from  $\underline{R}$  is due to a quirk of version 1.0.15 of the `libsodium` library [`libsodium`] which was initially used to implement Ed25519 signature validation in `zcashd`. (The `ED25519_COMPAT` compile-time option was not set.) The intent was to exclude points of order less than  $\ell$ ; however, not all such points were covered.

[Canopy onward] **Non-normative note:** Because the post-**Canopy** rules for Ed25519 signatures are a relaxation of the pre-**Canopy** rules, a *full validator* implementation that checkpoints on the **Canopy activation block** **MAY** validate using the post-**Canopy** rules for the whole chain (and `zcashd` does so since `zcashd` v4.2.0). We retain the pre-**Canopy** rules in the specification in order to accurately document the history of consensus changes.

### 5.4.7 RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas

RedDSA is a Schnorr-based *signature scheme*, optionally supporting key *re-randomization* as described in § 4.1.7.1 ‘*Signature with Re-Randomizable Keys*’ on p. 29. It also supports a Secret Key to Public Key Monomorphism as described in § 4.1.7.2 ‘*Signature with Signing Key to Validating Key Monomorphism*’ on p. 30. It is based on a scheme from [FKMSSS2016, section 3], with some ideas from EdDSA [BJLSY2015].

RedJubjub is a specialization of RedDSA to the Jubjub curve (§ 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102), using the BLAKE2b-512 hash function.

The *spend authorization signature scheme* `SpendAuthSigSapling` is instantiated by RedJubjub, using parameters defined in § 5.4.7.1 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.

The *binding signature scheme* `BindingSigSapling` is instantiated by RedJubjub without key *re-randomization*, using parameters defined in § 5.4.7.2 ‘*Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.

RedPallas is a specialization of RedDSA to the Pallas curve defined in § 5.4.9.6 ‘Pallas *and* Vesta’ on p. 105, using the BLAKE2b-512 hash function.

The *spend authorization signature scheme* `SpendAuthSigOrchard` is instantiated by RedPallas, using parameters defined in § 5.4.7.1 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.

The *binding signature scheme* `BindingSigOrchard` is instantiated by RedPallas without key *re-randomization*, using parameters defined in § 5.4.7.2 ‘*Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.

Let `I2LEBSP`, `I2LEOSP`, `LEOS2IP`, and `LEBS2OSP` be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

We first describe the scheme RedDSA over a general *represented group*. Its parameters are:

- a *represented group*  $\mathbb{G}$ , which also defines a subgroup  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$  of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a cofactor  $h_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a group operation  $+$ , an additive identity  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a bit-length  $\ell_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a representation function  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , and an abstraction function  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , as specified in § 4.1.9 ‘*Represented Group*’ on p. 32;
- $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a generator of  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$ ;
- a bit-length  $\ell_{\mathbb{H}} : \mathbb{N}$  such that  $2^{\ell_{\mathbb{H}} - 128} \geq r_{\mathbb{G}}$  and  $\ell_{\mathbb{H}} \bmod 8 = 0$ ;
- a cryptographic *hash function*  $\mathbb{H} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\mathbb{H}}/8}$ .







### 5.4.7.1 Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)

Let RedJubjub be as defined in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92.

Define  $\mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}} := \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(*)}}(\text{"Zcash\_G\_"}, \text{""})$ .

The *spend authorization signature scheme*  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is instantiated as RedJubjub with key *re-randomization* and with generator  $\mathcal{P}_G = \mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}}$ .

Let RedPallas be as defined in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92.

Define  $\mathcal{G}^{\text{Orchard}} := \text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}(\text{"z.cash:Orchard"}, \text{"G"})$ .

The *spend authorization signature scheme*  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is instantiated as RedPallas with key *re-randomization* and with generator  $\mathcal{P}_G = \mathcal{G}^{\text{Orchard}}$ .

See § 4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 57 for details on the use of this signature scheme.

**Security requirement:** Each instantiation of  $\text{SpendAuthSig}$  must be a SURK-CMA-secure signature scheme with *re-randomizable keys* as defined in § 4.1.7.1 ‘*Signature with Re-Randomizable Keys*’ on p. 29.

### 5.4.7.2 Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)

Let RedJubjub and RedPallas be as defined in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92.

The **Sapling** binding signature scheme,  $\text{BindingSig}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , is instantiated as RedJubjub without key *re-randomization*, using generator  $\mathcal{P}_G = \mathcal{R}^{\text{Sapling}}$  defined in § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97. See § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52 for details on the use of this signature scheme.

The **Orchard** binding signature scheme,  $\text{BindingSig}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , is instantiated as RedPallas without key *re-randomization*, using generator  $\mathcal{P}_G = \mathcal{R}^{\text{Orchard}}$  defined in § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97. See § 4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54 for details on the use of this signature scheme.

**Security requirement:** Each instantiation of  $\text{BindingSig}$  must be a SUF-CMA-secure signature scheme with key *monomorphism* as defined in § 4.1.7.2 ‘*Signature with Signing Key to Validating Key Monomorphism*’ on p. 30. A signature must prove knowledge of the *discrete logarithm* of the validating key with respect to the base  $\mathcal{R}^{\text{Sapling}}$  or  $\mathcal{R}^{\text{Orchard}}$ .

## 5.4.8 Commitment schemes

### 5.4.8.1 Sprout Note Commitments

The *note commitment scheme*  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  specified in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31 is instantiated using SHA-256 as follows:

$$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}_{\text{rcm}}(a_{\text{pk}}, v, \rho) := \text{SHA-256} \left( \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|c|c|c|} \hline 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \text{256-bit } a_{\text{pk}} \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \text{64-bit } v \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \text{256-bit } \rho \\ \hline \end{array} \parallel \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \text{256-bit rcm} \\ \hline \end{array} \right)$$

$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{GenTrapdoor}()$  generates the uniform distribution on  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Trapdoor}$ .

**Note:** The leading byte of the SHA-256 input is 0xB0.

#### Security requirements:

- SHA256Compress must be *collision-resistant*.
- SHA256Compress must be a *PRF* when keyed by the bits corresponding to the position of  $\text{rcm}$  in the second block of SHA-256 input, with input to the *PRF* in the remaining bits of the block and the chaining variable.

#### 5.4.8.2 Windowed Pedersen commitments

§ 5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79 defines a *Pedersen hash* construction. We construct “*windowed Pedersen commitments*” by reusing that construction, and adding a randomized point on the Jubjub curve (see § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102):

$$\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}_r(s) := \text{PedersenHashToPoint}(\text{"Zcash\_PH"}, s) + [r] \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}(r)*}(\text{"Zcash\_PH"}, \text{"r"})$$

See § A.3.5 ‘*Windowed Pedersen Commitment*’ on p. 213 for rationale and efficient circuit implementation of this function.

The *note commitment scheme*  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  specified in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31 is instantiated as follows using  $\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}$ :

$$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}_{\text{rcm}}(g_{\star_d}, \text{pk}_{\star_d}, v) := \text{WindowedPedersenCommit}_{\text{rcm}}([1]^6 \parallel \text{I2LEBSP}_{64}(v) \parallel g_{\star_d} \parallel \text{pk}_{\star_d})$$

$\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{GenTrapdoor}()$  generates the uniform distribution on  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{J}}}$ .

#### Security requirements:

- $\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}$ , and hence  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , must be computationally *binding* and at least computationally *hiding commitment schemes*.

(They are in fact unconditionally *hiding commitment schemes*.)

#### Notes:

- $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is also defined in terms of  $\text{PedersenHashToPoint}$  (see § 5.4.1.3 ‘*MerkleCRH<sup>Sapling</sup> Hash Function*’ on p. 76). The prefix  $[1]^6$  distinguishes the use of  $\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}$  in  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  from the layer prefix used in  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$ . That layer prefix is a 6-bit *little-endian* encoding of an integer in the range  $\{0 \dots \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} - 1\}$ ; because  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} < 64$ , it cannot collide with  $[1]^6$ .
- The arguments to  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  are in a different order to their encodings in  $\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}$ . There is no particularly good reason for this.

**Theorem 5.4.5.**  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is not in the range of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ .

*Proof.*  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is defined as  $\text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}(1)$ . By injectivity of  $\text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$  and definitions of  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{J}(r)}$ ,  $\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}$ , and  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,  $\text{I2LEBSP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}(1)$  can be in the range of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  only if there exist  $\text{rcm} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Trapdoor}$ ,  $D : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{V}[8]}$ , and  $M : \mathbb{B}^{[\mathbb{N}^+]}$  such that  $\mathcal{U}(\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}_{\text{rcm}}(D, M)) = 1$ . The latter can only be the *affine-ctEdwards*  $u$ -coordinate of a point in  $\mathbb{J}$ . We show that there are no points in  $\mathbb{J}$  with *affine-ctEdwards*  $u$ -coordinate 1. Suppose for a contradiction that  $(u, v) \in \mathbb{J}$  for  $u = 1$  and some  $v : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{J}}}$ . By writing the curve equation as  $v^2 = (1 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u^2) / (1 - d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u^2)$ , and noting that  $1 - d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u^2 \neq 0$  because  $d_{\mathbb{J}}$  is nonsquare, we have  $v^2 = (1 - a_{\mathbb{J}}) / (1 - d_{\mathbb{J}})$ . The right-hand-side is a nonsquare in  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{J}}}$  (for the Jubjub curve parameters), so there are no solutions for  $v$  (contradiction).  $\square$





### Security requirements:

- SinsemillaCommit and SinsemillaShortCommit, and hence NoteCommit<sup>Orchard</sup> and Commit<sup>ivk</sup>, must be computationally *binding* and at least computationally *hiding commitment schemes*. They are in fact unconditionally *hiding commitment schemes* provided that no  $\perp$  output is observed.

**Theorem 5.4.6.** Uncommitted<sup>Orchard</sup> is not in the range of NoteCommit<sup>Orchard</sup>.

*Proof.* Uncommitted<sup>Orchard</sup> is defined as 2. By the definitions of Extract $_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}$ , SinsemillaShortCommit, and NoteCommit<sup>Orchard</sup>, 2 can be in the range of NoteCommit<sup>Orchard</sup> only if there exist  $\text{rcm} : \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Trapdoor}$ ,  $D : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[\mathbb{N}]}$ , and  $M : \mathbb{B}^{[\mathbb{N}^+]}$  such that  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}(\text{SinsemillaCommit}_{\text{rcm}}(D, M)) = 2$ .  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}(\text{SinsemillaCommit}_{\text{rcm}}(D, M))$  can only be  $\perp$  or 0 or the affine-short-Weierstrass  $x$ -coordinate of a point in  $\mathbb{P}$ . But  $0 \neq 2 \pmod{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ , and there are no points in  $\mathbb{P}$  with affine-short-Weierstrass  $x$ -coordinate  $2 \pmod{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ , since  $2^3 + b_{\mathbb{P}} = 13$  is not square in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ .  $\square$

### Non-normative notes:

- Although the given theorem is correct for the definition of NoteCommit<sup>Orchard</sup> in this specification, the implementation in the *Action circuit* constrains the result to an unspecified set of values when an input results in an exceptional case for any incomplete addition. If this occurs then it yields a nontrivial *discrete logarithm* relation for the Pallas curve, as proven in Theorem 5.4.4 on p. 84. We can therefore assume that it is infeasible to find such inputs with nonnegligible probability.
- There are also no points in  $\mathbb{P}$  with affine-short-Weierstrass  $x$ -coordinate  $0 \pmod{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ , as shown in a note at §5.4.9.7 ‘Coordinate Extractor for Pallas’ on p.106. We do not choose Uncommitted<sup>Orchard</sup> = 0 because MerkleCRH<sup>Orchard</sup> returns 0 in exceptional cases. Although the *hash values* of *leaf nodes* are separated from the *hash values* at other *layers* by the layer input to MerkleCRH<sup>Orchard</sup>, it would arguably be confusing to rely on that.

## 5.4.9 Represented Groups and Pairings

### 5.4.9.1 BN-254

The *represented pairing* BN-254 is defined in this section.

Let  $q_{\mathbb{G}} := 2188824287183927522246405745257275088696311157297823662689037894645226208583$ .

Let  $r_{\mathbb{G}} := 2188824287183927522246405745257275088548364400416034343698204186575808495617$ .

Let  $b_{\mathbb{G}} := 3$ .

( $q_{\mathbb{G}}$  and  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  are prime.)

Let  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)}$  be the group (of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ ) of rational points on a Barreto–Naehrig ([BN2005]) curve  $E_{\mathbb{G}_1}$  over  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}$  with equation  $y^2 = x^3 + b_{\mathbb{G}}$ . This curve has embedding degree 12 with respect to  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ .

Let  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)}$  be the subgroup of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  in the sextic twist  $E_{\mathbb{G}_2}$  of  $E_{\mathbb{G}_1}$  over  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}^2}$  with equation  $y^2 = x^3 + \frac{b_{\mathbb{G}}}{\xi}$ , where  $\xi : \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}^2}$ .

We represent elements of  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}^2}$  as polynomials  $a_1 \cdot t + a_0 : \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}[t]$ , modulo the irreducible polynomial  $t^2 + 1$ ; in this representation,  $\xi$  is given by  $t + 9$ .

Let  $\mathbb{G}_T^{(r)}$  be the subgroup of  $r_{\mathbb{G}}^{\text{th}}$  roots of unity in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}^2}^*$ , with multiplicative identity  $1_{\mathbb{G}}$ .

Let  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{G}}$  be the optimal ate pairing (see [Vercauter2009] and [AKLGL2010, section 2]) of type  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)} \times \mathbb{G}_2^{(r)} \rightarrow \mathbb{G}_T^{(r)}$ .

For  $i : \{1 \dots 2\}$ , let  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}_i}$  be the point at infinity (which is the additive identity) in  $\mathbb{G}_i^{(r)}$ , and let  $\mathbb{G}_i^{(r)*} := \mathbb{G}_i^{(r)} \setminus \{\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}_i}\}$ .

Let  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}_1} : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*} := (1, 2)$ .

Let  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}_2} : \mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*} := (11559732032986387107991004021392285783925812861821192530917403151452391805634 \cdot t + 10857046999023057135944570762232829481370756359578518086990519993285655852781, 4082367875863433681332203403145435568316851327593401208105741076214120093531 \cdot t + 8495653923123431417604973247489272438418190587263600148770280649306958101930)$ .

$\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}_1}$  and  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}_2}$  are generators of  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)}$  and  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)}$  respectively.

Define  $\text{l2BEBSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$  as in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

For a point  $P : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*} = (x_P, y_P)$ :

- The field elements  $x_P$  and  $y_P : \mathbb{F}_q$  are represented as integers  $x$  and  $y : \{0 \dots q-1\}$ .
- Let  $\tilde{y} = y \bmod 2$ .
- $P$  is encoded as 

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

 1-bit  $\tilde{y}$  256-bit  $\text{l2BEBSP}_{256}(x)$ .

For a point  $P : \mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*} = (x_P, y_P)$ :

- Define  $\text{FE2IP} : \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}[t]/(t^2 + 1) \rightarrow \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{G}}^2 - 1\}$  such that  $\text{FE2IP}(a_{w,1} \cdot t + a_{w,0}) = a_{w,1} \cdot q + a_{w,0}$ .
- Let  $x = \text{FE2IP}(x_P)$ ,  $y = \text{FE2IP}(y_P)$ , and  $y' = \text{FE2IP}(-y_P)$ .
- Let  $\tilde{y} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } y > y' \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$
- $P$  is encoded as 

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

 1-bit  $\tilde{y}$  512-bit  $\text{l2BEBSP}_{512}(x)$ .

#### Non-normative notes:

- Only the  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ -order subgroups  $\mathbb{G}_{2,T}^{(r)}$  are used in the protocol, not their containing groups  $\mathbb{G}_{2,T}$ . Points in  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$  are *always* checked to be of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  when decoding from external representation. (The group of rational points  $\mathbb{G}_1$  on  $E_{\mathbb{G}_1}/\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}$  is of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$  so no subgroup checks are needed in that case, and elements of  $\mathbb{G}_T^{(r)}$  are never represented externally.) The  $(r)$  superscripts on  $\mathbb{G}_{1,2,T}^{(r)}$  are used for consistency with notation elsewhere in this specification.
- The points at infinity  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}_{1,2}}$  never occur in proofs and have no defined encodings in this protocol.
- A rational point  $P \neq \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}_2}$  on the curve  $E_{\mathbb{G}_2}$  can be verified to be of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ , and therefore in  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$ , by checking that  $r_{\mathbb{G}} \cdot P = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}_2}$ .
- The use of *big-endian* order by  $\text{l2BEBSP}$  is different from the encoding of most other integers in this protocol. The encodings for  $\mathbb{G}_{1,2}^{(r)*}$  are consistent with the definition of EC2OSP for compressed curve points in [IEEE2004, section 5.5.6.2]. The LSB compressed form (i.e. EC2OSP-XL) is used for points in  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}$ , and the SORT compressed form (i.e. EC2OSP-XS) for points in  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$ .
- Testing  $y > y'$  for the compression of  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$  points is equivalent to testing whether  $(a_{y,1}, a_{y,0}) > (a_{-y,1}, a_{-y,0})$  in lexicographic order.
- Algorithms for decompressing points from the above encodings are given in [IEEE2000, Appendix A.12.8] for  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}$ , and [IEEE2004, Appendix A.12.11] for  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$ .

When computing square roots in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}$  or  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}^2}$  in order to decompress a point encoding, the implementation **MUST NOT** assume that the square root exists, or that the encoding represents a point on the curve.























#### Non-normative notes:

- The length of  $D$  is in practice limited to  $233 - \text{length}(\text{curveName}_{\mathbb{G}})$  bytes due to the restriction of DST to at most 255 bytes. This limit is not exceeded by any use of  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$  or  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{V}}$  in this specification.
- $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$  and  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{V}}$  are intended to be instantiations of  $\text{hash\_to\_curve}$  using “Simplified SWU for  $AB = 0$ ” described in [ID-hashtocurve, section 6.6.3]. In the event of any discrepancy or change to the Internet Draft, the definition here takes precedence.
- It is not necessary to use the  $\text{clear\_cofactor}$  function specified in the Internet Draft, because Pallas and Vesta (and therefore iso-Pallas and iso-Vesta) are *prime-order curves*.
- The above description incorporates optimizations from [WB2019] that avoid inversions and unnecessary square tests in the computation of  $\text{map\_to\_curve\_simple\_swu}^{\text{iso-}\mathbb{G}}$ . In order to fully avoid inversions, the output of  $\text{map\_to\_curve\_simple\_swu}^{\text{iso-}\mathbb{G}}$  can be expressed in Jacobian coordinates, as can the input and output of  $\text{iso\_map}^{\mathbb{G}}$ . It is outside the scope of this document to describe Jacobian coordinates, but for example, the  $E_{\text{iso-}\mathbb{G}}$  point with *affine-short-Weierstrass* coordinates  $(x_{\text{num}}/x_{\text{div}}, y)$ , has Jacobian coordinates  $(x_{\text{num}} \cdot x_{\text{div}}, y \cdot x_{\text{div}}^3, x_{\text{div}})$ .

**Note:** The uses of  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$  for  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , and of both  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{P}}$  and  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{V}}$  to generate independent bases, need a *random oracle*. The  $\text{hash\_to\_curve}$  algorithm in [ID-hashtocurve] is designed to be indifferentiable from a *random oracle* (in the framework of [MRH2003]), given that XMD:BLAKE2b satisfies the requirements of [ID-hashtocurve, section 5.5.4]. The security of the Brier et al. construction on which this algorithm is based is analysed in [FFSTV2013] and [KT2015], with a verified proof in [BGHOZ2013].

## 5.4.10 Zero-Knowledge Proving Systems

### 5.4.10.1 BCTV14

**Before Sapling activation**, **Zcash** uses *zk-SNARKs* generated by a fork of *libsnark* [Zcash-libsnark] with the BCTV14 *proving system* described in [BCTV2014a], which is a modification of the systems in [PHGR2013] and [BCGTV2013].

A BCTV14 proof comprises  $(\pi_A : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi'_A : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi_B : \mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}, \pi'_B : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi_C : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi'_C : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi_K : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}, \pi_H : \mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*})$ . It is computed as described in [BCTV2014a, Appendix B], using the pairing parameters specified in § 5.4.9.1 ‘BN-254’ on p. 99.

**Note:** Many details of the *proving system* are beyond the scope of this protocol document. For example, the *quadratic constraint program* verifying the *JoinSplit statement*, or its translation to a *Quadratic Arithmetic Program* [BCTV2014a, section 2.3], are not specified in this document. In 2015, Bryan Parno found a bug in this translation, which is corrected by the *libsnark* implementation<sup>13</sup> [WCBTV2015] [Parno2015] [BCTV2014a, Remark 2.5]. In practice it will be necessary to use the specific proving and verifying keys that were generated for the **Zcash** production *block chain*, given in § 5.7 ‘BCTV14 *zk-SNARK Parameters*’ on p. 119, together with a *proving system* implementation that is interoperable with the **Zcash** fork of *libsnark*, to ensure compatibility.

**Vulnerability disclosure:** BCTV14 is subject to a security vulnerability, separate from [Parno2015], that could allow violation of Knowledge Soundness (and Soundness) [CVE-2019-7167] [SWB2019] [Gabizon2019]. The consequence for **Zcash** is that balance violation could have occurred before activation of the **Sapling network upgrade**, although there is no evidence of this having happened. Use of the vulnerability to produce false proofs is believed to have been fully mitigated by activation of **Sapling**. The use of BCTV14 in **Zcash** is now limited to verifying proofs that were made prior to the **Sapling network upgrade**.

Due to this issue, new forks of **Zcash** **MUST NOT** use BCTV14, and any other users of the **Zcash** protocol **SHOULD** discontinue use of BCTV14 as soon as possible.

<sup>13</sup>Confusingly, the bug found by Bryan Parno was fixed in *libsnark* in 2015, but that fix was incompletely described in the May 2015 update [BCTV2014a-old, Theorem 2.4]. It is described completely in [BCTV2014a, Theorem 2.4] and in [Gabizon2019].

The vulnerability does not affect the Zero Knowledge property of the scheme (as described in any version of [BCTV2014a] or as implemented in any version of *libsark* that has been used in **Zcash**), even under subversion of the parameter generation [BGG2017, Theorem 4.10].

**[Sapling onward]** An implementation of **Zcash** that checkpoints on a *block* after **Sapling** **MAY** choose to skip verification of BCTV14 proofs. Note that in §3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p.18, there is a requirement that a *full validator* that potentially risks *Mainnet* funds or displays *Mainnet transaction* information to a user **MUST** do so only for a *block chain* that includes the *activation block* of the most recent *settled network upgrade*, with its known *block hash* as specified in §3.12 ‘*Mainnet and Testnet*’ on p.23. Since the most recent *settled network upgrade* is after the **Sapling network upgrade**, this mitigates the potential risks due to skipping BCTV14 proof verification.

## Encoding of BCTV14 Proofs

A BCTV14 proof is encoded by concatenating the encodings of its elements; for the BN-254 pairing this is:

|                 |                  |                 |                  |                 |                  |                 |                 |
|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 264-bit $\pi_A$ | 264-bit $\pi'_A$ | 520-bit $\pi_B$ | 264-bit $\pi'_B$ | 264-bit $\pi_C$ | 264-bit $\pi'_C$ | 264-bit $\pi_K$ | 264-bit $\pi_H$ |
|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|

The resulting proof size is 296 bytes.

In addition to the steps to verify a proof given in [BCTV2014a, Appendix B], the verifier **MUST** check, for the encoding of each element, that:

- the lead byte is of the required form;
- the remaining bytes encode a *big-endian* representation of an integer in  $\{0 \dots q_S - 1\}$  or (for  $\pi_B$ )  $\{0 \dots q_S^2 - 1\}$ ;
- the encoding represents a point in  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)*}$  or (for  $\pi_B$ )  $\mathbb{G}_2^{(r)*}$ , including checking that it is of order  $r_G$  in the latter case.

### 5.4.10.2 Groth16

After **Sapling** activation, **Zcash** uses *zk-SNARKs* with the **Groth16 proving system** described in [BGM2017], which is a modification of the system in [Groth2016]. An independent security proof of this system and its setup is given in [Maller2018].

Groth16 *zk-SNARK proofs* are used in *transaction version 4* and later (§7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p.122), both in **Sprout JoinSplit** descriptions and in **Sapling Spend** descriptions and *Output descriptions*. They are generated by the *bellman* library [Bowe-bellman].

A Groth16 proof comprises  $(\pi_A : S_1^{(r)*}, \pi_B : S_2^{(r)*}, \pi_C : S_1^{(r)*})$ . It is computed as described in [Groth2016, section 3.2], using the pairing parameters specified in §5.4.9.2 ‘BLS12-381’ on p.101. The proof elements are in a different order to the presentation in [Groth2016].

**Note:** The *quadratic constraint programs* verifying the *Spend statement* and *Output statement* are described in Appendix §A ‘*Circuit Design*’ on p.200. However, many other details of the *proving system* are beyond the scope of this protocol document. For example, certain details of the translations of the *Spend statement* and *Output statement* to *Quadratic Arithmetic Programs* are not specified in this document. In practice it will be necessary to use the specific proving and verifying keys generated for the **Zcash** production *block chain* (see §5.8 ‘Groth16 *zk-SNARK Parameters*’ on p.119), and a *proving system* implementation that is interoperable with the *bellman* library used by **Zcash**, to ensure compatibility.

## Encoding of Groth16 Proofs

A Groth16 proof is encoded by concatenating the encodings of its elements; for the BLS12-381 pairing this is:

|                 |                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 384-bit $\pi_A$ | 768-bit $\pi_B$ | 384-bit $\pi_C$ |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|

The resulting proof size is 192 bytes.

In addition to the steps to verify a proof given in [Groth2016], the verifier **MUST** check, for the encoding of each element, that:

- the leading bitfield is of the required form;
- the remaining bits encode a *big-endian* representation of an integer in  $\{0 \dots q_S - 1\}$  or (in the case of  $\pi_B$ ) two integers in that range;
- the encoding represents a point in  $S_1^{(r)*}$  or (in the case of  $\pi_B$ )  $S_2^{(r)*}$ , including checking that it is of order  $r_S$  in each case.

### 5.4.10.3 Halo 2

For **Orchard** *Action descriptions* in version 5 transactions, **Zcash** uses *zk-SNARKs* with the Halo 2 proving system described in [Zcash-halo2].

#### Encoding of Halo 2 Proofs

Halo 2 proofs are defined as *byte sequences*, and so the encoding is the proof itself.

## 5.5 Encodings of Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields

As explained in § 3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15, transmitted *notes* are stored on the *block chain* in encrypted form. The components and usage of *note plaintexts*, and which keys they are encrypted to, are defined in that section.

The encoding of a **Sprout** *note plaintext* consists of:

|                |          |           |             |                  |
|----------------|----------|-----------|-------------|------------------|
| 8-bit leadByte | 64-bit v | 256-bit p | 256-bit rcm | memo (512 bytes) |
|----------------|----------|-----------|-------------|------------------|

- A byte, 0x00, indicating this version of the encoding of a **Sprout** *note plaintext*.
- 8 bytes specifying v.
- 32 bytes specifying p.
- 32 bytes specifying rcm.
- 512 bytes specifying memo.

The encoding of a **Sapling** or **Orchard** *note plaintext* consists of:

|                |          |          |               |                  |
|----------------|----------|----------|---------------|------------------|
| 8-bit leadByte | 88-bit d | 64-bit v | 256-bit rseed | memo (512 bytes) |
|----------------|----------|----------|---------------|------------------|

- A byte, 0x01 or 0x02 as specified in § 3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15, indicating this version of the encoding of a **Sapling** or **Orchard** *note plaintext*.
- 11 bytes specifying d.
- 8 bytes specifying v.
- 32 bytes specifying rseed.
- 512 bytes specifying memo.

## 5.6 Encodings of Addresses and Keys

This section describes how **Zcash** encodes *shielded payment addresses*, *incoming viewing keys*, and *spending keys*. Addresses and keys can be encoded as a *byte sequence*; this is called the *raw encoding*. For **Sprout** *shielded payment addresses*, this *byte sequence* can then be further encoded using *Base58Check*. The *Base58Check* layer is the same as for upstream **Bitcoin** addresses [Bitcoin-Base58].

For **Sapling**-specific key and address formats, *Bech32* [ZIP-173] is used instead of *Base58Check*.

**Non-normative note:** ZIP 173 is similar to **Bitcoin**'s BIP 173, except for dropping the limit of 90 characters on an encoded *Bech32* string (which does not hold for **Sapling** viewing keys, for example), and requirements specific to **Bitcoin**'s Segwit addresses.

**Orchard** introduces a new address format called a *unified payment address*. This can encode an **Orchard** address, but also a **Sapling** address, a *transparent address*, and potentially future address formats, all in the same *unified payment address*. It is **RECOMMENDED** to use *unified payment addresses* for all new applications, unless compatibility with software that only accepts previous address formats is required.

*Unified payment addresses* and **Orchard** *spending keys* are encoded with *Bech32m* [BIP-350] rather than *Bech32*.

*Payment addresses MAY be encoded as QR codes; in this case, the RECOMMENDED format for a Sapling payment address is the Bech32 form converted to uppercase, using the Alphanumeric mode [ISO2015, sections 7.3.4 and 7.4.4]. Similarly, the RECOMMENDED format for a unified payment address is the Bech32m form converted to uppercase, using the Alphanumeric mode.*

### 5.6.1 Transparent Encodings

#### 5.6.1.1 Transparent Addresses

*Transparent addresses* are either *P2SH* (Pay to Script Hash) addresses [BIP-13] or *P2PKH* (Pay to Public Key Hash) addresses [Bitcoin-P2PKH].

The *raw encoding* of a *P2SH* address consists of:

|            |            |                     |
|------------|------------|---------------------|
| 8-bit 0x1C | 8-bit 0xBD | 160-bit script hash |
|------------|------------|---------------------|

- Two bytes [0x1C, 0xBD], indicating this version of the *raw encoding* of a *P2SH* address on *Mainnet*. (Addresses on *Testnet* use [0x1C, 0xBA] instead.)
- 20 bytes specifying a script hash [Bitcoin-P2SH].

The *raw encoding* of a *P2PKH* address consists of:

|            |            |                                    |
|------------|------------|------------------------------------|
| 8-bit 0x1C | 8-bit 0xB8 | 160-bit <i>validating key hash</i> |
|------------|------------|------------------------------------|

- Two bytes [0x1C, 0xB8], indicating this version of the *raw encoding* of a *P2PKH* address on *Mainnet*. (Addresses on *Testnet* use [0x1D, 0x25] instead.)
- 20 bytes specifying a *validating key hash*, which is a RIPEMD-160 hash [RIPEMD160] of a SHA-256 hash [NIST2015] of a compressed ECDSA key encoding.

#### Notes:

- In **Bitcoin** a single byte is used for the version field identifying the address type. In **Zcash** two bytes are used. For addresses on *Mainnet*, this and the encoded length cause the first two characters of the *Base58Check* encoding to be fixed as “t3” for *P2SH* addresses, and as “t1” for *P2PKH* addresses. (This does *not* imply that a *transparent Zcash* address can be parsed identically to a **Bitcoin** address just by removing the “t”.)
- **Zcash** does not yet support Hierarchical Deterministic Wallet addresses [BIP-32].

### 5.6.1.2 Transparent Private Keys

These are encoded in the same way as in **Bitcoin** [Bitcoin-Base58], for both *Mainnet* and *Testnet*.

## 5.6.2 Sprout Encodings

### 5.6.2.1 Sprout Payment Addresses

Let  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout Key Agreement**’ on p. 88.

A **Sprout shielded payment address** consists of  $a_{pk} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  and  $pk_{\text{enc}} : KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public}$ .

$a_{pk}$  is a SHA256Compress output.  $pk_{\text{enc}}$  is a  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Public}$  key, for use with the encryption scheme defined in § 4.19 ‘**In-band secret distribution (Sprout)**’ on p. 65. These components are derived from a *spending key* as described in § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36.

The *raw encoding* of a **Sprout shielded payment address** consists of:

|            |            |                  |                           |
|------------|------------|------------------|---------------------------|
| 8-bit 0x16 | 8-bit 0x9A | 256-bit $a_{pk}$ | 256-bit $pk_{\text{enc}}$ |
|------------|------------|------------------|---------------------------|

- Two bytes [0x16, 0x9A], indicating this version of the *raw encoding* of a **Sprout shielded payment address** on *Mainnet*. (Addresses on *Testnet* use [0x16, 0xB6] instead.)
- 32 bytes specifying  $a_{pk}$ .
- 32 bytes specifying  $pk_{\text{enc}}$ , using the normal encoding of a Curve25519 *public key* [Bernstein2006].

**Note:** For addresses on *Mainnet*, the lead bytes and encoded length cause the first two characters of the *Base58Check* encoding to be fixed as “zc”. For *Testnet*, the first two characters are fixed as “zt”.

### 5.6.2.2 Sprout Incoming Viewing Keys

Let  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout Key Agreement**’ on p. 88.

A **Sprout incoming viewing key** consists of  $a_{pk} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{PRF}}^{\text{Sprout}}]}$  and  $sk_{\text{enc}} : KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Private}$ .

$a_{pk}$  is a SHA256Compress output.  $sk_{\text{enc}}$  is a  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{Private}$  key, for use with the encryption scheme defined in § 4.19 ‘**In-band secret distribution (Sprout)**’ on p. 65. These components are derived from a *spending key* as described in § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36.

The *raw encoding* of a **Sprout incoming viewing key** consists of:

|            |            |            |                  |                           |
|------------|------------|------------|------------------|---------------------------|
| 8-bit 0xA8 | 8-bit 0xAB | 8-bit 0xD3 | 256-bit $a_{pk}$ | 256-bit $sk_{\text{enc}}$ |
|------------|------------|------------|------------------|---------------------------|

- Three bytes [0xA8, 0xAB, 0xD3], indicating this version of the *raw encoding* of a **Zcash incoming viewing key** on *Mainnet*. (Addresses on *Testnet* use [0xA8, 0xAC, 0x0C] instead.)
- 32 bytes specifying  $a_{pk}$ .
- 32 bytes specifying  $sk_{\text{enc}}$ , using the normal encoding of a Curve25519 *private key* [Bernstein2006].

$sk_{\text{enc}}$  **MUST** be “clamped” using  $KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{FormatPrivate}$  as specified in § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36. That is, a decoded *incoming viewing key* **MUST** be considered invalid if  $sk_{\text{enc}} \neq KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{FormatPrivate}(sk_{\text{enc}})$ .

$KA^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{FormatPrivate}$  is defined in § 5.4.5.1 ‘**Sprout Key Agreement**’ on p. 88.

**Note:** For addresses on *Mainnet*, the lead bytes and encoded length cause the first four characters of the *Base58Check* encoding to be fixed as “ZiVK”. For *Testnet*, the first four characters are fixed as “ZiVt”.



### 5.6.2.3 Sprout Spending Keys

A **Sprout** spending key consists of  $a_{sk}$ , which is a sequence of 252 bits (see § 4.2.1 ‘**Sprout** Key Components’ on p. 36).

The raw encoding of a **Sprout** spending key consists of:

|            |            |         |                  |
|------------|------------|---------|------------------|
| 8-bit 0xAB | 8-bit 0x36 | $[0]^4$ | 252-bit $a_{sk}$ |
|------------|------------|---------|------------------|

- Two bytes [0xAB, 0x36], indicating this version of the raw encoding of a **Zcash** spending key on *Mainnet*. (Addresses on *Testnet* use [0xAC, 0x08] instead.)
- 32 bytes: 4 zero padding bits and 252 bits specifying  $a_{sk}$ .

The zero padding occupies the most significant 4 bits of the third byte.

#### Notes:

- If an implementation represents  $a_{sk}$  internally as a sequence of 32 bytes with the 4 bits of zero padding intact, it will be in the correct form for use as an input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$ , and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$  without need for bit-shifting.
- For addresses on *Mainnet*, the lead bytes and encoded length cause the first two characters of the *Base58Check* encoding to be fixed as “SK”. For *Testnet*, the first two characters are fixed as “ST”.

## 5.6.3 Sapling Encodings

### 5.6.3.1 Sapling Payment Addresses

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.3 ‘**Sapling** Key Agreement’ on p. 89.

Let  $\ell_d$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘**Constants**’ on p. 74.

Let  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ ,  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘**Jubjub**’ on p. 102.

Let  $\text{LEBS2OSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}[\text{ceiling}(\ell/8)]}$  be as defined in § 5.1 ‘**Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness**’ on p. 73.

A **Sapling** shielded payment address consists of  $d : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}$  and  $\text{pk}_d : \text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ .

$\text{pk}_d$  is an encoding of a  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$  public key of type  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ , for use with the encryption scheme defined in § 4.20 ‘**In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 67.  $d$  is a *diversifier*. These components are derived as described in § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling** Key Components’ on p. 36.

The raw encoding of a **Sapling** shielded payment address consists of:

|                           |                                                                |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{88}(d)$ | $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{pk}_d))$ |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|

- 11 bytes specifying  $d$ .
- 32 bytes specifying the *ctEdwards compressed* encoding of  $\text{pk}_d$  (see § 5.4.9.3 ‘**Jubjub**’ on p. 102).

When decoding the representation of  $\text{pk}_d$ , the address **MUST** be considered invalid if  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}$  returns  $\perp$ , or the encoding of  $\text{pk}_d$  is a *non-canonical* encoding as defined in § 4.1.9 ‘**Represented Group**’ on p. 32, or the resulting  $\text{pk}_d$  is not in  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ .



The *raw encoding* of a **Sapling** full viewing key consists of:

|                                                              |                                                              |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{ak}))$ | $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{nk}))$ | 32-byte ovk |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|

- 32 bytes specifying the *ctEdwards compressed encoding* of  $\text{ak}$  (see § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p.102).
- 32 bytes specifying the *ctEdwards compressed encoding* of  $\text{nk}$ .
- 32 bytes specifying the *outgoing viewing key*  $\text{ovk}$ .

When decoding this representation, the key **MUST** be considered invalid if  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}$  returns  $\perp$  for either  $\text{ak}$  or  $\text{nk}$ , or if  $\text{ak} \notin \mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , or if  $\text{nk} \notin \mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ .

For *full viewing keys* on *Mainnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**zviews**”. For *full viewing keys* on *Testnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**zviewtestsapling**”.

### 5.6.3.4 Sapling Spending Keys

A **Sapling** spending key consists of  $\text{sk} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{sk}}]}$  (see § 4.2.2 ‘**Sapling Key Components**’ on p.36).

The *raw encoding* of a **Sapling** spending key consists of:

|                                    |
|------------------------------------|
| $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{sk})$ |
|------------------------------------|

- 32 bytes specifying  $\text{sk}$ .

For *spending keys* on *Mainnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**secret-spending-key-main**”. For *spending keys* on *Testnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**secret-spending-key-test**”.

## 5.6.4 Unified and Orchard Encodings

### 5.6.4.1 Unified Payment Addresses and Viewing Keys

Rather than defining a *Bech32* string encoding of **Orchard** shielded payment addresses, we instead define, in [ZIP-316], a *unified payment address* format that is able to encode a set of *payment addresses* of different types. This enables the consumer of an address to choose the best address type it supports, providing a better user experience as new formats are added in the future.

Similarly, *unified incoming viewing keys* and *unified full viewing keys* are defined to encode sets of *incoming viewing keys* and *full viewing keys* respectively.

Since [ZIP-316] includes a full specification of encoding, decoding, and other processing of *unified payment addresses*, *unified incoming viewing keys*, and *unified full viewing keys*, we give only a summary here.

A *unified payment address* includes zero or one address of each type in the following Priority List:

- typecode 0x03 – § 5.6.4.2 ‘**Orchard Raw Payment Addresses**’ on p.118;
- typecode 0x02 – § 5.6.3.1 ‘**Sapling Payment Addresses**’ on p.115;
- typecode 0x01 – *transparent P2SH address*, or typecode 0x00 – *transparent P2PKH address*.

with the restrictions that there **MUST** be at least one *shielded payment address* (typecodes  $\geq 0x02$ ), and that both *P2SH* and *P2PKH* cannot be present.

When sending a payment, the consumer of a *unified payment address* **MUST** use the most preferred address type that it supports from the set, i.e. the first in the above list. See [ZIP-316] for additional requirements, and for discussion of *unified incoming viewing keys* and *unified full viewing keys*.

Note that there is intentionally no typecode defined for a **Sprout** shielded payment address (or **Sprout** viewing keys). Since it is no longer possible (since activation of [ZIP-211] in the **Canopy** network upgrade) to send funds into the **Sprout** chain value pool, this would not be generally useful.

The format uses *Bech32m* [BIP-350] (ignoring any length restrictions) for the checksum algorithm and string encoding. This is chosen over *Bech32* in order for the checksum to better handle variable-length inputs.

A “jumbling” algorithm is used in order to mitigate address replacement attacks given that a user might only check part of the address. See [ZIP-316] for full details.

#### 5.6.4.2 Orchard Raw Payment Addresses

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.5 ‘*Orchard Key Agreement*’ on p. 90.

An **Orchard** shielded payment address consists of  $d : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_d]}$  and  $\text{pk}_d : \text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ .

$\text{pk}_d$  is an encoding of a  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  public key of type  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ , for use with the encryption scheme defined in § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67.  $d$  is a sequence of 11 bytes. These components are derived as described in § 4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p. 38.

The raw encoding of an **Orchard** shielded payment address consists of:

|                                |                                                                     |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LEBS2OSP <sub>88</sub> ( $d$ ) | LEBS2OSP <sub>256</sub> ( $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{P}}(\text{pk}_d)$ ) |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|

- 11 bytes specifying  $d$ .
- 32 bytes specifying the *short Weierstrass compressed encoding* of  $\text{pk}_d$  (see § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105).

When decoding the representation of  $\text{pk}_d$ , the address **MUST** be considered invalid if  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{P}}$  returns  $\perp$  or  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ .

There is no *Bech32[m]* encoding defined for an individual **Orchard** shielded payment address; instead use a *unified payment address* as defined in [ZIP-316].

#### 5.6.4.3 Orchard Raw Incoming Viewing Keys

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.5 ‘*Orchard Key Agreement*’ on p. 90.

An **Orchard** incoming viewing key consists of a *diversifier* key  $\text{dk}$ , and a  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Private}$  key  $\text{ivk}$  restricted to the range  $\{1 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$ . It is derived as described in § 4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p. 38, and is used with the encryption scheme defined in § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67.

Let I2LEOSP be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

The raw encoding of an **Orchard** incoming viewing key consists of:

|             |                                         |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------|
| $\text{dk}$ | I2LEOSP <sub>256</sub> ( $\text{ivk}$ ) |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------|

- 32 bytes specifying  $\text{dk}$ .
- 32 bytes (*little-endian*) specifying  $\text{ivk}$ .

$\text{ivk}$  **MUST** be in the range  $\{1 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  as specified in § 4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p. 38. That is, a decoded *incoming viewing key* **MUST** be considered invalid if  $\text{ivk}$  is not in this range.

There is no *Bech32[m]* encoding defined for an individual **Orchard** incoming viewing key; instead use a *unified incoming viewing key* as defined in [ZIP-316].

#### 5.6.4.4 Orchard Raw Full Viewing Keys

Let  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.5.5 ‘*Orchard Key Agreement*’ on p. 90.

Let  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106.

An **Orchard** full viewing key consists of  $\text{ak} : \{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$ ,  $\text{nk} : \mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ , and  $\text{rivk} : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{P}}}$ .

$\text{ak}$  is the *Spend validating key*, a result of applying  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}$  to a point on the Pallas curve (see § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105).  $\text{nk}$  is the *nullifier deriving key*, a field element in  $\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{P}}}$ .  $\text{rivk}$  is the  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  randomness, a field element in  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{P}}}$ . They are derived as described in § 4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p. 38.

Let I2LEOSP be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

The *raw encoding* of an **Orchard** *full viewing key* consists of:

|                     |                     |                       |
|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| $I2LEOSP_{256}(ak)$ | $I2LEOSP_{256}(nk)$ | $I2LEOSP_{256}(rivk)$ |
|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|

- 32 bytes (*little-endian*) specifying  $ak$ .
- 32 bytes (*little-endian*) specifying  $nk$ .
- 32 bytes (*little-endian*) specifying  $rivk$ .

When decoding this representation, the key **MUST** be considered invalid if  $ak$ ,  $nk$ , or  $rivk$  are not canonically encoded elements of their respective fields, or if  $ak$  is not a valid affine  $x$ -coordinate of a Pallas curve point in  $\mathbb{P}^*$ , or if either the external or internal *incoming viewing keys* derived as specified in § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38 are 0 or  $\perp$ .

There is no *Bech32[m]* encoding defined for an individual **Orchard** *full viewing key*; instead use a *unified full viewing key* as defined in [ZIP-316].

#### 5.6.4.5 Orchard Spending Keys

An **Orchard** *spending key* consists of  $sk : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{sk}]}$  (see § 4.2.3 ‘**Orchard Key Components**’ on p. 38).

The *raw encoding* of an **Orchard** *spending key* consists of:

|                      |
|----------------------|
| $LEBS2OSP_{256}(sk)$ |
|----------------------|

- 32 bytes specifying  $sk$ .

**Orchard** *spending keys* are encoded using *Bech32m* (not *Bech32*).

For *spending keys* on *Mainnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**secret-orchard-sk-main**”. For *spending keys* on *Testnet*, the *Human-Readable Part* is “**secret-orchard-sk-test**”.

## 5.7 BCTV14 zk-SNARK Parameters

The SHA-256 hashes of the *proving key* and *verifying key* for the **Sprout** *JoinSplit circuit*, encoded in *libsark* format, are:

```
8bc20a7f013b2b58970cddd2e7ea028975c88ae7ceb9259a5344a16bc2c0eef7 sprout-proving.key
4bd498dae0aacfd8e98dc306338d017d9c08dd0918ead18172bd0aec2fc5df82 sprout-verifying.key
```

These parameters were obtained by a *multi-party computation* described in [BGG-mpc] and [BGG2017]. **They are used only before Sapling activation**. Due to the security vulnerability described in § 5.4.10.1 ‘BCTV14’ on p. 110, it is not recommended to use these parameters in new protocols, and it is recommended to stop using them in protocols other than **Zcash** where they are currently used.

## 5.8 Groth16 zk-SNARK Parameters

*bellman* [Bowe-bellman] encodes the *proving key* and *verifying key* for a *zk-SNARK circuit* in a single parameters file. The BLAKE2b-512 hashes of this file for the **Sapling** *Spend circuit* and *Output circuit*, and for the implementation of the **Sprout** *JoinSplit circuit* used after **Sapling** activation, are respectively:

```
8270785a1a0d0bc77196f000ee6d221c9c9894f55307bd9357c3f0105d31ca63
991ab91324160d8f53e2bbd3c2633a6eb8bdf5205d822e7f3f73edac51b2b70c sapling-spend.params
657e3d38dbb5cb5e7dd2970e8b03d69b4787dd907285b5a7f0790dcc8072f60b
f593b32cc2d1c030e00ff5ae64bf84c5c3beb84ddc841d48264b4a171744d028 sapling-output.params
e9b238411bd6c0ec4791e9d04245ec350c9c5744f5610dfcce4365d5ca49dfef
d5054e371842b3f88fa1b9d7e8e075249b3ebabd167fa8b0f3161292d36c180a sprout-groth16.params
```

These parameters were obtained by a *multi-party computation* described in [BGM2017].

## 5.9 Randomness Beacon

## 6 Network Upgrades

Zcash launched with a protocol revision that we call **Sprout**.

A seventh upgrade, called **NU6**, activated on *Mainnet* on 23 November, 2024 at *block height* 2726400 (coinciding with the second *block subsidy halving*) [Zcash-Nu6]. Its specifications are described in this document, [ZIP-253], [ZIP-236], and [ZIP-2001], with updates to [ZIP-207] and [ZIP-214]. Additional information and rationale is given in [ZIP-1015].

This section summarizes the strategy for upgrading from **Sprout** to subsequent versions of the protocol (**Overwinter**, **Sapling**, **Blossom**, **Heartwood**, **Canopy**, **NU5**, **NU6**, and **NU6.1**), and for future upgrades.

The *network upgrade* mechanism is described in [ZIP-200].

Each *network upgrade* is introduced as a “*bilateral consensus rule change*”. In this kind of upgrade,

- there is an *activation block height* at which the *consensus rule change* takes effect;

- *blocks* and *transactions* that are valid according to the post-upgrade rules are not valid before the upgrade *block height*;
- *blocks* and *transactions* that are valid according to the pre-upgrade rules are no longer valid at or after the *activation block height*.

Full support for each *network upgrade* is indicated by a minimum version of the *peer-to-peer protocol*. At the planned *activation block height*, nodes that support a given upgrade will disconnect from (and will not reconnect to) nodes with a protocol version lower than this minimum. See [ZIP-201] for how this applies to the **Overwinter** upgrade, for example.

This ensures that upgrade-supporting nodes transition cleanly from the old protocol to the new protocol. Nodes that do not support the upgrade will find themselves on a network that uses the old protocol and is fully partitioned from the upgrade-supporting network. This allows us to specify arbitrary protocol changes that take effect at a given *block height*.

Note, however, that a *block chain reorganization* across the upgrade *activation block height* is possible. In the case of such a reorganization, *blocks* at a height before the *activation block height* will still be created and validated according to the pre-upgrade rules, and upgrade-supporting nodes **MUST** allow for this.



## 7 Consensus Changes from Bitcoin

### 7.1 Transaction Encoding and Consensus

The **Zcash** *transaction* format up to and including *transaction version* 4 is as follows (this should be read in the context of consensus rules later in the section):

| Version* | Bytes                   | Name                | Data Type                                | Description                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------|-------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1..4     | 4                       | header              | uint32                                   | Contains:<br>· fOverwintered flag (bit 31)<br>· version (bits 30..0) = <i>transaction version</i> .                                                                       |
| 3..4     | 4                       | nVersionGroupId     | uint32                                   | VersionGroupId (bits 30..0) = <i>transaction version</i> .                                                                                                                |
| 1..4     | Varies                  | tx_in_count         | compactSize                              | Number of <i>transparent</i> inputs.                                                                                                                                      |
| 1..4     | Varies                  | tx_in               | tx_in                                    | <i>Transparent</i> inputs, encoded as in <b>Bitcoin</b> .                                                                                                                 |
| 1..4     | Varies                  | tx_out_count        | compactSize                              | Number of <i>transparent</i> outputs.                                                                                                                                     |
| 1..4     | Varies                  | tx_out              | tx_out                                   | <i>Transparent</i> outputs, encoded as in <b>Bitcoin</b> .                                                                                                                |
| 1..4     | 4                       | lock_time           | uint32                                   | Unix-epoch UTC time or <i>block height</i> , encoded as in <b>Bitcoin</b> .                                                                                               |
| 3..4     | 4                       | nExpiryHeight       | uint32                                   | A <i>block height</i> after which the <i>transaction</i> will expire, or 0 to disable expiry. [ZIP-203]                                                                   |
| 4        | 8                       | valueBalanceSapling | int64                                    | The net value of <b>Sapling</b> spends minus outputs.                                                                                                                     |
| 4        | Varies                  | nSpendsSapling      | compactSize                              | The number of <i>Spend</i> descriptions in vSpendsSapling.                                                                                                                |
| 4        | 384·<br>nSpendsSapling  | vSpendsSapling      | SpendDescriptionV4<br>[nSpendsSapling]   | A sequence of <i>Spend</i> descriptions, encoded per §7.3 ‘ <i>Spend Description Encoding and Consensus</i> ’ on p.128.                                                   |
| 4        | Varies                  | nOutputsSapling     | compactSize                              | The number of <i>Output</i> descriptions in vOutputsSapling.                                                                                                              |
| 4        | 948·<br>nOutputsSapling | vOutputsSapling     | OutputDescriptionV4<br>[nOutputsSapling] | A sequence of <i>Output</i> descriptions, encoded per §7.4 ‘ <i>Output Description Encoding and Consensus</i> ’ on p.129.                                                 |
| 2..4     | Varies                  | nJoinSplit          | compactSize                              | The number of <i>JoinSplit</i> descriptions in vJoinSplit.                                                                                                                |
| 2..3     | 1802·<br>nJoinSplit     | vJoinSplit          | JSDescriptionBCTV14<br>[nJoinSplit]      | A sequence of <i>JoinSplit</i> descriptions using BCTV14 proofs, encoded per §7.2 ‘ <i>JoinSplit Description Encoding and Consensus</i> ’ on p.128.                       |
| 4        | 1698·<br>nJoinSplit     | vJoinSplit          | JSDescriptionGroth16<br>[nJoinSplit]     | A sequence of <i>JoinSplit</i> descriptions using Groth16 proofs, encoded per §7.2 ‘ <i>JoinSplit Description Encoding and Consensus</i> ’ on p.128.                      |
| 2..4 †   | 32                      | joinSplitPubKey     | byte[32]                                 | An encoding of a <i>JoinSplitSig</i> public validating key.                                                                                                               |
| 2..4 †   | 64                      | joinSplitSig        | byte[64]                                 | A signature on a prefix of the <i>transaction</i> encoding, validated using joinSplitPubKey as specified in §4.11 <i>Non-malleability (Sprout)</i> ’ on p.51.             |
| 4 ‡      | 64                      | bindingSigSapling   | byte[64]                                 | A <i>Sapling</i> binding signature on the <i>SIGHASH</i> transaction hash, validated as specified in §5.4.7.2 ‘ <i>Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)</i> ’ on p.95. |

\* Version constraints apply to the effectiveVersion, which is equal to min(2, version) when fOverwintered = 0 and to version otherwise. If effectiveVersion ≥ 5 once header has been parsed, the remainder of the *transaction* encoding **MUST** be parsed according to the v5 format described in the next table. The consensus rules later in this section specify constraints on nVersionGroupId depending on effectiveVersion.

† The joinSplitPubKey and joinSplitSig fields are present if and only if effectiveVersion ≥ 2 and nJoinSplit > 0.

‡ bindingSigSapling is present if and only if effectiveVersion = 4 and nSpendsSapling + nOutputsSapling > 0.

Note that the valueBalanceSapling field is always present for these *transaction* versions.

Several **Sapling** fields have been renamed from previous versions of this specification:

valueBalance → valueBalanceSapling; nShieldedSpend → nSpendsSapling; vShieldedSpend → vSpendsSapling; nShieldedOutput → nOutputsSapling; vShieldedOutput → vOutputsSapling; bindingSig → bindingSigSapling.



## 7.1.1 Transaction Identifiers

The *transaction ID* of a **version 4** or earlier *transaction* is the SHA-256d hash of the *transaction* encoding in the pre-v5 format described above.

The *transaction ID* of a version 5 *transaction* is as defined in [ZIP-244]. A v5 *transaction* also has a *wtxid* (used for example in the *peer-to-peer protocol*) as defined in [ZIP-239].

## 7.1.2 Transaction Consensus Rules

Consensus rules:

- The *transaction version number* **MUST** be greater than or equal to 1.
- [Pre-Overwinter] The `f0verwintered` flag **MUST NOT** be set.
- [Overwinter onward] The `f0verwintered` flag **MUST** be set.
- [Overwinter onward] The *version group ID* **MUST** be recognized.
- [Overwinter only, pre-Sapling] The *transaction version number* **MUST** be 3, and the *version group ID* **MUST** be 0x03C48270.
- [Sapling to Canopy inclusive, pre-NU5] The *transaction version number* **MUST** be 4, and the *version group ID* **MUST** be 0x892F2085.
- [NU5 onward] The *transaction version number* **MUST** be 4 or 5. If the *transaction version number* is 4 then the *version group ID* **MUST** be 0x892F2085. If the *transaction version number* is 5 then the *version group ID* **MUST** be 0x26A7270A.
- [NU5 onward] If `effectiveVersion`  $\geq 5$ , the `nConsensusBranchId` field **MUST** match the *consensus branch ID* used for *SIGHASH transaction hashes*, as specified in [ZIP-244].
- [Pre-Sapling] The encoded size of the *transaction* **MUST** be less than or equal to 100000 bytes.
- [NU5 onward] `nSpendSapling`, `nOutputsSapling`, and `nActionsOrchard` **MUST** all be less than  $2^{16}$ .
- [Pre-Sapling] If `effectiveVersion` = 1 or `nJoinSplit` = 0, then both `tx_in_count` and `tx_out_count` **MUST** be nonzero.
- [Sapling onward] If `effectiveVersion` < 5, then at least one of `tx_in_count`, `nSpendSapling`, and `nJoinSplit` **MUST** be nonzero.
- [Sapling onward] If `effectiveVersion` < 5, then at least one of `tx_out_count`, `nOutputsSapling`, and `nJoinSplit` **MUST** be nonzero.
- [NU5 onward] If `effectiveVersion`  $\geq 5$  then this condition **MUST** hold: `tx_in_count` > 0 or `nSpendSapling` > 0 or (`nActionsOrchard` > 0 and `enableSpendOrchard` = 1).
- [NU5 onward] If `effectiveVersion`  $\geq 5$  then this condition **MUST** hold: `tx_out_count` > 0 or `nOutputsSapling` > 0 or (`nActionsOrchard` > 0 and `enableOutputsOrchard` = 1).
- [NU5 onward] If `effectiveVersion`  $\geq 5$  and `nActionsOrchard` > 0, then at least one of `enableSpendOrchard` and `enableOutputsOrchard` **MUST** be 1.
- A *transaction* with one or more *transparent inputs* from *coinbase transactions* **MUST** have no *transparent outputs* (i.e. `tx_out_count` **MUST** be 0). Inputs from *coinbase transactions* include *Founders' Reward outputs* and *funding stream outputs*.
- If `effectiveVersion`  $\geq 2$  and `nJoinSplit` > 0, then:
  - `joinSplitPubKey` **MUST** be a valid encoding (see §5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90) of an Ed25519 *validating key*.
  - `joinSplitSig` **MUST** represent a valid signature under `joinSplitPubKey` of `dataToBeSigned`, as defined in §4.11 ‘Non-malleability (*Sprout*)’ on p. 51.

- [Sapling onward] If  $\text{effectiveVersion} \geq 4$  and  $\text{nSpendSapling} + \text{nOutputsSapling} > 0$ , then:
  - let  $\text{bvK}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{SigHash}$  be as defined in § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52;
  - $\text{bindingSigSapling}$  **MUST** represent a valid signature under the *transaction binding validating key*  $\text{bvK}^{\text{Sapling}}$  of  $\text{SigHash}$  — i.e.  $\text{BindingSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Validate}_{\text{bvK}^{\text{Sapling}}}(\text{SigHash}, \text{bindingSigSapling}) = 1$ . [NU5 onward] As specified in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas’ on p. 92, the validation of the  $\underline{R}$  component of the signature changes to prohibit *non-canonical* encodings. This change is also retrospectively valid on *Mainnet* and *Testnet* before NU5.
- [Sapling onward] If  $\text{effectiveVersion} = 4$  and there are no *Spend descriptions* or *Output descriptions*, then  $\text{valueBalanceSapling}$  **MUST** be 0.
- [NU5 onward] If  $\text{effectiveVersion} \geq 5$  and  $\text{nActionsOrchard} > 0$ , then:
  - let  $\text{bvK}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{SigHash}$  be as defined in § 4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54;
  - $\text{bindingSigOrchard}$  **MUST** represent a valid signature under the *transaction binding validating key*  $\text{bvK}^{\text{Orchard}}$  of  $\text{SigHash}$  — i.e.  $\text{BindingSig}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Validate}_{\text{bvK}^{\text{Orchard}}}(\text{SigHash}, \text{bindingSigOrchard}) = 1$ . As specified in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas’ on p. 92, validation of the  $\underline{R}$  component of the signature prohibits *non-canonical* encodings.
- Let  $\text{totalDeferredOutput}$  and  $\text{totalDeferredInput}$  be as defined in § 7.8 on p. 136. For the *block* at *block height*  $\text{height}$ :
  - define the *total output value* of its *coinbase transaction* to be the total value in *zatoshi* of its *transparent outputs*, minus  $v^{\text{balanceSapling}}$ , minus  $v^{\text{balanceOrchard}}$ , plus  $\text{totalDeferredOutput}(\text{height})$ ;
  - define the *total input value* of its *coinbase transaction* to be the value in *zatoshi* of the *block subsidy*, plus the *transaction fees* paid by *transactions* in the *block*, plus  $\text{totalDeferredInput}(\text{height})$ .
- [Pre-NU6] The *total output value* of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** be greater than its *total input value*.
- [NU6 onward] The *total output value* of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST** be equal to its *total input value*.
- A *coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** have any *JoinSplit descriptions*.
- A *coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** have any *Spend descriptions*.
- [Pre-Heartwood] A *coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** have any *Output descriptions*.
- [NU5 onward] In a version 5 *coinbase transaction*, the  $\text{enableSpendOrchard}$  flag **MUST** be 0.
- [NU5 onward] In a version 5 *transaction*, the reserved bits 2 .. 7 of the  $\text{flagsOrchard}$  field **MUST** be zero.
- A *coinbase transaction* for a *block* at *block height* greater than 0 **MUST** have a script that, as its first item, encodes the *block height*  $\text{height}$  as follows. For  $\text{height}$  in the range  $\{1 \dots 16\}$ , the encoding is a single byte of value  $0x50 + \text{height}$ . Otherwise, let  $\text{heightBytes}$  be the signed *little-endian* representation of  $\text{height}$ , using the minimum nonzero number of bytes such that the most significant byte is  $< 0x80$ . The length of  $\text{heightBytes}$  **MUST** be in the range  $\{1 \dots 5\}$ . Then the encoding is the length of  $\text{heightBytes}$  encoded as one byte, followed by  $\text{heightBytes}$  itself. This matches the encoding used by **Bitcoin** in the implementation of [BIP-34] (but the description here is to be considered normative).
- A *coinbase transaction* script **MUST** have length in  $\{2 \dots 100\}$  bytes.
- A *transparent input* in a non-*coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** have a null *prevout*.
- Every non-null *prevout* **MUST** point to a unique *UTXO* in either a preceding *block*, or a *previous transaction* in the same *block*.
- A *transaction* **MUST NOT** spend a *transparent output* of a *coinbase transaction* from a *block* less than 100 *blocks* prior to the spend. Note that *transparent outputs* of *coinbase transactions* include *Founders’ Reward outputs*, *transparent funding stream outputs* [ZIP-207], and *lockbox disbursement outputs* [ZIP-271].
- A *transaction* **MUST NOT** spend an output of the *genesis block coinbase transaction*. (There is one such zero-valued output, on each of *Testnet* and *Mainnet*.)
- [Overwinter to Canopy inclusive, pre-NU5]  $\text{nExpiryHeight}$  **MUST** be less than or equal to 499999999.

- [NU5 onward] `nExpiryHeight` **MUST** be less than or equal to 499999999 for non-coinbase *transactions*.
- [Overwinter onward] If a *transaction* is not a *coinbase transaction* and its `nExpiryHeight` field is nonzero, then it **MUST NOT** be mined at a *block height* greater than its `nExpiryHeight`.
- [NU5 onward] The `nExpiryHeight` field of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST** be equal to its *block height*.
- [Sapling onward] `valueBalanceSapling` **MUST** be in the range  $\{-\text{MAX\_MONEY} .. \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$ .
- [NU5 onward] `valueBalanceOrchard` **MUST** be in the range  $\{-\text{MAX\_MONEY} .. \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  for version 5 *transactions*.
- [Heartwood onward] All **Sapling** and **Orchard** outputs in *coinbase transactions* **MUST** decrypt to a *note plaintext*, i.e. the procedure in §4.20.3 ‘*Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 70 does not return  $\perp$ , using a sequence of 32 zero bytes as the *outgoing viewing key*. (This implies that before **Canopy** activation, **Sapling** outputs of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST** have *note plaintext lead byte* equal to 0x01.)
- [Canopy onward] Any **Sapling** or **Orchard** output of a *coinbase transaction* decrypted to a *note plaintext* according to the preceding rule **MUST** have *note plaintext lead byte* equal to 0x02. (This applies even during the “grace period” specified in [ZIP-212].)
- TODO: Other rules inherited from **Bitcoin**.

The types specified in §7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 122 are part of the consensus rules.

Consensus rules associated with each *JoinSplit* description (§7.2 ‘*JoinSplit Description Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 128), each *Spend* description (§7.3 ‘*Spend Description Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 128), each *Output* description (§7.4 ‘*Output Description Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 129), and each *Action* description (§7.5 ‘*Action Description Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 130) **MUST** also be followed.

#### Notes:

- Previous versions of this specification defined what is now the header field as a signed `int32` field which was required to be positive. The consensus rule that the `fOverwintered` flag **MUST NOT** be set before **Overwinter** has activated, has the same effect.
- The semantics of *transactions* with *version number* not equal to 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5 is not currently defined.
- The exclusion of *transactions* with *transaction version number* *greater than* 2 is not a consensus rule before **Overwinter** activation. Such *transactions* may exist in the *block chain* and **MUST** be treated identically to version 2 *transactions*.
- [Overwinter onward] Once **Overwinter** has activated, limits on the maximum *transaction version number* are consensus rules.
- The *transaction version number* 0x7FFFFFFF, and the *version group ID* 0xFFFFFFFF, are reserved for use in experimental extensions to *transaction* format or semantics on private testnets. They **MUST NOT** be used on the **Zcash** Mainnet or Testnet.
- Note that a future upgrade might use *any transaction version number* or *version group ID*. It is likely that an upgrade that changes the *transaction version number* or *version group ID* will also change the *transaction* format, and software that parses *transactions* **SHOULD** take this into account.
- [Overwinter onward] The purpose of *version group ID* is to allow unambiguous parsing of “loose” *transactions*, independent of the context of a *block chain*. Code that parses *transactions* is likely to be reused between *consensus branches* as defined in [ZIP-200], and in that case the `fOverwintered` and *version* fields alone may be insufficient to determine the format to be used for parsing.
- A *transaction version number* of 2 does not have the same meaning as in **Bitcoin**, where it is associated with support for `OP_CHECKSEQUENCEVERIFY` as specified in [BIP-68]. **Zcash** was forked from Bitcoin Core v0.11.2 and does not currently support BIP 68.
- [Sapling onward] Because *coinbase transactions* have no *Spend descriptions*, the `valueBalanceSapling` field of a *coinbase transaction* must have a negative or zero value. The negative case can only occur after **Heartwood** activation, for *transactions* with [ZIP-213] *shielded outputs*.



- Prior to the **Heartwood** network upgrade, it was not possible for *coinbase transactions* to have *shielded* outputs, and therefore the “coinbase maturity” rule and the requirement to spend coinbase outputs only in *transactions with no transparent outputs*, applied to *all* coinbase outputs.
- [Canopy onward] The rule that **Sapling** outputs in *coinbase transactions* **MUST** decrypt to a *note plaintext* with lead byte 0x02, also applies to *funding stream* outputs that specify **Sapling** *shielded payment addresses*, if there are any.
- [NU5 onward] The flags in `flagsOrchard` allow a version 5 *transaction* to declare that no funds are spent from **Orchard** *notes* (by setting `enableSpendsOrchard` to 0), or that no new **Orchard** *notes* with nonzero values are created (by setting `enableOutputsOrchard` to 0). This has two primary purposes. First, the `enableSpendsOrchard` flag is set to 0 in version 5 *coinbase transactions* to ensure that they cannot spend from existing **Orchard** outputs. This maintains a restriction present in *coinbase transactions* for *transparent*, **Sprout**, or **Sapling** funds, which would not otherwise be enforceable in the combined *Action transfer* design. Second, if a security vulnerability were found that affected only the input side, or only the output side of the *Action circuit*, it would be possible to use these flags in a soft fork (i.e. a strictly contracting consensus change) to effectively “switch off” non-zero-valued transfers only on the relevant side. Setting either of these flags to 0 does not affect the presence or validation of *spend authorization signatures*, or other consensus rules associated with *Action descriptions*. These *note* spending and creation consensus rules are specified as part of the **Orchard** *Action statement* (§ 4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p. 63).
- [NU5 onward] Because `enableSpendsOrchard` is set to 0 in version 5 *coinbase transactions* –which disables non-zero-valued **Orchard** spends– the `valueBalanceOrchard` field of a *coinbase transaction* must have a negative or zero value. The negative case can only occur for *transactions* with [ZIP-213] *shielded outputs*.
- [NU5 onward] The rule that `nSpendsSapling`, `nOutputsSapling`, and `nActionsOrchard` **MUST** all be less than  $2^{16}$ , is technically redundant because a *transaction* that could violate this rule would not fit within the 2 MB *block* size limit. It is included in order to simplify the security argument for balance preservation.
- [NU5 onward] The rule that from **NU5** activation, the `nExpiryHeight` field of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST** be equal to the *block height*, is needed to maintain the property that all *transactions* have unique *transaction IDs*. All non-coinbase *transactions* necessarily have some effecting data that is unique across all *transactions* in a *valid block chain*: either a `tx_in` referring to a previous unique `tx_out`, or a *Spend description* or *Action description* referring to a unique *nullifier*. However, *coinbase transactions* do not necessarily have any such unique *effecting* data; the *block height* encoded in the coinbase script is unique in a *valid block chain*, but for v5 *transactions*, it is not included in the *transaction ID* hash specified by [ZIP-244]. Requiring `nExpiryHeight` to be set to the *block height* ensures that the effecting data that contributes to the *transaction ID* is unique, even for v5 *coinbase transactions*. In order to avoid the *block height* being limited to 499999999, we also remove that bound on `nExpiryHeight` for *coinbase transactions*. For consistency, these changes apply to *all* *coinbase transactions*, not just v5 *coinbase transactions*.

The changes relative to **Bitcoin** version 1 *transactions* as described in [Bitcoin-Format] are:

- *Transaction version* 0 is not supported.
- A version 1 *transaction* is equivalent to a version 2 *transaction* with `nJoinSplit` = 0.
- The fields `nJoinSplit`, `vJoinSplit`, `joinSplitPubKey`, and `joinSplitSig` have been added.
- [Overwinter onward] The field `nVersionGroupId` has been added.
- [Sapling onward] The following fields have been added: `nSpendsSapling`, `vSpendsSapling`, `nOutputsSapling`, `vOutputsSapling`, and `bindingSigSapling`.
- [NU5 onward] In version 5 *transactions*, these fields have been added: `nConsensusBranchId`, `nActionsOrchard`, `vActionsOrchard`, `flagsOrchard`, `valueBalanceOrchard`, `anchorOrchard`, `sizeProofsOrchard`, `proofsOrchard`, `bindingSigOrchard`, and `vSpendAuthSigsOrchard`.
- In **Zcash** it is permitted for a *transaction* to have no *transparent inputs*, provided at least one of `nJoinSplit`, `nSpendsSapling`, `nOutputsSapling`, and `nActionsOrchard` are nonzero.
- A consensus rule limiting *transaction* size has been added. In **Bitcoin** there is a corresponding standard rule but no consensus rule.

## 7.2 JoinSplit Description Encoding and Consensus

An abstract *JoinSplit description*, as described in § 3.5 ‘*JoinSplit Transfers and Descriptions*’ on p. 19, is encoded in a *transaction* as an instance of a `JoinSplitDescription` type:

| Bytes | Name                        | Data Type                                | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8     | <code>vpub_old</code>       | <code>uint64</code>                      | A value $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$ that the <i>JoinSplit</i> transfer removes from the <i>transparent transaction value pool</i> .                                                                                                   |
| 8     | <code>vpub_new</code>       | <code>uint64</code>                      | A value $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$ that the <i>JoinSplit</i> transfer inserts into the <i>transparent transaction value pool</i> .                                                                                                   |
| 32    | <code>anchor</code>         | <code>byte[32]</code>                    | A root $rt^{\text{Sprout}}$ of the <b>Sprout</b> note commitment tree at some <i>block height</i> in the past, or the root produced by a previous <i>JoinSplit</i> transfer in this <i>transaction</i> .                                |
| 64    | <code>nullifiers</code>     | <code>byte[32] [N<sup>old</sup>]</code>  | A sequence of <i>nullifiers</i> of the input notes $nf_{1..N}^{\text{old}}$ .                                                                                                                                                           |
| 64    | <code>commitments</code>    | <code>byte[32] [N<sup>new</sup>]</code>  | A sequence of <i>note commitments</i> for the output notes $cm_{1..N}^{\text{new}}$ .                                                                                                                                                   |
| 32    | <code>ephemeralKey</code>   | <code>byte[32]</code>                    | A Curve25519 <i>public key</i> <code>epk</code> .                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 32    | <code>randomSeed</code>     | <code>byte[32]</code>                    | A 256-bit seed that must be chosen independently at random for each <i>JoinSplit description</i> .                                                                                                                                      |
| 64    | <code>vmacs</code>          | <code>byte[32] [N<sup>old</sup>]</code>  | A sequence of message authentication tags $h_{1..N}^{\text{old}}$ binding $h_{\text{sig}}$ to each $a_{\text{sk}}$ of the <i>JoinSplit description</i> , computed as described in § 4.11 ‘ <i>Non-malleability (Sprout)</i> ’ on p. 51. |
| 296 † | <code>zkproof</code>        | <code>byte[296]</code>                   | An encoding of the <i>zk-SNARK proof</i> $\pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}$ (see § 5.4.10.1 ‘BCTV14’ on p. 110).                                                                                                                                |
| 192 ‡ | <code>zkproof</code>        | <code>byte[192]</code>                   | An encoding of the <i>zk-SNARK proof</i> $\pi_{\text{ZKJoinSplit}}$ (see § 5.4.10.2 ‘Groth16’ on p. 111).                                                                                                                               |
| 1202  | <code>encCiphertexts</code> | <code>byte[601] [N<sup>new</sup>]</code> | A sequence of ciphertext components for the encrypted output notes, $C_{1..N}^{\text{enc}}$ .                                                                                                                                           |

† BCTV14 proofs are used when the *transaction version* is 2 or 3, i.e. before **Sapling** activation.

‡ Groth16 proofs are used when the *transaction version* is  $\geq 4$ , i.e. after **Sapling** activation.

The `ephemeralKey` and `encCiphertexts` fields together form the *transmitted notes ciphertext*, which is computed as described in § 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65.

Consensus rules applying to a *JoinSplit description* are given in § 4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40.

## 7.3 Spend Description Encoding and Consensus

Let `LEBS2OSP` be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

Let `reprJ` and `qJ` be as defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102.

Let `spendAuthSig` be the *spend authorization signature* for this *Spend* transfer, and let  $\pi_{\text{ZKSpnd}}$  be the *zk-SNARK proof* of the corresponding *Spend* statement. In a version 4 *transaction* these are encoded in the `spendAuthSig` field and `zkproof` field respectively of the *Spend description*. In a version 5 *transaction*, *spend authorization signatures* in `vSpendAuthSigsSapling` and *proofs* in `vSpendProofsSapling` are in one-to-one correspondence with *Spend descriptions* in `vSpendsSapling`.







## 7.6 Block Header Encoding and Consensus

The **Zcash** *block header* format is as follows (this should be read in the context of consensus rules later in the section):

| Bytes | Name                                                                                      | Data Type   | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4     | nVersion                                                                                  | int32       | The <i>block version number</i> indicates which set of <i>block</i> validation rules to follow. The current and only defined <i>block version number</i> for <b>Zcash</b> is 4.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 32    | hashPrevBlock                                                                             | byte[32]    | A SHA-256d hash in internal byte order of the previous <i>block's header</i> . This ensures no previous <i>block</i> can be changed without also changing this <i>block's header</i> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 32    | hashMerkleRoot                                                                            | byte[32]    | A SHA-256d hash in internal byte order. The merkle root is derived from the hashes of all <i>transactions</i> included in this <i>block</i> , ensuring that none of those <i>transactions</i> can be modified without modifying the <i>header</i> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 32    | hashReserved /<br>hashFinalSaplingRoot /<br>hashLightClientRoot /<br>hashBlockCommitments | byte[32]    | <b>[Pre-Sapling]</b> A reserved field, to be ignored.<br><b>[Sapling and Blossom only, pre-Heartwood]</b> The root $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}})$ of the <b>Sapling note commitment tree</b> corresponding to the final <b>Sapling treestate</b> of this <i>block</i> .<br><b>[Heartwood and Canopy only, pre-NU5]</b> The <b>hashChainHistoryRoot</b> of this <i>block</i> [ZIP-221].<br><b>[NU5 onward]</b> The <b>hashBlockCommitments</b> of this <i>block</i> [ZIP-244]. |
| 4     | nTime                                                                                     | uint32      | The <i>block timestamp</i> is a Unix epoch time (UTC) when the miner started hashing the <i>header</i> (according to the miner).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 4     | nBits                                                                                     | uint32      | An encoded version of the <i>target threshold</i> this <i>block's header</i> hash must be less than or equal to, in the same nBits format used by <b>Bitcoin</b> .<br>[Bitcoin-nBits]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 32    | nNonce                                                                                    | byte[32]    | An arbitrary field that miners can change to modify the <i>header</i> hash in order to produce a hash less than or equal to the <i>target threshold</i> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 3     | solutionSize                                                                              | compactSize | The size of an <i>Equihash</i> solution in bytes (always 1344).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1344  | solution                                                                                  | byte[1344]  | The <i>Equihash</i> solution.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

A *block* consists of a *block header* and a sequence of *transactions*. How *transactions* are encoded in a *block* is part of the Zcash *peer-to-peer protocol* but not part of the consensus protocol.

Let **ThresholdBits** be as defined in §7.7.3 ‘*Difficulty adjustment*’ on p. 134, and let **PoWMedianBlockSpan** be the constant defined in §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Define the *median-time-past* of a *block* to be the median (as defined in §7.7.3 ‘*Difficulty adjustment*’ on p. 134) of the **nTime** fields of the *preceding* **PoWMedianBlockSpan** *blocks* (or all preceding *blocks* if there are fewer than **PoWMedianBlockSpan**). The *median-time-past* of a *genesis block* is not defined.

### Consensus rules:

- The *block version number* **MUST** be greater than or equal to 4.
- For a *block* at *block height* *height*, *nBits* **MUST** be equal to `ThresholdBits(height)`.
- The *block* **MUST** pass the difficulty filter defined in §7.7.2 ‘*Difficulty filter*’ on p. 134.
- solution **MUST** represent a *valid Equihash solution* as defined in §7.7.1 ‘*Equihash*’ on p. 133.
- For each *block* other than the *genesis block*, *nTime* **MUST** be strictly greater than the *median-time-past* of that *block*.
- For each *block* at *block height* 2 or greater on *Mainnet*, or *block height* 653606 or greater on *Testnet*, *nTime* **MUST** be less than or equal to the *median-time-past* of that *block* plus  $90 \cdot 60$  seconds.
- The size of a *block* **MUST** be less than or equal to 2000000 bytes.
- [Sapling and Blossom only, pre-Heartwood] `hashLightClientRoot` **MUST** be  $\text{LEBS2OSP}_{256}(\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}})$  where  $\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is the root of the **Sapling** note commitment tree for the final **Sapling** treestate of this *block*.
- [Heartwood and Canopy only, pre-NU5] `hashLightClientRoot` **MUST** be set to the `hashChainHistoryRoot` for this *block*, as specified in [ZIP-221].
- [NU5 onward] `hashBlockCommitments` **MUST** be set to the value of `hashBlockCommitments` for this *block*, as specified in [ZIP-244].
- A *block* **MUST** have at least one *transaction*.
- The first *transaction* in a *block* **MUST** be a *coinbase transaction*, and subsequent *transactions* **MUST NOT** be *coinbase transactions*.
- TODO: Other rules inherited from **Bitcoin**.

In addition, a *full validator* **MUST NOT** accept *blocks* with *nTime* more than two hours in the future according to its clock. This is not strictly a consensus rule because it is nondeterministic, and clock time varies between nodes. Also note that a *block* that is rejected by this rule at a given point in time may later be accepted.

### Notes:

- The semantics of *blocks* with *block version number* not equal to 4 is not currently defined. Miners **MUST NOT** create such *blocks*.
- The exclusion of *blocks* with *block version number* *greater than* 4 is not a consensus rule; such *blocks* may exist in the *block chain* and **MUST** be treated identically to version 4 *blocks* by *full validators*. Note that a future upgrade might use *block version number* either greater than or less than 4. It is likely that such an upgrade will change the *block* header and/or *transaction* format, and software that parses *blocks* **SHOULD** take this into account.
- The *nVersion* field is a signed integer. (It was specified as unsigned in a previous version of this specification.) A future upgrade might use negative values for this field, or otherwise change its interpretation.
- There is no relation between the values of the *version* field of a *transaction*, and the *nVersion* field of a *block header*.
- Like other serialized fields of type *compactSize*, the *solutionSize* field **MUST** be encoded with the minimum number of bytes (3 in this case), and other encodings **MUST** be rejected. This is necessary to avoid a potential attack in which a miner could test several distinct encodings of each *Equihash* solution against the difficulty filter, rather than only the single intended encoding.
- As in **Bitcoin**, the *nTime* field **MUST** represent a time *strictly greater than* the median of the timestamps of the past `PoWMedianBlockSpan` *blocks*. The Bitcoin Developer Reference [Bitcoin-Block] was previously in error on this point, but has now been corrected.
- The rule limiting *nTime* to be no later than  $90 \cdot 60$  seconds after the *median-time-past* is a retrospective consensus change, applied as a soft fork in `zcashd` v2.1.1-1. It had not been violated by any *block* from the given *block heights* in the consensus *block chains* of either *Mainnet* or *Testnet*.
- There are no changes to the *block version number* or format for **Overwinter**.

- Although the *block version number* does not change for **Sapling**, the previously reserved (and ignored) field `hashReserved` has been repurposed for `hashFinalSaplingRoot`. There are no other format changes.
- There are no changes to the *block version number* or format for **Blossom**.
- For **Heartwood**, the `hashFinalSaplingRoot` field is renamed to `hashLightClientRoot`. Once **Heartwood** activates, the meaning of this field changes according to [ZIP-221].
- There are no changes to the *block version number* or format for **Canopy**.
- For **NU5**, the `hashLightClientRoot` field is renamed to `hashBlockCommitments`. Once **NU5** activates, the meaning of this field changes according to [ZIP-244].
- There are no changes to the *block version number* or format for **NU6**.
- There are no changes to the *block version number* or format for **NU6.1**.

The changes relative to **Bitcoin** version 4 blocks as described in [Bitcoin-Block] are:

- *Block versions* less than 4 are not supported.
- The `hashReserved` / `hashFinalSaplingRoot` / `hashLightClientRoot` / `hashBlockCommitments`, `solutionSize`, and `solution` fields have been added.
- The type of the `nNonce` field has changed from `uint32` to `byte` [32].
- The maximum *block* size has been doubled to 2000000 bytes.

## 7.7 Proof of Work

**Zcash** uses *Equihash* [BK2016] as its *proof-of-work*. The original motivations for changing the *proof-of-work* from SHA-256d used by **Bitcoin** were described in [WG2016].

A *block* satisfies the *proof-of-work* if and only if:

- The `solution` field encodes a *valid Equihash solution* according to §7.7.1 ‘*Equihash*’ on p. 133.
- The *block header* satisfies the difficulty check according to §7.7.2 ‘*Difficulty filter*’ on p. 134.

### 7.7.1 Equihash

An instance of the *Equihash* algorithm is parameterized by positive integers  $n$  and  $k$ , such that  $n$  is a multiple of  $k + 1$ . We assume  $k \geq 3$ .

The *Equihash* parameters for *Mainnet* and *Testnet* are  $n = 200, k = 9$ .

*Equihash* is based on a variation of the Generalized Birthday Problem [AR2017]: given a sequence  $X_1 \dots X_N$  of  $n$ -bit strings, find  $2^k$  distinct  $X_{i_j}$  such that  $\bigoplus_{j=1}^{2^k} X_{i_j} = 0$ .

In *Equihash*,  $N = 2^{\frac{n}{k+1}+1}$ , and the sequence  $X_1 \dots X_N$  is derived from the *block header* and a nonce.

Let `powheader` :=

|                                   |                                    |                                     |                             |  |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--|
| 32-bit <code>nVersion</code>      | 256-bit <code>hashPrevBlock</code> | 256-bit <code>hashMerkleRoot</code> |                             |  |
| 256-bit <code>hashReserved</code> | 32-bit <code>nTime</code>          | 32-bit <code>nBits</code>           | 256-bit <code>nNonce</code> |  |

For  $i \in \{1 \dots N\}$ , let  $X_i = \text{EquihashGen}_{n,k}(\text{powheader}, i)$ .

*EquihashGen* is instantiated in §5.4.1.11 ‘*Equihash Generator*’ on p. 85.

Define  $\text{l2BEBSP} : (\ell : \mathbb{N}) \times \{0 \dots 2^\ell - 1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell]}$  as in §5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

A valid Equihash solution is then a sequence  $i : \{1 \dots N\}^{2^k}$  that satisfies the following conditions:

Generalized Birthday condition  $\bigoplus_{i=1}^{2^k} X_{i_j} = 0$ .

## Algorithm Binding conditions

- For all  $r \in \{1 \dots k-1\}$ , for all  $w \in \{0 \dots 2^{k-r}-1\}$  :  $\bigoplus_{j=1}^{2^r} X_{i_{w \cdot 2^r + j}}$  has  $\frac{n \cdot r}{k+1}$  leading zeros; and
- For all  $r \in \{1 \dots k\}$ , for all  $w \in \{0 \dots 2^{k-r}-1\}$  :  $i_{w \cdot 2^r + 1} \dots i_{w \cdot 2^r + 2^{r-1}} < i_{w \cdot 2^r + 2^{r-1} + 1} \dots i_{w \cdot 2^r + 2^r}$  lexicographically.

Notes:

- This does not include a difficulty condition, because here we are defining validity of an *Equihash* solution independent of difficulty.
- Previous versions of this specification incorrectly specified the range of  $r$  to be  $\{1 \dots k-1\}$  for both parts of the algorithm binding condition. The implementation in `zcashd` was as intended.

An *Equi*hash solution with  $n = 200$  and  $k = 9$  is encoded in the solution field of a *block header* as follows:

|                                |                                |         |                                    |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------|
| $\text{I2BEBSP}_{21}(i_1 - 1)$ | $\text{I2BEBSP}_{21}(i_2 - 1)$ | $\dots$ | $\text{I2BEBSP}_{21}(i_{512} - 1)$ |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------|

Recall from § 5.2 ‘*Bit layout diagrams*’ on p. 73 that the bits in the above diagram are ordered from most to least significant in each byte. For example, if the first 3 elements of  $i$  are  $[69, 42, 2^{21}]$ , then the corresponding bit array is:

[illegible]

and so the first 7 bytes of solution would be [0, 2, 32, 0, 10, 127, 255].

**Note:** I2BEBSP is *big-endian*, while integer field encodings in powheader and in the instantiation of EquihashGen are *little-endian*. The rationale for this is that *little-endian* serialization of *block headers* is consistent with **Bitcoin**, but *little-endian* ordering of bits in the solution encoding would require bit-reversal (as opposed to only shifting).

### 7.7.2 Difficulty filter

Let ToTarget be as defined in §7.7.4 ‘*nBits conversion*’ on p.136.

Difficulty is defined in terms of a *target threshold*, which is adjusted for each *block* according to the algorithm defined in §7.7.3 ‘*Difficulty adjustment*’ on p.134.

The difficulty filter is unchanged from **Bitcoin**, and is calculated using SHA-256d on the whole *block header* (including `solutionSize` and `solution`). The result is interpreted as a 256-bit integer represented in *little-endian* byte order, which **MUST** be less than or equal to the *target threshold* given by `ToTarget(nBits)`.

### 7.7.3 Difficulty adjustment

The desired time between *blocks* is called the *block target spacing*. **Zcash** uses a difficulty adjustment algorithm based on DigiShield v3/v4 [DigiByte-PoW], with simplifications and altered parameters, to adjust difficulty to target the desired *block target spacing*. Unlike **Bitcoin**, the difficulty adjustment occurs after every *block*.

The constants `PoWLimit`, `PreBlossomHalvingInterval`, `PoWAveragingWindow`, `PoWMaxAdjustDown`, `PoWMaxAdjustUp`, `PoWDampingFactor`, `PreBlossomPoWTargetSpacing`, and `PostBlossomPoWTargetSpacing` are specified in section §5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p.74.



Let ToCompact and ToTarget be as defined in §7.7.4 ‘*nBits conversion*’ on p.136.

Let nTime(height) be the value of the nTime field in the *header* of the *block* at *block height* height.

Let nBits(height) be the value of the nBits field in the *header* of the *block* at *block height* height.

*Block header* fields are specified in §7.6 ‘*Block Header Encoding and Consensus*’ on p.131.

Define:

$$\text{mean}(S) := \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{\text{length}(S)} S_i}{\text{length}(S)}$$

$$\text{median}(S) := \text{sorted}(S)_{\text{ceiling}((\text{length}(S)+1)/2)}$$

$$\text{bound}_{\text{lower}}^{\text{upper}}(x) := \max(\text{lower}, \min(\text{upper}, x))$$

$$\text{trunc}(x) := \begin{cases} \text{floor}(x), & \text{if } x \geq 0 \\ -\text{floor}(-x), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{IsBlossomActivated}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := (\text{height} \geq \text{BlossomActivationHeight})$$

$$\text{BlossomPoWTargetSpacingRatio} := \frac{\text{PreBlossomPoWTargetSpacing}}{\text{PostBlossomPoWTargetSpacing}}$$

$$\text{PostBlossomHalvingInterval} := \text{floor}(\text{PreBlossomHalvingInterval} \cdot \text{BlossomPoWTargetSpacingRatio})$$

$$\text{PoWTargetSpacing}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} \text{PreBlossomPoWTargetSpacing}, & \text{if not IsBlossomActivated}(\text{height}) \\ \text{PostBlossomPoWTargetSpacing}, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{AveragingWindowTimespan}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{PoWAveragingWindow} \cdot \text{PoWTargetSpacing}(\text{height})$$

$$\text{MinActualTimespan}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{floor}(\text{AveragingWindowTimespan}(\text{height}) \cdot (1 - \text{PoWMaxAdjustUp}))$$

$$\text{MaxActualTimespan}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{floor}(\text{AveragingWindowTimespan}(\text{height}) \cdot (1 + \text{PoWMaxAdjustDown}))$$

$$\text{MedianTime}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{median}([\text{nTime}(i) \text{ for } i \text{ from } \max(0, \text{height} - \text{PoWMedianBlockSpan}) \text{ up to } \text{height} - 1])$$

$$\text{ActualTimespan}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{MedianTime}(\text{height}) - \text{MedianTime}(\text{height} - \text{PoWAveragingWindow})$$

$$\text{ActualTimespanDamped}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) :=$$

$$\text{AveragingWindowTimespan}(\text{height}) + \text{trunc}\left(\frac{\text{ActualTimespan}(\text{height}) - \text{AveragingWindowTimespan}(\text{height})}{\text{PoWDampingFactor}}\right)$$

$$\text{ActualTimespanBounded}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{bound}_{\text{MinActualTimespan}(\text{height})}^{\text{MaxActualTimespan}(\text{height})}(\text{ActualTimespanDamped}(\text{height}))$$

$$\text{MeanTarget}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} \text{PoWLimit}, & \text{if } \text{height} \leq \text{PoWAveragingWindow} \\ \text{mean}([\text{ToTarget}(\text{nBits}(i)) \text{ for } i \text{ from } \text{height} - \text{PoWAveragingWindow} \text{ up to } \text{height} - 1]), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The *target threshold* for a given *block height* height is then calculated as:

$$\text{Threshold}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} \text{PoWLimit}, & \text{if } \text{height} = 0 \\ \min(\text{PoWLimit}, \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{MeanTarget}(\text{height})}{\text{AveragingWindowTimespan}}\right) \cdot \text{ActualTimespanBounded}(\text{height})), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{ThresholdBits}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \text{ToCompact}(\text{Threshold}(\text{height})).$$

**Notes:**

- The convention used for the height parameters to the functions MedianTime, MeanTarget, ActualTimespan, ActualTimespanDamped, ActualTimespanBounded, Threshold, and ThresholdBits is that these functions use only information from *blocks preceding* the given *block height*.



- When the median function is applied to a sequence of even length (which only happens in the definition of MedianTime during the first PoWAveragingWindow – 1 blocks of the *block chain*), the element that begins the second half of the sequence is taken. This corresponds to the zcashd implementation, but was not specified correctly in versions of this specification prior to v2019.0.0.

On *Testnet* from *block height* 299188 onward, the difficulty adjustment algorithm is changed to allow minimum-difficulty blocks, as described in [ZIP-205]. The **Blossom network upgrade changes the minimum-difficulty time threshold to 6 times the block target spacing**, as described in [ZIP-208]. These changes do not apply to *Mainnet*.

## 7.7.4 nBits conversion

Deterministic conversions between a *target threshold* and a “compact” nBits value are not fully defined in the Bitcoin documentation [Bitcoin-nBits], and so we define them here:

$$\text{size}(x) := \text{ceiling}\left(\frac{\text{bitlength}(x)}{8}\right)$$

$$\text{mantissa}(x) := \text{floor}\left(x \cdot 2^{56 - \text{size}(x)}\right)$$

$$\text{ToCompact}(x) := \begin{cases} \text{mantissa}(x) + 2^{24} \cdot \text{size}(x), & \text{if } \text{mantissa}(x) < 2^{23} \\ \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{mantissa}(x)}{2^{24}}\right) + 2^{24} \cdot (\text{size}(x) + 1), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{ToTarget}(x) := \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } x \& 2^{23} = 2^{23} \\ (x \& (2^{23} - 1)) \cdot 2^{56 \cdot \text{floor}(x/2^{24}) - 3}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

## 7.7.5 Definition of Work

As explained in § 3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p. 18, a node chooses the “best” *block chain* visible to it by finding the chain of valid *blocks* with the greatest total work.

Let ToTarget be as defined in § 7.7.4 ‘*nBits conversion*’ on p. 136.

The work of a *block* with value nBits for the nBits field in its *block header* is defined as  $\text{floor}\left(\frac{2^{256}}{\text{ToTarget}(\text{nBits}) + 1}\right)$ .

## 7.8 Calculating Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, Lockbox Disbursement, and Founders’ Reward

In § 3.10 ‘*Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, and Founders’ Reward*’ on p. 22 the *block subsidy*, *miner subsidy*, *Founders’ Reward*, and *funding streams* are defined. Their amounts in *zatoshi* are calculated from the *block height* using the formulae below.

Let the constants SlowStartInterval, PreBlossomHalvingInterval, PostBlossomHalvingInterval, BlossomActivationHeight, MaxBlockSubsidy, and FoundersFraction be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let FundingStreams be as specified in § 7.10.1 ‘*ZIP 214 Funding Streams*’ on p. 140.

Let ZIP271ActivationHeight and ZIP271DisbursementAmount be as defined in [ZIP-271].

$$\text{SlowStartShift} : \mathbb{N} := \frac{\text{SlowStartInterval}}{2}$$

$$\text{SlowStartRate} : \mathbb{N} := \frac{\text{MaxBlockSubsidy}}{\text{SlowStartInterval}}$$

$$\text{Halving}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } \text{height} < \text{SlowStartShift} \\ \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{height} - \text{SlowStartShift}}{\text{PreBlossomHalvingInterval}}\right), & \text{if not IsBlossomActivated}(\text{height}) \\ \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{BlossomActivationHeight} - \text{SlowStartShift}}{\text{PreBlossomHalvingInterval}} + \frac{\text{height} - \text{BlossomActivationHeight}}{\text{PostBlossomHalvingInterval}}\right), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{BlockSubsidy}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} \text{SlowStartRate} \cdot \text{height}, & \text{if } \text{height} < \text{SlowStartShift} \\ \text{SlowStartRate} \cdot (\text{height} + 1), & \text{if } \text{SlowStartShift} \leq \text{height} \text{ and } \text{height} < \text{SlowStartInterval} \\ \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{MaxBlockSubsidy}}{2^{\text{Halving}(\text{height})}}\right), & \text{if } \text{SlowStartInterval} \leq \text{height} \text{ and not } \text{IsBlossomActivated}(\text{height}) \\ \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{MaxBlockSubsidy}}{\text{BlossomPoWTargetSpacingRatio} \cdot 2^{\text{Halving}(\text{height})}}\right), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{FoundersReward}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := \begin{cases} \text{BlockSubsidy}(\text{height}) \cdot \text{FoundersFraction}, & \text{if } \text{Halving}(\text{height}) < 1 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

for  $fs \in \text{FundingStreams}$ ,  $fs.\text{Value}(\text{height}) :=$

$$\begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } \text{height} < \text{CanopyActivationHeight} \\ \text{floor}\left(\text{BlockSubsidy}(\text{height}) \cdot \frac{fs.\text{Numerator}}{fs.\text{Denominator}}\right), & \text{if } fs.\text{StartHeight} \leq \text{height} \text{ and } \text{height} < fs.\text{EndHeight} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{totalDeferredOutput}(\text{height}) := \sum_{fs \in \text{FundingStreams} : fs.\text{Recipient}(\text{height}) = \text{DEFERRED\_POOL}} fs.\text{Value}(\text{height})$$

$$\text{totalDeferredInput}(\text{height}) := \begin{cases} \text{ZIP271DisbursementAmount}, & \text{if } \text{height} = \text{ZIP271ActivationHeight} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{MinerSubsidy}(\text{height}) := \text{BlockSubsidy}(\text{height}) - \text{FoundersReward}(\text{height}) - \sum_{fs \in \text{FundingStreams}} fs.\text{Value}(\text{height}).$$

## 7.9 Payment of Founders' Reward

The *Founders' Reward* is paid by a *transparent output* in the *coinbase transaction*, to one of `NumFounderAddresses` *transparent addresses*, depending on the *block height*.

For *Mainnet*, `FounderAddressList`<sub>1..NumFounderAddresses</sub> is:

```
[ "t3Vz22vK5z2LcKEdg16Yv4FFneEL1zg9oJd", "t3cL9AucCajm3HXDhb5jBnJK2vapVoXsop3",
  "t3fqvkzrrNaMcamkQMwAyHRjfdM2xQvDTR", "t3TgZ9ZT2CTSK44AnUPi6qeNaHa2eC7pUyF",
  "t3SpkcPQPfuYHsP5vz3Pv86PgKo5m9KVmx", "t3Xt4oQMRPagwbpQqkgAViQgtST4VoSWR6S",
  "t3ayBkZ4w6kKXynwoHZFUSSgXRktogTXNgb", "t3adJBQuaa21u7NxbR8YMzp3km3TbSZ4MGB",
  "t3K4aLYagSSBySdrfAGGeUd5H9z5Qvz88t2", "t3RYnsc5nhEvKiva3ZPhfRSk7eyh1CrA6Rk",
  "t3UUt4KUq2ZSMTPE67pBU5LqYCi2q36KpXQ", "t3ZnCNAvgu6CSyHm1vWtrx3aiN98dSAGpnD",
  "t3fB9cB3eSYim64BS9xfwAHQUKLgQQroBDG", "t3cwZfKNNj2vXMAHBQeewm6pXhKFdhk18kD",
  "t3YcoujXfspWy7rbNUSGKxFEWZqNstGpeG4", "t3bLvCLigc6rbNrUTS5NwkgyVrZcZumTRa4",
  "t3VvHWa7r3oy67YtU4LZKGCWa2J6eGHvShi", "t3eF9X6X2dSo7MCvTjffZEzWvRvZquxRLNeY",
  "t3esCNwmmcy8i9qQfyTbYhTqmYXZ9AwK3X", "t3M4jN7hYE2e27yLsuQPPjuVek81WV3VbBj",
  "t3gGWxdC67CYNoBbPjNvrrWLAwxPqZLxrVY", "t3LTWeoxeWPbmdkUD3NWBquk4WkazhFBmvU",
  "t3P5KKX97gXYFSaSJPIruQEX84yF5z3Tjq", "t3f3T3nCWsEpzmd35VK62JgQfFig74dV8C9",
  "t3Rqonuzz7afkF7156ZA4vi4iimRSEn41hj", "t3fJZ5jYsyxDtvNrWBeoMbvJaQCj4JJgbgX",
  "t3Pnbg7XjP7FGPBuuz75H65aczphHgkpoJW", "t3WeKQDxCijL5X7rwFem1MTL9ZwVJkUFhpF",
  "t3Y9FNi26J7UtAUC4moaETLbMo8KS1Be6ME", "t3aNRLLsL2y8xcjPheZZwFy3Pcv7CsTwBec",
  "t3gQDEavk5VzAAHK8TrQu2BWDLxEiF1unBm", "t3Rbykhx1TUFrgXrmBYrAJe2STxRKFL7G9r",
  "t3aaW4aTdP7a8d1VTE1Bod2yhbeggHgMajR", "t3YEiAa6uEjXwFL2v5ztU1fn3yKgzMQqNyo",
  "t3g1yUUwt2PbmDvMDevTCPWUcbDatL2iQGP", "t3dPWnep6YqGPuY1CecgbeZrY9iUwH8Yd4z",
  "t3QRZXHDP2hwU46iQs2776kRuuWfwFp4dV", "t3enhACRxi1ZD7e8ePomVGKn7wp7N9fFJ3r",
  "t3PkLgT71TnF112nSwBToXsD77yNbx2gJJY", "t3LQtHUDoe7ZhhvddRv4vnaoNAhCr2f4oFN",
  "t3fNcdBUbycbCtsD2n9q3LuxG7jVPvFB8L", "t3dKoJUU2EMjs28nHV84TvkVEUDu1M1FaEx",
  "t3aKH6NiWn1ofGd8c19rZiqgYpkJ3n679ME", "t3MEXDF9Wsi63KwpPuQdD6by32Mw2bNTbEa",
  "t3WDhPfik343yNmPTqtKZAoQZeqA83K7Y3f", "t3PSn5TbMMAEw7Eu36DYctFezRzpX1hzt3M",
  "t3R3Y5vnBLrEn8L6wFjpjBLnxSUQsKnmFpv", "t3Pcm737EsVkgTbhsu2NekKtJeG92mvYyoN" ]
```

For *Testnet*, `FounderAddressList`<sub>1..NumFounderAddresses</sub> is:

```
[ "t2UNzUUx8mWBCRYPRRezV4363EYXyEpHokyI", "t2N9PH9Wk9xjqYg9iin1Ua3aekJqfAtE543",
  "t2NGQjYMQhFndDHgUvUw4wZdNdssA6K7x2", "t2ENG7hHVqqs9JwU5cgjvSbxnT2a9USNfhy",
  "t2BkYdVCHzvTJJUTx4yZB8qeeGd8QsPx8bo", "t2J8q1xH1EuigJ52MfExyyjYtN3VgvsKdF",
  "t2Crq9mydTm37kZokC68HzT6yez3t2FBnFj", "t2EaMPUiQ1kthqcP5UEkF42CAFKJqXCkXC9",
  "t2F9dtQc63JDDyrhnfpzvVYTJcr57MkqA12", "t2LPirmnfYSZc481GgZBa6xUGcoovfytBnC",
  "t26xfxoSw2UV9Pe5o3C8V4YybQD4SESfxtP", "t2D3k4fNdErd66YxtvXEdft9xuLoKD7CcVo",
  "t2DWYBkxKNivdmsMiiVnJzutaQGqmoRjRnL", "t2C3kFF9iQRxfc4B9zgbWo4dQLLqzqjpuGQ",
  "t2MnT5tzU9HSKcppRyUNwoTp8MUueuSGNaB", "t2AREsWdoW1F8EQYsScsJkgqobmgrkKeUkK",
  "t2Vf4wKcJ3ZFtLj4jezUUKwYR92BLHn5UT", "t2K3fdViH6R5tRuXLphKyoYXyZhyWGghDNY",
  "t2VEn3KiKyHSGydz3nDw6ESWtaCQHwuv9WC", "t2F8XouqdNMq6zzEvxQXHV1TjwZRHwRg8gC",
  "t2BS7Mrbaef3fA4xrmkvDisFVXVRBnZ6QJ", "t2FuSwoLCdBVPwdZuYoHrEzxAb9qy4qjbnL",
  "t2SX3U8NtrT6gz5Db1AtQCSGjrpptR8JC6h", "t2V51gZNSoJ5kRL74bf9YTtbZuv8Fcqx2FH",
  "t2FyTsLjjdm4jeVwir4xzj7FAkUidbr1b4R", "t2EYbGLEkmpqHyn8UBF6kqpahrYm7D6N1Le",
  "t2NQTrStZHTJECNFT3dUBLYA9AerxPCmkka", "t2GSWZZJzoesYxfPTWXkFn5UaxjiYxGBU2a",
  "t2RpfkzyLRevGM3w9aWdqMX6bd8uuAK3vn", "t2JzjoQqnuXtTGSN7k7yk5keURBGvYofh1d",
  "t2AEefc72ieTnsXKmgK2bZNckiWvZe3oPNL", "t2NNs3ZGZFsNj2wvmVd8BSwSfvETgiLRd8J",
  "t2ECCQPvcxUCSSQopdNquguEPE14HsVfcUn", "t2JabDUkG8TaqVKYfqDJ3rqkVdHKp6hwXvG",
  "t2FGzW5Zdc8Cy98ZKmRygsVGi6oKcmYir9n", "t2DUD8a21FtEFn42oVlp5NGbogY13uyjy9t",
  "t2UjVSD3zheHPgAkUX8WQW2CiC9xHQ8EvWp", "t2TBUAhELyHUn8i6SXYsXz5Lmy7kDzA1uT5",
  "t2Tz3uCyhP6eizUWDc3bGH7XUC9GQsEyQnc", "t2NysJSZtLwMLWEJ6MH3BsXRh6h27mNcsSy",
  "t2KXJVVyyrjVxxSeazbY9ksGyft4qsXUNm9", "t2J9YYtH31cveiLZzjaE4AcuwVho6qjTNzp",
  "t2QgVw4sP9zaGpPMH1GRzy7cpydmuRfB4AZ", "t2NDTJP9MosKpyFPHJmfjc5pGCvAU58XGa4",
  "t29pHDBWq7qN4EjwSEHG8wEqYe9pkmVrtRP", "t2Ez9KM8VJLuArcxuEkNRakhNvidKkzXcjJ",
  "t2D5y7J5fpXajLbGrMBQkFg2mFN8fo3n8cX", "t2UV2wr1PTaUiypbkV3FdSdGxUJeZdZztyt" ]
```

**Note:** For *Testnet* only, the addresses from index 4 onward have been changed from what was implemented at launch. This reflects an upgrade on *Testnet*, starting from *block height* 53127. [Zcash-Issue2113]

Each address representation in `FounderAddressList` denotes a *transparent P2SH multisig address*.

Let `SlowStartShift` and `Halving` be defined as in the previous section.

Define:

$$\text{FounderAddressChangeInterval} := \text{ceiling} \left( \frac{\text{SlowStartShift} + \text{PreBlossomHalvingInterval}}{\text{NumFounderAddresses}} \right)$$

$$\text{FounderAddressAdjustedHeight}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) :=$$

$$\begin{cases} \text{height}, & \text{if not } \text{IsBlossomActivated}(\text{height}), \\ \text{BlossomActivationHeight} + \text{floor} \left( \frac{\text{height} - \text{BlossomActivationHeight}}{\text{BlossomPoWTargetSpacingRatio}} \right), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\text{FounderAddressIndex}(\text{height} : \mathbb{N}) := 1 + \text{floor} \left( \frac{\text{FounderAddressAdjustedHeight}(\text{height})}{\text{FounderAddressChangeInterval}} \right)$$

$$\text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight} := \max(\{\text{height} : \mathbb{N} \mid \text{Halving}(\text{height}) < 1\}).$$

Let `FounderRedeemScriptHash`(*height* :  $\mathbb{N}$ ) be the *standard redeem script* hash, as specified in [Bitcoin-Multisig], for the *P2SH multisig address* with *Base58Check* form given by `FounderAddressList`<sub>`FounderAddressIndex`(*height*)</sub>.

**Consensus rule:** [Pre-Canopy] A coinbase transaction at *height*  $\in \{1 \dots \text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight}\}$  **MUST** include at least one output that pays exactly `FoundersReward`(*height*) *zatoshi* with a *standard P2SH script* of the form `OP_HASH160 FounderRedeemScriptHash`(*height*) `OP_EQUAL` as its *scriptPubKey*.

#### Notes:

- No *Founders' Reward* is required to be paid for height  $> \text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight}$  (i.e. after the first halving), or for height  $= 0$  (i.e. the *genesis block*), or after **Canopy** activation.
- The *Founders' Reward* addresses are not treated specially in any other way, and there can be other outputs to them, in *coinbase transactions* or otherwise. In particular, it is valid for a *coinbase transaction* with height  $\in \{1 \dots \text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight}\}$  to have other outputs, possibly to the same address, that do not meet the criterion in the above consensus rule, as long as at least one output meets it.
- The assertion  $\text{FounderAddressIndex}(\text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight}) \leq \text{NumFounderAddresses}$  holds, ensuring that the *Founders' Reward* address index remains in range for the whole period in which the *Founders' Reward* is paid.

#### Non-normative notes:

- **[Blossom onward]**  $\text{FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight} = 1046399$ .
- **Blossom** is not intended to change the total *Founders' Reward* or the effective period over which it is paid.

## 7.10 Payment of Funding Streams, Deferred Lockbox, and Lockbox Disbursement

Let  $\text{PostBlossomHalvingInterval}$  be as defined in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74.

Let  $\text{Halving}$  be as defined in § 7.8 on p. 136.

Let  $\text{ZIP271ActivationHeight}$ ,  $\text{ZIP271DisbursementAmount}$ ,  $\text{ZIP271DisbursementChunks}$ , and  $\text{ZIP271DisbursementAddress}$  be as defined for the relevant network (*Mainnet* or *Testnet*) in [ZIP-271].

[ZIP-207] defines a consensus mechanism to require *coinbase transactions* to include *funding stream* outputs, intended to provide funds from issuance for Zcash development. [ZIP-2001] extended this mechanism to support directing funds from issuance into a reserve, the *deferred development fund lockbox*. [ZIP-271] defines a one-time disbursement of funds from this lockbox in order to support the Community And Coinholder Funding Model [ZIP-1016].

The *funding streams* are paid to one of a pre-defined set of recipients, depending on the *block height*. Each recipient identifier is either the string encoding of an address to be paid by an output in the *coinbase transaction*, or the identifier `DEFERRED_POOL`. The latter indicates that the value is to be paid into the *deferred development fund lockbox*.

A *funding stream*  $fs$  is defined by a *block subsidy* fraction (represented as a numerator and denominator), a start *block height* (inclusive), an end *block height* (exclusive), and a sequence of recipients:

$fs.\text{Numerator} : \mathbb{N}^+$   
 $fs.\text{Denominator} : \mathbb{N}^+$   
 $fs.\text{StartHeight} : \mathbb{N}$   
 $fs.\text{EndHeight} : \mathbb{N}$   
 $fs.\text{Recipients} : (\mathbb{B}^Y[\mathbb{N}] \cup \{\text{DEFERRED\_POOL}\})^{[\mathbb{N}^+]}$ .

Define:

$\text{HeightForHalving}(\text{halving} : \mathbb{N}^+) := \min(\{\text{height} : \mathbb{N} \mid \text{Halving}(\text{height}) = \text{halving}\})$   
 $\text{FSRecipientChangeInterval} := \text{PostBlossomHalvingInterval} / 48$   
 $\text{FSRecipientPeriod}(\text{height}) := \text{floor}\left(\frac{\text{height} - (\text{HeightForHalving}(1) - \text{PostBlossomHalvingInterval})}{\text{FSRecipientChangeInterval}}\right)$ .



| Stream       | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|--------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_ZIP214_BP | 7         | 100         | 1046400      | 2726400    |
| FS_ZIP214_ZF | 5         | 100         | 1046400      | 2726400    |
| FS_ZIP214_MG | 8         | 100         | 1046400      | 2726400    |

It also defines these *funding streams* for *Testnet*:

| Stream       | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|--------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_ZIP214_BP | 7         | 100         | 1028500      | 2796000    |
| FS_ZIP214_ZF | 5         | 100         | 1028500      | 2796000    |
| FS_ZIP214_MG | 8         | 100         | 1028500      | 2796000    |

#### Notes:

- The *block heights* of *halvings* are different between *Testnet* and *Mainnet*, as a result of different *activation block heights* for the **Blossom** network upgrade (which changed the *block target spacing*). The end height of these *funding streams* corresponds to the second *halving* on each network.
- On *Testnet*, the *activation block height* of **Canopy** is before the first *halving*. Therefore, the consequence of the above rules for *Testnet* is that the amount sent to each **Zcash** Development Fund recipient address will initially (before *Testnet block height* 1116000) be double the number of currency units as the corresponding initial amount on *Mainnet*. This reduces to the same number of currency units as on *Mainnet*, from *Testnet block heights* 1116000 (inclusive) to 2796000 (exclusive).

[**NU6** onward] [ZIP-214] Revision 1 defines these *funding streams* for *Mainnet*:

| Stream      | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|-------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_FPF_ZCG  | 8         | 100         | 2726400      | 3146400    |
| FS_DEFERRED | 12        | 100         | 2726400      | 3146400    |

It also defines these *funding streams* for *Testnet*:

| Stream      | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|-------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_FPF_ZCG  | 8         | 100         | 2976000      | 3396000    |
| FS_DEFERRED | 12        | 100         | 2976000      | 3396000    |

**Note:** The new funding streams begin at the second halving for Mainnet, but the second halving on Testnet occurred prior to the introduction of the new funding streams. For both new funding streams on each network, the associated duration corresponds to approximately one year's worth of blocks.

[**NU6.1** onward] [ZIP-214] Revision 2 defines these *funding streams* for *Mainnet*:

| Stream        | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|---------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_FPF_ZCG_H3 | 8         | 100         | 3146400      | 4406400    |
| FS_CCF_H3     | 12        | 100         | 3146400      | 4406400    |

It also defines these *funding streams* for *Testnet*:

| Stream        | Numerator | Denominator | Start height | End height |
|---------------|-----------|-------------|--------------|------------|
| FS_FPF_ZCG_H3 | 8         | 100         | 3536500      | 4476000    |
| FS_CCF_H3     | 12        | 100         | 3536500      | 4476000    |



## 7.11 Changes to the Script System

The `OP_CODESEPARATOR` opcode has been disabled. This opcode also no longer affects the calculation of *SIGHASH transaction hashes*.

## 7.12 Bitcoin Improvement Proposals

In general, Bitcoin Improvement Proposals (BIPs) do not apply to **Zcash** unless otherwise specified in this section.

All of the BIPs referenced below should be interpreted by replacing “BTC”, or “bitcoin” used as a currency unit, with “ZEC”; and “satoshi” with “zatoshi”.

The following BIPs apply, otherwise unchanged, to **Zcash**: [BIP-11], [BIP-14], [BIP-31], [BIP-35], [BIP-37], [BIP-61].

The following BIPs apply starting from the **Zcash** *genesis block*, i.e. any activation rules or exceptions for particular *blocks* in the **Bitcoin** *block chain* are to be ignored: [BIP-16], [BIP-30], [BIP-65], [BIP-66].

The effect of [BIP-34] has been incorporated into the consensus rules (§ 7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124). This excludes the *Mainnet* and *Testnet* *genesis blocks*, for which the “height in coinbase” was inadvertently omitted.

[BIP-13] applies with the changes to address version bytes described in § 5.6.1.1 ‘*Transparent Addresses*’ on p. 113.

[BIP-111] applies from *peer-to-peer protocol* version 170004 onward; that is:

- references to protocol version 70002 are to be replaced by 170003;
- references to protocol version 70011 are to be replaced by 170004;
- the reference to protocol version 70000 is to be ignored (**Zcash** nodes have supported Bloom-filtered connections since launch).

## 8 Differences from the Zerocash paper

### 8.1 Transaction Structure

**Zerocash** introduces two new operations, which are described in the paper as new transaction types, in addition to the original transaction type of the cryptocurrency on which it is based (e.g. **Bitcoin**).

In **Zcash**, there is only the original **Bitcoin** transaction type, which is extended to contain a sequence of zero or more **Zcash**-specific operations.

This allows for the possibility of chaining transfers of *shielded* value in a single **Zcash** *transaction*, e.g. to spend a *shielded note* that has just been created. (In **Zcash**, we refer to value stored in *UTXOs* as *transparent*, and value stored in output *notes* of *JoinSplit* transfers or *Output transfers* as *shielded*.) This was not possible in the **Zerocash** design without using multiple transactions. It also allows *transparent* and *shielded* transfers to happen atomically — possibly under the control of nontrivial script conditions, at some cost in distinguishability.

Computation of *SIGHASH transaction hashes*, as described in § 4.10 ‘*SIGHASH Transaction Hashing*’ on p. 50, was changed to clean up handling of an error case for `SIGHASH_SINGLE`, to remove the special treatment of `OP_CODESEPARATOR`, and to include **Zcash**-specific fields in the hash [ZIP-76].

### 8.2 Memo Fields

**Zcash** adds a *memo field* sent from the creator of a *JoinSplit* *description* to the recipient of each output *note*. This feature is described in more detail in § 3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15.



## 8.3 Unification of Mints and Pours

In the original **Zerocash** protocol, there were two kinds of transaction relating to *shielded notes*:

- a “Mint” transaction takes value from *UTXOs* (*unspent transaction outputs*) as input and produces a new *shielded note* as output.
- a “Pour” transaction takes up to  $N^{\text{old}}$  *shielded notes* as input, and produces up to  $N^{\text{new}}$  *shielded notes* and a *UTXO* as output.

Only “Pour” transactions included a *zk-SNARK* proof.

**[Pre-Sapling]** In **Zcash**, the sequence of operations added to a *transaction* (see § 8.1 “*Transaction Structure*” on p. 142) consists only of *JoinSplit transfers*. A *JoinSplit transfer* is a Pour operation generalized to take a *UTXO* as input, allowing *JoinSplit transfers* to subsume the functionality of Mints. An advantage of this is that a **Zcash** *transaction* that takes input from a *UTXO* can produce up to  $N^{\text{new}}$  output *notes*, improving the indistinguishability properties of the protocol. A related change conceals the input arity of the *JoinSplit transfer*: an unused (zero-valued) input is indistinguishable from an input that takes value from a *note*.

This unification also simplifies the fix to the Faerie Gold attack described below, since no special case is needed for Mints.

**[Sapling onward]** In **Sapling**, there are still no “Mint” transactions. Instead of *JoinSplit transfers*, there are *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers*. These make use of *Pedersen value commitments* to represent the shielded values that are transferred. Because these commitments are additively homomorphic, it is possible to check that all *Spend transfers* and *Output transfers* balance; see § 4.13 “*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*” on p. 52 for detail. This reduces the granularity of the circuit, allowing a substantial performance improvement (orthogonal to other **Sapling** circuit improvements) when the numbers of *shielded* inputs and outputs are significantly different. This comes at the cost of revealing the exact number of *shielded* inputs and outputs, but *dummy* (zero-valued) outputs are still possible.

## 8.4 Faerie Gold attack and fix

When a *shielded note* is created in **Zerocash**, the creator is supposed to choose a new  $\rho$  value at random. The *nullifier* of the *note* is derived from its *spending key* ( $a_{sk}$ ) and  $\rho$ . The *note commitment* is derived from the recipient address component  $a_{pk}$ , the value  $v$ , and the *commitment trapdoor*  $rcm$ , as well as  $\rho$ . However nothing prevents creating multiple *notes* with different  $v$  and  $rcm$  (hence different *note commitments*) but the same  $\rho$ .

An adversary can use this to mislead a *note* recipient, by sending two *notes* both of which are verified as valid by Receive (as defined in [BCGGMTV2014, Figure 2]), but only one of which can be spent.

We call this a “Faerie Gold” attack — referring to various Celtic legends in which faeries pay mortals in what appears to be gold, but which soon after reveals itself to be leaves, gorse blossoms, gingerbread cakes, or other less valuable things [LG2004].

This attack does not violate the security definitions given in [BCGGMTV2014]. The issue could be framed as a problem either with the definition of Completeness, or the definition of Balance:

- The Completeness property asserts that a validly received *note* can be spent provided that its *nullifier* does not appear on the ledger. This does not take into account the possibility that distinct *notes*, which are validly received, could have the same *nullifier*. That is, the security definition depends on a protocol detail — *nullifiers* — that is not part of the intended abstract security property, and that could be implemented incorrectly.
- The Balance property only asserts that an adversary cannot obtain *more* funds than they have minted or received via payments. It does not prevent an adversary from causing others’ funds to decrease. In a Faerie Gold attack, an adversary can cause spending of a *note* to reduce (to zero) the effective value of another *note* for which the adversary does not know the *spending key*, which violates an intuitive conception of global balance.

These problems with the security definitions need to be repaired; how to do so is discussed in [Hopwood2022], but that is outside the scope of this specification. Here we only describe how **Zcash** addresses the immediate attack.

It would be possible to address the attack by requiring that a recipient remember all of the  $\rho$  values for all *notes* they have ever received, and reject duplicates (as proposed in [GGM2016]). However, this requirement would interfere with the intended **Zcash** feature that a holder of a *spending key* can recover access to (and be sure that they are able to spend) all of their funds, even if they have forgotten everything but the *spending key*.

[**Sprout**] Instead, **Zcash** enforces that an adversary must choose distinct values for each  $\rho$ , by making use of the fact that all of the *nullifiers* in *JoinSplit descriptions* that appear in a *valid block chain* must be distinct. This is true regardless of whether the *nullifiers* corresponded to real or *dummy notes* (see §4.8.1 ‘*Dummy Notes (Sprout)*’ on p. 47). The *nullifiers* are used as input to  $\text{hSigCRH}$  to derive a public value  $\text{h}_{\text{sig}}$  which uniquely identifies the transaction, as described in §4.3 ‘*JoinSplit Descriptions*’ on p. 40. ( $\text{h}_{\text{sig}}$  was already used in **Zerocash** in a way that requires it to be unique in order to maintain indistinguishability of *JoinSplit descriptions*; adding the *nullifiers* to the input of the hash used to calculate it has the effect of making this uniqueness property robust even if the *transaction creator* is an adversary.)

[**Sprout**] The  $\rho$  value for each output *note* is then derived from a random private seed  $\phi$  and  $\text{h}_{\text{sig}}$  using  $\text{PRF}_{\phi}^{\rho}$ . The correct construction of  $\rho$  for each output *note* is enforced by §4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60 in the *JoinSplit statement*.

[**Sprout**] Now even if the creator of a *JoinSplit description* does not choose  $\phi$  randomly, uniqueness of *nullifiers* and *collision resistance* of both  $\text{hSigCRH}$  and  $\text{PRF}^{\rho}$  will ensure that the derived  $\rho$  values are unique, at least for any two *JoinSplit descriptions* that get into a *valid block chain*. This is sufficient to prevent the Faerie Gold attack.

A variation on the attack attempts to cause the *nullifier* of a sent *note* to be repeated, without repeating  $\rho$ . However, since the *nullifier* is computed as  $\text{PRF}_{\text{ask}}^{\text{nfSprout}}(\rho)$  or  $\text{PRF}_{\text{nk}}^{\text{nfSapling}}(\rho^*)$  (for **Orchard**, see below); this is only possible if the adversary finds a collision across both inputs on  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$  or  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}$ , which is assumed to be infeasible — see §4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.

[**Sprout**] Crucially, “*nullifier integrity*” is enforced whether or not the  $\text{enforceMerklePath}_i$  flag is set for an input *note* (§4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60). If this were not the case then an adversary could perform the attack by creating a zero-valued *note* with a repeated *nullifier*, since the *nullifier* would not depend on the value.

[**Sprout**] *Nullifier integrity* also prevents a “roadblock attack” in which the adversary sees a victim’s *transaction*, and is able to publish another *transaction* that is mined first and blocks the victim’s *transaction*. This attack would be possible if the public value(s) used to enforce uniqueness of  $\rho$  could be chosen arbitrarily by the *transaction creator*: the victim’s *transaction*, rather than the adversary’s, would be considered to be repeating these values. In the chosen solution that uses *nullifiers* for these public values, they are enforced to be dependent on *spending keys* controlled by the original *transaction creator* (whether or not each input *note* is a *dummy*), and so a roadblock attack cannot be performed by another party who does not know these keys.

[**Sapling onward**] In **Sapling**, uniqueness of  $\rho$  is ensured by making it dependent on the position of the *note commitment* in the **Sapling note commitment tree**. Specifically,  $\rho = \text{cm} + [\text{pos}] \mathcal{J}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , where  $\mathcal{J}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is a generator independent of the generators used in  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ . Therefore,  $\rho$  commits uniquely to the *note* and its position, and this commitment is *collision-resistant* by the same argument used to prove *collision resistance* of *Pedersen hashes*. Note that it is possible for two distinct **Sapling positioned notes** (having different  $\rho$  values and *nullifiers*, but different *note positions*) to have the same *note commitment*, but this causes no security problem. Roadblock attacks are not possible because a given *note position* does not repeat for outputs of different *transactions* in the same *block chain*. Note that this depends on the fact that the value is bound by the *note commitment*: it could be the case that the adversary uses a *dummy note* that is not required to have a *note commitment* in the *note commitment tree* when it is spent. If this happens and the victim’s *note* is not a *dummy*, the *note commitments* will differ and so will the *nullifiers*. If both *notes* are dummies, the adversary cannot know the inputs to the *note commitment* since they are generated at random for the victim’s spend, regardless of the adversary’s potential knowledge of viewing keys.

[**NU5 onward**] In **Orchard**, the *nullifier* is computed using a construction that combines elliptic curve cryptography and the Poseidon-based  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  in a way that, for privacy, aims to provide defence in depth against potential weaknesses in either (see [Zcash-Orchard, Section 3.5 Nullifiers] and §4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58).

Resistance to Faerie Gold attacks, on the other hand, depends entirely on hardness of the *Discrete Logarithm Problem*. The  $\rho$  value of a *note* created in a given *Action transfer* is obtained from the *nullifier* of the *note* spent in that *Action transfer*; this ensures (without any cryptographic assumption) that all  $\rho$  values of *notes* added to the *note commitment tree* are unique. Then, the *nullifier* derivation can be considered as computing a vector Pedersen commitment on input that includes  $\rho$ , so that the *binding* property of that *commitment scheme* ensures that **Orchard** *nullifiers* will be unique. (Specifically, this is a Sinsemilla commitment with an additional term having base  $\mathcal{K}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , truncated to its  $x$ -coordinate. The  $x$ -coordinate truncation cannot harm *collision resistance* because, assuming hardness of the *Discrete Logarithm Problem* on the Pallas curve, §5.4.1.9 ‘*Security argument*’ on p. 82 covers the case where the additional term is added.) Roadblock attacks are not possible because  $\rho$  does not repeat for *notes* in the *note commitment tree*, and by a corresponding argument to **Sapling** for *dummy notes*.

## 8.5 Internal hash collision attack and fix

The **Zerocash** security proof requires that the composition of  $\text{COMM}_{\text{rcm}}$  and  $\text{COMM}_s$  is a computationally *binding* commitment to its inputs  $a_{\text{pk}}$ ,  $v$ , and  $\rho$ . However, the instantiation of  $\text{COMM}_{\text{rcm}}$  and  $\text{COMM}_s$  in section 5.1 of the paper did not meet the definition of a *binding* commitment at a 128-bit security level. Specifically, the internal hash of  $a_{\text{pk}}$  and  $\rho$  is truncated to 128 bits (motivated by providing statistical *hiding* security). This allows an attacker, with a work factor on the order of  $2^{64}$ , to find distinct pairs  $(a_{\text{pk}}, \rho)$  and  $(a'_{\text{pk}}, \rho')$  with colliding outputs of the truncated hash, and therefore the same *note commitment*. This would have allowed such an attacker to break the Balance property by *double-spending notes*, potentially creating arbitrary amounts of currency for themselves [HW2016].

**Zcash** uses a simpler construction with a single hash evaluation for the commitment: SHA-256 for **Sprout** *notes*, **PedersenHashToPoint** for **Sapling** *notes*, and **SinsemillaHashToPoint** for **Orchard** *notes*. The motivation for the nested construction in **Zerocash** was to allow Mint transactions to be publically verified without requiring zk-SNARK proofs (BCGGMTV2014, section 1.3, under step 3). Since **Zcash** combines “Mint” and “Pour” transactions into generalized *JoinSplit* transfers (for **Sprout**), or *Spend transfers and Output transfers* (for **Sapling**), or *Action transfers* (for **Orchard**), and each transfer always uses a zk-SNARK proof, **Zcash** does not require the nesting. A side benefit is that this reduces the cost of computing the *note commitments*: for **Sprout** it reduces the number of SHA256Compress evaluations needed to compute each *note commitment* from three to two, saving a total of four SHA256Compress evaluations in the *JoinSplit statement*.

**[Sprout] Note:** The full SHA-256 algorithm is used for  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$ , with randomness appended after the commitment input. The commitment input can be split into two blocks, call them  $x$  of length 64 bytes, and  $y$  of the remaining length (9 bytes). Let  $\text{COMM}'_r(z : \mathbb{B}^{41})$  be the *commitment scheme* that applies SHA256Compress with the first 32 bytes of  $z$  in the IV, and the rest of  $z$  (9 bytes), the randomness  $r$  (32 bytes), and padding up to 64 bytes in the SHA256Compress input block. Then we have  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}_r(x || y) = \text{COMM}'_r(\text{SHA256Compress}(x) || y)$ . Suppose we make the reasonable assumption that  $\text{COMM}'$  is a computationally *binding* and *hiding* *commitment scheme*. If SHA256Compress is *collision-resistant* with the standard IV<sup>14</sup>, then  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is as secure for *binding* as  $\text{COMM}'$ . Also  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is as secure for *hiding* as  $\text{COMM}'$  (without any assumption on SHA256Compress). This effectively rules out potential concerns about the Merkle–Damgård structure [Damgård1989] of SHA-256 causing any security problem for  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$ .

**[Sprout] Note:** **Sprout** *note commitments* are not statistically *hiding*, so for **Sprout** *notes*, **Zcash** does not support the “everlasting anonymity” property described in [BCGGMTV2014, section 8.1], even when used as described in that section. While it is possible to define a statistically *hiding*, computationally *binding* *commitment scheme* for this use at a 128-bit security level, the overhead of doing so within the *JoinSplit statement* was not considered to justify the benefits.

**[Sapling onward]** In **Sapling**, **Pedersen** or **Sinsemilla** commitments are used instead of SHA256Compress. These commitments are statistically *hiding*, and so “everlasting anonymity” is supported for **Sapling** and **Orchard** *notes* under the same conditions as in **Zerocash** (by the protocol, not necessarily by zcashd). Note that *diversified payment addresses* can be linked if the *Decisional Diffie–Hellman Problem* on the Jubjub curve or the Pallas curve can be broken.

<sup>14</sup>If SHA256Compress is not *collision-resistant* with the standard IV, then SHA-256 is not *collision-resistant* for a 2-block input.

## 8.6 Changes to PRF inputs and truncation

The format of inputs to the *PRFs* instantiated in § 5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 86 has changed relative to **Zerocash**. There is also a requirement for another *PRF*,  $\text{PRF}^p$ , which must be domain-separated from the others.

In the **Zerocash** protocol,  $\rho_i^{\text{old}}$  is truncated from 256 to 254 bits in the input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{sn}}$  (which corresponds to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$  in **Zcash**). Also,  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  is truncated from 256 to 253 bits in the input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$ . These truncations are not taken into account in the security proofs.

Both truncations affect the validity of the proof sketch for Lemma D.2 in the proof of Ledger Indistinguishability in [BCGGMTV2014, Appendix D].

In more detail:

- In the argument relating **H** and  $\mathcal{D}_2$ , it is stated that in  $\mathcal{D}_2$ , “for each  $i \in \{1, 2\}$ ,  $\text{sn}_i := \text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{sn}}(\rho)$  for a random (and not previously used)  $\rho$ ”. It is also argued that “the calls to  $\text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{sn}}$  are each by definition unique”. The latter assertion depends on the fact that  $\rho$  is “not previously used”. However, the argument is incorrect because the truncated input to  $\text{PRF}_{a_{\text{sk}}}^{\text{sn}}$ , i.e.  $[\rho]_{254}$ , may repeat even if  $\rho$  does not.
- In the same argument, it is stated that “with overwhelming probability,  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  is unique”. In fact what is required to be unique is the truncated input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$ , i.e.  $[h_{\text{Sig}}]_{253} = [\text{CRH}(\text{pk}_{\text{Sig}})]_{253}$ . In practice this value will be unique under a plausible assumption on CRH provided that  $\text{pk}_{\text{Sig}}$  is chosen randomly, but no formal argument for this is presented.

Note that  $\rho$  is truncated in the input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{sn}}$  but not in the input to  $\text{COMM}_{\text{rcm}}$ , which further complicates the analysis.

As further evidence that it is essential for the proofs to explicitly take any such truncations into account, consider a slightly modified protocol in which  $\rho$  is truncated in the input to  $\text{COMM}_{\text{rcm}}$  but not in the input to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{sn}}$ . In that case, it would be possible to violate balance by creating two *notes* for which  $\rho$  differs only in the truncated bits. These *notes* would have the same *note commitment* but different *nullifiers*, so it would be possible to spend the same value twice.

[**Sprout**] For resistance to Faerie Gold attacks as described in § 8.4 ‘*Faerie Gold attack and fix*’ on p. 143, **Zcash** depends on *collision resistance* of  $h_{\text{Sig}}\text{CRH}$  and  $\text{PRF}^p$  (instantiated using BLAKE2b-256 and SHA256Compress respectively). *Collision resistance* of a truncated hash does not follow from *collision resistance* of the original hash, even if the truncation is only by one bit. This motivated avoiding truncation along any path from the inputs to the computation of  $h_{\text{Sig}}$  to the uses of  $\rho$ .

[**Sprout**] Since the *PRFs* are instantiated using SHA256Compress which has an input block size of 512 bits (of which 256 bits are used for the *PRF* input and 4 bits are used for domain separation), it was necessary to reduce the size of the *PRF* key to 252 bits. The key is set to  $a_{\text{sk}}$  in the case of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$ ,  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSprout}}$ , and  $\text{PRF}^{\text{pk}}$ , and to  $\phi$  (which does not exist in **Zerocash**) for  $\text{PRF}^p$ , and so those values have been reduced to 252 bits. This is preferable to requiring reasoning about truncation, and 252 bits is quite sufficient for security of these cryptovalues.

**Sapling** uses *Pedersen hashes* and BLAKE2s where **Sprout** used SHA256Compress. *Pedersen hashes* can be efficiently instantiated for arbitrary input lengths. BLAKE2s has an input block size of 512 bits, and uses a finalization flag rather than padding of the last input block; it also supports domain separation via a personalization parameter distinct from the input. Therefore, there is no need for truncation in the inputs to any of these hashes. Note however that the *output* of  $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$  is truncated, requiring a security assumption on BLAKE2s truncated to 251 bits (see § 5.4.1.5 ‘ $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$  *Hash Function*’ on p. 77).

**Orchard** replaces *Pedersen hashes* by *Sinsemilla hashes* which can also be efficiently instantiated for arbitrary input lengths. It replaces uses of BLAKE2s in the circuit by the *commitment scheme*  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$ , and by a construction for *nullifier* derivation that uses the Poseidon-based  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  (along with scalar multiplication on the Pallas curve). Again, there is no need for truncation in the inputs to any of these functions, and the need for truncation in the derivation of *ivk* is removed.



## 8.7 In-band secret distribution

**Zerocash** specified ECIES (referencing Certicom’s SEC 1 standard) as the encryption scheme used for the *in-band* secret distribution. This has been changed to a *key agreement scheme* based on Curve25519 (for **Sprout**) or **Jubjub** (for **Sapling**) and the authenticated encryption algorithm AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305. This scheme is still loosely based on ECIES, and on the `crypto_box_seal` scheme defined in `libsodium` [`libsodium-Seal`].

The motivations for this change were as follows:

- The **Zerocash** paper did not specify the curve to be used. We believe that Curve25519 has significant *side-channel* resistance, performance, implementation complexity, and robustness advantages over most other available curve choices, as explained in [Bernstein2006]. For **Sapling**, the Jubjub curve was designed according to a similar design process following the “Safe curves” criteria [BL-SafeCurves] [Hopwood2018]. This retains Curve25519’s advantages while keeping *shielded payment address* sizes short, because the same *public key* material supports both encryption and *spend authentication*. For **Orchard**, we define a *prime-order* curve Pallas [Hopwood2020], with similar advantages to Jubjub.
- ECIES permits many options, which were not specified. There are at least –counting conservatively– 576 possible combinations of options and algorithms over the four standards (ANSI X9.63, IEEE Std 1363a-2004, ISO/IEC 18033-2, and SEC 1) that define ECIES variants [MÁEÁ2010].
- Although the **Zerocash** paper states that ECIES satisfies *key privacy* (as defined in [BBDP2001]), it is not clear that this holds for all curve parameters and key distributions. For example, if a group of non-prime order is used, the distribution of ciphertexts could be distinguishable depending on the order of the points representing the ephemeral and recipient *public keys*. Public key validity is also a concern. Curve25519 (and Jubjub) key agreement is defined in a way that avoids these concerns due to the curve structure and the “clamping” of *private keys* (or explicit cofactor multiplication and point validation for **Sapling**). The Pallas curve is prime-order, but we still validate points, and use a similar *key agreement scheme* to **Sapling** for consistency and ease of analysis.
- Unlike the DHAES/DHIES proposal on which it is based [ABR1999], ECIES does not require a representation of the sender’s *ephemeral public key* to be included in the input to the KDF, which may impair the security properties of the scheme. (The Std 1363a-2004 version of ECIES [IEEE2004] has a “DHAES mode” that allows this, but the representation of the key input is underspecified, leading to incompatible implementations.) The scheme we use for **Sprout** has both the ephemeral and recipient *public key* encodings –which are unambiguous for Curve25519– and also  $h_{sig}$  and a nonce as described below, as input to the KDF. For **Sapling** and **Orchard**, it is only possible to include the *ephemeral public key encoding*, but this is sufficient to retain the original security properties of DHAES. Note that being able to break the Elliptic Curve Diffie–Hellman Problem on Curve25519 or Jubjub or Pallas (without breaking AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305 as an authenticated encryption scheme or BLAKE2b-256 as a KDF) would not help to decrypt the *transmitted note(s) ciphertext* unless  $pk_{enc}$  or  $pk_d$  is known or guessed.
- [**Sprout**] The KDF also takes a public seed  $h_{sig}$  as input. This can be modeled as using a different “randomness extractor” for each *JoinSplit transfer*, which limits degradation of security with the number of *JoinSplit transfers*. This facilitates security analysis as explained in [DGKM2011] – see section 7 of that paper for a security proof that can be applied to this construction under the assumption that single-block BLAKE2b-256 is a “weak PRF”. Note that  $h_{sig}$  is authenticated, by the *zk-SNARK proof*, as having been chosen with knowledge of  $a_{sk,1..N}^{old}$ , so an adversary cannot modify it in a ciphertext from someone else’s transaction for use in a chosen-ciphertext attack without detection. (In **Sapling** and **Orchard**, there is no equivalent to  $h_{sig}$ , but the *binding signature* and *spend authorization signatures* prevent such modifications.)
- [**Sprout**] The scheme used by **Sprout** includes an optimization that reuses the same ephemeral key (with different nonces) for the two ciphertexts encrypted in each *JoinSplit description*.

The security proofs of [ABR1999] can be adapted straightforwardly to the resulting scheme. Although DHAES as defined in that paper does not pass the recipient *public key* or a public seed to the *hash function*  $H$ , this does not impair the proof because we can consider  $H$  to be the specialization of our KDF to a given recipient key and seed.

(Passing the recipient *public* key to the KDF could in principle compromise *key privacy*, but not confidentiality of encryption.) [Sprout] It is necessary to adapt the “HDH independence” assumptions and the proof slightly to take into account that the ephemeral key is reused for two encryptions.

Note that the 256-bit key for AEAD\_CHACHA20\_POLY1305 maintains a high concrete security level even under attacks using parallel hardware [Bernstein2005] in the multi-user setting [Zaverucha2012]. This is especially necessary because the privacy of **Zcash** transactions may need to be maintained far into the future, and upgrading the encryption algorithm would not prevent a future adversary from attempting to decrypt ciphertexts encrypted before the upgrade. Other cryptovalues that could be attacked to break the privacy of transactions are also sufficiently long to resist parallel brute force in the multi-user setting: for **Sprout**,  $a_{sk}$  is 252 bits, and  $sk_{enc}$  is no shorter than  $a_{sk}$ .

In **Sapling**,  $ivk$  is an output of  $CRH^{ivk}$ , which is a 251-bit value. In **Orchard**,  $ivk$  is an  $x$ -coordinate on the Pallas curve. This degree of divergence from a uniform distribution on the scalar field is not expected to cause any weakness in *note* encryption.

For all *shielded protocols*, the checking of *note commitments* makes *partitioning oracle attacks* [LGR2021] against the *transmitted note ciphertext* infeasible, at least in the absence of *side-channel attacks*. The following argument applies to **Sapling** and **Orchard**, but can be adapted to **Sprout** by replacing  $ivk$  with  $sk_{enc}$ ,  $pk_d$  with  $pk_{enc}$ , and using a fixed base. The decryption procedure for *transmitted note ciphertexts* in **Sapling** and **Orchard** is specified in §4.20.2 ‘*Decryption using an Incoming Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 68; it ensures that a successful decryption cannot occur unless the decrypted *note plaintext* encodes a *note* consistent with the *note commitment* (encoded as the  $cm_v$  field of the *Output description* or the  $cm_x$  field of the *Action description*). Suppose that it were feasible to find a pair of *transmitted note ciphertext* and *note commitment* that decrypts successfully for two different *incoming viewing keys*  $ivk_1$  and  $ivk_2$ . Assuming that the *note commitment scheme* is *binding* and that *note commitment* opens to a *note* with  $pk_d$  and  $g_d$ , we must have  $pk_d = KA.Agree(ivk_1, g_d) = KA.Agree(ivk_2, g_d)$ . But this is impossible given that  $g_d$  has order greater than the maximum value of  $ivk$  that can be an output of  $CRH^{ivk}$  or  $Commit^{ivk}$ .

There is also a decryption procedure making use of *outgoing ciphertexts* in **Sapling** and **Orchard**, as specified in §4.20.3 on p. 70. It checks (via  $KA.DerivePublic$ , and also via  $PRF_{rseed}^{expand}$  in the case of post-[ZIP-212] ciphertexts with *note plaintext lead byte*  $\neq 0x01$ ) that the decrypted  $esk$  value is consistent with the *transmitted note ciphertext*, which is protected from *partitioning oracle attacks* as described above. It also checks that the  $pk_d$  value is consistent with the *note commitment*. Since these are the only fields in an *outgoing ciphertext*, even if a *partitioning oracle attack* occurred against an *outgoing ciphertext*, it could not result in any equivocation of the decrypted data. Because  $ovk$  and  $ock$  are each 256 bits, *partitioning oracle attacks* that speed up a search for these keys (analogous to the attacks against Password-based AEAD in [LGR2021]) are infeasible, even given knowledge of  $ivk$ .

## 8.8 Omission in Zerocash security proof

The abstract **Zerocash** protocol requires  $PRF^{addr}$  only to be a *PRF*; it is not specified to be *collision-resistant*. This reveals a flaw in the proof of the Balance property.

Suppose that an adversary finds a collision on  $PRF^{addr}$  such that  $a_{sk}^1$  and  $a_{sk}^2$  are distinct *spending keys* for the same  $a_{pk}$ . Because the *note commitment* is to  $a_{pk}$ , but the *nullifier* is computed from  $a_{sk}$  (and  $\rho$ ), the adversary is able to *double-spend* the note, once with each  $a_{sk}$ . This is not detected because each *Spend* reveals a different *nullifier*. The *JoinSplit statements* are still valid because they can only check that the  $a_{sk}$  in the witness is *some* preimage of the  $a_{pk}$  used in the *note commitment*.

The error is in the proof of Balance in [BCGGMTV2014, Appendix D.3]. For the “ $\mathcal{A}$  violates Condition I” case, the proof says:

- “(i) If  $cm_1^{old} = cm_2^{old}$ , then the fact that  $sn_1^{old} \neq sn_2^{old}$  implies that the witness  $a$  contains two distinct openings of  $cm_1^{old}$  (the first opening contains  $(a_{sk,1}^{old}, \rho_1^{old})$ , while the second opening contains  $(a_{sk,2}^{old}, \rho_2^{old})$ ). This violates the *binding* property of the *commitment scheme* COMM.”

In fact the openings do not contain  $a_{sk,i}^{old}$ ; they contain  $a_{pk,i}^{old}$ . (In **Sprout**  $cm_i^{old}$  opens directly to  $(a_{pk,i}^{old}, v_i^{old}, \rho_i^{old})$ , and in **Zerocash** it opens to  $(v_i^{old}, COMM_s(a_{pk,i}^{old}, \rho_i^{old}))$ .)

A similar error occurs in the argument for the “*A* violates Condition II” case.

The flaw is not exploitable for the actual instantiations of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  in **Zerocash** and **Sprout**, which *are collision-resistant* assuming that `SHA256Compress` is.

The proof can be straightforwardly repaired. The intuition is that we can rely on *collision resistance* of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  (on both its arguments) to argue that distinctness of  $a_{sk,1}^{\text{old}}$  and  $a_{sk,2}^{\text{old}}$ , together with constraint 1(b) of the *JoinSplit statement* (see §4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60), implies distinctness of  $a_{pk,1}^{\text{old}}$  and  $a_{pk,2}^{\text{old}}$ , therefore distinct openings of the *note commitment* when Condition I or II is violated.

## 8.9 Miscellaneous

- The paper defines a *note* as  $((a_{pk}, pk_{\text{enc}}), v, \rho, rcm, s, cm)$ , whereas this specification defines a **Sprout** *note* as  $(a_{pk}, v, \rho, rcm)$ . The instantiation of  $\text{COMM}_s$  in section 5.1 of the paper did not actually use  $s$ , and neither does the new instantiation of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  in **Sprout**.  $pk_{\text{enc}}$  is also not needed as part of a *note*: it is not an input to  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  nor is it constrained by the **Zerocash** *POUR statement* or the **Zcash** *JoinSplit statement*.  $cm$  can be computed from the other fields. (The definition of *notes* for **Sapling** is different again.)
- The length of proof encodings given in the paper is 288 bytes. [**Sprout**] This differs from the 296 bytes specified in §5.4.10.1 ‘*BCTV14*’ on p. 110, because both the  $x$ -coordinate and compressed  $y$ -coordinate of each point need to be represented. Although it is possible to encode a proof in 288 bytes by making use of the fact that elements of  $\mathbb{F}_q$  can be represented in 254 bits, we prefer to use the standard formats for points defined in [IEEE2004]. The fork of *libsnaark* used by **Zcash** uses this standard encoding rather than the less efficient (uncompressed) one used by upstream *libsnaark*. In **Sapling**, a customized encoding is used for BLS12-381 points in Groth16 proofs to minimize length, and similarly for Pallas and Vesta points in **Orchard**.
- The range of monetary values differs. In **Zcash** this range is  $\{0 \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$ , while in **Zerocash** it is  $\{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}$ . (The *JoinSplit statement* still only directly enforces that the sum of amounts in a given *JoinSplit transfer* is in the latter range; this enforcement is technically redundant given that the *Balance* property holds.)

## 9 Acknowledgements

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The errors in the proof of Ledger Indistinguishability mentioned in § 8.6 ‘*Changes to PRF inputs and truncation*’ on p. 146 were also found by Daira-Emma Hopwood.

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The observation in § 5.4.1.6 ‘DiversifyHash<sup>Sapling</sup> and DiversifyHash<sup>Orchard</sup> *Hash Functions*’ on p. 78 that *diversified payment address* unlinkability can be proven in the same way as *key privacy* for ElGamal, is due to Mary Maller.

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Many of the ideas used in **Zcash** —including the use of *zero-knowledge proofs* to resolve the tension between privacy and auditability, Merkle trees over note commitments (using Pedersen hashes as in **Sapling**), and the use of “serial numbers” or *nullifiers* to detect or prevent *double-spends*— were first applied to privacy-preserving digital currencies by Tomas Sander and Amnon Ta-Shma. To a large extent **Zcash** is a refinement of their “Auditable, Anonymous Electronic Cash” proposal in [ST1999].

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## 10 Change History

### 2025.6.3 2025-12-02

- Specify in § 3.3 *‘The Block Chain’* on p. 18 that **NU6.1** is the most recent *settled network upgrade* on *Testnet* and *Mainnet*.
- Update the description in § 3.12 *‘Mainnet and Testnet’* on p. 23 of protocol governance.

### 2025.6.2 2025-11-11

- In § 4.16 *‘Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers’* on p. 58, add a note that the  $\rho$  and  $\psi$  inputs to `DeriveNullifier` must be consistent with the note committed to by `cm`.
- Fix an error in the statement of **Merkle Path Validity** for **Orchard**: the *Merkle path* should be from the leaf value `ExtractP(cmold)` rather than `cmold`. This was implemented as intended in the orchard crate.
- Add a note to the **Orchard** key components diagram in § 3.1 *‘Payment Addresses and Keys’* on p. 13, saying that the derivations of `ask` and `rvk` shown there are not the only possibility, and referencing § 4.2.3 *‘Orchard Key Components’* on p. 38. Also change the existing note in that section to say that “most **Zcash** wallets”, not just `zcashd`, derive **Sapling** and **Orchard** keys and addresses according to [ZIP-32].
- Fix type errors in § 4.20.2 *‘Decryption using an Incoming Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’* on p. 68 and in § 4.20.3 *‘Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’* on p. 70: `ToScalar` returns an integer, not a byte sequence, and so cannot be assigned to `rcm`. This was implemented as intended in the `zcash_note_encryption` crate.
- Rename § 4.20.3 on p. 70 from “Decryption using a Full Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)” to “Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)”.
- Define `allowedLeadBytes` in § 3.2.1 *‘Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields’* on p. 15, and use it to refactor the constraints on *note plaintext lead bytes*.
- Correct the accents on Lukáš Korba’s name.
- Add acknowledgements to Joe Kilian, Yael Tauman Kalai, and Guy Rothblum for contributions to the science of zero-knowledge proving systems.

### 2025.6.1 2025-10-08

- Update **NU6.1** consensus changes with the one-time *lockbox disbursement* addresses, the splitting of the disbursement into `ZIP271DisbursementChunks` chunks, and other updates to [ZIP-271].
- Remove “proposal” from the version string.

### 2025.6.0 2025-09-17

- Apply **NU6.1** consensus changes from [ZIP-271].
- Add boilerplate support for **NU6.1**.
- Specify in § 3.3 *‘The Block Chain’* on p. 18 that **NU6** is the most recent *settled network upgrade*.
- Clarify § 3.4 *‘Transactions and Treestates’* on p. 18, taking into account the **NU6** consensus changes from [ZIP-236].
- Adjust the recommendation in § 4.2.2 *‘Sapling Key Components’* on p. 36 not to encode information in the *diversifier*, to recommend instead using a [ZIP-32] *diversifier index*.
- Deprecate the encoding of a **Sapling** `ivk` in § 5.6.3.2 *‘Sapling Incoming Viewing Keys’* on p. 116, in favour of using a *unified incoming viewing key* with a **Sapling** component that includes the *diversifier key* `dk`.

- Tighten the type of `ivk` in **Sapling** to  $\{1 \dots 2^{\text{Sapling}_{\text{ivk}}} - 1\}$ , and the type of `pkd` in **Sapling** to  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ , in order to make the exclusion of the zero point for `pkd` more obvious [Zips-Issue664]. This also has the effect that a **Sapling** incoming viewing key § 5.6.3.2 ‘**Sapling Incoming Viewing Keys**’ on p. 116 or a **Sapling IVK Encoding** in a unified incoming viewing key [ZIP-316] that encodes the zero `ivk` **MUST** be considered invalid when imported. Notes have been added in § 5.6.3.1 ‘**Sapling Payment Addresses**’ on p. 115 and § 5.6.3.2 ‘**Sapling Incoming Viewing Keys**’ on p. 116 calling out these changes.
- In § 4.20.3 ‘**Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 70, retrospectively enforce the check for canonicity of `pkd`. This has no effect on consensus relative to the previous version, because only small-order Jubjub curve points have *non-canonical* encodings, and so the check that returns  $\perp$  if  $\text{pk}_d \notin \mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$  would catch all such cases.
- Document in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas’ on p. 92, § 4.4 ‘**Spend Descriptions**’ on p. 41, and § 7.1.2 ‘**Transaction Consensus Rules**’ on p. 124 that the canonicity restriction on the encoding of *R* in RedDSA signature validation is retrospectively valid on *Mainnet* and *Testnet* before **NU5**.
- So that **Sapling** and **Orchard** are consistent, § 5.4.5.5 ‘**Orchard Key Agreement**’ on p. 90 now also defines  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$ , which is used instead of  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Public}$  as the type of an **Orchard** `pkd`. This has no effect on conformance since both  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{PublicPrimeOrder}$  and  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Public}$  are defined as  $\mathbb{P}^*$ .
- In § 5.6.4.4 ‘**Orchard Raw Full Viewing Keys**’ on p. 118, clarify the requirement on `ak` by rewording “valid Pallas *x*-coordinate” to “valid affine *x*-coordinate of a Pallas curve point in  $\mathbb{P}^*$ ”. Implementations might use  $(0, 0)$  to represent  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ , but 0 is not a valid *x*-coordinate in the sense required here.
- Change incorrect uses of “block reward” to *block subsidy*.
- Added dark mode rendering (<https://zips.z.cash/protocol/protocol-dark.pdf>).
- Add an acknowledgement to Schell Scivally for discussions on the Zcash protocol.

#### 2024.5.1 2024-09-26

- Apply **NU6** consensus changes from [ZIP-2001] and [ZIP-236].
- Collect the definitions of balances for each *chain value pool* into § 4.17 ‘**Chain Value Pool Balances**’ on p. 59.
- Add a definition of *total issued supply*.
- Add acknowledgements to Aditya Bharadwaj, Andrew Arnott, Arya, Andrea Kobra, Lukáš Korba, and Honza Rychnovský for discussions on the Zcash protocol.

#### 2024.5.0 2024-08-28

- Add the hyphen in Daira-Emma Hopwood.
- Correct some author lists in the References.
- Prevent incorrect line-breaking on hyphens.
- In § 5.4.1.9 ‘**Sinsemilla Hash Function**’ on p. 81, declare use of LEBS2IP instead of LEOS2IP.
- Add an acknowledgement to Conrado Gouvêa for discussions on the Zcash protocol.
- Add boilerplate support for **NU6**.

## 2023.4.0 2023-12-19

- The domain separators [4] and [5] used in the input to  $\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}$  for **Sapling** were accidentally swapped in the protocol specification relative to [ZIP-212]. The implementation in zcashd followed [ZIP-212], using [4] to derive rcm and [5] to derive esk. This has been corrected in the protocol specification.

For **Orchard**, the implementation in the orchard crate (and therefore in zcashd) followed the protocol specification, using  $[5] \parallel \text{I2LEOSP}_{256}(\rho)$  to derive rcm and  $[4] \parallel \text{I2LEOSP}_{256}(\rho)$  to derive esk. This cannot now be changed, and so [ZIP-212] has been updated to follow this implementation. Notes have been added pointing out the discrepancy.

- Document that the attacks in [DKLS2020] are no better than brute force key search against FF1-AES256 as specified in § 5.4.4 ‘*Pseudo Random Permutations*’ on p. 88.
- In the table of § 7.6 ‘*Block Header Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 131, clarify that `hashLightClientRoot` is used in **Heartwood** and **Canopy**, but not in **NU5** or later.
- The return type of  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  in § 5.4.9.5 ‘*Group Hash into Jubjub*’ on p. 104 was incorrectly given as  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}$ , rather than the correct  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)*} \cup \{\perp\}$ .
- In the discussion of partitioning oracle attacks on *note* encryption in § 8.7 ‘*In-band secret distribution*’ on p. 147, we now use the fact that  $g_d$  has order greater than the maximum value of *ivk*, rather than assuming that  $g_d$  is a non-zero point in the *prime-order subgroup*. (In the case of **Sapling**, the circuits only enforce that  $g_d$  is not a *small-order* point, not that it is in the *prime-order subgroup*. It is true that honestly generated addresses have *prime-order*  $g_d$  which would have been sufficient for the security argument against this class of attacks, but the chosen fix is more direct.)
- Delete a confusing claim in § 4.4 ‘*Spend Descriptions*’ on p. 41 that “The check that *rk* is not of *small order* is technically redundant with a check in the *Spend circuit*...”. The *small-order* check excludes the zero point  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , which the **Spend authority** check that this claim was intending to reference does not.
- An implementation of  $\text{HomomorphicPedersenCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  **MAY** resample the *commitment trapdoor* until the resulting commitment is not  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , in order to avoid it being rejected as the *cv* field of a *Spend description* or *Output description*. Add notes in § 4.4 ‘*Spend Descriptions*’ on p. 41, § 4.5 ‘*Output Descriptions*’ on p. 42, and § 5.4.8.3 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen commitments (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 97 to that effect.
- Rename the section “Note Commitments and Nullifiers” to § 4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58, to more accurately reflect its contents.
- Split some of the content of the section “Notes” into subsections § 3.2.2 ‘*Note Commitments*’ on p. 16 and § 3.2.3 ‘*Nullifiers*’ on p. 17. Make the descriptions of how *note commitments* and *nullifiers* are used more precise and explicit, and add forward references where helpful.
- Remove redundancy in the definition of *note plaintexts* between § 3.2.1 ‘*Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 15 and § 5.5 ‘*Encodings of Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 112.
- The abstract no longer describes the **NU5** version of the specification as a draft.
- Acknowledge Greg Pfeil as a co-designer of the **Zcash** protocol.
- Acknowledge Daira-Emma Hopwood for the fix to the Faerie Gold attack in **Sprout**, and add a reference to her *Explaining the Security of Zcash* talk at Zcon3 [Hopwood2022] for repairs to the **Zerocash** security definitions.
- Acknowledge the font designers Pablo Impallari and Morris Fuller.
- Change Daira-Emma Hopwood’s name.

## 2022.3.8 2022-09-15

- Correct Jurgen Bos’ name.

### 2022.3.7 2022-09-10

- Remove a now-unused sampling of rcv in § 4.8.3 ‘*Dummy Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 48.
- Specify in § 3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p. 18 that **NU5** is the most recent settled *network upgrade*.

### 2022.3.6 2022-09-01

- Correct Kexin Hu’s name.
- Correct cross-references for the definition of an *anchor*.
- Remove a calculation of cv in § 4.8.3 ‘*Dummy Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 48 that is not applicable to **Orchard** (since cv for an *Action description* depends on both the spent and output *notes*).
- Clarify that the recommended format for a QR code starts with a *Bech32* encoding for a **Sapling** payment address and with a *Bech32m* encoding for a *unified payment address*.
- Replace ResearchGate links for [CDvdG1987] and [BDPA2007] with alternatives that do not cause false-positive link checker errors.
- In protocol/README.rst: update the build dependency documentation for Debian Bullseye, mention the “make linkcheck” target, and correct the description of “make all”.
- Update the Makefile to build correctly with newer versions of latexmk.

### 2022.3.5 2022-08-02

- ZIP 244 is not modified by ZIP 225.
- § 5.4.1.5 ‘**CRH<sup>ivk</sup> Hash Function**’ on p. 77 incorrectly cross-referenced BLAKE2b-256 rather than BLAKE2s-256. The actual specification was correct.

### 2022.3.4 2022-06-22

- Document in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90 that a *full validator* implementation that checkpoints on the **Canopy** activation block **MAY** validate Ed25519 signatures using the post-**Canopy** rules for the whole chain.
- Update references for [ECCZF2019] and [ZIP-302] and [ZIP-252].

### 2022.3.3 2022-06-21

- In § 3.12 ‘*Mainnet and Testnet*’ on p. 23, update the settled activation *block hashes* to be those for **NU5** on *Mainnet* and *Testnet*.
- Correct the history entry for v2022.3.2 to include the entry about the calculation for sizeProofsOrchard.
- Rename ExcludedPointEncodings to PreCanopyExcludedPointEncodings.
- In § 5.6.2.3 ‘**Sprout Spending Keys**’ on p. 115, remove the statement that future key representations might use the padding bits of **Sprout** spending keys.
- Give a full-text URL for [Nakamoto2008].

### 2022.3.2 2022-06-06

- Set NUFiveActivationHeight for *Testnet* and *Mainnet*.
- An [**NU5** onward] consensus rule requiring the nConsensusBranchId field to match the *consensus branch ID* used for *SIGHASH transaction hashes*, should apply only when effectiveVersion  $\geq 5$  (since v4 transactions did not explicitly encode the nConsensusBranchId field).
- Correction in § 5.3 ‘*Constants*’ on p. 74: Uncommitted<sup>Orchard</sup> :  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  is not a *bit sequence*.

- In §7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p.122, add the calculation for `sizeProofsOrchard` to the v5 *transaction* format table.
- Make §1.2 ‘*High-level Overview*’ on p.8 more precise about *chain value pools*.

### 2022.3.1 2022-04-28

- In §4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p.38, do not allow construction of **Orchard** *spending keys* such that the corresponding internal *incoming viewing key* is 0 or  $\perp$ . (This was already specified for the external *incoming viewing key*.) Similarly in §5.6.4.4 ‘*Orchard Raw Full Viewing Keys*’ on p.118, do not consider a decoded key valid if either its external or internal *incoming viewing key* would be 0 or  $\perp$ .
- Clarify how to determine which table in §7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p.122 to use for *transaction* parsing, depending on the `effectiveVersion` as determined by the header field.
- Correct “block chain branch” to “*consensus branch*” to match [ZIP-200].
- Add an acknowledgement to Mary Maller for reviewing the Halo 2 security proofs.
- Add an acknowledgement to Josh Cincinnati for discussions on the Zcash protocol.
- Add acknowledgements to more people associated with the ZK Podcast.

### 2022.3.0 2022-03-18

- Correct a type error in the usage of  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$ : the output type  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}.\text{Output}$  includes 0, but the type of *incoming viewing keys* should not include 0 because  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}.\text{Private}$  does not. This is now handled by explicitly rejecting 0 as output from  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  when generating *ivk* in §4.2.3 ‘*Orchard Key Components*’ on p.38. An encoding of *ivk* as 0 is also rejected in §5.6.4.3 ‘*Orchard Raw Incoming Viewing Keys*’ on p.118 when parsing an *incoming viewing key*. The *Action circuit* needed no changes because  $\text{pk}_d$  already could not be  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ , and therefore the **Diversified address integrity** condition fails when *ivk* = 0.
- In §3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p.18, define what a *settled network upgrade* is, specify requirements for checkpointing, and allow nodes to impose a limitation on rollback depth.
- In §5.4.10.1 ‘*BCTV14*’ on p.110, note that the above checkpointing requirement mitigates the risks of not performing BCTV14 zk proof verification.
- Document the consensus rule that coinbase script length **MUST** be  $\{2 \dots 100\}$  bytes.
- §3.11 ‘*Coinbase Transactions*’ on p.22 effectively defined a *coinbase transaction* as the first *transaction* in a *block*. This wording was copied from the Bitcoin Developer Reference [Bitcoin-CbInput], but it does not match the implementation in `zcashd` that was inherited from Bitcoin Core. Instead, a *coinbase transaction* should be, and now is, defined as a *transaction* with a single null *prevout*. The specifications of consensus rules have been clarified and adjusted (without any actual consensus change) to take this into account, as follows:
  - a *block* **MUST** have at least one *transaction*;
  - the first *transaction* in a *block* **MUST** be a *coinbase transaction*, and subsequent *transactions* **MUST NOT** be *coinbase transactions*;
  - a *transparent input* in a non-coinbase *transaction* **MUST NOT** have a null *prevout*;
  - every non-null *prevout* **MUST** point to a unique *UTXO* in either a preceding *block*, or a *previous transaction* in the same *block* (this rule was previously not given explicitly because it was assumed to be inherited from **Bitcoin**);
  - the rule that “A *coinbase transaction* **MUST NOT** have any *transparent inputs* with non-null *prevout* fields” is removed as an explicit consensus rule because it is implied by the corrected definition of *coinbase transaction*.



## 2022.2.19 2022-01-19

- In § 4.10 ‘*SIGHASH Transaction Hashing*’ on p. 50, add a consensus rule that *SIGHASH* type encodings **MUST** be canonical for v5 transactions.
- In § 3.5 ‘*JoinSplit Transfers and Descriptions*’ on p. 19, clarify that balance for *JoinSplit* transfers is enforced by the *JoinSplit* statement, and that there is no consensus rule to check it directly.
- In § 8.5 ‘*Internal hash collision attack and fix*’ on p. 145, add a security argument for why the SHA-256-based commitment scheme  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sprout}}$  is *binding* and *hiding*, under reasonable assumptions about SHA256Compress.

## 2022.2.18 2022-01-03

- Change the types of  $\text{cm}_x$ ,  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , and  $\text{ak}$  in **Orchard** to  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$ , avoiding type errors and reflecting the implementation in zcashd. This eliminates all uses of  $\mathbb{P}_x$  (except that  $\text{ak}$  in an **Orchard** full viewing key is still required to be a valid Pallas affine-short-Weierstrass  $x$ -coordinate).
- Refine the security argument about *partitioning oracle attacks* in § 8.7 ‘*In-band secret distribution*’ on p. 147:
  - The argument for decryption with an *incoming viewing key* does not need to depend on the *Decisional Diffie-Hellman Problem*, since  $\text{g}_d$  is committed to by the *note commitment* as well as  $\text{pk}_d$ .
  - It is necessary to say that the *note commitment* is always checked for a successful decryption.
  - Pedantically, it was not correct to conclude from the given security argument that *partitioning oracle attacks* against an *outgoing ciphertext* are necessarily prevented, according to the definition in [LGR2021]. Instead, the correct conclusions are that such attacks could not feasibly result in any equivocation of the decrypted data, or in recovery of  $\text{ovk}$  or  $\text{ock}$ .
- Correct the note about domain separators for  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  in § 4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25, and ensure that new domain separators for deriving internal keys from [ZIP-32] and [ZIP-316] are included.

## 2021.2.17 2021-12-01

- Add notes in § B.1 ‘*RedDSA batch validation*’ on p. 220, § B.2 ‘*Groth16 batch verification*’ on p. 221 and § B.3 ‘*Ed25519 batch validation*’ on p. 223 that  $z_j$  may be sampled from  $\{0 \dots 2^{128} - 1\}$  instead of  $\{1 \dots 2^{128} - 1\}$ .
- Add note in § 8.7 ‘*In-band secret distribution*’ on p. 147 about resistance of *note encryption* to *partitioning oracle attacks* [LGR2021].
- Add acknowledgement to Mihir Bellare for contributions to the science of *zero-knowledge proofs*.
- Add acknowledgement to Sasha Meyer.

## 2021.2.16 2021-09-30

- Use complete addition in *SinsemillaCommit*.
- Correct the proof of Theorem 5.4.6 on p. 99.
- Change the type of  $\text{cm}^{\text{old}}$  in **Orchard** to  $\mathbb{P}$  rather than  $\mathbb{P}^*$ , i.e. allow the identity point.
- Change the type of  $\text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}$  from  $\mathbb{P}_x$  (i.e. a Pallas  $x$ -coordinate or 0) to  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$ . This reflects the existing zcashd implementation; also checking  $\text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}} \in \mathbb{P}_x$  would require a square root and is unnecessary.
- Witness  $\text{g}_d^{\text{new}}$  and  $\text{pk}_d^{\text{new}}$  in the **Orchard** Action circuit as  $\mathbb{P}^*$ , i.e. non-identity Pallas points, rather than witnessing their representations as *bit sequences*. This reflects the existing zcashd implementation.
- Note that  $\text{ak}^{\mathbb{P}}$  in **Orchard** cannot be the identity.
- Correct the consensus rule about the maximum value of outputs in a *coinbase transaction*: it should reference the *block subsidy* rather than the *miner subsidy*.

#### 2021.2.15 2021-09-01

- Correct a minor error in the proof of Theorem 5.4.3 on p. 83: the condition  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}(D, M) \neq \perp$  is required in the proof. (The case  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}(D, M) = \perp$  is covered by Theorem 5.4.4 on p. 84.) The proof had not been updated correctly when the statement was revised in v2021.2.0. Also add a missing  $D$  argument to  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}$  in that proof.
- Fix a reference to nonexistent version 2019.0-beta-40 of this specification (in §7.7.3 ‘*Difficulty adjustment*’ on p. 134) that should be v2019.0.0.
- Fix URL links to [BBDP2001] and [BDJR2000].
- Improve `protocol/links_and_dests.py` to eliminate false positives when checking DOI links.

#### 2021.2.14 2021-08-12

- Fix the URL for [ZIP-239] in the References.
- **Reword the reference to a Sapling full viewing key in §4.8.2 ‘*Dummy Notes (Sapling)*’ on p. 47 (the full viewing key would include `ovk`, although it is not used in that section).**

#### 2021.2.13 2021-07-29

- Add consensus rules in §3.8 ‘*Note Commitment Trees*’ on p. 21 that, for each *note commitment tree*, a block **MUST NOT** add *note commitments* that exceed the capacity of that tree.

#### 2021.2.12 2021-07-29

- Change the number of partial rounds,  $R_P$ , for Poseidon from 58 to 56. This matches the number calculated by `calc_round_numbers.py` (for 128-bit security “with margin”) in Version 1.1 of the Poseidon reference implementation [Poseidon-1.1] [Poseidon-Zc1.1].

#### 2021.2.11 2021-07-20

- Change the definition of inputs to the *Action circuit* to split `enableSpend`s and `enableOutput`s into two field elements.

#### 2021.2.10 2021-07-13

- Clarify that decomposition of scalars for scalar multiplication in the *Action circuit* **MUST** be canonical, unless a non-canonical decomposition can be proven to result in an equivalent statement – and clarify for which multiplications the latter case applies.
- The encoding of the *block height* in the `scriptSig` of a *coinbase transaction* is now at most 5 bytes (rather than 9 bytes), because *block height* **MUST** also be encoded in the 32-bit `nExpiryHeight` field of *coinbase transactions* after **NU5** activation.
- Clarify in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18 that the remaining value in a *transparent transaction value pool* is only available to miners as a fee in the case of non-coinbase *transactions*, and that the remaining value in the *transparent transaction value pool* of a *coinbase transaction* is destroyed.
- Remove a spurious reference to `rseed` in §4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65. There were no changes for **Sprout** in [ZIP-212].

### 2021.2.9 2021-07-01

- Add a consensus rule for version 5 or later *transactions*, that if  $\text{nActionsOrchard} > 0$  then at least one of  $\text{enableSpendsOrchard}$  and  $\text{enableOutputsOrchard}$  **MUST** be 1.
- Delete the consensus rule in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18 that required checking that each intermediate *root* of the *note commitment tree* is not  $\perp$ . Checking this rule would have imposed a significant performance penalty, since intermediate roots do not otherwise need to be computed.
- Change the type of  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  to have  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  in place of  $\{0 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\} \cup \{\perp\}$  for the inputs and output, and map a  $\perp$  output from  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  to 0. (We retain the original definitions of  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  and  $\text{SinsemillaHashToPoint}$  both because it would be disruptive to change them at this point in the Network Upgrade Process, and because it is necessary to track  $\perp$  outputs in order to correctly model non-determinism in the *Action circuit*.)
- Allow the Merkle path validity check in the *Action circuit* to pass if any output of  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  is 0, and add a note in §4.9 ‘*Merkle Path Validity*’ on p. 49 arguing that this is safe.
- Fix a typo in the Security Requirements for §5.4.1.3 ‘ $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  *Hash Function*’ on p. 77: the length of the input to  $\text{SinsemillaHash}$  is  $10 + 2 \cdot \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  bits, not  $6 + 2 \cdot \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Orchard}}$  bits.
- Replace “must” with “**MUST**” in two consensus rules specified in §7.1 ‘*Transaction Encoding and Consensus*’ on p. 122.
- Add a clarification in §7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124 that after **Heartwood** and before **Canopy** activation, **Sapling** outputs of a *coinbase transaction* **MUST** have *note plaintext lead byte* equal to 0x01. This was implied by the existing rule that such outputs **MUST** decrypt successfully with an all-zero *outgoing viewing key*.
- Correct *l* to *l\** in two places in §5.4.1.3 ‘ $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Sapling}}$  *Hash Function*’ on p. 76.
- Correct an erroneous statement in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18 that claimed *transaction IDs* are not part of the consensus protocol.

### 2021.2.8 2021-06-29

- Change one of the **[Sapling onward]** consensus rules in §7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124 to have the correct applicability: **[Sapling to Canopy inclusive, pre-NU5]**.
- Describe *transaction IDs* and *wtxids* in §3.4 ‘*Transactions and Treestates*’ on p. 18.
- Add a section §7.1.1 ‘*Transaction Identifiers*’ on p. 124 on how to compute *transaction IDs* and *wtxids*.
- Split the *transaction*-related consensus rules into their own subsection §7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124, for more precise cross-referencing.

### 2021.2.7 2021-06-28

- Correct the type of  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Orchard}}$ , which should be  $\mathbb{P}_x$  rather than a *bit sequence*.
- Explicitly say that padding in §5.4.1.9 ‘*Sinsemilla Hash Function*’ on p. 81 is by appending zero bits.
- Add a step to the algorithm for generating an **Orchard** *note* in §4.7.3 ‘*Sending Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 46, to restart if  $\text{esk} = 0$ .

### 2021.2.6 2021-06-26

- Require that from **NU5** activation, the  $\text{nExpiryHeight}$  field of a *coinbase transaction* is set to the *block height*. This is needed to maintain the property that all *transactions* have unique *transaction IDs*, as explained in a note in §7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124. In order to avoid the *block height* being limited to 499999999, we also remove that bound on  $\text{nExpiryHeight}$  for *coinbase transactions*.
- Remove the recommendation to support 63-bit *block heights* in §3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p. 18 (since it is incompatible with the above consensus rule for *coinbase nExpiryHeight*).

- Ensure that the *layer* number is passed to MerkleCRH in §4.9 ‘*Merkle Path Validity*’ on p. 49.
- Refine the key components diagram in §3.1 ‘*Payment Addresses and Keys*’ on p. 13 to show that **Orchard incoming viewing keys** include both *dk* and *ivk*.
- Clarify that the  $\{-\text{MAX\_MONEY} \dots \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$  range restriction applies to both *valueBalanceSapling* and *valueBalanceOrchard*.
- Update §5.5 ‘*Encodings of Note Plaintexts and Memo Fields*’ on p. 112 for **Orchard**.
- Add [ZIP-203], [ZIP-212], and [ZIP-213] to the list of ZIPs updated for **NU5**.
- Give cross-references to §2 ‘*Notation*’ on p. 10 where  $\sqrt[3]{\cdot}$  and  $\sqrt[4]{\cdot}$  are used.

#### 2021.2.5 2021-06-19

- Change the consensus rule that requires at least one input to, and at least one output from a v5 or later *transaction*, to take into account the *enableSpendOrchard* and *enableOutputsOrchard* flags.
- Correct the type of  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}$  imported in §5.4.1.9 ‘*Sinsemilla Hash Function*’ on p. 81 (from  $\mathbb{P} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_x$  to  $\mathbb{P} \cup \{\perp\} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_x \cup \{\perp\}$ ).
- Add [ZIP-209] to the list of ZIPs updated for **NU5**.

#### 2021.2.4 2021-06-08

- Add an explicit consensus rule in §7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124 that the reserved bits of the *flagsOrchard* field **MUST** be zero.
- Correct a cut-and-paste error in the algorithm for §4.8.3 ‘*Dummy Notes (Orchard)*’ on p. 48, which should refer to the *Action statement* rather than the *Spend statement*.

#### 2021.2.3 2021-06-06

- Specify (as a note in §4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p. 63) the encoding of *primary inputs* to the *Action circuit*. This uses new helper functions  $\mathcal{X}$  and  $\mathcal{Y}$  defined in §5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106. The specification of  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}$  has also been refactored to use  $\mathcal{X}$  (this does not change the **Orchard** protocol).
- In §5.4.1.10 ‘*PoseidonHash Function*’ on p. 84, say that the round constants as well as the MDS matrices are generated according to Version 1.1 of the reference implementation.
- Clarify that *epk* encoded in an *Action description* cannot be  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ .
- Specify that **Orchard spending keys** are encoded using *Bech32m*.
- Add [ZIP-239] to the list of ZIPs included in **NU5**.
- Move the section on abstraction (previously section 5.1) to §4 ‘*Abstract Protocol*’ on p. 23. Section 5.2 has been split into two (§5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73 and §5.2 ‘*Bit layout diagrams*’ on p. 73) to avoid renumbering later subsections.
- Correct an error in the encoding of height-in-coinbase for *blocks* at heights 1 .. 16.
- Clarify, in §3.3 ‘*The Block Chain*’ on p. 18, requirements on the range of *block heights* that should be supported.
- Delete the sentence “All conversions between Ed25519 points, *byte sequences*, and integers used in this section are as specified in [BDLSY2012].” from §5.4.6 ‘*Ed25519*’ on p. 90. This sentence was misleading given that the conversions in [BDLSY2012] are not sufficiently well-specified for a consensus protocol; it should have been deleted earlier when explicit definitions for  $\text{reprBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$  and  $\text{abstBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$  were added.
- Make the **NU5** specification the default.



#### 2021.1.24 2021-04-23

- Add the `nConsensusBranchId` field to *v5 transactions*, matching the *consensus branch ID* used for *SIGHASH transaction hashes*.
- Include the *diversifier* key in an encoded **Orchard** Incoming Viewing Key.
- Remove an unused precomputation in §5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 107.
- Clarify that only an *outgoing cipher key* is strictly needed to decrypt an *outgoing ciphertext*.
- Explicitly say that *coinbase transactions* **MUST NOT** have *transparent inputs* (this is a consensus rule inherited from **Bitcoin** which has been present since launch).

#### 2021.1.23 2021-04-19

- Correct errors in the definitions of  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}$  and  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}$  in §5.4.9.7 ‘*Coordinate Extractor for Pallas*’ on p. 106:  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}})$  should be 0, and  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{P}}^{\perp}(\perp)$  should be  $\perp$ .
- Change the type of  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  public keys and shared secrets to  $\mathbb{P}^*$  (i.e. exclude  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$ ), and the type of  $\text{KA}^{\text{Orchard}}$  private keys to  $\mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{P}}}^*$  (i.e. exclude 0).
- Change the type of an **Orchard** ivk to  $\{1 \dots q_{\mathbb{P}} - 1\}$  (i.e. exclude 0).
- Change the types of  $\text{pk}_d^{\text{old}}$ ,  $\text{cm}^{\text{old}}$  and  $\text{ak}^{\mathbb{P}}$  to  $\mathbb{P}^*$  in the *auxiliary inputs* to the *Action statement*.
- When creating **Orchard** notes, repeat with another rseed if *cm* is  $\perp$ .
- Add a note in §4.2.3 ‘**Orchard** Key Components’ on p. 38 about non-uniformity of ivk.
- Fix a typo: “Decryption” to “Description”.
- Add *Action descriptions* to the introduction of §4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58.
- Use a different footnote symbol for each **Sapling** field cardinality rule in *v5 transactions*.
- Fix some URLs in references.

#### 2021.1.22 2021-04-05

- Specify that a *unified payment address* **MUST** contain at least one *shielded payment address*.
- Further clarifications to Theorem 5.4.3 on p. 83.
- **Correct ZKSpend.Verify to ZKOutput.Verify in §4.5 ‘Output Descriptions’ on p. 42.**
- Make sure that Change History entries are URL destinations.

#### 2021.1.21 2021-04-01

- Correct and clarify Theorem 5.4.3 on p. 83 and Theorem 5.4.4 on p. 84.
- Clarify that a *dummy note* should be created if no real **Orchard** note is being spent in an *Action transfer*.
- Add a caveat in §4.2.3 ‘**Orchard** Key Components’ on p. 38 about reuse of *rivk* between  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  and  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$ .
- Expand the set of ZIPs associated with **NU5** in §6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120, and reference [Zcash-halo2] and [Zcash-Orchard] there.
- Section §5.4.5.6 ‘**Orchard** Key Derivation’ on p. 90 should be in slate blue.
- Explicitly note that the end of the [ZIP-212] grace period precedes **NU5** activation.
- Change the condition for presence of *anchorSapling* in a version 5 *transaction* to  $\text{vSpendSapling} > 0$ .
- **Fix type error in *kdfinput* for  $\text{KDF}^{\text{Sapling}}$  and  $\text{KDF}^{\text{Orchard}}$  (ephemeralKey is already a byte sequence).**
- **Make a note in §8.7 ‘In-band secret distribution’ on p. 147 of the divergence of ivk for Sapling and Orchard from a uniform scalar.**



- Correct the set of inputs to  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  used for [ZIP-32] and **Orchard** in § 4.1.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 25.
- Write the caution about linkage between the abstract and concrete protocols in § 4 ‘*Abstract Protocol*’ on p. 23.
- Update the **Sprout** key component diagram in § 3.1 ‘*Payment Addresses and Keys*’ on p. 13 to remove magenta highlighting.

#### 2021.1.20 2021-03-25

- Credit Eirik Ogilvie-Wigley as a designer of the Zcash protocol. Add Andre Serrano, Brad Miller, Charlie O’Keefe, David Campbell, Elena Giral, Francisco Gindre, Joseph Van Geffen, Josh Swihart, Kevin Gorham, Larry Ruane, Marshall Gaucher, and Ryan Taylor to the acknowledgements.
- Add proof of *collision resistance* for Sinsemilla.
- Correct some interim findings of the NCC specification audit:
  - Fix typos.
  - Correct the definition of  $c$  in § 5.4.1.9 ‘*Sinsemilla Hash Function*’ on p. 81.
  - Propagate  $\perp$  intermediate results to the output of Sinsemilla primitives.
  - Change the output types of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  and  $\text{Commit}^{\text{ivk}}$  to reflect that these can return  $\perp$ , and change the *Action statement* to be satisfied if they do.
  - Propagate  $\perp$  from the inputs of  $\text{MerkleCRH}^{\text{Orchard}}$  to its output, and add an explicit consensus rule that  $\text{rt}^{\text{Orchard}}$  computed from appending a *note commitment* is not  $\perp$ .
  - Correct the definition of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfOrchard}}$  in § 5.4.2 ‘*Pseudo Random Functions*’ on p. 86 by changing Poseidon to PoseidonHash.
  - Restrict the definition of a *short Weierstrass elliptic curve* in § 5.4.9.6 ‘*Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 105 to base fields of characteristic greater than 3.
  - Define  $\mathbb{G}$  in § 5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 107.
  - Fix type confusion between integers and field elements (including additional cases not found in the audit, involving *nullifiers* and  $\text{cm}_x$ ).
  - Fix a discrepancy between § 5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 107 and [ID-hashtocurve]: the zero padding in `expand_message_xmd` should be 128 bytes (matching the input block size of BLAKE2b), rather than 64 bytes.
  - Document that the use of  $k = 256$  when extracting field elements in `hash_to_field` is intentional, despite the Pallas curve only having 126-bit conjectured security against generic attacks.
  - Correct the output type of  $\text{sqrt\_ratio}_{\mathbb{F}_{q_{\mathbb{G}}}}$ .
  - Document that the choice of nonsquare for  $\lambda_{\mathbb{G}}$  in § 5.4.9.8 ‘*Group Hash into Pallas and Vesta*’ on p. 107 makes no difference to the output of `map_to_curve_simple_swu`<sup>iso- $\mathbb{G}$</sup> .
  - Document the limitation on the domain separation string for the *group hash* into Pallas and Vesta.
  - Correct the sizes of `SpendDescriptionV5` and `OutputDescriptionV5` in the version 5 *transaction* format.
  - Make the description of when fields are included in v5 *transactions* consistent between the protocol specification and [ZIP-225].
  - Make the naming of `enableSpend`s and `enableOutput`s consistent.
- Change the specifications of *note* decryption in § 4.19 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sprout)*’ on p. 65 and § 4.20 ‘*In-band secret distribution (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 67 to return the *note* and *memo field*, rather than a *note plaintext*.
- Generalize the *block chain* scanning algorithm in § 4.22 ‘*Block Chain Scanning (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 72 to support **Orchard**.
- Update the `hashFinalSaplingRoot`/`hashLightClientRoot`/`hashBlockCommitments` field for **NU5**.

- Update specification of Poseidon.
- Fix errors in **Orchard** due to cut-and-paste from **Sapling**.
- Add references to [Zcash-halo2].
- Correct the description of length in § 5.6.4.1 ‘*Unified Payment Addresses and Viewing Keys*’ on p. 117.
- Correct the type signature of  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}$  in § 4.1.1 ‘*Hash Functions*’ on p. 24.
- Various rationale updates for **NU5**.
- Other fixes to the **Orchard** specification, including generation of *dummy notes* and *output notes*.
- Describe the recommended way to encode a **Sapling** or unified *payment address* as a QR code.
- Move the definition of  $\perp$  to before its first use.
- Delete a confusing part of the definition of  $\text{concat}_{\mathbb{B}}$  that we don’t rely on.
- Add a definition for the  $\$$  symbol in § 1 ‘*Introduction*’ on p. 7, before its first use.
- Remove specification of *memo field* contents, which will be in [ZIP-302].
- Remove support for building the **Sprout**-only specification (*sprout.pdf*).
- Remove magenta highlighting of differences from **Zerocash**.

#### 2021.1.19 2021-03-17

- Correct the range of input to  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Orchard}}$  in the *Action statement*, and the corresponding security argument in § 4.14 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Orchard)*’ on p. 54.
- Update the consensus rules that prevent trivial transactions (with no inputs or outputs) to take into account *Action transfers* in the v5 *transaction* format.
- Make  $\text{DiversifyHash}^{\text{Orchard}}$  total, by replacing an output of  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}}$  with another base.
- Fix a type error in the non-normative note at the end of § 5.4.8.4 ‘*Sinsemilla commitments*’ on p. 98.

#### 2021.1.18 2021-03-17

- Define *unified payment addresses* in place of the *Bech32* form of **Orchard** *shielded payment addresses*.
- Remove **Sprout**-specific fields from the v5 *transaction* format.
- The  $\rho$  value for an **Orchard** output *note* was incorrectly described as being derived from *rseed*, instead of being set to the nullifier from the same *Action description* as intended.
- The  $\psi$  value is now derived using the  $\text{PRF}^{\text{expand}}$  input [9], instead of [10].
- Correct a note about the range of the Merkle hash inputs in § 4.18.4 ‘*Action Statement (Orchard)*’ on p. 63.
- Correct the validity condition for *ak* in § 5.6.4.4 ‘*Orchard Raw Full Viewing Keys*’ on p. 118.
- Add a definition for  $\mathcal{K}^{\text{Orchard}}$  in § 4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58.
- Correct the number of full and partial rounds for Poseidon.
- Add a note explaining the origin of the  $2^{65}$  constant in the definition of  $\text{PoseidonHash}$ .
- The subgroup check added to § 4.20.3 ‘*Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 70 for **Sapling** in v2021.1.17 was applied to the wrong variable ( $g_d$ , when it should have been  $pk_d$ ), despite being described correctly in the Change History entry below.

#### 2021.1.17 2021-03-15

- Draft **NU5** specification.
- In the consensus rule that a *transaction* with one or more *transparent* inputs from *coinbase transactions* **MUST** have no *transparent* outputs, explicitly say that inputs from *coinbase transactions* include *funding stream* outputs.
- The definition of an abstraction function in § 4.1.9 ‘*Represented Group*’ on p. 32 incorrectly required canonicity, i.e. that  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}$  does not accept inputs outside the range of  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ . While this was originally intended, it is not true of  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}$ . (It is also not true of  $\text{abstBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$ , but Ed25519 is not strictly defined as a *represented group* in this specification.)
- Correct Theorem 5.4.5 on p. 96, which was proving the wrong thing. It needs to prove that  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  does not return  $\text{Uncommitted}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , but was previously proving that  $\text{PedersenHash}$  does not return that value.
- The note about *non-canonical* encodings in § 5.4.9.3 ‘*Jubjub*’ on p. 102 gave incorrect values for the encodings of the point of order 2, by omitting a  $q_{\mathbb{J}}$  term.
- The specification of decryption in § 4.20.3 on p. 70 differed from the *zcashd* implementation in two respects:
  - The specification had a type error in that it failed to check whether  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{pk} \star_d) = \perp$ , which is needed in order for its use as input to  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$ . Agree to be well-typed.
  - The specification did not require  $\text{pk}_d$  to be in the subgroup  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$ , while the implementation in *zcashd* did. This check is not needed for security; however, since *Jubjub* public keys are normally of type  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sapling}}$ .*PublicPrimeOrder*, we change the specification to match *zcashd*.
- Correct the procedure for generating *dummy Sapling notes* in § 4.8.2 ‘*Dummy Notes (Sapling)*’ on p. 47.
- Add a note in § 5.4.10.1 ‘*BCTV14*’ on p. 110 describing conditions under which an implementation that check-points on **Sapling** can omit verifying *BCTV14* proofs.
- Rename “hash extractor” to *coordinate extractor*. This is a more accurate name since it is also used on commitments.
- Rename *char* to *byte* in field type declarations.

#### 2021.1.16 2021-01-11

- Add macros and *Makefile* support for building the **NU5** draft specification.
- Clarify the encoding of *block heights* for the “height in coinbase” rule. The description of this rule has also moved from § 7.6 on p. 131 to § 7.1.2 ‘*Transaction Consensus Rules*’ on p. 124.
- Include the activation dates of **Heartwood** and **Canopy** in § 6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120.
- Section links in the **Heartwood** and **Canopy** versions of the specification now go to the correct document URL.
- Attempt to improve search and cut-and-paste behaviour for ligatures in some PDF readers.

#### 2020.1.15 2020-11-06

- Add a missing consensus rule that has always been implemented in *zcashd*: there must be at least one *transparent output*, *Output description*, or *JoinSplit description* in a *transaction*.
- Add a consensus rule that the (zero-valued) *coinbase transaction* output of the *genesis block* cannot be spent.
- Define **Sprout** *chain value pool balance* and **Sapling** *chain value pool balance*, and include consensus rules from [ZIP-209].
- Correct the **Sapling** *note* decryption algorithms:
  - *ephemeralKey* is kept as a *byte sequence* rather than immediately converted to a curve point; this matters because of *non-canonical* encoding.

- The representation of  $pk_d$  in a *note plaintext* may also be *non-canonical* and need not be in the *prime-order subgroup*.
- Move checking of  $cm_u$  in decryption with  $ivk$  to the end of the algorithm, to more closely match the implementation.
- The note about decryption of outputs in *mempool transactions* should have been normative.
- Reserve *transaction version number*  $0x7FFFFFFF$  and *version group ID*  $0xFFFFFFFF$  for experimental use.
- Remove a statement that the language consisting of key and address encoding possibilities is prefix-free. (The human-readable forms are prefix-free but the raw encodings are not; for example, the *raw encoding* of a **Sapling** *spending key* can be a prefix of several of the other encodings.)
- Use “let mutable” to introduce mutable variables in algorithms.
- Include a reference to [BFI]SV2010] for batch pairing verification techniques.
- Acknowledge Jack Gavigan as a co-designer of **Sapling** and of the **Zcash** protocol.
- Acknowledge Izaak Meckler, Zac Williamson, Vitalik Buterin, and Jakub Zalewski.
- Acknowledge Alexandra Elbakyan.

#### 2020.1.14 2020-08-19

- The consensus rule that a *coinbase transaction* must not spend more than is available from the *block subsidy* and *transaction fees*, was not explicitly stated. (This rule was correctly implemented in *zcashd*.)
- Fix a type error in the output of  $PRF^{nfSapling}$ ; a **Sapling nullifier** is a sequence of 32 bytes, not a *bit sequence*.
- Correct an off-by-one in an expression used in the definition of  $c$  in § 5.4.1.7 ‘**Pedersen Hash Function**’ on p. 79 (this does not change the value of  $c$ ).

#### 2020.1.13 2020-08-11

- Rename the type of **Sapling** *transmission keys* from  $KA^{Sapling}.PublicPrimeOrder$  to  $KA^{Sapling}.PublicPrimeSubgroup$ . This type is defined as  $\mathbb{J}^{(n)}$ , which reflects the implementation in *zcashd* (subject to the next point below); it was never enforced that a *transmission key* ( $pk_d$ ) cannot be  $\mathcal{O}_J$ .
- Add a non-normative note saying that *zcashd* does not fully conform to the requirement to treat *transmission keys* not in  $KA^{Sapling}.PublicPrimeSubgroup$  as invalid when importing *shielded payment addresses*.
- **Retrospective note:** Changing  $KA^{Sapling}.PublicPrimeOrder$  to  $KA^{Sapling}.PublicPrimeSubgroup$  was a mistake and has since been reverted in specification version v2025.6.0. As discussed in notes added in version v2023.4.0 at § 4.20.3 ‘**Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (Sapling and Orchard)**’ on p. 70, librustzcash changed in [librustzcash-109] to enforce that  $pk_d$  is not  $\mathcal{O}_J$ . *zcashd* also used a different implementation for a consensus check on *shielded* coinbase outputs. The missing check on  $pk_d$  for the latter was corrected in [zcashd-6459], and simplified when it was observed to be retrospectively valid in [zcashd-6725]. However [ZIP-216] was only corrected later [Zips-Issue664], at the same time as the publication of v2025.6.0.
- Set *CanopyActivationHeight* for *Testnet*.
- Modify the tables and notes in § 7.10.1 ‘**ZIP 214 Funding Streams**’ on p. 140 to reflect changes in [ZIP-214].
- Updates to reflect [ZIP-211]: add a consensus rule on  $v_{pub}^{old}$  in § 4.3 ‘**JoinSplit Descriptions**’ on p. 40, and a rule about node and wallet support for sending to **Sprout** addresses in § 4.7.1 ‘**Sending Notes (Sprout)**’ on p. 44.
- Refine the domain of *HeightForHalving* from  $\mathbb{N}$  to  $\mathbb{N}^+$ .
- Make *Halving(height)* return 0 (rather than  $-1$ ) for  $height < SlowStartShift$ . This has no effect on consensus since the *Halving* function is not used in that case, but it makes the definition match the intuitive meaning of the function.
- Rename sections under § 7 ‘**Consensus Changes from Bitcoin**’ on p. 122 to clarify that these sections do not only concern encoding, but also consensus rules.

- Make the **Canopy** specification the default.

#### 2020.1.12 2020-08-03

- Include SHA-512 in § 5.4.1.1 ‘SHA-256, SHA-256d, SHA256Compress, and SHA-512 Hash Functions’ on p. 75.
- Add a reference to [BCCGLRT2014] in § 4.1.13 ‘Zero-Knowledge Proving System’ on p. 34.
- Use  $\text{abstBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$  and  $\text{reprBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$  for conversions in § B.3 ‘Ed25519 batch validation’ on p. 223, and fix a missing requirement that  $S_j < \ell$  for all signatures.

#### 2020.1.11 2020-07-13

- Change instances of “the production network” to “Mainnet”, and “the test network” to *Testnet*. This follows the terminology used in ZIPs.
- Update stale references to **Bitcoin** documentation.
- Add changes for [ZIP-207] and [ZIP-214].

#### 2020.1.10 2020-07-05

- Corrections to a note in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90.

#### 2020.1.9 2020-07-05

- Add § 3.12 ‘Mainnet and Testnet’ on p. 23.
- Acknowledge Jane Lusby and teor.
- Precisely specify the encoding and decoding of Ed25519 points.
- Correct an error introduced in v2020.1.8; “ $-\mathcal{O}_j$ ” was incorrectly used when the point  $(0, -1)$  on Jubjub was meant.
- Precisely specify the conversion from a bit sequence in  $\text{abst}_j$ .

#### 2020.1.8 2020-07-04

- Add Ying Tong Lai and Kris Nuttycombe as **Zcash** protocol designers.
- Change the specification of  $\text{abst}_j$  in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102 to match the implementation.
- Repair the argument for  $\text{GroupHash}_{\text{URS}}^{(r)*}$  being usable as a *random oracle*, which previously depended on  $\text{abst}_j$  being injective.
- In RedDSA verification, clarify that  $\underline{R}$  used as part of the input to  $H^\circ$  **MUST** be exactly as encoded in the signature.
- Specify that *shielded outputs* of coinbase transactions **MUST** use v2 note plaintexts after **Canopy** activation.
- Correct a bug in § 4.20.3 ‘Decryption using an Outgoing Viewing Key (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)’ on p. 70:  $\text{esk}$  is only to be checked against  $\text{ToScalar}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([4]))$  when  $\text{leadByte} \neq 0x01$ . [Later edit: this should have been  $\text{ToScalar}(\text{PRF}_{\text{rseed}}^{\text{expand}}([5]))$ .]

#### 2020.1.7 2020-06-26

- Delete some ‘new’ superscripts that only added notational clutter.
- Add an explicit lead byte field to **Sprout** *note plaintexts*, and clearly specify the error handling when it is invalid.
- Define a **Sapling** *note plaintext lead byte* as having type  $\mathbb{Y}$  (so that decoding to a *note plaintext* always succeeds, and error handling is more explicit).
- Fix a sign error in the fixed-base term of the batch validation equation in § B.1 ‘RedDSA *batch validation*’ on p. 220.
- Fix a sign error in the fixed-base term of the batch validation equation in § B.3 ‘Ed25519 *batch validation*’ on p. 223.

#### 2020.1.6 2020-06-17

- Incorporate changes to **Sapling** *note* encryption from [ZIP-212].
- Correct an error in the specification of Ed25519 *validating keys*: they should not have been specified to be checked against PreCanopyExcludedPointEncodings, since libsodium v1.0.15 does not do so.
- Incorporate Ed25519 changes for **Canopy** from [ZIP-215].
- Add Appendix § B.3 ‘Ed25519 *batch validation*’ on p. 223.
- Consistently use “validating” for signatures and “verifying” for proofs.
- Use the symbol  $\sqrt[+]{\cdot}$  for positive square root.

#### 2020.1.5 2020-06-02

- Reference [ZIP-173] instead of BIP 173.
- Mark more index entries as definitions.

#### 2020.1.4 2020-05-27

- Reference [BIP-32] and [ZIP-32] when describing keys and their encodings.
- Network Upgrade 4 has been given the name **Canopy**.
- Reference [ZIP-211], [ZIP-212], and [ZIP-215] for the **Canopy** upgrade.
- Improve LaTeX portability of this specification.

#### 2020.1.3 2020-04-22

- Correct a wording error transposing *transparent inputs* and *transparent outputs* in § 4.12 ‘*Balance (Sprout)*’ on p. 52.
- Minor wording clarifications.
- Reference [ZIP-251], [ZIP-207], and [ZIP-214] for the **Canopy** upgrade.



## 2020.1.2 2020-03-20

- The implementation of **Sprout** Ed25519 signature validation in zcashd differed from what was specified in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90. The specification has been changed to match the implementation.
- Add consensus rules for **Heartwood**.
- Remove “pvc” Makefile targets.
- Make the **Heartwood** specification the default.
- Add macros and Makefile support for building the **Canopy** specification.

## 2020.1.1 2020-02-13

- Resolve conflicts in the specification of *memo fields* by deferring to [ZIP-302].

## 2020.1.0 2020-02-06

- Specify a retrospective soft fork implemented in zcashd v2.1.1-1 that limits the *nTime* field of a *block* relative to its *median-time-past*.
- Correct the definition of *median-time-past* for the first PoWMedianBlockSpan *blocks* in a *block chain*.
- Add acknowledgements to Henry de Valence, Deirdre Connolly, Chelsea Komlo, and Zancas Wilcox.
- Add an acknowledgement to Trail of Bits for their security audit.
- Change indices in the *incremental Merkle tree* diagram to be zero-based.
- Use the term “*monomorphism*” for an injective homomorphism, in the context of a *signature scheme with key monomorphism*.

## 2019.0.9 2019-12-27

- No changes to **Sprout** or **Sapling**.
- Specify the height at which **Blossom** activated.
- Add **Blossom** to § 6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120.
- Add a non-normative note giving the explicit value of *FoundersRewardLastBlockHeight*.
- Clarify the effect of **Blossom** on *SIGHASH transaction hashes*.
- Makefile updates for **Heartwood**.

## 2019.0.8 2019-09-24

- Fix a typo in the generator  $\mathcal{P}_{S_1}$  in § 5.4.9.2 ‘BLS12-381’ on p. 101 found by magrady.
- Clarify the type of  $v^{\text{new}}$  in § 4.7.2 ‘*Sending Notes (Sapling)*’ on p. 45.

## 2019.0.7 2019-09-24

- Fix a discrepancy in the number of constraints for BLAKE2s found by QED-it.
- Fix an error in the expression for  $\Delta$  in § A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210, and add acknowledgement to Kobi Gurkan.
- Fix a typo in § 4.9 ‘*Merkle Path Validity*’ on p. 49 and add acknowledgement to Weikeng Chen.
- Update references to ZIPs and to the Electric Coin Company blog.
- Makefile improvements to suppress unneeded output.

#### 2019.0.6 2019-08-23

- No changes to **Sprout** or **Sapling**.
- Replace dummy **Blossom activation block height** with the *Testnet* height, and a reference to [ZIP-206].

#### 2019.0.5 2019-08-23

- Note the change to the minimum-difficulty threshold time on *Testnet* for **Blossom**.
- Correct the packing of  $nf^{\text{old}}$  into input elements in § A.4 ‘*The Sapling Spend circuit*’ on p. 217.
- Add an epigraph from [Carroll1876] to the start of § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102.
- Clarify how the constant  $c$  in § 5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79 is obtained.
- Add a footnote that *zcashd* uses [ZIP-32] *extended spending keys* instead of the derivation from  $sk$  in § 3.1 ‘*Payment Addresses and Keys*’ on p. 13.
- Remove “optimized” *Makefile* targets (which actually produced a larger PDF, with TeXLive 2019).
- Remove “html” *Makefile* targets.
- Make the **Blossom** spec the default.

#### 2019.0.4 2019-07-23

- Clicking on a section heading now shows section labels.
- Add a **List of Theorems and Lemmata**.
- Changes needed to support TeXLive 2019.

#### 2019.0.3 2019-07-08

- Experimental support for building using LuaTeX and XeTeX.
- Add an **Index**.

#### 2019.0.2 2019-06-18

- Correct a misstatement in the security argument in § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52: *binding for a commitment scheme* does not imply that the commitment determines its randomness. The rest of the security argument did not depend on this; it is simpler to rely on knowledge soundness of the Spend and Output proofs.
- Give a definition for *complete twisted Edwards elliptic curves* in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102.
- Clarify that Theorem 5.4.5 on p. 96 depends on the parameters of the Jubjub curve.
- Ensure that this document builds correctly and without missing characters on recent versions of TeXLive.
- Update the *Makefile* to use Ghostscript for PDF optimization.
- Ensure that hyperlinks are preserved, and available as “Destination names” in URL fragments and links from other PDF documents.

#### 2019.0.1 2019-05-20

- No changes to **Sprout** or **Sapling**.
- Minor fix to the list of integer constants in § 2 ‘*Notation*’ on p. 10.
- Use `IsBlossomActivated` in the definition of `FounderAddressAdjustedHeight` for consistency.

## 2019.0.0 2019-05-01

- Fix a specification error in the *Founders' Reward* calculation during the slow start period.
- Correct an inconsistency in difficulty adjustment between the spec and zcashd implementation for the first PoWAveragingWindow – 1 *blocks* of the *block chain*. This inconsistency was pointed out by NCC Group in their **Blossom** specification audit.
- Revert changes for *funding streams* from Withdrawn ZIP 207.

## 2019.0-beta-39 2019-04-18

- Change author affiliations from “ZeroCoin Electric Coin Company” to “Electric Coin Company”.
- Add acknowledgement to Mary Maller for the observation that *diversified payment address* unlinkability can be proven in the same way as *key privacy* for ElGamal.

## 2019.0-beta-38 2019-04-18

- Update the following sections to match the current draft of [ZIP-208]:
  - §7.7.3 ‘*Difficulty adjustment*’ on p.134
  - §7.8 ‘*Calculating Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, Lockbox Disbursement, and Founders' Reward*’ on p.136
- Specify *funding streams*, along with the draft *funding streams* defined in the current draft of ZIP 207.
- Update the following sections to match the current draft of ZIP 207:
  - §3.10 ‘*Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, and Founders' Reward*’ on p.22
  - §3.11 ‘*Coinbase Transactions*’ on p.22
  - §7.8 ‘*Calculating Block Subsidy, Funding Streams, Lockbox Disbursement, and Founders' Reward*’ on p.136
  - §7.9 ‘*Payment of Founders' Reward*’ on p.137
- Correct the generators  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{S}_1}$  and  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{S}_2}$  for BLS12-381.
- Update README.rst to include Makefile targets for **Blossom**.
- Makefile updates:
  - Fix a typo for the pvcblossom target.
  - Update the pinned git hashes for sam2p and pdfsizeopt.

## 2019.0-beta-37 2019-02-22

- The rule that miners **SHOULD NOT** mine *blocks* that chain to other *blocks* with a *block version number* greater than 4, has been removed. This is because such *blocks* (mined nonconformantly) exist in the current *Mainnet* consensus *block chain*.
- Clarify that *Equihash* is based on a *variation* of the Generalized Birthday Problem, and cite [AR2017].
- Update reference [BGG2017] (previously [BGG2016]).
- Clarify which transaction fields are added by **Overwinter** and **Sapling**.
- Correct the rule about when a *transaction* is permitted to have no *transparent* inputs.
- Explain the differences between the system in [Groth2016] and what we refer to as Groth16.
- Reference Mary Maller's security proof for Groth16 [Maller2018].
- Correct [BGM2018] to [BGM2017].

- Fix a typo in § B.2 ‘Groth16 *batch verification*’ on p. 221 and clarify the costs of Groth16 batch verification.
- Add macros and Makefile support for building the **Blossom** specification.

2019.0-beta-36 2019-02-09

- Correct isis agora lovecruft’s name.

2019.0-beta-35 2019-02-08

- Cite [Gabizon2019] and acknowledge Ariel Gabizon.
- Correct [SBB2019] to [SWB2019].
- The [Gabizon2019] vulnerability affected Soundness of BCTV14 as well as Knowledge Soundness.
- Clarify the history of the [Parno2015] vulnerability and acknowledge Bryan Parno.
- Specify the difficulty adjustment change that occurred on *Testnet* at *block height* 299188.
- Add Eirik Ogilvie-Wigley and Benjamin Winston to acknowledgements.
- Rename *zk-SNARK Parameters* sections to be named according to the proving system (BCTV14 or Groth16), not the *shielded protocol* construction (**Sprout** or **Sapling**).
- In § 6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120, say when **Sapling** activated.

2019.0-beta-34 2019-02-05

- Disclose a security vulnerability in BCTV14 that affected **Sprout** before activation of the **Sapling network upgrade** (see § 5.4.10.1 ‘BCTV14’ on p. 110).
- Rename PHGR13 to BCTV2014.
- Rename reference [BCTV2015] to [BCTV2014a], and [BCTV2014] to [BCTV2014b].

2018.0-beta-33 2018-11-14

- Complete § A.4 ‘*The **Sapling** Spend circuit*’ on p. 217.
- Add § A.5 ‘*The **Sapling** Output circuit*’ on p. 219.
- Change the description of window lookup in § A.3.3.7 ‘*Fixed-base Affine-ctEdwards scalar multiplication*’ on p. 208 to match sapling-crypto.
- Describe 2-bit window lookup with conditional negation in § A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210.
- Fix or complete various calculations of constraint costs.
- Adjust the notation used for scalar multiplication in Appendix A to allow *bit sequences* as scalars.

2018.0-beta-32 2018-10-24

- Correct the input to  $H^\circ$  used to derive the nonce  $r$  in  $\text{RedDSA.Sign}$ , from  $T \parallel M$  to  $T \parallel \underline{vk} \parallel M$ . This matches the sapling-crypto implementation; the specification of this input was unintentionally changed in v2018.0-beta-20.
- Clarify the description of the Merkle path check in § A.3.4 ‘*Merkle path check*’ on p. 213.

## 2018.0-beta-31 2018-09-30

- Correct some uses of  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  that should have been  $r_{\mathbb{S}}$  or  $q$ .
- Correct uses of  $\text{LEOS2IP}_{\ell}$  in `RedDSA.Validate` and `RedDSA.BatchValidate` to ensure that  $\ell$  is a multiple of 8 as required.
- Minor changes to avoid clashing notation for Edwards curves  $E_{\text{Edwards}(a,d)}$ , *Montgomery curves*  $E_{\text{Mont}(A,B)}$ , and extractors  $\mathcal{E}_{\mathcal{A}}$ .
- Correct a use of  $\mathbb{J}$  that should have been  $\mathbb{M}$  in the proof of Theorem A.3.4 on p. 206, and make a minor tweak to the theorem statement ( $k_2 \neq \pm k_1$  instead of  $k_1 \neq \pm k_2$ ) to make the contradiction derived by the proof clearer.
- Clarify notation in the proof of Theorem A.3.3 on p. 206.
- Address some of the findings of the QED-it report:
  - Improved cross-referencing in § 5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79.
  - Clarify the notes concerning domain separation of prefixes in § 5.4.1.3 ‘*MerkleCRH<sup>Sapling</sup> Hash Function*’ on p. 76 and § 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96.
  - Correct the statement and proof of Theorem A.3.2 on p. 206.
- Add the QED-it report to the acknowledgements.

## 2018.0-beta-30 2018-09-02

- Give an informal security argument for Unlinkability of *diversified payment addresses* based on reduction to *key privacy* of ElGamal encryption, for which a security proof is given in [BBDP2001]. (This argument has gaps which will be addressed in a future version.)
- Add a reference to [BGM2017] for the **Sapling** zk-SNARK parameters.
- Write § A.4 ‘*The **Sapling** Spend circuit*’ on p. 217 (draft).
- Add a reference to the ristretto\_bulletproofs design notes [Dalek-notes] for the synthetic blinding factor technique.
- Ensure that the constraint costs in § A.3.3.1 ‘*Checking that Affine-ctEdwards coordinates are on the curve*’ on p. 205 and § A.3.3.6 ‘*Affine-ctEdwards nonsmall-order check*’ on p. 208 accurately reflect the implementation in sapling-crypto.
- Minor correction to the non-normative note in § A.3.2.2 ‘*Range check*’ on p. 203.
- Clarify non-normative note in § 4.1.8 ‘*Commitment*’ on p. 31 about the definitions of `ValueCommitSapling.Output` and `NoteCommitSapling.Output`.
- Clarify that the signer of a *spend authorization signature* is supposed to choose the *spend authorization randomizer*,  $\alpha$ , itself. Only step 4 in § 4.15 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (**Sapling** and **Orchard**)*’ on p. 57 may securely be delegated.
- Add a non-normative note to § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92 explaining that RedDSA key randomization may interact with other uses of additive properties of Schnorr keys.
- Add dates to Change History entries. (These are the dates of the git tags in local, i.e. UK, time.)

## 2018.0-beta-29 2018-08-15

- Finish § A.3.2.2 ‘*Range check*’ on p. 203.
- Change § A.3.7 ‘*BLAKE2s hashes*’ on p. 214 to correct the constraint count and to describe batched equality checks performed by the sapling-crypto implementation.

2018.0-beta-28 2018-08-14

- Finish § A.3.7 *'BLAKE2s hashes'* on p. 214.
- Minor corrections to § A.3.3.8 *'Variable-base Affine-ctEdwards scalar multiplication'* on p. 209.

2018.0-beta-27 2018-08-12

- Notational changes:
  - Use a superscript  $^{(r)}$  to mark the subgroup order, instead of a subscript.
  - Use  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)*}$  for the set of  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ -order points in  $\mathbb{G}$ .
  - Mark the subgroup order in pairing groups, e.g. use  $\mathbb{G}_1^{(r)}$  instead of  $\mathbb{G}_1$ .
  - Make the bit-representation indicator  $\star$  an affix instead of a superscript.
- Clarify that when validating a Groth16 proof, it is necessary to perform a subgroup check for  $\pi_A$  and  $\pi_C$  as well as for  $\pi_B$ .
- Correct the description of Groth16 batch verification to explicitly take account of how verification depends on *primary inputs*.
- Add Charles Rackoff, Rafail Ostrovsky, and Amit Sahai to the acknowledgements section for their work on *zero-knowledge proofs*.

2018.0-beta-26 2018-08-05

- Add § B.2 *'Groth16 batch verification'* on p. 221.

2018.0-beta-25 2018-08-05

- Add the hashes of parameter files for **Sapling**.
- Add cross references for parameters and functions used in RedDSA batch validation.
- Makefile changes: name the PDF file for the **Sprout** version of the specification as `sprout.pdf`, and make `protocol.pdf` link to the **Sapling** version.

2018.0-beta-24 2018-07-31

- Add a missing consensus rule for version 4 *transactions*: if there are no **Sapling** Spends or Outputs, then `valueBalanceSapling` **MUST** be 0.

2018.0-beta-23 2018-07-27

- Update RedDSA validation to use cofactor multiplication. This is necessary in order for the output of batch validation to match that of unbatched validation in all cases.
- Add § B.1 *'RedDSA batch validation'* on p. 220.



## 2018.0-beta-22 2018-07-18

- Update § 6 ‘*Network Upgrades*’ on p. 120 to take account that **Overwinter** has activated.
- The recommendation for *transactions* without *JoinSplit* descriptions to be version 1 applies only before **Overwinter**, not before **Sapling**.
- Complete the proof of Theorem A.3.5 on p. 211.
- Add a note about redundancy in the nonsmall-order checking of  $rk$ .
- Clarify the use of  $cv^{new}$  and  $cm^{new}$ , and the selection of *outgoing viewing key*, in sending **Sapling** notes.
- Delete the description of optimizations for the affine twisted Edwards nonsmall-order check, since the **Sapling** circuit does not use them. Also clarify that some other optimizations are not used.

## 2018.0-beta-21 2018-06-22

- Remove the consensus rule “If  $nJoinSplit > 0$ , the *transaction* **MUST NOT** use *SIGHASH* types other than *SIGHASH\_ALL*,” which was never implemented.
- Add section on signature hashing.
- Briefly describe the changes to computation of *SIGHASH* transaction hashes in **Sprout**.
- Clarify that interstitial *treestates* form a tree for each *transaction* containing *JoinSplit* descriptions.
- Correct the description of *P2PKH* addresses in § 5.6.1.1 ‘*Transparent Addresses*’ on p. 113 — they use a hash of a compressed, not an uncompressed ECDSA key representation.
- Clarify the wording of the caveat<sup>4</sup> about the claimed security of shielded *transactions*.
- Correct the definition of set difference  $(S \setminus T)$ .
- Add a note concerning malleability of *zk-SNARK* proofs.
- Clarify attribution of the **Zcash** protocol design.
- Acknowledge Alex Biryukov and Dmitry Khovratovich as the designers of *Equihash*.
- Acknowledge Shafi Goldwasser, Silvio Micali, Oded Goldreich, Rosario Gennaro, Bryan Parno, Jon Howell, Craig Gentry, Mariana Raykova, and Jens Groth for their work on *zero-knowledge proving systems*.
- Acknowledge Tomas Sander and Amnon Ta-Shma for [ST1999].
- Acknowledge Kudelski Security’s audit.
- Use the more precise subgroup types  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$  and  $\mathbb{J}^{(r)}$  in preference to  $\mathbb{G}$  and  $\mathbb{J}$  where applicable.
- Change the types of *auxiliary inputs* to the *Spend statement* and *Output statement*, to be more faithful to the implementation.
- Rename the  $cm$  field of an *Output description* to  $cm_u$ , reflecting the fact that it is a Jubjub curve  $u$ -coordinate.
- Add explicit consensus rules that the  $anchorSapling$  field of a *Spend description* and the  $cm_u$  field of an *Output description* must be canonical encodings.
- Enforce that  $esk$  in  $outCiphertext$  is a canonical encoding.
- Add consensus rules that  $cv$  in a *Spend description*, and  $cv$  and  $epk$  in an *Output description*, are not of *small order*. Exclude 0 from the range of  $esk$  when encrypting **Sapling** notes.
- Add a consensus rule that  $valueBalanceSapling$  is in the range  $\{-MAX\_MONEY .. MAX\_MONEY\}$ .
- Enforce stronger constraints on the types of key components  $pk_d$ ,  $ak$ , and  $nk$ .
- Correct the conformance rule for  $fOverwintered$  (it must not be set before **Overwinter** has activated, not before **Sapling** has activated).
- Correct the argument that  $v^*$  is in range in § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p. 52.

- Correct an error in the algorithm for `RedDSA.Validate`: the *validating key* `vk` is given directly to this algorithm and should not be computed from the unknown *signing key* `sk`.
- Correct or improve the types of `GroupHashJ(r)*`, `FindGroupHashJ(r)*`, `ExtractJ(r)`, `PRFexpand`, `PRFockSapling`, and `CRHivk`.
- Instantiate `PRFockSapling` using BLAKE2b-256.
- Change the syntax of a *commitment scheme* to add `COMM.GenTrapdoor`. This is necessary because the intended distribution of *commitment trapdoors* may not be uniform on all values that are acceptable *trapdoor* inputs.
- Add notes on the purpose of *outgoing viewing keys*.
- Correct the encoding of a *full viewing key* (`ovk` was missing).
- Ensure that **Sprout** functions and values are given **Sprout**-specific types where appropriate.
- Improve cross-referencing.
- Clarify the use of BCTV14 vs Groth16 proofs in *JoinSplit statements*.
- Clarify that the  $\sqrt{a}$  notation refers to the positive square root. (This matters for the conversion in § A.3.3.3 ‘*ctEdwards*  $\leftrightarrow$  *Montgomery conversion*’ on p.205.)
- Model the group hash as a *random oracle*. This appears to be unavoidable in order to allow proving unlinkability of `DiversifyHashSapling`. Explain how this relates to the Discrete Logarithm Independence assumption used previously, and justify this modelling by showing that it follows from treating BLAKE2s-256 as a *random oracle* in the instantiation of `GroupHashJ(r)*`.
- Rename CRS (Common Random String) to URS (*Uniform Random String*), to match the terminology adopted at the first ZKProof workshop held in Boston, Massachusetts on May 10–11, 2018.
- Generalize `PRFexpand` to accept an arbitrary-length input. (This specification does not use that generalization, but [ZIP-32] does.)
- Change the notation for a multiplication constraint in Appendix § A ‘*Circuit Design*’ on p.200 to avoid potential confusion with cartesian product.
- Clarify the wording of the abstract.
- Correct statements about which algorithms are instantiated by BLAKE2s and BLAKE2b.
- Add a note explaining which conformance requirements of BIP 173 (defining *Bech32*) apply.
- Add the Jubjub bird image to the title page. This image has been edited from a scan of Peter Newell’s original illustration (as it appeared in [Carroll1902]) to remove the background and Bandersnatch, and to restore the bird’s clipped right wing.
- Change the light yellow background to white (indicating that this **Overwinter** and **Sapling** specification is no longer a draft).

## 2018.0-beta-20 2018-05-22

- Add Michael Dixon and Andrew Poelstra to acknowledgements.
- Minor improvements to cross-references.
- Correct the order of arguments to `RedDSA.RandomizePrivate` and `RedDSA.RandomizePublic`.
- Correct a reference to `RedDSA.RandomizePrivate` that was intended to be `RedDSA.RandomizePublic`.
- Fix the description of the *Sapling balancing value* in § 4.13 ‘*Balance and Binding Signature (Sapling)*’ on p.52.
- Correct a type error in § 5.4.9.5 ‘*Group Hash into Jubjub*’ on p.104.
- Correct a type error in `RedDSA.Sign` in § 5.4.7 ‘*RedDSA, RedJubjub, and RedPallas*’ on p.92.

- Ensure  $\mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}}$  is defined in § 5.4.7.1 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95.
- Make the *validating key* prefix part of the input to the *hash function* in RedDSA, not part of the message.
- Correct the statement about  $\text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$  never returning  $\perp$ .
- Correct an error in the computation of generators for *Pedersen hashes*.
- Change the order in which  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$  commits to its inputs, to match the sapling-crypto implementation.
- Fail **Sapling** key generation if  $\text{ivk} = 0$ . (This has negligible probability.)
- Change the notation  $H^*$  to  $H^\circ$  in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92, to avoid confusion with the  $*$  convention for representations of group elements.
- $\text{cmu}$  encodes only the  $u$ -coordinate of the *note commitment*, not the full curve point.
- $\text{rk}$  is checked to be not of *small order* outside the *Spend statement*, not in the *Spend statement*.
- Change terminology describing constraint systems.

2018.0-beta-19 2018-04-23

- Minor clarifications.

2018.0-beta-18 2018-04-23

- Clarify the security argument for balance in **Sapling**.
- Correct a subtle problem with the type of the value input to  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , although it is only directly used to commit to values in  $\{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}}-1\}$ , the security argument depends on a sum of commitments being *binding* on  $\{-\frac{r_3-1}{2} \dots \frac{r_3-1}{2}\}$ .
- Fix the loss of tightness in the use of  $\text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}$  by specifying the keyspace more precisely.
- Correct type ambiguities for  $\rho$ .
- Specify the representation of  $i$  in group  $\mathbb{G}_2$  of BLS12-381.

2018.0-beta-17 2018-04-21

- Correct an error in the definition of **DefaultDiversifier**.

2018.0-beta-16 2018-04-21

- Explicitly note that outputs from *coinbase transactions* include *Founders’ Reward* outputs.
- The point represented by  $\underline{R}$  in an Ed25519 signature is checked to not be of *small order*; this is not the same as checking that it is of *prime order*  $\ell$ .
- Specify support for [BIP-111] (the `NODE_BLOOM` service bit) in *peer-to-peer protocol* version 170004.
- Give references [Vercauter2009] and [AKLGL2010] for the optimal ate pairing.
- Give references for BLS [BLS2002] and BN [BN2005] curves.
- Define  $\text{KA}^{\text{Sprout}}.\text{DerivePublic}$  for Curve25519.
- Caveat the claim about *note traceability set* in § 1.2 ‘*High-level Overview*’ on p. 8 and link to [Peterson2017] and [Quesnelle2017].
- Do not require a generator as part of the specification of a *represented group*; instead, define it in the *represented pairing* or scheme using the group.

- Refactor the abstract definition of a *signature scheme* to allow derivation of *validating keys* independent of key pair generation.
- Correct the explanation in §1.2 ‘*High-level Overview*’ on p. 8 to apply to **Sapling**.
- Add the definition of a *signing key* to *validating key* homomorphism for *signature schemes*.
- Remove the output index as an input to  $\text{KDF}^{\text{Sapling}}$ .
- Allow dummy **Sapling** input *notes*.
- Specify RedDSA and RedJubjub.
- Specify *Sapling binding signatures* and *spend authorization signatures*.
- Specify the randomness beacon.
- Add *outgoing ciphertexts* and *ock*.
- Define DefaultDiversifier.
- Change the *Spend circuit* and *Output circuit* specifications to remove unintended differences from sapling-crypto.
- Use  $h_J$  to refer to the Jubjub curve cofactor, rather than 8.
- Correct an error in the  $y$ -coordinate formula for addition in §A.3.3.4 ‘*Affine-Montgomery arithmetic*’ on p.206 (the constraints were correct).
- Add acknowledgements for Brian Warner, Mary Maller, and the Least Authority audit.
- Makefile improvements.

#### 2018.0-beta-15 2018-03-19

- Clarify the bit ordering of SHA-256.
- Drop `_t` from the names of representation types.
- Remove functions from the **Sprout** specification that it does not use.
- Updates to transaction format and consensus rules for Overwinter and Sapling.
- Add specification of the *Output statement*.
- Change  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}$  from 29 to 32.
- Updates to **Sapling** construction, changing how the *nullifier* is computed and separating it from the *randomized Spend validating key* ( $rk$ ).
- Clarify conversions between *bit sequences* and *byte sequences* for  $sk$ ,  $\text{repr}_J(ak)$ , and  $\text{repr}_J(nk)$ .
- Change the Makefile to avoid multiple reloads in PDF readers while rebuilding the PDF.
- Spacing and pagination improvements.

#### 2018.0-beta-14 2018-03-11

- Only cosmetic changes to **Sprout**.
- Simplify  $\text{FindGroupHash}^{J^{(r)*}}$  to use a single-byte index.
- Changes to diversification for *Pedersen hashes* and *Pedersen commitments*.
- Improve security definitions for signatures.

## 2018.0-beta-13 2018-03-11

- Only cosmetic changes to **Sprout**.
- Change how  $(ask, nsk)$  are derived from the *spending key*  $sk$  to ensure they are on the full range of  $\mathbb{F}_{r_j}$ .
- Change  $PRF^{nr}$  to produce output computationally indistinguishable from uniform on  $\mathbb{F}_{r_j}$ .
- Change  $Uncommitted^{Sapling}_t$  to be a  $u$ -coordinate for which there is no point on the curve.
- Appendix A updates:
  - categorize components into larger sections
  - fill in the [de]compression and validation algorithm
  - more precisely state the assumptions for inputs and outputs
  - delete not-all-one component which is no longer needed
  - factor out xor into its own component
  - specify [un]packing more precisely; separate it from boolean constraints
  - optimize checking for non-*small order*
  - notation in variable-base multiplication algorithm.

## 2018.0-beta-12 2018-03-06

- Add references to **Overwinter** ZIPs and update the section on **Overwinter/Sapling** transitions.
- Add a section on re-randomizable signatures.
- Add definition of  $PRF^{nr}$ .
- Work-in-progress on **Sapling** statements.
- Rename “raw” to “homomorphic” *Pedersen commitments*.
- Add packing modulo the field size and range checks to Appendix A.
- Update the algorithm for variable-base scalar multiplication to what is implemented by **sapling-crypto**.

## 2018.0-beta-11 2018-02-26

- Add sections on *Spend descriptions* and *Output descriptions*.
- Swap order of  $cv$  and  $rt$  in a *Spend description* for consistency.
- Fix off-by-one error in the range of  $ivk$ .

## 2018.0-beta-10 2018-02-26

- Split the descriptions of SHA-256 and SHA256Compress and of **BLAKE2**, into their own sections. Specify SHA256Compress more precisely.
- Add Kexin Hu to acknowledgements (for the idea of explicitly encoding the root of the **Sapling** note commitment tree in block headers).
- Move bit/byte/integer conversion primitives into §5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p.73.
- Refer to **Overwinter** and **Sapling** just as “upgrades” in the abstract, not as the next “minor version” and “major version”.
- $PRF^{nr}$  must be *collision-resistant*.
- Correct an error in the *Pedersen hash* specification.
- Use a named variable,  $c$ , for chunks per segment in the *Pedersen hash* specification, and change its value from 61 to 63. Add a proof justifying this value of  $c$ .

- Specify *Pedersen commitments*.
- Notation changes.
- Generalize the *distinct- $x$  criterion* (Theorem A.3.4 on p. 206) to allow negative indices.

#### 2018.0-beta-9 2018-02-10

- Specify the coinbase maturity rule, and the rule that *coinbase transactions* cannot contain *JoinSplit descriptions*, *Spend descriptions*, or *Output descriptions*.
- Delay lifting the 100000-byte *transaction* size limit from **Overwinter** to **Sapling**.
- Improve presentation of the proof of injectivity for  $\text{Extract}_{\mathbb{J}}^{(r)}$ .
- Specify  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$ .
- Specify *Pedersen hashes*.

#### 2018.0-beta-8 2018-02-08

- Add instantiation of  $\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}$ .
- Add instantiation of a hash extractor (later renamed to *coordinate extractor*) for Jubjub.
- Make the background lighter and the **Sapling** green darker, for contrast.

#### 2018.0-beta-7 2018-02-07

- Specify the 100000-byte limit on *transaction* size. (The implementation in `zcashd` was as intended.)
- Specify that `0xF6` followed by 511 zero bytes encodes an empty *memo field*.
- Reference security definitions for *Pseudo Random Functions* and *Pseudo Random Generators*.
- Rename `clamp` to `bound` and `ActualTimespanClamped` to `ActualTimespanBounded` in the difficulty adjustment algorithm, to avoid a name collision with Curve25519 scalar “clamping”.
- Change uses of the term *full node* to *full validator*. A *full node* by definition participates in the *peer-to-peer network*, whereas a *full validator* just needs a copy of the *block chain* from somewhere. The latter is what was meant.
- Add an explanation of how **Sapling** prevents Faerie Gold and roadblock attacks.
- **Sapling** work in progress.

#### 2018.0-beta-6 2018-01-31

- **Sapling** work in progress, mainly on Appendix § A ‘*Circuit Design*’ on p. 200.

#### 2018.0-beta-5 2018-01-30

- Specify more precisely the requirements on Ed25519 *validating keys* and signatures.
- **Sapling** work in progress.

#### 2018.0-beta-4 2018-01-25

- Update key components diagram for **Sapling**.



#### 2018.0-beta-3 2018-01-22

- Explain how the chosen fix to Faerie Gold avoids a potential “roadblock” attack.
- Update some explanations of changes from **Zerocash** for **Sapling**.
- Add a description of the Jubjub curve.
- Add an acknowledgement to George Tankersley.
- Add an appendix on the design of the **Sapling** circuits at the *quadratic constraint program* level.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.9 2017-12-17

- Refer to  $sk_{enc}$  as a *receiving key* rather than as a viewing key.
- Updates for *incoming viewing key* support.
- Refer to Network Upgrade 0 as **Overwinter**.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.8 2017-12-02

- Correct the non-normative note describing how to check the order of  $\pi_B$ .
- Initial version of draft **Sapling** protocol specification.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.7 2017-07-10

- Fix an off-by-one error in the specification of the *Equihash* algorithm binding condition. (The implementation in *zcashd* was as intended.)
- Correct the types and consensus rules for *transaction version numbers* and *block version numbers*. (Again, the implementation in *zcashd* was as intended.)
- Clarify the computation of  $h_i$  in a *JoinSplit* statement.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.6 2017-05-09

- Be more precise when talking about curve points and pairing groups.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.5 2017-03-07

- Clarify the consensus rule preventing *double-spends*.
- Clarify what a *note commitment* opens to in § 8.8 ‘*Omission in **Zerocash** security proof*’ on p.148.
- Correct the order of arguments to COMM in § 5.4.8.1 ‘**Sprout** Note Commitments’ on p.95.
- Correct a statement about indistinguishability of *JoinSplit* descriptions.
- Change the *Founders’ Reward* addresses, for *Testnet* only, to reflect the hard-fork upgrade described in [Zcash-Issue2113].

#### 2017.0-beta-2.4 2017-02-25

- Explain a variation on the Faerie Gold attack and why it is prevented.
- Generalize the description of the InternalH attack to include finding collisions on  $(a_{pk}, \rho)$  rather than just on  $\rho$ .
- Rename  $enforce_i$  to  $enforceMerklePath_i$ .

#### 2017.0-beta-2.3 2017-02-12

- Specify the security requirements on the SHA256Compress function, in order for the scheme in §5.4.8.1 ‘**Sprout Note Commitments**’ on p. 95 to be a secure commitment.
- Specify  $\mathbb{G}_2$  more precisely.
- Explain the use of interstitial *treestates* in chained *JoinSplit transfers*.

#### 2017.0-beta-2.2 2017-02-11

- Give definitions of computational *binding* and computational *hiding* for *commitment schemes*.
- Give a definition of statistical zero knowledge.
- Reference the white paper on MPC parameter generation [BGG2017].

#### 2017.0-beta-2.1 2017-02-06

- $\ell_{\text{Merkle}}$  is a bit length, not a byte length.
- Specify the maximum *block* size.

#### 2017.0-beta-2 2017-02-04

- Add abstract and keywords.
- Fix a typo in the definition of *nullifier* integrity.
- Make the description of *block chains* more consistent with upstream **Bitcoin** documentation (referring to “best” chains rather than using the concept of a *block chain view*).
- Define how nodes select a *best valid block chain*.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.13 2017-01-20

- Specify the difficulty adjustment algorithm.
- Clarify some definitions of fields in a *block header*.
- Define  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  in §4.2.1 ‘**Sprout Key Components**’ on p. 36.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.12 2017-01-09

- Update the hashes of proving and verifying keys for the final Sprout parameters.
- Add cross references from *shielded payment address* and *spending key* encoding sections to where the key components are specified.
- Add acknowledgements for Filippo Valsorda and Zaki Manian.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.11 2016-12-19

- Specify a check on the order of  $\pi_B$  in a *zk-SNARK proof*.
- Note that due to an oversight, the **Zcash** *genesis block* does not follow [BIP-34].

#### 2016.0-beta-1.10 2016-10-30

- Update reference to the *Equihash* paper [BK2016]. (The newer version has no algorithmic changes, but the section discussing potential ASIC implementations is substantially expanded.)
- Clarify the discussion of proof size in “Differences from the **Zerocash** paper”.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.9 2016-10-28

- Add *Founders' Reward* addresses for *Mainnet*.
- Change “*protected*” terminology to “*shielded*”.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.8 2016-10-04

- Revise the lead bytes for *transparent P2SH* and *P2PKH* addresses, and reencode the *Testnet Founders' Reward* addresses.
- Add a section on which BIPs apply to **Zcash**.
- Specify that OP\_CODESEPARATOR has been disabled, and no longer affects *SIGHASH transaction hashes*.
- Change the representation type of *vpub\_old* and *vpub\_new* to `uint64`. (This is not a consensus change because the type of  $v_{pub}^{old}$  and  $v_{pub}^{new}$  was already specified to be  $\{0..MAX\_MONEY\}$ ; it just better reflects the implementation.)
- Correct the representation type of the *block nVersion* field to `uint32`.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.7 2016-10-02

- Clarify the consensus rule for payment of the *Founders' Reward*, in response to an issue raised by the NCC audit.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.6 2016-09-26

- Fix an error in the definition of the sortedness condition for *Equihash*: it is the sequences of indices that are sorted, not the sequences of hashes.
- Correct the number of bytes in the encoding of *solutionSize*.
- Update the section on encoding of *transparent addresses*. (The precise prefixes are not decided yet.)
- Clarify why *BLAKE2b- $\ell$*  is different from truncated *BLAKE2b-512*.
- Clarify a note about SU-CMA security for signatures.
- Add a note about  $PRF^{nfSprout}$  corresponding to  $PRF^{sn}$  in **Zerocash**.
- Add a paragraph about key length in § 8.7 ‘*In-band secret distribution*’ on p. 147.
- Add acknowledgements for John Tromp, Paige Peterson, Maureen Walsh, Jay Graber, and Jack Gavigan.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.5 2016-09-22

- Update the *Founders' Reward* address list.
- Add some clarifications based on Eli Ben-Sasson’s review.

#### 2016.0-beta-1.4 2016-09-19

- Specify the *block subsidy*, *miner subsidy*, and the *Founders' Reward*.
- Specify *coinbase transaction* outputs to *Founders' Reward* addresses.
- Improve notation (for example “ $\cdot$ ” for multiplication and “ $T^{[\ell]}$ ” for sequence types) to avoid ambiguity.

### 2016.0-beta-1.3 2016-09-16

- Correct the omission of `solutionSize` from the *block header* format.
- Document that `compactSize` encodings must be canonical.
- Add a note about conformance language in the introduction.
- Add acknowledgements for Solar Designer, Ling Ren and Alison Stevenson, and for the NCC Group and Coinspect security audits.

### 2016.0-beta-1.2 2016-09-11

- Remove GeneralCRH in favour of specifying `hSigCRH` and `EquihashGen` directly in terms of `BLAKE2b-ℓ`.
- Correct the security requirement for `EquihashGen`.

### 2016.0-beta-1.1 2016-09-05

- Add a specification of abstract signatures.
- Clarify what is signed in the “Sending Notes” section.
- Specify ZK parameter generation as a randomized algorithm, rather than as a distribution of parameters.

### 2016.0-beta-1 2016-09-04

- Major reorganization to separate the abstract cryptographic protocol from the algorithm instantiations.
- Add type declarations.
- Add a “High-level Overview” section.
- Add a section specifying the *zero-knowledge proving system* and the encoding of proofs. Change the encoding of points in proofs to follow IEEE Std 1363[a].
- Add a section on consensus changes from **Bitcoin**, and the specification of *Equihash*.
- Complete the “Differences from the **Zerocash** paper” section.
- Correct the Merkle tree depth to 29.
- Change the length of *memo fields* to 512 bytes.
- Switch the *JoinSplit signature* scheme to Ed25519, with consequent changes to the computation of `hSig`.
- Fix the lead bytes in *shielded payment address* and *spending key* encodings to match the implemented protocol.
- Add a consensus rule about the ranges of  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{old}}$  and  $v_{\text{pub}}^{\text{new}}$ .
- Clarify cryptographic security requirements and added definitions relating to the *in-band* secret distribution.
- Add various citations: the “Fixing Vulnerabilities in the Zcash Protocol” and “Why Equihash?” blog posts, several crypto papers for security definitions, the **Bitcoin** whitepaper, the **CryptoNote** whitepaper, and several references to **Bitcoin** documentation.
- Reference the extended version of the **Zerocash** paper rather than the Oakland proceedings version.
- Add *JoinSplit transfers* to the Concepts section.
- Add a section on Coinbase Transactions.
- Add acknowledgements for Jack Grigg, Simon Liu, Ariel Gabizon, jl777, Ben Blaxill, Alex Balducci, and Jake Tarren.
- Fix a `Makefile` compatibility problem with the escaping behaviour of `echo`.

- Switch to biber for the bibliography generation, and add backreferences.
- Make the date format in references more consistent.
- Add visited dates to all URLs in references.
- Terminology changes.

#### 2016.0-alpha-3.1 2016-05-20

- Change main font to Quattrocento.

#### 2016.0-alpha-3 2016-05-09

- Change version numbering convention (no other changes).

#### 2.0-alpha-3 2016-05-06

- Allow anchoring to any previous output *treestate* in the same *transaction*, rather than just the immediately preceding output *treestate*.
- Add change history.

#### 2.0-alpha-2 2016-04-21

- Change from truncated BLAKE2b-512 to BLAKE2b-256.
- Clarify endianness, and that uses of BLAKE2b are unkeyed.
- Minor correction to what *SIGHASH types* cover.
- Add “as intended for the **Zcash** release of summer 2016” to title page.
- Require  $\text{PRF}^{\text{addr}}$  to be *collision-resistant* (see § 8.8 ‘*Omission in Zerocash security proof*’ on p. 148).
- Add specification of path computation for the *incremental Merkle tree*.
- Add a note in § 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60 about how this condition corresponds to conditions in the **Zerocash** paper.
- Changes to terminology around keys.

#### 2.0-alpha-1 2016-03-30

- First version intended for public review.

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## Appendices

### A Circuit Design

#### A.1 Quadratic Constraint Programs

**Sapling** defines two circuits, Spend and Output, each implementing an abstract *statement* described in § 4.18.2 ‘*Spend Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 61 and § 4.18.3 ‘*Output Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 62 respectively. It also adds a Groth16 circuit for the *JoinSplit statement* described in § 4.18.1 ‘*JoinSplit Statement (Sprout)*’ on p. 60.

At the next lower level, each circuit is defined in terms of a *quadratic constraint program* (specifying a *Rank 1 Constraint System*), as detailed in this section. In the BCTV14 or Groth16 proving systems, this program is translated to a *Quadratic Arithmetic Program* [BCTV2014a, section 2.3] [WCBTV2015]. The circuit descriptions given here are necessary to compute witness elements for each circuit, as well as the proving and verifying keys.

Let  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  be the finite field over which Jubjub is defined, as given in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102.

A *quadratic constraint program* consists of a set of constraints over variables in  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ , each of the form:

$$(A) \times (B) = (C)$$

where  $(A)$ ,  $(B)$ , and  $(C)$  are *linear combinations* of variables and constants in  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ .

Here  $\times$  and  $\cdot$  both represent multiplication in the field  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ , but we use  $\times$  for multiplications corresponding to gates of the circuit, and  $\cdot$  for multiplications by constants in the terms of a *linear combination*.  $\times$  should not be confused with  $\times$  which is defined as cartesian product in § 2 ‘*Notation*’ on p. 10.

#### A.2 Elliptic curve background

The **Sapling** circuits make use of a *complete twisted Edwards elliptic curve* (“*ctEdwards curve*”) Jubjub, defined in § 5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p. 102, and also a *Montgomery elliptic curve*  $\mathbb{M}$  that is birationally equivalent to Jubjub. Following the notation in [BL2017] we use  $(u, v)$  for affine coordinates on the *ctEdwards curve*, and  $(x, y)$  for affine coordinates on the *Montgomery curve*.

A point  $P$  is normally represented by two  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  variables, which we name as  $(P^u, P^v)$  for an *affine-ctEdwards* point, for instance.

The implementations of scalar multiplication require the scalar to be represented as a *bit sequence*. We therefore allow the notation  $[k\star] P$  meaning  $[\text{LEBS2IP}_{\text{length}(k\star)}(k\star)] P$ . There will be no ambiguity because variables representing *bit sequences* are named with a  $\star$  suffix.

The *Montgomery curve*  $\mathbb{M}$  has parameters  $A_{\mathbb{M}} = 40962$  and  $B_{\mathbb{M}} = 1$ . We use an affine representation of this curve with the formula:

$$B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot y^2 = x^3 + A_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot x^2 + x$$

Usually, elliptic curve arithmetic over prime fields is implemented using some form of projective coordinates, in order to reduce the number of expensive inversions required. In the circuit, it turns out that a division can be implemented at the same cost as a multiplication, i.e. one constraint. Therefore it is beneficial to use affine coordinates for both curves.

We define the following types representing *affine-ctEdwards* and *affine-Montgomery* coordinates respectively:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AffineCtEdwardsJubjub} &:= (u : \mathbb{F}_{r_s}) \times (v : \mathbb{F}_{r_s}) : a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u^2 + v^2 = 1 + d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u^2 \cdot v^2 \\ \text{AffineMontJubjub} &:= (x : \mathbb{F}_{r_s}) \times (y : \mathbb{F}_{r_s}) : B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot y^2 = x^3 + A_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot x^2 + x \end{aligned}$$

We also define a type representing compressed, *not necessarily valid*, ctEdwards coordinates:

$$\text{CompressedCtEdwardsJubjub} := (\tilde{u} : \mathbb{B}) \times (v : \mathbb{F}_{r_s})$$

See §5.4.9.3 ‘Jubjub’ on p.102 for how this type is represented as a *byte sequence* in external encodings.

We use *affine-Montgomery* arithmetic in parts of the circuit because it is more efficient, in terms of the number of constraints, than *affine-ctEdwards* arithmetic.

An important consideration when using Montgomery arithmetic is that the addition formula is not complete, that is, there are cases where it produces the wrong answer. We must ensure that these cases do not arise.

We will need the theorem below about  $y$ -coordinates of points on *Montgomery curves*.

**Fact:**  $A_{\mathbb{M}}^2 - 4$  is a nonsquare in  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ .

**Theorem A.2.1.**  $(0, 0)$  is the only point with  $y = 0$  on certain Montgomery curves.

Let  $P = (x, y)$  be a point other than  $(0, 0)$  on a Montgomery curve  $E_{\text{Mont}(A, B)}$  over  $\mathbb{F}_r$ , such that  $A^2 - 4$  is a nonsquare in  $\mathbb{F}_r$ . Then  $y \neq 0$ .

*Proof.* Substituting  $y = 0$  into the Montgomery curve equation gives  $0 = x^3 + A \cdot x^2 + x = x \cdot (x^2 + A \cdot x + 1)$ . So either  $x = 0$  or  $x^2 + A \cdot x + 1 = 0$ . Since  $P \neq (0, 0)$ , the case  $x = 0$  is excluded. In the other case, complete the square for  $x^2 + A \cdot x + 1 = 0$  to give the equivalent  $(2 \cdot x + A)^2 = A^2 - 4$ . The left-hand side is a square, so if the right-hand side is a nonsquare, then there are no solutions for  $x$ .  $\square$

## A.3 Circuit Components

Each of the following sections describes how to implement a particular component of the circuit, and counts the number of constraints required. Some components make use of others; the order of presentation is “bottom-up”.

It is important for security to ensure that variables intended to be of boolean type are boolean-constrained; and for efficiency that they are boolean-constrained only once. We explicitly state for the boolean inputs and outputs of each component whether they are boolean-constrained by the component, or are assumed to have been boolean-constrained separately.

Affine coordinates for elliptic curve points are assumed to represent points on the relevant curve, unless otherwise specified.

In this section, variables have type  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  unless otherwise specified. In contrast to most of this document, we use zero-based indexing in order to more closely match the implementation.

### A.3.1 Operations on individual bits

#### A.3.1.1 Boolean constraints

A boolean constraint  $b \in \mathbb{B}$  can be implemented as:

$$(1 - b) \times (b) = (0)$$

#### A.3.1.2 Conditional equality

The constraint “either  $a = 0$  or  $b = c$ ” can be implemented as:

$$(a) \times (b - c) = (0)$$

### A.3.1.3 Selection constraints

A selection constraint  $(b \ ? \ x : y) = z$ , where  $b : \mathbb{B}$  has been boolean-constrained, can be implemented as:

$$(b) \times (y - x) = (y - z)$$

### A.3.1.4 Nonzero constraints

Since only nonzero elements of  $\mathbb{F}_{r_S}$  have a multiplicative inverse, the assertion  $a \neq 0$  can be implemented by witnessing the inverse,  $a_{\text{inv}} = a^{-1} \pmod{r_S}$ :

$$(a_{\text{inv}}) \times (a) = (1)$$

This technique comes from [SVPBABW2012, Appendix D.1].

**Non-normative note:** A global optimization allows to use a single inverse computation outside the circuit for any number of nonzero constraints. Suppose that we have  $n$  variables (or *linear combinations*) that are supposed to be nonzero:  $a_0 \dots a_{n-1}$ . Multiply these together (using  $n-1$  constraints) to give  $a^* = \prod_{i=0}^{n-1} a_i$ ; then, constrain  $a^*$  to be nonzero. This works because the product  $a^*$  is nonzero if and only if all of  $a_0 \dots a_{n-1}$  are nonzero. However, the **Sapling** circuit does not use this optimization.

### A.3.1.5 Exclusive-or constraints

An exclusive-or operation  $a \oplus b = c$ , where  $a, b : \mathbb{B}$  are already boolean-constrained, can be implemented in one constraint as:

$$(2 \cdot a) \times (b) = (a + b - c)$$

This automatically boolean-constrains  $c$ . Its correctness can be seen by checking the truth table of  $(a, b)$ .

## A.3.2 Operations on multiple bits

### A.3.2.1 [Un]packing modulo $r_S$

Let  $n : \mathbb{N}^+$  be a constant. The operation of converting a field element,  $a : \mathbb{F}_{r_S}$ , to a sequence of boolean variables  $b_0 \dots b_{n-1} : \mathbb{B}^{[n]}$  such that  $a = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_i \cdot 2^i \pmod{r_S}$ , is called “*unpacking*”. The inverse operation is called “*packing*”.

In the *quadratic constraint program* these are the same operation (but see the note about canonical representation below). We assume that the variables  $b_0 \dots b_{n-1}$  are boolean-constrained separately.

$$\text{We have } a \bmod r_S = \left( \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_i \cdot 2^i \right) \bmod r_S = \left( \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_i \cdot (2^i \bmod r_S) \right) \bmod r_S.$$

This can be implemented in one constraint:

$$\left( \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_i \cdot (2^i \bmod r_S) \right) \times (1) = (a)$$

**Notes:**

- The bit length  $n$  is not limited by the field element size.
- Since the constraint has only a trivial multiplication, it is possible to eliminate it by merging it into the boolean constraint of one of the output bits, expressing that bit as a linear combination of the others and  $a$ . However, this optimization requires substitutions that would interfere with the modularity of the circuit implementation (for a saving of only one constraint per unpacking operation), and so we do not use it for the **Sapling** circuit.
- In the case  $n = 255$ , for  $a < 2^{255} - r_{\mathbb{S}}$  there are two possible representations of  $a : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{S}}}$  as a sequence of 255 bits, corresponding to  $\text{l2LEBSP}_{255}(a)$  and  $\text{l2LEBSP}_{255}(a + r_{\mathbb{S}})$ . This is a potential hazard, but it may or may not be necessary to force use of the canonical representation  $\text{l2LEBSP}_{255}(a)$ , depending on the context in which the [un]packing operation is used. We therefore do not consider this to be part of the [un]packing operation itself.

### A.3.2.2 Range check

Let  $n : \mathbb{N}^+$  be a constant, and let  $a = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} a_i \cdot 2^i : \mathbb{N}$ . Suppose we want to constrain  $a \leq c$  for some *constant*  $c = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} c_i \cdot 2^i : \mathbb{N}$ .

Without loss of generality we can assume that  $c_{n-1} = 1$ , because if it were not then we would decrease  $n$  accordingly.

Note that since  $a$  and  $c$  are provided in binary representation, their bit length  $n$  is not limited by the field element size. We *do not* assume that the bits  $a_{0..n-1}$  are already boolean-constrained.

Define  $\Pi_m = \prod_{i=m}^{n-1} (c_i = 0 \vee a_i = 1)$  for  $m \in \{0..n-1\}$ . Notice that for any  $m < n-1$  such that  $c_m = 0$ , we have  $\Pi_m = \Pi_{m+1}$ , and so it is only necessary to allocate separate variables for the  $\Pi_m$  such that  $m < n-1$  and  $c_m = 1$ . Furthermore if  $c_{n-2..0}$  has  $t > 0$  trailing 1 bits, then we do not need to allocate variables for  $\Pi_{0..t-1}$  because those variables will not be used below.

More explicitly:

Let  $\Pi_{n-1} = a_{n-1}$ .

For  $i$  from  $n-2$  down to  $t$ ,

- if  $c_i = 0$ , then let  $\Pi_i = \Pi_{i+1}$ ;
- if  $c_i = 1$ , then constrain  $(\Pi_{i+1}) \times (a_i) = (\Pi_i)$ .

Then we constrain the  $a_i$  as follows:

For  $i$  from  $n-1$  down to 0,

- if  $c_i = 0$ , constrain  $(1 - \Pi_{i+1} - a_i) \times (a_i) = (0)$ ;
- if  $c_i = 1$ , boolean-constrain  $a_i$  as in § A.3.1.1 ‘*Boolean constraints*’ on p. 201.

Note that the constraints corresponding to zero bits of  $c$  are *in place of* boolean constraints on bits of  $a_i$ .

This costs  $n + k$  constraints, where  $k$  is the number of non-trailing 1 bits in  $c_{n-2..0}$ .

**Theorem A.3.1.** *Correctness of a constraint system for range checks.*

Assume  $c_{0..n-1} : \mathbb{B}^{[n]}$  and  $c_{n-1} = 1$ . Define  $A_m := \sum_{i=m}^{n-1} a_i \cdot 2^i$  and  $C_m := \sum_{i=m}^{n-1} c_i \cdot 2^i$ . For any  $m \in \{0..n-1\}$ ,  $A_m \leq C_m$  if and only if the restriction of the above constraint system to  $i \in \{m..n-1\}$  is satisfied. Furthermore the system at least boolean-constrains  $a_{0..n-1}$ .

*Proof.* For  $i \in \{0..n-1\}$  such that  $c_i = 1$ , the corresponding  $a_i$  are unconditionally boolean-constrained. This implies that the system constrains  $\Pi_i \in \mathbb{B}$  for all  $i \in \{0..n-1\}$ . For  $i \in \{0..n-1\}$  such that  $c_i = 0$ , the constraint  $(1 - \Pi_{i+1} - a_i) \times (a_i) = (0)$  constrains  $a_i$  to be 0 if  $\Pi_{i+1} = 1$ , otherwise it constrains  $a_i \in \mathbb{B}$ . So all of  $a_{0..n-1}$  are at least boolean-constrained.

To prove the rest of the theorem we proceed by induction on decreasing  $m$ , i.e. taking successively longer prefixes of the *big-endian* binary representations of  $a$  and  $c$ .

Base case  $m = n - 1$ : since  $c_{n-1} = 1$ , the constraint system has just one boolean constraint on  $a_{n-1}$ , which fulfils the theorem since  $A_{n-1} \leq C_{n-1}$  is always satisfied.

Inductive case  $m < n - 1$ :

- If  $A_{m+1} > C_{m+1}$ , then by the inductive hypothesis the constraint system must fail, which fulfils the theorem regardless of the value of  $a_m$ .
- If  $A_{m+1} \leq C_{m+1}$ , then by the inductive hypothesis the constraint system restricted to  $i \in \{m+1..n-1\}$  succeeds. We have  $\Pi_{m+1} = \prod_{i=m+1}^{n-1} (c_i = 0 \vee a_i = 1) = \prod_{i=m+1}^{n-1} (a_i \geq c_i)$ .
  - If  $A_{m+1} = C_{m+1}$ , then  $a_i = c_i$  for all  $i \in \{m+1..n-1\}$  and so  $\Pi_{m+1} = 1$ . Also  $A_m \leq C_m$  if and only if  $a_m \leq c_m$ .  
 When  $c_m = 1$ , only a boolean constraint is added for  $a_m$  which fulfils the theorem.  
 When  $c_m = 0$ ,  $a_m$  is constrained to be 0 which fulfils the theorem.
  - If  $A_{m+1} < C_{m+1}$ , then it cannot be the case that  $a_i \geq c_i$  for all  $i \in \{m+1..n-1\}$ , so  $\Pi_{m+1} = 0$ .  
 This implies that the constraint on  $a_m$  is always equivalent to a boolean constraint, which fulfils the theorem because  $A_m \leq C_m$  must be true regardless of the value of  $a_m$ .

This covers all cases. □

Correctness of the full constraint system follows by taking  $m = 0$  in the above theorem.

The algorithm in § A.3.3.2 ‘*ctEdwards [de]compression and validation*’ on p. 205 uses range checks with  $c = r_{\mathbb{S}} - 1$  to validate *ctEdwards compressed encodings*. In that case  $n = 255$  and  $k = 132$ , so the cost of each such range check is 387 constraints.

**Non-normative note:** It is possible to optimize the computation of  $\Pi_{t..n-2}$  further. Notice that  $\Pi_m$  is only used when  $m$  is the index of the last bit of a run of 1 bits in  $c$ . So for each such run of 1 bits  $c_m..m+N-2$  of length  $N - 1$ , it is sufficient to compute an  $N$ -ary AND of  $a_m..m+N-2$  and  $\Pi_{m+N-1}$ :  $R = \prod_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i$ . This can be computed in 3 constraints for any  $N$ ; boolean-constrain the output  $R$ , and then add constraints

$$\left(N - \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i\right) \times (\text{inv}) = (1 - R) \quad \text{to enforce that } \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i \neq N \text{ when } R = 0;$$

$$\left(N - \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i\right) \times (R) = (0) \quad \text{to enforce that } \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i = N \text{ when } R = 1.$$

where  $\text{inv}$  is witnessed as  $\left(N - \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} X_i\right)^{-1}$  if  $R = 0$  or is unconstrained otherwise. (Since  $N < r_{\mathbb{S}}$ , the sums cannot overflow.)

In fact the last constraint is not needed in this context because it is sufficient to compute an upper bound on each  $\Pi_m$  (i.e. it does not benefit a malicious prover to witness  $R = 1$  when the result of the AND should be 0). So the cost of computing  $\Pi$  variables for an arbitrarily long run of 1 bits can be reduced to 2 constraints. For example, for  $c = r_{\mathbb{S}} - 1$  the overall cost would be reduced to  $255 + 68 = 323$  constraints.

These optimizations are not used in **Sapling**.

### A.3.3 Elliptic curve operations

#### A.3.3.1 Checking that Affine-ctEdwards coordinates are on the curve

To check that  $(u, v)$  is a point on the *ctEdwards curve*, the **Sapling** circuit uses 4 constraints:

$$\begin{aligned} (u) \times (u) &= (uu) \\ (v) \times (v) &= (vv) \\ (uu) \times (vv) &= (uuvv) \\ (a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot uu + vv) \times (1) &= (1 + d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot uuvv) \end{aligned}$$

**Non-normative note:** The last two constraints can be combined into  $(d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot uu) \times (vv) = (a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot uu + vv - 1)$ . The **Sapling** circuit does not use this optimization.

#### A.3.3.2 ctEdwards [de]compression and validation

Define  $\text{DecompressValidate} : \text{CompressedCtEdwardsJubjub} \rightarrow \text{AffineCtEdwardsJubjub}$  as follows:

```
DecompressValidate( $\tilde{u}, v$ ) :
  // Prover supplies the  $u$ -coordinate.
  Let  $u : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{S}}}$ .
  // §A.3.3.1 ‘Checking that Affine-ctEdwards coordinates are on the curve’ on p.205.
  Check that  $(u, v)$  is a point on the ctEdwards curve.
  // §A.3.2.1 ‘[Un]packing modulo  $r_{\mathbb{S}}$ ’ on p.202.
  Unpack  $u$  to  $\sum_{i=0}^{254} u_i \cdot 2^i$ , equating  $\tilde{u}$  with  $u_0$ .
  // §A.3.2.2 ‘Range check’ on p.203.
  Check that  $\sum_{i=0}^{254} u_i \cdot 2^i \leq r_{\mathbb{S}} - 1$ .
  Return  $(u, v)$ .
```

This costs 4 constraints for the curve equation check, 1 constraint for the unpacking, and 387 constraints for the range check (as computed in §A.3.2.2 ‘Range check’ on p.203) for a total of 392 constraints. The cost of the range check includes boolean-constraining  $u_0 \dots u_{254}$ .

The same *quadratic constraint program* is used for compression and decompression.

**Non-normative note:** The point-on-curve check could be omitted if  $(u, v)$  were already known to be on the curve. However, the **Sapling** circuit never omits it; this provides a consistency check on the elliptic curve arithmetic.

#### A.3.3.3 ctEdwards $\leftrightarrow$ Montgomery conversion

Define the notation  $\sqrt[4]{\cdot}$  as in §2 ‘Notation’ on p.10.

Define  $\text{CtEdwardsToMont} : \text{AffineCtEdwardsJubjub} \rightarrow \text{AffineMontJubjub}$  as follows:

$$\text{CtEdwardsToMont}(u, v) = \left( \frac{1+v}{1-v}, \sqrt[4]{-40964} \cdot \frac{1+v}{(1-v) \cdot u} \right) \quad [1-v \neq 0 \text{ and } u \neq 0]$$

Define  $\text{MontToCtEdwards} : \text{AffineMontJubjub} \rightarrow \text{AffineCtEdwardsJubjub}$  as follows:

$$\text{MontToCtEdwards}(x, y) = \left( \sqrt[4]{-40964} \cdot \frac{x}{y}, \frac{x-1}{x+1} \right) \quad [x+1 \neq 0 \text{ and } y \neq 0]$$

Either of these conversions can be implemented by the same *quadratic constraint program*:

$$\begin{aligned}(y) \times (u) &= \left( \sqrt[4]{-40964} \cdot x \right) \\ (x+1) \times (v) &= (x-1)\end{aligned}$$

The above conversions should only be used if the input is guaranteed to be a point on the relevant curve. If that is the case, the theorems below enumerate all exceptional inputs that may violate the side-conditions.

**Theorem A.3.2.** *Exceptional points (ctEdwards  $\rightarrow$  Montgomery).*

Let  $(u, v)$  be an affine point on a ctEdwards curve  $E_{\text{ctEdwards}(a,d)}$ . Then the only points with  $u = 0$  or  $1 - v = 0$  are  $(0, 1) = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and  $(0, -1)$  of order 2.

*Proof.* The curve equation is  $a \cdot u^2 + v^2 = 1 + d \cdot u^2 \cdot v^2$  with  $a \neq d$  (see [BBJLP2008, Definition 2.1]). By substituting  $u = 0$  we obtain  $v = \pm 1$ , and by substituting  $v = 1$  and using  $a \neq d$  we obtain  $u = 0$ .  $\square$

**Theorem A.3.3.** *Exceptional points (Montgomery  $\rightarrow$  ctEdwards).*

Let  $(x, y)$  be an affine point on a Montgomery curve  $E_{\text{Mont}(A,B)}$  over  $\mathbb{F}_r$ , with parameters  $A$  and  $B$  such that  $A^2 - 4$  is a nonsquare in  $\mathbb{F}_r$ , that is birationally equivalent to a ctEdwards curve. Then  $x + 1 \neq 0$ , and the only point  $(x, y)$  with  $y = 0$  is  $(0, 0)$  of order 2.

*Proof.* That the only point with  $y = 0$  is  $(0, 0)$  is proven by Theorem A.2.1 on p. 201.

If  $x + 1 = 0$ , then substituting  $x = -1$  into the Montgomery curve equation gives  $B \cdot y^2 = x^3 + A \cdot x^2 + x = A - 2$ . So in that case  $y^2 = (A - 2)/B$ . The right-hand-side is equal to the parameter  $d$  of a particular ctEdwards curve birationally equivalent to the Montgomery curve (see [BL2017, section 4.3.5]). For all ctEdwards curves,  $d$  is nonsquare, so this equation has no solutions for  $y$ , hence  $x + 1 \neq 0$ .  $\square$

(When the theorem is applied with  $E_{\text{Mont}(A,B)} = \mathbb{M}$  defined in § A.2 ‘*Elliptic curve background*’ on p. 200, the ctEdwards curve referred to in the proof is an isomorphic rescaling of the Jubjub curve.)

#### A.3.3.4 Affine-Montgomery arithmetic

The incomplete *affine-Montgomery* addition formulae given in [BL2017, section 4.3.2] are:

$$\begin{aligned}x_3 &= B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot \lambda^2 - A_{\mathbb{M}} - x_1 - x_2 \\ y_3 &= (x_1 - x_3) \cdot \lambda - y_1 \\ \text{where } \lambda &= \begin{cases} \frac{3 \cdot x_1^2 + 2 \cdot A_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot x_1 + 1}{2 \cdot B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot y_1}, & \text{if } x_1 = x_2 \\ \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}\end{aligned}$$

The following theorem helps to determine when these incomplete addition formulae can be safely used:

**Theorem A.3.4.** *Distinct- $x$  theorem.*

Let  $Q$  be a point of odd-prime order  $s$  on a Montgomery curve  $\mathbb{M} = E_{\text{Mont}(A_{\mathbb{M}}, B_{\mathbb{M}})}$  over  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ . Let  $k_1 \dots k_2$  be integers in  $\{-\frac{s-1}{2} \dots \frac{s-1}{2}\} \setminus \{0\}$ . Let  $P_i = [k_i]Q = (x_i, y_i)$  for  $i \in \{1 \dots 2\}$ , with  $k_2 \neq \pm k_1$ . Then the non-unified addition constraints

$$\begin{aligned}(x_2 - x_1) \times (\lambda) &= (y_2 - y_1) \\ (B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot \lambda) \times (\lambda) &= (A_{\mathbb{M}} + x_1 + x_2 + x_3) \\ (x_1 - x_3) \times (\lambda) &= (y_3 + y_1)\end{aligned}$$

implement the affine-Montgomery addition  $P_1 + P_2 = (x_3, y_3)$  for all such  $P_1 \dots P_2$ .



*Proof.* The given constraints are equivalent to the Montgomery addition formulae under the side condition that  $x_1 \neq x_2$ . (Note that neither  $P_i$  can be the zero point since  $k_{1..2} \not\equiv 0 \pmod{s}$ .) Assume for a contradiction that  $x_1 = x_2$ . For any  $P_1 = [k_1] Q$ , there can be only one other point  $-P_1$  with the same  $x$ -coordinate. (This follows from the fact that the curve equation determines  $\pm y$  as a function of  $x$ .) But  $-P_1 = [-1] [k_1] Q = [-k_1] Q$ . Since  $k : \{-\frac{s-1}{2} .. \frac{s-1}{2}\} \mapsto [k] Q : \mathbb{M}$  is injective and  $k_{1..2}$  are in  $\{-\frac{s-1}{2} .. \frac{s-1}{2}\}$ , then  $k_2 = \pm k_1$  (contradiction).  $\square$

The conditions of this theorem are called the *distinct- $x$  criterion*.

In particular, if  $k_{1..2}$  are integers in  $\{1 .. \frac{s-1}{2}\}$  then it is sufficient to require  $k_2 \neq k_1$ , since that implies  $k_2 \neq \pm k_1$ .

*Affine-Montgomery doubling* can be implemented as:

$$\begin{aligned} (x) \times (x) &= (xx) \\ (2 \cdot B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot y) \times (\lambda) &= (3 \cdot xx + 2 \cdot A_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot x + 1) \\ (B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot \lambda) \times (\lambda) &= (A_{\mathbb{M}} + 2 \cdot x + x_3) \\ (x - x_3) \times (\lambda) &= (y_3 + y) \end{aligned}$$

This doubling formula is valid when  $y \neq 0$ , which is the case when  $(x, y)$  is not the point  $(0, 0)$  (the only point of order 2), as proven in Theorem A.2.1 on p. 201.

### A.3.3.5 Affine-ctEdwards arithmetic

Formulae for *affine-ctEdwards* addition are given in [BBJLP2008, section 6]. With a change of variable names to match our convention, the formulae for  $(u_1, v_1) + (u_2, v_2) = (u_3, v_3)$  are:

$$\begin{aligned} u_3 &= \frac{u_1 \cdot v_2 + v_1 \cdot u_2}{1 + d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_1 \cdot u_2 \cdot v_1 \cdot v_2} \\ v_3 &= \frac{v_1 \cdot v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_1 \cdot u_2}{1 - d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_1 \cdot u_2 \cdot v_1 \cdot v_2} \end{aligned}$$

We use an optimized implementation found by Daira-Emma Hopwood making use of an observation by Bernstein and Lange in [BL2017, last paragraph of section 4.5.2]:

$$\begin{aligned} (u_1 + v_1) \times (v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_2) &= (T) \\ (u_1) \times (v_2) &= (A) \\ (v_1) \times (u_2) &= (B) \\ (d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot A) \times (B) &= (C) \\ (1 + C) \times (u_3) &= (A + B) \\ (1 - C) \times (v_3) &= (T - A + a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot B) \end{aligned}$$

The correctness of this implementation can be seen by expanding  $T - A + a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot B$ :

$$\begin{aligned} T - A + a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot B &= (u_1 + v_1) \cdot (v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_2) - u_1 \cdot v_2 + a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot v_1 \cdot u_2 \\ &= v_1 \cdot v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_1 \cdot u_2 + u_1 \cdot v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot v_1 \cdot u_2 - u_1 \cdot v_2 + a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot v_1 \cdot u_2 \\ &= v_1 \cdot v_2 - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u_1 \cdot u_2 \end{aligned}$$

The above addition formulae are “unified”, that is, they can also be used for doubling. *Affine-ctEdwards* doubling [2]  $(u, v) = (u_3, v_3)$  can also be implemented slightly more efficiently as:

$$\begin{aligned}(u + v) \times (v - a_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot u) &= (T) \\ (u) \times (v) &= (A) \\ (d_{\mathbb{J}} \cdot A) \times (A) &= (C) \\ (1 + C) \times (u_3) &= (2 \cdot A) \\ (1 - C) \times (v_3) &= (T + (a_{\mathbb{J}} - 1) \cdot A)\end{aligned}$$

This implementation is obtained by specializing the addition formulae to  $(u, v) = (u_1, v_1) = (u_2, v_2)$  and observing that  $u \cdot v = A = B$ .

### A.3.3.6 Affine-ctEdwards nonsmall-order check

In order to avoid small-subgroup attacks, we check that certain points used in the circuit are not of *small order*. In practice the **Sapling** circuit uses this in combination with a check that the coordinates are on the curve (§ A.3.3.1 ‘*Checking that Affine-ctEdwards coordinates are on the curve*’ on p. 205), so we combine the two operations.

The Jubjub curve has a large *prime-order subgroup* with a cofactor of 8. To check for a point  $P$  of order 8 or less, the **Sapling** circuit doubles three times (as in § A.3.3.5 ‘*Affine-ctEdwards arithmetic*’ on p. 207) and checks that the resulting  $u$ -coordinate is not 0 (as in § A.3.1.4 ‘*Nonzero constraints*’ on p. 202).

On a *ctEdwards* curve, only the zero point  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ , and the unique point of order 2 at  $(0, -1)$  have zero  $u$ -coordinate. The point of order 2 cannot occur as the result of three doublings. So this  $u$ -coordinate check rejects only  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$ .

The total cost, including the curve check, is  $4 + 3 \cdot 5 + 1 = 20$  constraints.

**Note:** This *does not* ensure that the point is in the *prime-order subgroup*.

#### Non-normative notes:

- It would have been sufficient to do two doublings rather than three, because the check that the  $u$ -coordinate is nonzero would reject both  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$  and the point of order 2.
- It is possible to reduce the cost to 8 constraints by eliminating the redundant constraint in the curve point check (as mentioned in § A.3.3.1 ‘*Checking that Affine-ctEdwards coordinates are on the curve*’ on p. 205); merging the first doubling with the curve point check; and then optimizing the second doubling based on the fact that we only need to check whether the resulting  $u$ -coordinate is zero. The **Sapling** circuit does not use these optimizations.

### A.3.3.7 Fixed-base Affine-ctEdwards scalar multiplication

If the base point  $B$  is fixed for a given scalar multiplication  $[k] B$ , we can fully precompute window tables for each window position.

It is most efficient to use 3-bit fixed windows. Since the length of  $r_{\mathbb{J}}$  is 252 bits, we need 84 windows.

Express  $k$  in base 8, i.e.  $k = \sum_{i=0}^{83} k_i \cdot 8^i$ .

Then  $[k] B = \sum_{i=0}^{83} w_{(B, i, k_i)}$ , where  $w_{(B, i, k_i)} = [k_i \cdot 8^i] B$ .

We precompute all of  $w_{(B, i, s)}$  for  $i \in \{0 \dots 83\}$ ,  $s \in \{0 \dots 7\}$ .

To look up a given window entry  $w_{(B,i,s)} = (u_s, v_s)$ , where  $s = 4 \cdot s_2 + 2 \cdot s_1 + s_0$ , we use:

$$\begin{aligned}
(s_1) \times (s_2) &= (s_{\&}) \\
(s_0) \times (-u_0 \cdot s_{\&} + u_0 \cdot s_2 + u_0 \cdot s_1 - u_0 + u_2 \cdot s_{\&} - u_2 \cdot s_1 + u_4 \cdot s_{\&} - u_4 \cdot s_2 - u_6 \cdot s_{\&} \\
&\quad + u_1 \cdot s_{\&} - u_1 \cdot s_2 - u_1 \cdot s_1 + u_1 - u_3 \cdot s_{\&} + u_3 \cdot s_1 - u_5 \cdot s_{\&} + u_5 \cdot s_2 + u_7 \cdot s_{\&}) = \\
&\quad (u_s - u_0 \cdot s_{\&} + u_0 \cdot s_2 + u_0 \cdot s_1 - u_0 + u_2 \cdot s_{\&} - u_2 \cdot s_1 + u_4 \cdot s_{\&} - u_4 \cdot s_2 - u_6 \cdot s_{\&}) \\
(s_0) \times (-v_0 \cdot s_{\&} + v_0 \cdot s_2 + v_0 \cdot s_1 - v_0 + v_2 \cdot s_{\&} - v_2 \cdot s_1 + v_4 \cdot s_{\&} - v_4 \cdot s_2 - v_6 \cdot s_{\&} \\
&\quad + v_1 \cdot s_{\&} - v_1 \cdot s_2 - v_1 \cdot s_1 + v_1 - v_3 \cdot s_{\&} + v_3 \cdot s_1 - v_5 \cdot s_{\&} + v_5 \cdot s_2 + v_7 \cdot s_{\&}) = \\
&\quad (v_s - v_0 \cdot s_{\&} + v_0 \cdot s_2 + v_0 \cdot s_1 - v_0 + v_2 \cdot s_{\&} - v_2 \cdot s_1 + v_4 \cdot s_{\&} - v_4 \cdot s_2 - v_6 \cdot s_{\&})
\end{aligned}$$

For a full-length (252-bit) scalar this costs 3 constraints for each of 84 window lookups, plus 6 constraints for each of 83 *ctEdwards* additions (as in §A.3.3.5 ‘*Affine-ctEdwards arithmetic*’ on p. 207), for a total of 750 constraints.

Fixed-base scalar multiplication is also used in two places with shorter scalars:

- §A.3.6 ‘*Homomorphic Pedersen Commitment*’ on p. 213 uses 64 bits for the  $v$  input to  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ , requiring 22 windows at a cost of  $3 \cdot 22 - 1 + 6 \cdot 21 = 191$  constraints;
- §A.3.3.10 ‘*Mixing Pedersen hash*’ on p. 212 uses 32 bits for the  $\text{pos}$  input to  $\text{MixingPedersenHash}$ , requiring 11 windows at a cost of  $3 \cdot 11 - 1 + 6 \cdot 10 = 92$  constraints.

None of these costs include the cost of boolean-constraining the scalar.

#### Non-normative notes:

- It would be more efficient to use arithmetic on the *Montgomery curve*, as in §A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210. However since there are only three instances of fixed-base scalar multiplication in the *Spend circuit* and two in the *Output circuit*<sup>15</sup>, the additional complexity was not considered justified for **Sapling**.
- For the multiplications with 64-bit and 32-bit scalars, the scalar is padded to a multiple of 3 bits with zeros. This causes the computation of  $s_{\&}$  in the lookup for the most significant window to be optimized out, which is where the “ $-1$ ” comes from in the above cost calculations. No further optimization is done for this lookup.

### A.3.3.8 Variable-base Affine-ctEdwards scalar multiplication

When the base point  $B$  is not fixed, the method in the preceding section cannot be used. Instead we use a naïve double-and-add method.

Given  $k = \sum_{i=0}^{250} k_i \cdot 2^i$ , we calculate  $R = [k] B$  using:

```

// Basei = [2i] B
let Base0 = B
let Acc0u = k0 ? Base0u : 0
let Acc0v = k0 ? Base0v : 1

for i from 1 up to 250:
    let Basei = [2] Basei-1
    // select Basei or  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{J}}$  depending on the bit ki
    let Addendiu = ki ? Baseiu : 0
    let Addendiv = ki ? Baseiv : 1
    let Acci = Acci-1 + Addendi

let R = Acc250.

```

This costs 5 constraints for each of 250 *ctEdwards* doublings, 6 constraints for each of 250 *ctEdwards* additions, and 2 constraints for each of 251 point selections, for a total of 3252 constraints.

<sup>15</sup> A *Pedersen commitment* uses fixed-base scalar multiplication as a subcomponent.

**Non-normative note:** It would be more efficient to use 2-bit fixed windows, and/or to use arithmetic on the *Montgomery curve* in a similar way to §A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210. However since there are only two instances of variable-base scalar multiplication in the *Spend circuit* and one in the *Output circuit*, the additional complexity was not considered justified for **Sapling**.

### A.3.3.9 Pedersen hash

The specification of the *Pedersen hashes* used in **Sapling** is given in §5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79. It is based on the scheme from [CvHP1991, section 5.2] –for which a tighter security reduction to the *Discrete Logarithm Problem* was given in [BGG1995]– but tailored to allow several optimizations in the circuit implementation.

*Pedersen hashes* are the single most commonly used primitive in the **Sapling** circuits.  $\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}$  *Pedersen hash* instances are used in the *Spend circuit* to check a *Merkle path* to the *note commitment* of the *note* being spent. We also reuse the *Pedersen hash* implementation to construct the *note commitment scheme*  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ .

This motivates considerable attention to optimizing this circuit implementation of this primitive, even at the cost of complexity.

First, we use a windowed scalar multiplication algorithm with signed digits. Each 3-bit message chunk corresponds to a window; the chunk is encoded as an integer from the set  $\text{Digits} = \{-4 \dots 4\} \setminus \{0\}$ . This allows a more efficient lookup of the window entry for each chunk than if the set  $\{1 \dots 8\}$  had been used, because a point can be conditionally negated using only a single constraint.

Next, we optimize the cost of point addition by allowing as many additions as possible to be performed on the *Montgomery curve*. An incomplete Montgomery addition costs 3 constraints, in comparison with a *ctEdwards* addition which costs 6 constraints.

However, we cannot do all additions on the *Montgomery curve* because the Montgomery addition is incomplete. In order to be able to prove that exceptional cases do not occur, we need to ensure that the *distinct- $x$  criterion* from §A.3.3.4 ‘*Affine-Montgomery arithmetic*’ on p. 206 is met. This requires splitting the input into segments (each using an independent generator), calculating an intermediate result for each segment, and then converting to the *ctEdwards curve* and summing the intermediate results using *ctEdwards* addition.

Abstracting away the changes of curve, this calculation can be written as:

$$\text{PedersenHashToPoint}(D, M) = \sum_{j=1}^N [\langle M_j \rangle] \mathcal{I}(D, j)$$

where  $\langle \cdot \rangle$  and  $\mathcal{I}(D, j)$  are defined as in §5.4.1.7 ‘*Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 79.

We have to prove that:

- the Montgomery-to-*ctEdwards* conversions can be implemented without exceptional cases;
- the *distinct- $x$  criterion* is met for all Montgomery additions within a segment.

The proof of Theorem 5.4.1 on p. 80 showed that all indices of addition inputs are in the range  $\{-\frac{r_{\mathbb{J}}-1}{2} \dots \frac{r_{\mathbb{J}}-1}{2}\} \setminus \{0\}$ .

Because the  $\mathcal{I}(D, j)$  (which are outputs of  $\text{GroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}$ ) are all of *prime order*, and  $\langle M_j \rangle \neq 0 \pmod{r_{\mathbb{J}}}$ , it is guaranteed that all of the terms  $[\langle M_j \rangle] \mathcal{I}(D, j)$  to be converted to *ctEdwards* form are of *prime order*. From Theorem A.3.3 on p. 206, we can infer that the conversions will not encounter exceptional cases.

We also need to show that the indices of addition inputs are all distinct disregarding sign.

**Theorem A.3.5.** *Concerning addition inputs in the Pedersen circuit.*

For all disjoint nonempty subsets  $S$  and  $S'$  of  $\{1 \dots c\}$ , all  $m \in \mathbb{B}^{[3][c]}$ , and all  $\Theta \in \{-1, 1\}$ :

$$\sum_{j \in S} \text{enc}(m_j) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j-1)} \neq \Theta \cdot \sum_{j' \in S'} \text{enc}(m_{j'}) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j'-1)}.$$

*Proof.* Suppose for a contradiction that  $S, S', m, \Theta$  is a counterexample. Taking the multiplication by  $\Theta$  on the right hand side inside the summation, we have:

$$\sum_{j \in S} \text{enc}(m_j) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j-1)} = \sum_{j' \in S'} \Theta \cdot \text{enc}(m_{j'}) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j'-1)}.$$

Define  $\text{enc}' : \{-1, 1\} \times \mathbb{B}^{[3]} \rightarrow \{0 \dots 8\} \setminus \{4\}$  as  $\text{enc}'_\theta(m_i) := 4 + \theta \cdot \text{enc}(m_i)$ .

Let  $\Delta = 4 \cdot \sum_{i=1}^c 2^{4 \cdot (i-1)}$  as in the proof of Theorem 5.4.1 on p. 80. By adding  $\Delta$  to both sides, we get

$$\sum_{j \in S} \text{enc}'_1(m_j) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j-1)} + \sum_{j \in \{1 \dots c\} \setminus S} 4 \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j-1)} = \sum_{j' \in S'} \text{enc}'_{\Theta}(m_{j'}) \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j'-1)} + \sum_{j' \in \{1 \dots c\} \setminus S'} 4 \cdot 2^{4 \cdot (j'-1)}$$

where all of the  $\text{enc}'_1(m_j)$  and  $\text{enc}'_{\Theta}(m_{j'})$  are in  $\{0 \dots 8\} \setminus \{4\}$ .

Each term on the left and on the right affects the single hex digit indexed by  $j$  and  $j'$  respectively. Since  $S$  and  $S'$  are disjoint subsets of  $\{1 \dots c\}$  and  $S$  is nonempty,  $S \cap (\{1 \dots c\} \setminus S')$  is nonempty. Therefore the left hand side has at least one hex digit not equal to 4 such that the corresponding right hand side digit is 4; contradiction.  $\square$

This implies that the terms in the Montgomery addition –as well as any intermediate results formed from adding a distinct subset of terms– have distinct indices disregarding sign, hence distinct  $x$ -coordinates by Theorem A.3.4 on p. 206. (We make no assumption about the order of additions.)

We now describe the subcircuit used to process each chunk, which contributes most of the constraint cost of the hash. This subcircuit is used to perform a lookup of a Montgomery point in a 2-bit window table, conditionally negate the result, and add it to an accumulator holding another Montgomery point.

Suppose that the bits of the chunk,  $[s_0, s_1, s_2]$ , are already boolean-constrained.

We aim to compute  $C = A + [(1 - 2 \cdot s_2) \cdot (1 + s_0 + 2 \cdot s_1)] P$  for some fixed base point  $P$  and accumulated sum  $A$ .

We first compute  $s_{\&} = s_0 \& s_1$ :

$$(s_0) \times (s_1) = (s_{\&})$$

Let  $(x_k, y_k) = [k] P$  for  $k \in \{1 \dots 4\}$ . Define each coordinate of  $(x_S, y_R) = [1 + s_0 + 2 \cdot s_1] P$  as a linear combination of  $s_0, s_1$ , and  $s_{\&}$ :

$$\text{let } x_S = x_1 + (x_2 - x_1) \cdot s_0 + (x_3 - x_1) \cdot s_1 + (x_4 + x_1 - x_2 - x_3) \cdot s_{\&}$$

$$\text{let } y_R = y_1 + (y_2 - y_1) \cdot s_0 + (y_3 - y_1) \cdot s_1 + (y_4 + y_1 - y_2 - y_3) \cdot s_{\&}$$

We implement the conditional negation as  $(2 \cdot y_R) \times (s_2) = (y_R - y_S)$ . After substitution of  $y_R$  this becomes:

$$(2 \cdot (y_1 + (y_2 - y_1) \cdot s_0 + (y_3 - y_1) \cdot s_1 + (y_4 + y_1 - y_2 - y_3) \cdot s_{\&})) \times (s_2) = (y_1 + (y_2 - y_1) \cdot s_0 + (y_3 - y_1) \cdot s_1 + (y_4 + y_1 - y_2 - y_3) \cdot s_{\&} - y_S)$$

Then we substitute  $x_S$  into the Montgomery addition constraints from § A.3.3.4 ‘*Affine-Montgomery arithmetic*’ on p. 206, as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}(x_1 + (x_2 - x_1) \cdot s_0 + (x_3 - x_1) \cdot s_1 + (x_4 + x_1 - x_2 - x_3) \cdot s_{\otimes} - x_A) \times (\lambda) &= (y_S - y_A) \\ (B_{\mathbb{M}} \cdot \lambda) \times (\lambda) &= (A_{\mathbb{M}} + x_A + x_1 + (x_2 - x_1) \cdot s_0 + (x_3 - x_1) \cdot s_1 + (x_4 + x_1 - x_2 - x_3) \cdot s_{\otimes} + x_C) \\ (x_A - x_C) \times (\lambda) &= (y_C + y_A)\end{aligned}$$

(In the sapling-crypto implementation, linear combinations are first-class values, so these substitutions do not need to be done “by hand”.)

For the first addition in each segment, both sides are looked up and substituted into the Montgomery addition, so the first lookup takes only 2 constraints.

When these hashes are used in the circuit, the first 6 bits of the input are fixed. For example, in the Merkle tree hashes they represent the layer number. This would allow a precomputation for the first two windows, but that optimization is not done in **Sapling**.

The cost of a Pedersen hash over  $\ell$  bits (where  $\ell$  includes the fixed bits) is as follows. The number of chunks is  $c = \text{ceiling}\left(\frac{\ell}{3}\right)$  and the number of segments is  $n = \text{ceiling}\left(\frac{\ell}{3 \cdot 63}\right)$ .

The cost is then:

- $2 \cdot c$  constraints for the lookups;
- $3 \cdot (c - n)$  constraints for incomplete additions on the *Montgomery curve*;
- $2 \cdot n$  constraints for Montgomery-to-*ctEdwards* conversions;
- $6 \cdot (n - 1)$  constraints for *ctEdwards* additions;

for a total of  $5 \cdot c + 5 \cdot n - 6$  constraints. This does not include the cost of boolean-constraining inputs.

In particular,

- for the Merkle tree hashes  $\ell = 516$ , so  $c = 172$ ,  $n = 3$ , and the cost is 869 constraints;
- when a Pedersen hash is used to implement part of a Pedersen commitment for NoteCommit<sup>Sapling</sup> (§ 5.4.8.2 ‘*Windowed Pedersen commitments*’ on p. 96),  $\ell = 6 + \ell_{\text{value}} + 2 \cdot \ell_{\mathbb{J}} = 582$ ,  $c = 194$ , and  $n = 4$ , so the cost of the hash alone is 984 constraints.

### A.3.3.10 Mixing Pedersen hash

A mixing *Pedersen hash* is used to compute  $\rho$  from  $\text{cm}$  and  $\text{pos}$  in § 4.16 ‘*Computing  $\rho$  values and Nullifiers*’ on p. 58. It takes as input a *Pedersen commitment*  $P$ , and hashes it with another input  $x$ .

Let  $\mathcal{J}^{\text{Sapling}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.1.8 ‘*Mixing Pedersen Hash Function*’ on p. 81.

We define  $\text{MixingPedersenHash} : \{0 \dots r_{\mathbb{J}} - 1\} \times \mathbb{J} \rightarrow \mathbb{J}$  by:

$$\text{MixingPedersenHash}(P, x) := P + [x] \mathcal{J}^{\text{Sapling}}.$$

This costs 92 constraints for a scalar multiplication (§ A.3.3.7 ‘*Fixed-base Affine-ctEdwards scalar multiplication*’ on p. 208), and 6 constraints for a *ctEdwards* addition (§ A.3.3.5 ‘*Affine-ctEdwards arithmetic*’ on p. 207), for a total of 98 constraints.

### A.3.4 Merkle path check

Checking each layer of a Merkle authentication path, as described in §4.9 ‘*Merkle Path Validity*’ on p. 49, requires to:

- boolean-constrain the path bit specifying whether the previous node is a left or right child;
- conditionally swap the previous-layer and sibling hashes (as  $\mathbb{F}_r$  elements) depending on the path bit;
- unpack the left and right hash inputs to two sequences of 255 bits;
- compute the Merkle hash for this node.

The unpacking need not be canonical in the sense discussed in §A.3.2.1 ‘*[Un]packing modulo  $r_s$* ’ on p. 202; that is, it is *not* necessary to ensure that the left or right inputs to the hash represent integers in the range  $\{0 \dots r_s - 1\}$ . Since the root of the Merkle tree is calculated outside the circuit using the canonical representations, and since the *Pedersen hashes* are *collision-resistant* on arbitrary *bit-sequence* inputs, an attempt by an adversarial prover to use a *non-canonical* input would result in the wrong root being calculated, and the overall path check would fail.

For each layer, the cost is  $1 + 2 \cdot 255$  boolean constraints, 2 constraints for the conditional swap (implemented as two selection constraints), and 869 constraints for the Merkle hash (§A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210), for a total of 1380 constraints.

**Non-normative note:** The conditional swap  $(a_0, a_1) \mapsto (c_0, c_1)$  could be implemented in only one constraint by substituting  $c_1 = a_0 + a_1 - c_0$  into the uses of  $c_1$ . The **Sapling** circuit does not use this optimization.

### A.3.5 Windowed Pedersen Commitment

We construct *windowed Pedersen commitments* by reusing the Pedersen hash implementation described in §A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210, and adding a randomized point:

$$\text{WindowedPedersenCommit}_r(s) = \text{PedersenHashToPoint}(\text{"Zcash\_PH"}, s) + [r] \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}(\text{"Zcash\_PH"}, \text{"r"})$$

This can be implemented in:

- $5 \cdot c + 5 \cdot n - 6$  constraints for the Pedersen hash applied to  $\ell = 6 + \text{length}(s)$  bits, where  $c = \text{ceiling}\left(\frac{\ell}{3}\right)$  and  $n = \text{ceiling}\left(\frac{\ell}{3 \cdot 63}\right)$ ;
- 750 constraints for the fixed-base scalar multiplication;
- 6 constraints for the final *ctEdwards* addition.

When `WindowedPedersenCommit` is used to instantiate `NoteCommit`<sup>Sapling</sup>, the cost of the Pedersen hash is 984 constraints as calculated in §A.3.3.9 ‘*Pedersen hash*’ on p. 210, and so the total cost in that case is 1740 constraints. This does not include the cost of boolean-constraining the input  $s$  or the randomness  $r$ .

### A.3.6 Homomorphic Pedersen Commitment

The *windowed Pedersen commitments* defined in the preceding section are highly efficient, but they do not support the homomorphic property we need when instantiating `ValueCommit`.

In order to support this property, we also define *homomorphic Pedersen commitments* as follows:

$$\text{HomomorphicPedersenCommit}_{\text{rcv}}^{\text{Sapling}}(D, v) = [v] \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}(D, \text{"v"}) + [\text{rcv}] \text{FindGroupHash}^{\mathbb{J}^{(r)*}}(D, \text{"r"})$$



In the case that we need for ValueCommit,  $v$  has 64 bits<sup>16</sup>. This value is given as a bit representation, which does not need to be constrained equal to an integer.

ValueCommit can be implemented in:

- 750 constraints for the 252-bit fixed-base multiplication by  $rcv$ ;
- 191 constraints for the 64-bit fixed-base multiplication by  $v$ ;
- 6 constraints for the *ctEdwards* addition

for a total cost of 947 constraints. This does not include the cost to boolean-constrain the input  $v$  or randomness  $rcv$ .

### A.3.7 BLAKE2s hashes

BLAKE2s is defined in [ANWW2013]. Its main subcomponent is a “ $G$  function”, defined as follows:

$$G : \{0..9\} \times \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[4]} \rightarrow \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[4]}$$

$$G(a, b, c, d, x, y) = (a'', b'', c'', d'') \text{ where}$$

$$a' = (a + b + x) \bmod 2^{32}$$

$$d' = (d \oplus a') \ggg 16$$

$$c' = (c + d') \bmod 2^{32}$$

$$b' = (b \oplus c') \ggg 12$$

$$a'' = (a' + b' + y) \bmod 2^{32}$$

$$d'' = (d' \oplus a'') \ggg 8$$

$$c'' = (c' + d'') \bmod 2^{32}$$

$$b'' = (b' \oplus c'') \ggg 7$$

The following table is used to determine which message words the  $x$  and  $y$  arguments to  $G$  are selected from:

$$\sigma_0 = [ 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15 ]$$

$$\sigma_1 = [ 14, 10, 4, 8, 9, 15, 13, 6, 1, 12, 0, 2, 11, 7, 5, 3 ]$$

$$\sigma_2 = [ 11, 8, 12, 0, 5, 2, 15, 13, 10, 14, 3, 6, 7, 1, 9, 4 ]$$

$$\sigma_3 = [ 7, 9, 3, 1, 13, 12, 11, 14, 2, 6, 5, 10, 4, 0, 15, 8 ]$$

$$\sigma_4 = [ 9, 0, 5, 7, 2, 4, 10, 15, 14, 1, 11, 12, 6, 8, 3, 13 ]$$

$$\sigma_5 = [ 2, 12, 6, 10, 0, 11, 8, 3, 4, 13, 7, 5, 15, 14, 1, 9 ]$$

$$\sigma_6 = [ 12, 5, 1, 15, 14, 13, 4, 10, 0, 7, 6, 3, 9, 2, 8, 11 ]$$

$$\sigma_7 = [ 13, 11, 7, 14, 12, 1, 3, 9, 5, 0, 15, 4, 8, 6, 2, 10 ]$$

$$\sigma_8 = [ 6, 15, 14, 9, 11, 3, 0, 8, 12, 2, 13, 7, 1, 4, 10, 5 ]$$

$$\sigma_9 = [ 10, 2, 8, 4, 7, 6, 1, 5, 15, 11, 9, 14, 3, 12, 13, 0 ]$$

The Initialization Vector is defined as:

$$\text{IV} : \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[8]} := [ 0x6A09E667, 0xBB67AE85, 0x3C6EF372, 0xA54FF53A, \\ 0x510E527F, 0x9B05688C, 0x1F83D9AB, 0x5BE0CD19 ]$$

<sup>16</sup>It would be sufficient to use 51 bits, which accomodates the range  $\{0.. \text{MAX\_MONEY}\}$ , but the **Sapling** circuit uses 64.

The full hash function applied to an 8-byte personalization string and a single 64-byte block, in sequential mode with 32-byte output, can be expressed as follows.

Define BLAKE2s-256 :  $(p : \mathbb{B}^{[8]}) \times (x : \mathbb{B}^{[64]}) \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[32]}$  as:

```

let PB :  $\mathbb{B}^{[32]}$  =  $[32, 0, 1, 1] \parallel [0x00]^{20} \parallel p$ 
let  $[t_0, t_1, f_0, f_1] : \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[4]} = [0, 0, 0, 0xFFFFFFFF, 0]$ 
let  $h : \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[8]} = [LEOS2IP_{32}(PB_{4 \cdot i..4 \cdot i+3}) \oplus IV_i \text{ for } i \text{ from } 0 \text{ up to } 7]$ 
let  $m : \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[16]} = [LEOS2IP_{32}(x_{4 \cdot i..4 \cdot i+3}) \text{ for } i \text{ from } 0 \text{ up to } 15]$ 
let mutable  $v : \{0..2^{32}-1\}^{[16]} \leftarrow h \parallel [IV_0, IV_1, IV_2, IV_3, t_0 \oplus IV_4, t_1 \oplus IV_5, f_0 \oplus IV_6, f_1 \oplus IV_7]$ 

for  $r$  from 0 up to 9:
  set  $(v_0, v_4, v_8, v_{12}) \leftarrow G(v_0, v_4, v_8, v_{12}, m_{\sigma_{r,0}}, m_{\sigma_{r,1}})$ 
  set  $(v_1, v_5, v_9, v_{13}) \leftarrow G(v_1, v_5, v_9, v_{13}, m_{\sigma_{r,2}}, m_{\sigma_{r,3}})$ 
  set  $(v_2, v_6, v_{10}, v_{14}) \leftarrow G(v_2, v_6, v_{10}, v_{14}, m_{\sigma_{r,4}}, m_{\sigma_{r,5}})$ 
  set  $(v_3, v_7, v_{11}, v_{15}) \leftarrow G(v_3, v_7, v_{11}, v_{15}, m_{\sigma_{r,6}}, m_{\sigma_{r,7}})$ 

  set  $(v_0, v_5, v_{10}, v_{15}) \leftarrow G(v_0, v_5, v_{10}, v_{15}, m_{\sigma_{r,8}}, m_{\sigma_{r,9}})$ 
  set  $(v_1, v_6, v_{11}, v_{12}) \leftarrow G(v_1, v_6, v_{11}, v_{12}, m_{\sigma_{r,10}}, m_{\sigma_{r,11}})$ 
  set  $(v_2, v_7, v_8, v_{13}) \leftarrow G(v_2, v_7, v_8, v_{13}, m_{\sigma_{r,12}}, m_{\sigma_{r,13}})$ 
  set  $(v_3, v_4, v_9, v_{14}) \leftarrow G(v_3, v_4, v_9, v_{14}, m_{\sigma_{r,14}}, m_{\sigma_{r,15}})$ 

return LEBS2OSP256(concat $\mathbb{B}$ ( $[I2LEBSP_{32}(h_i \oplus v_i \oplus v_{i+8}) \text{ for } i \text{ from } 0 \text{ up to } 7]$ ))

```

In practice the message and output will be expressed as *bit sequences*. In the **Sapling** circuit, the personalization string will be constant for each use.

Each 32-bit exclusive-or is implemented in 32 constraints, one for each bit position  $a \oplus b = c$  as in §A.3.1.5 ‘*Exclusive-or constraints*’ on p. 202.

Additions not involving a message word, i.e.  $(a + b) \bmod 2^{32} = c$ , are implemented using 33 constraints and a 33-bit equality check: constrain 33 boolean variables  $c_{0..32}$ , and then check  $\sum_{i=0}^{i=31} (a_i + b_i) \cdot 2^i = \sum_{i=0}^{i=32} c_i \cdot 2^i$ .

Additions involving a message word, i.e.  $(a + b + m) \bmod 2^{32} = c$ , are implemented using 34 constraints and a 34-bit equality check: constrain 34 boolean variables  $c_{0..33}$ , and then check  $\sum_{i=0}^{i=31} (a_i + b_i + m_i) \cdot 2^i = \sum_{i=0}^{i=33} c_i \cdot 2^i$ .

For each addition, only  $c_{0..31}$  are used subsequently.

The equality checks are batched; as many sets of 33 or 34 boolean variables as will fit in a  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  field element are equated together using one constraint. This allows 7 such checks per constraint.

Each  $G$  evaluation requires 262 constraints:

- $4 \cdot 32 = 128$  constraints for  $\oplus$  operations;
- $2 \cdot 33 = 66$  constraints for 32-bit additions not involving message words (excluding equality checks);
- $2 \cdot 34 = 68$  constraints for 32-bit additions involving message words (excluding equality checks).

The overall cost is 21006 constraints:

- $10 \cdot 8 \cdot 262 - 4 \cdot 2 \cdot 32 = 20704$  constraints for 80  $G$  evaluations, excluding equality checks (the deduction of  $4 \cdot 2 \cdot 32$  is because  $v$  is constant at the start of the first round, so in the first four calls to  $G$ , the parameters  $b$  and  $d$  are constant, eliminating the constraints for the first two XORs in those four calls to  $G$ );
- $\text{ceiling}\left(\frac{10 \cdot 8 \cdot 4}{7}\right) = 46$  constraints for equality checks;
- $8 \cdot 32 = 256$  constraints for final  $v_i \oplus v_{i+8}$  operations (the  $h_i$  words are constants so no additional constraints are required to exclusive-or with them).

This cost includes boolean-constraining the hash output bits (done implicitly by the final  $\oplus$  operations), but not the message bits.

**Non-normative notes:**

- The equality checks could be eliminated entirely by substituting each check into a boolean constraint for  $c_0$ , for instance, but this optimization is not done in **Sapling**.
- It should be clear that BLAKE2s is very expensive in the circuit compared to elliptic curve operations. This is primarily because it is inefficient to use  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  elements to represent single bits. However Pedersen hashes do not have the necessary cryptographic properties for the two cases where the *Spend circuit* uses BLAKE2s. While it might be possible to use variants of functions with low circuit cost such as MiMC [AGRRT2017], it was felt that they had not yet received sufficient cryptanalytic attention to confidently use them for **Sapling**.

## A.4 The Sapling Spend circuit

The **Sapling** Spend *statement* is defined in § 4.18.2 ‘*Spend Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 61.

The primary input is

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}} : \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}} \rceil}, \\ &\text{cv}^{\text{old}} : \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}, \\ &\text{nf}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell_{\text{PRFntSapling}}/8 \rceil}, \\ &\text{rk} : \text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Public}), \end{aligned}$$

which is encoded as  $8 \mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  elements (starting with the fixed element 1 required by Groth16):

$$[1, \mathcal{U}(\text{rk}), \mathcal{V}(\text{rk}), \mathcal{U}(\text{cv}^{\text{old}}), \mathcal{V}(\text{cv}^{\text{old}}), \text{LEBS2IP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}(\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}), \text{LEBS2IP}_{254}(\text{nf}_{\star 0 \dots 253}^{\text{old}}), \text{LEBS2IP}_2(\text{nf}_{\star 254 \dots 255}^{\text{old}})]$$

where  $\text{nf}_{\star}^{\text{old}} = \text{LEOS2BSP}_{\ell_{\text{PRFntSapling}}}(\text{nf}^{\text{old}})$ .

The auxiliary input is

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{path} : \mathbb{B}^{\lceil \ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}} \rceil \lceil \text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}} \rceil}, \\ &\text{pos} : \{0 \dots 2^{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{g}_d : \mathbb{J}, \\ &\text{pk}_d : \mathbb{J}, \\ &\text{v}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{rcv}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{cm}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{J}, \\ &\text{rcm}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\alpha : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{ak} : \text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Public}, \\ &\text{nsk} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}). \end{aligned}$$

$\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}$  and  $\text{SpendAuthSig}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Public}$  are of type  $\mathbb{J}$ , so we have  $\text{cv}^{\text{old}}$ ,  $\text{cm}^{\text{old}}$ ,  $\text{rk}$ ,  $\text{g}_d$ ,  $\text{pk}_d$ , and  $\text{ak}$  that represent Jubjub curve points. However,

- $\text{cv}^{\text{old}}$  will be constrained to an output of  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ;
- $\text{cm}^{\text{old}}$  will be constrained to an output of  $\text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ;
- $\text{rk}$  will be constrained to  $[\alpha] \mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}} + \text{ak}$ ;
- $\text{pk}_d$  will be constrained to  $[\text{ivk}] \text{g}_d$

so  $\text{cv}^{\text{old}}$ ,  $\text{cm}^{\text{old}}$ ,  $\text{rk}$ , and  $\text{pk}_d$  do not need to be explicitly checked to be on the curve.

In addition,  $\text{nk}_{\star}$  and  $\text{p}_{\star}$  used in **Nullifier integrity** are compressed representations of Jubjub curve points. **TODO:** explain why these are implemented as § A.3.3.2 ‘*ctEdwards [de]compression and validation*’ on p. 205 even though the statement spec doesn’t explicitly say to do validation.

Therefore we have  $\text{g}_d$ ,  $\text{ak}$ ,  $\text{nk}$ , and  $\text{p}$  that need to be constrained to valid Jubjub curve points as described in § A.3.3.2 ‘*ctEdwards [de]compression and validation*’ on p. 205.

In order to aid in comparing the implementation with the specification, we present the checks needed in the order in which they are implemented in the sapling-crypto code:

| Check                                                                                                                           | Implements                                                               | Cost            | Reference            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| ak is on the curve <b>TODO: FIXME also decompressed below</b>                                                                   | ak : SpendAuthSig <sup>Sapling</sup> .Public                             | 4               | § A.3.3.1 on p. 205  |
| ak is not <i>small-order</i>                                                                                                    | <b>Small order checks</b>                                                | 16              | § A.3.3.6 on p. 208  |
| $\alpha \star : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$                                                             | $\alpha : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$     | 252             | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201  |
| $\alpha' = [\alpha \star] \mathcal{G}^{\text{Sapling}}$                                                                         | <b>Spend authority</b>                                                   | 750             | § A.3.3.7 on p. 208  |
| $\text{rk} = \alpha' + \text{ak}$                                                                                               |                                                                          | 6               | § A.3.3.5 on p. 207  |
| inputize rk <b>TODO: not ccteddecompress-validate =&gt; wrong count</b>                                                         | rk : SpendAuthSig <sup>Sapling</sup> .Public                             | 392?            | § A.3.3.2 on p. 205  |
| $\text{nsk} \star : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$                                                         | $\text{nsk} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252             | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201  |
| $\text{nk} = [\text{nsk} \star] \mathcal{H}^{\text{Sapling}}$                                                                   | <b>Nullifier integrity</b>                                               | 750             | § A.3.3.7 on p. 208  |
| $\text{ak} \star = \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{ak} : \mathbb{J})$                                                            | <b>Diversified address integrity</b>                                     | 392             | § A.3.3.2 on p. 205  |
| $\text{nk} \star = \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\text{nk})$ <b>TODO: spec doesn't say to validate nk since it's calculated</b>      | <b>Nullifier integrity</b>                                               | 392             | § A.3.3.2 on p. 205  |
| $\text{ivk} \star = \text{I2LEBSP}_{251}(\text{CRH}^{\text{ivk}}(\text{ak}, \text{nk})) \dagger$                                | <b>Diversified address integrity</b>                                     | 21006           | § A.3.7 on p. 214    |
| $\text{g}_d$ is on the curve                                                                                                    | $\text{g}_d : \mathbb{J}$                                                | 4               | § A.3.3.1 on p. 205  |
| $\text{g}_d$ is not <i>small-order</i>                                                                                          | <b>Small order checks</b>                                                | 16              | § A.3.3.6 on p. 208  |
| $\text{pk}_d = [\text{ivk} \star] \text{g}_d$                                                                                   | <b>Diversified address integrity</b>                                     | 3252            | § A.3.3.8 on p. 209  |
| $\text{v}^{\text{old}} \star : \mathbb{B}^{[64]}$                                                                               | $\text{v}^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{64} - 1\}$                         | 64              | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201  |
| $\text{rcv} \star : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$                                                         | $\text{rcv} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252             | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201  |
| $\text{cv} = \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{rcv}, \text{v}^{\text{old}}}$                                                            | <b>Value commitment integrity</b>                                        | 947             | § A.3.6 on p. 213    |
| inputize cv                                                                                                                     |                                                                          | ?               |                      |
| $\text{rcm} \star : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}}$                                                         | $\text{rcm} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252             | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201  |
| $\text{cm} = \text{NoteCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}_{\text{rcm}}(\text{g}_d, \text{pk}_d, \text{v}^{\text{old}})$                   | <b>Note commitment integrity</b>                                         | 1740            | § A.3.5 on p. 213    |
| $\text{cm}_u = \text{Extract}_{\mathbb{J}(r)}(\text{cm})$                                                                       | <b>Merkle path validity</b>                                              | 0               |                      |
| $\text{rt}'$ is the root of a Merkle tree with leaf $\text{cm}_u$ , and authentication path $(\text{path}, \text{pos} \star)$   |                                                                          | $32 \cdot 1380$ | § A.3.4 on p. 213    |
| $\text{pos} \star = \text{I2LEBSP}_{\text{MerkleDepth}^{\text{Sapling}}}(\text{pos})$                                           |                                                                          | 1               | § A.3.2.1 on p. 202  |
| if $\text{v}^{\text{old}} \neq 0$ then $\text{rt}' = \text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}$                                                |                                                                          | 1               | § A.3.1.2 on p. 201  |
| inputize $\text{rt}^{\text{Sapling}}$                                                                                           |                                                                          | ?               |                      |
| $\rho = \text{MixingPedersenHash}(\text{cm}^{\text{old}}, \text{pos})$                                                          | <b>Nullifier integrity</b>                                               | 98              | § A.3.3.10 on p. 212 |
| $\rho \star = \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(\rho)$ <b>TODO: spec doesn't say to validate <math>\rho</math> since it's calculated</b> |                                                                          | 392             | § A.3.3.2 on p. 205  |
| $\text{nf}^{\text{old}} = \text{PRF}^{\text{nfSapling}}_{\text{nk} \star}(\rho \star)$                                          |                                                                          | 21006           | § A.3.7 on p. 214    |
| pack $\text{nf}^{\text{old}}_{0 \dots 253}$ and $\text{nf}^{\text{old}}_{254 \dots 255}$ into two $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ inputs     | input encoding                                                           | 2               | § A.3.2.1 on p. 202  |

† This is implemented by taking the output of BLAKE2s-256 as a *bit sequence* and dropping the most significant 5 bits, not by converting to an integer and back to a *bit sequence* as literally specified.

**Note:** The implementation represents  $\alpha^*$ ,  $\text{nsk}^*$ ,  $\text{ivk}^*$ ,  $\text{rcm}^*$ ,  $\text{rcv}^*$ , and  $\text{v}^{\text{old}}$  as *bit sequences* rather than integers. It represents  $\text{nf}$  as a *bit sequence* rather than a *byte sequence*.

## A.5 The Sapling Output circuit

The **Sapling** Output *statement* is defined in §4.18.3 ‘*Output Statement (Sapling)*’ on p. 62.

The primary input is

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{cv}^{\text{new}} : \text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}, \\ &\text{cm}_u : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}, \\ &\text{epk} : \mathbb{J}), \end{aligned}$$

which is encoded as  $6 \mathbb{F}_{r_s}$  elements (starting with the fixed element 1 required by Groth16):

$$[1, \mathcal{U}(\text{cv}^{\text{new}}), \mathcal{V}(\text{cv}^{\text{new}}), \mathcal{U}(\text{epk}), \mathcal{V}(\text{epk}), \text{LEBS2IP}_{\ell_{\text{Merkle}}^{\text{Sapling}}}(\text{cm}_u)]$$

The auxiliary input is

$$\begin{aligned} &(\text{g}_d : \mathbb{J}, \\ &\text{pk}^*_d : \mathbb{B}^{\ell_d}, \\ &\text{v}^{\text{new}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{value}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{rcv}^{\text{new}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{rcm}^{\text{new}} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}, \\ &\text{esk} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{scalar}}^{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}) \end{aligned}$$

$\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}.\text{Output}$  is of type  $\mathbb{J}$ , so we have  $\text{cv}^{\text{new}}$ ,  $\text{epk}$ , and  $\text{g}_d$  that represent Jubjub curve points. However,

- $\text{cv}^{\text{new}}$  will be constrained to an output of  $\text{ValueCommit}^{\text{Sapling}}$ ,
- $\text{epk}$  will be constrained to  $[\text{esk}] \text{g}_d$

so  $\text{cv}^{\text{new}}$  and  $\text{epk}$  do not need to be explicitly checked to be on the curve.

Therefore we have only  $\text{g}_d$  that needs to be constrained to a valid Jubjub curve point as described in §A.3.3.2 ‘*ctEdwards [de]compression and validation*’ on p. 205.

**Note:**  $\text{pk}^*_d$  is *not* checked to be a valid compressed representation of a Jubjub curve point.

In order to aid in comparing the implementation with the specification, we present the checks needed in the order in which they are implemented in the sapling-crypto code:

| Check                                                                                                   | Implements                                               | Cost | Reference           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------|---------------------|
| $v_{\star}^{\text{old}} : \mathbb{B}^{[64]}$                                                            | $v^{\text{old}} : \{0 \dots 2^{64} - 1\}$                | 64   | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201 |
| $\text{rcv}_{\star} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Sapling}}]}$                                             | $\text{rcv} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252  | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201 |
| $\text{cv} = \text{ValueCommit}_{\text{rcv}}^{\text{Sapling}}(v^{\text{old}})$                          | <b>Value commitment integrity</b>                        | 947  | § A.3.6 on p. 213   |
| inputize cv                                                                                             |                                                          | ?    |                     |
| $g_{\star d} = \text{repr}_{\mathbb{J}}(g_d : \mathbb{J})$                                              | <b>Note commitment integrity</b>                         | 392  | § A.3.3.2 on p. 205 |
| $g_d$ is not <i>small-order</i>                                                                         | <b>Small order checks</b>                                | 16   | § A.3.3.6 on p. 208 |
| $\text{esk}_{\star} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Sapling}}]}$                                             | $\text{esk} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252  | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201 |
| $\text{epk} = [\text{esk}_{\star}] g_d$                                                                 | <b>Ephemeral public key integrity</b>                    | 3252 | § A.3.3.8 on p. 209 |
| inputize epk                                                                                            |                                                          | ?    |                     |
| $\text{pk}_{\star d} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{J}}]}$                                                | $\text{pk}_{\star d} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{J}}]}$ | 256  | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201 |
| $\text{rcm}_{\star} : \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\text{Sapling}}]}$                                             | $\text{rcm} : \{0 \dots 2^{\ell_{\text{Sapling}}} - 1\}$ | 252  | § A.3.1.1 on p. 201 |
| $\text{cm} = \text{NoteCommit}_{\text{rcm}}^{\text{Sapling}}(g_d, \text{pk}_{\star d}, v^{\text{old}})$ | <b>Note commitment integrity</b>                         | 1740 | § A.3.5 on p. 213   |
| pack inputs                                                                                             |                                                          | ?    |                     |

**Note:** The implementation represents  $\text{esk}_{\star}$ ,  $\text{pk}_{\star d}$ ,  $\text{rcm}_{\star}$ ,  $\text{rcv}_{\star}$ , and  $v_{\star}^{\text{old}}$  as *bit sequences* rather than integers.

## B Batching Optimizations

### B.1 RedDSA batch validation

The reference validation algorithm for RedDSA signatures is defined in § 5.4.7 ‘RedDSA, RedJubjub, *and* RedPallas’ on p. 92.

Let the RedDSA parameters  $\mathbb{G}$  (defining a subgroup  $\mathbb{G}^{(r)}$  of order  $r_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a cofactor  $h_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a group operation  $+$ , an additive identity  $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a bit-length  $\ell_{\mathbb{G}}$ , a representation function  $\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}$ , and an abstraction function  $\text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}$ );  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}} : \mathbb{G}; \ell_{\mathbb{H}} : \mathbb{N}; \mathbb{H} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[N]}} \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^{[\ell_{\mathbb{H}}/8]}$ ; and the derived hash function  $\mathbb{H}^{\otimes} : \mathbb{B}^{\mathbb{Y}^{[N]}} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{G}}}$  be as defined in that section.

Implementations **MAY** alternatively use the optimized procedure described in this section to perform faster validation of a batch of signatures, i.e. to determine whether all signatures in a batch are valid. Its input is a sequence of  $N$  *signature batch entries*, each of which is a (*validating key*, *message*, *signature*) triple.

Let LEOS2BSP, LEOS2IP, and LEBS2OSP be as defined in § 5.1 ‘*Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness*’ on p. 73.

Define  $\text{RedDSA.BatchEntry} := \text{RedDSA.Public} \times \text{RedDSA.Message} \times \text{RedDSA.Signature}$ .



Define  $\text{RedDSA.BatchValidate} : (\text{entry}_{0..N-1} : \text{RedDSA.BatchEntry}^{[N]}) \rightarrow \mathbb{B}$  as:

For each  $j \in \{0..N-1\}$ :

Let  $(\text{vk}_j, M_j, \sigma_j) = \text{entry}_j$ .

Let  $\underline{R}_j$  be the first ceiling  $(\ell_{\mathbb{G}}/8)$  bytes of  $\sigma_j$ , and let  $\underline{S}_j$  be the remaining ceiling  $(\text{bitlength}(r_{\mathbb{G}})/8)$  bytes.

Let  $R_j = \text{abst}_{\mathbb{G}}(\text{LEOS2BSP}_{\ell_{\mathbb{G}}}(\underline{R}_j))$ , and let  $S_j = \text{LEOS2IP}_{\text{S.length}(\underline{S}_j)}(\underline{S}_j)$ .

Let  $\underline{\text{vk}}_j = \text{LEBS2OSP}_{\ell_{\mathbb{G}}}(\text{repr}_{\mathbb{G}}(\text{vk}_j))$ .

Let  $c_j = \text{H}^{\oplus}(\underline{R}_j || \underline{\text{vk}}_j || M_j)$ .

Choose random  $z_j : \mathbb{F}_{r_{\mathbb{G}}}^* \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \{1..2^{128} - 1\}$ .

Return 1 if

- for all  $j \in \{0..N-1\}$ ,  $R_j \neq \perp$  and  $S_j < r_{\mathbb{G}}$ ; and
- $[h_{\mathbb{G}}] \left( - \left[ \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} (z_j \cdot S_j) \pmod{r_{\mathbb{G}}} \right] \mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}} + \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} [z_j] R_j + \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} [z_j \cdot c_j \pmod{r_{\mathbb{G}}}] \text{vk}_j \right) = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{G}}$ .

otherwise 0.

The  $z_j$  values **MUST** be chosen independently of the *signature batch entries*.

**Non-normative note:** It is also acceptable to sample each  $z_j$  from  $\{0..2^{128} - 1\}$ , since the probability of obtaining zero for any  $z_j$  is negligible.

The performance benefit of this approach arises partly from replacing the per-signature scalar multiplication of the base  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}}$  with one such multiplication per batch, and partly from using an efficient algorithm for multiscalar multiplication such as Pippenger’s method [Bernstein2001] or the Bos–Coster method [deRoos1995], as explained in [BDLSY2012, section 5].

**Note:** Spend authorization signatures (§ 5.4.7.1 ‘*Spend Authorization Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95) and binding signatures (§ 5.4.7.2 ‘*Binding Signature (Sapling and Orchard)*’ on p. 95) use different bases  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{G}}$ . It is straightforward to adapt the above procedure to handle multiple bases; there will be one  $-\left[\sum_j (z_j \cdot S_j) \pmod{r_{\mathbb{G}}}\right] \mathcal{P}$  term for each base  $\mathcal{P}$ . The benefit of this relative to using separate batches is that the multiscalar multiplication can be extended across a larger batch.

## B.2 Groth16 batch verification

The reference verification algorithm for Groth16 proofs is defined in § 5.4.10.2 ‘Groth16’ on p. 111. The batch verification algorithm in this section applies techniques from [BFIJSV2010, section 4].

Let  $q_{\mathbb{S}}$ ,  $r_{\mathbb{S}}$ ,  $\mathbb{S}_{1,2,T}^{(r)}$ ,  $\mathbb{S}_{1,2,T}^{(r)*}$ ,  $\mathcal{P}_{\mathbb{S}_{1,2,T}}$ ,  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{S}}$ , and  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{S}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.9.2 ‘BLS12-381’ on p. 101.

Define  $\text{MillerLoop}_{\mathbb{S}} : \mathbb{S}_1^{(r)} \times \mathbb{S}_2^{(r)} \rightarrow \mathbb{S}_T^{(r)}$  and  $\text{FinalExp}_{\mathbb{S}} : \mathbb{S}_T^{(r)} \rightarrow \mathbb{S}_T^{(r)}$  to be the Miller loop and final exponentiation respectively of the  $\hat{e}_{\mathbb{S}}$  pairing computation, so that:

$$\hat{e}_{\mathbb{S}}(P, Q) = \text{FinalExp}_{\mathbb{S}}(\text{MillerLoop}_{\mathbb{S}}(P, Q))$$

where  $\text{FinalExp}_{\mathbb{S}}(R) = R^t$  for some fixed  $t$ .

Define  $\text{Groth16}_{\mathbb{S}}.\text{Proof} := \mathbb{S}_1^{(r)*} \times \mathbb{S}_2^{(r)*} \times \mathbb{S}_1^{(r)*}$ .

A  $\text{Groth16}_{\mathbb{S}}$  proof comprises a tuple  $(\pi_A, \pi_B, \pi_C) : \text{Groth16}_{\mathbb{S}}.\text{Proof}$ .

Verification of a single Groth16<sub>S</sub> proof against an instance encoded as  $a_{0.. \ell} : \mathbb{F}_{r_S}^{[\ell+1]}$  requires checking the equation

$$\hat{e}_S(\pi_A, \pi_B) = \hat{e}_S(\pi_C, \Delta) \cdot \hat{e}_S\left(\sum_{i=0}^{\ell} [a_i] \Psi_i, \Gamma\right) \cdot Y$$

where  $\Delta = [\delta] \mathcal{P}_{S_2}$ ,  $\Gamma = [\gamma] \mathcal{P}_{S_2}$ ,  $Y = [\alpha \cdot \beta] \mathcal{P}_{S_T}$ , and  $\Psi_i = \left[ \frac{\beta \cdot u_i(x) + \alpha \cdot v_i(x) + w_i(x)}{\gamma} \right] \mathcal{P}_{S_1}$  for  $i \in \{0.. \ell\}$  are elements of the verification key, as described (with slightly different notation) in [Groth2016, section 3.2].

This can be written as:

$$\hat{e}_S(\pi_A, -\pi_B) \cdot \hat{e}_S(\pi_C, \Delta) \cdot \hat{e}_S\left(\sum_{i=0}^{\ell} [a_i] \Psi_i, \Gamma\right) \cdot Y = \mathbf{1}_S.$$

Raising to the power of random  $z \neq 0$  gives:

$$\hat{e}_S([z] \pi_A, -\pi_B) \cdot \hat{e}_S([z] \pi_C, \Delta) \cdot \hat{e}_S\left(\sum_{i=0}^{\ell} [z \cdot a_i] \Psi_i, \Gamma\right) \cdot Y^z = \mathbf{1}_S.$$

This justifies the following optimized procedure for performing faster verification of a batch of Groth16<sub>S</sub> proofs. Implementations **MAY** use this procedure to determine whether all proofs in a batch are valid.

Define a type  $\text{Groth16}_S.\text{BatchEntry} := \text{Groth16}_S.\text{Proof} \times \text{Groth16}_S.\text{PrimaryInput}$  representing *proof batch entries*.

Define  $\text{Groth16}_S.\text{BatchVerify} : (\text{entry}_{0..N-1} : \text{Groth16}_S.\text{BatchEntry}^{[N]}) \rightarrow \mathbb{B}$  as:

For each  $j \in \{0..N-1\}$ :

Let  $((\pi_{j,A}, \pi_{j,B}, \pi_{j,C}), a_{j,0.. \ell}) = \text{entry}_j$ .

Choose random  $z_j : \mathbb{F}_{r_S}^* \xleftarrow{R} \{1..2^{128} - 1\}$ .

Let  $\text{Accum}_{AB} = \prod_{j=0}^{N-1} \text{MillerLoop}_S([z_j] \pi_{j,A}, -\pi_{j,B})$ .

Let  $\text{Accum}_{\Delta} = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} [z_j] \pi_{j,C}$ .

Let  $\text{Accum}_{\Gamma,i} = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} (z_j \cdot a_{j,i}) \pmod{r_S}$  for  $i \in \{0.. \ell\}$ .

Let  $\text{Accum}_Y = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} z_j \pmod{r_S}$ .

Return 1 if

$$\text{FinalExp}_S\left(\text{Accum}_{AB} \cdot \text{MillerLoop}_S(\text{Accum}_{\Delta}, \Delta) \cdot \text{MillerLoop}_S\left(\sum_{i=0}^{\ell} [\text{Accum}_{\Gamma,i}] \Psi_i, \Gamma\right)\right) \cdot Y^{\text{Accum}_Y} = \mathbf{1}_S,$$

otherwise 0.

The  $z_j$  values **MUST** be chosen independently of the *proof batch entries*.

**Non-normative note:** It is also acceptable to sample each  $z_j$  from  $\{0..2^{128} - 1\}$ , since the probability of obtaining zero for any  $z_j$  is negligible.

The performance benefit of this approach arises from computing two of the three Miller loops, and the final exponentiation, per batch instead of per proof. For the multiplications by  $z_j$ , an efficient algorithm for multiscalar multiplication such as Pippenger's method [Bernstein2001] or the Bos-Coster method [deRoos1995] may be used.

**Note:** Spend proofs (of the *statement* in §4.18.2 '**Spend Statement (Sapling)**' on p. 61) and output proofs (of the *statement* in §4.18.3 '**Output Statement (Sapling)**' on p. 62) use different verification keys, with different parameters  $\Delta$ ,  $\Gamma$ ,  $Y$ , and  $\Psi_{0.. \ell}$ . It is straightforward to adapt the above procedure to handle multiple verification keys; the accumulator variables  $\text{Accum}_{\Delta}$ ,  $\text{Accum}_{\Gamma,i}$ , and  $\text{Accum}_Y$  are duplicated, with one term in the verification equation for each variable, while  $\text{Accum}_{AB}$  is shared.

Neglecting multiplications in  $\mathbb{S}_T^{(r)}$  and  $\mathbb{F}_{r_s}$ , and other trivial operations, the cost of batched verification is therefore

- for each proof: the cost of decoding the proof representation to the form  $\text{Groth16}_{\mathbb{S}}.\text{Proof}$ , which requires three point decompressions and three subgroup checks (two for  $\mathbb{S}_1^{(r)*}$  and one for  $\mathbb{S}_2^{(r)*}$ );
- for each successfully decoded proof: a Miller loop; and a 128-bit scalar multiplication by  $z_j$  in  $\mathbb{S}_1^{(r)}$ ;
- for each verification key: two Miller loops; an exponentiation in  $\mathbb{S}_T^{(r)}$ ; a multiscalar multiplication in  $\mathbb{S}_1^{(r)}$  with  $N$  128-bit scalars to compute  $\text{Accum}_{\Delta}$ ; and a multiscalar multiplication in  $\mathbb{S}_1^{(r)}$  with  $\ell + 1$  255-bit scalars to compute  $\sum_{i=0}^{\ell} [\text{Accum}_{\Gamma, i}] \Psi_i$ ;
- one final exponentiation.

### B.3 Ed25519 batch validation

The reference validation algorithm for Ed25519 signatures is defined in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90.

[**Canopy** onward] Implementations **MAY** alternatively use the optimized procedure described in this section to perform faster validation of a batch of signatures, i.e. to determine whether all signatures in a batch are valid. The correctness of this procedure is dependent on the Ed25519 validation changes made for the **Canopy network upgrade** in [ZIP-215] (in particular the change to use the cofactor variant of the validation equation). The input is a sequence of  $N$  *signature batch entries*, each of which is a (*validating key*, message, signature) triple.

Let  $\ell$ ,  $B$ ,  $\text{abstBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$ , and  $\text{reprBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}$  be as defined in § 5.4.6 ‘Ed25519’ on p. 90.

Let  $\text{LEOS2IP}$  be as defined in § 5.1 ‘Integers, Bit Sequences, and Endianness’ on p. 73.

SHA-512 is defined in § 5.4.1.1 ‘SHA-256, SHA-256d, SHA256Compress, and SHA-512 Hash Functions’ on p. 75.

Define  $\text{Ed25519.BatchEntry} := \text{Ed25519.Public} \times \text{Ed25519.Message} \times \text{Ed25519.Signature}$ .

Define  $\text{Ed25519.BatchValidate} : (\text{entry}_0 \dots \text{entry}_{N-1} : \text{Ed25519.BatchEntry}^{[N]}) \rightarrow \mathbb{B}$  as:

For each  $j \in \{0 \dots N - 1\}$ :

Let  $(A_j, M_j, \sigma_j) = \text{entry}_j$ .

Let  $\underline{R}_j$  be the first 32 bytes of  $\sigma_j$ , and let  $\underline{S}_j$  be the remaining 32 bytes.

Let  $R_j = \text{abstBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}(\underline{R}_j)$ , and let  $S_j = \text{LEOS2IP}_{256}(\underline{S}_j)$ .

Let  $\underline{A}_j = \text{reprBytes}_{\text{Ed25519}}(A_j)$ .

Let  $c_j = \text{LEOS2IP}_{512}(\text{SHA-512}(\underline{R}_j \parallel \underline{A}_j \parallel M_j))$ .

Choose random  $z_j : \mathbb{F}_{\ell}^* \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \{1 \dots 2^{128} - 1\}$ .

Return 1 if

- for all  $j \in \{0 \dots N - 1\}$ ,  $R_j \neq \perp$  and  $S_j < \ell$ ; and
- $[8] \left( - \left[ \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} (z_j \cdot S_j) \pmod{\ell} \right] B + \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} [z_j] R_j + \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} [z_j \cdot c_j \pmod{\ell}] A_j \right) = \mathcal{O}_{\text{Ed25519}}$ ,

otherwise 0.

The  $z_j$  values **MUST** be chosen independently of the *signature batch entries*.

**Non-normative note:** It is also acceptable to sample each  $z_j$  from  $\{0 \dots 2^{128} - 1\}$ , since the probability of obtaining zero for any  $z_j$  is negligible.

The performance benefits of this approach are the same as for § B.1 ‘RedDSA *batch validation*’ on p. 220.

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